MARVEL
MULTIVERSE
ROLE-PLAYING GAME
THE CATACLYSM OF
KANG
ADVENTURE

MARVEL

MULTIVERSE ROLE-PLAYING GAME

THE CATACLYSM OF KANG

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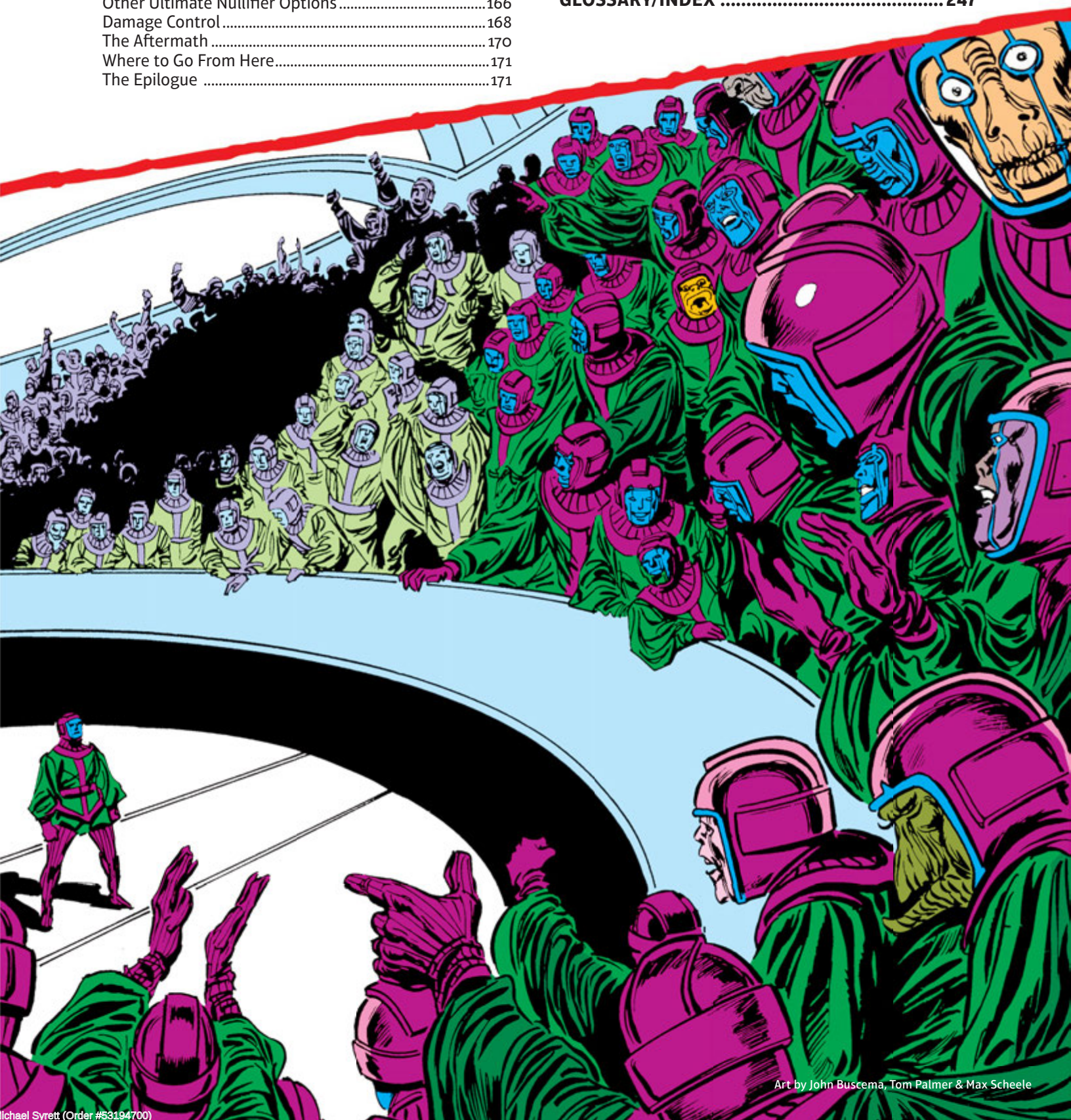

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READY FOR ADVENTURE

Welcome to *The Cataclysm of Kang*! This is the first adventure book for the *Marvel Multiverse Role-Playing Game*.

NARRATORS ONLY!

The information in this book is meant only for the game's Narrator. That's the person in charge of running the game for the rest of the players.

This book is full of all sorts of secrets that unfold during the game. Because of that, people playing heroes in the game should put the book down and walk away to avoid spoiling any of the surprises the book might hold for them.

Or, if you like, buy the book and give it to your Narrator. They might appreciate that. Don't expect any special favors for your heroes, though!

WHAT YOU NEED

This book does not stand on its own. To play through these adventures, you need a copy of the *Marvel Multiverse Role-Playing Game: Core Rulebook*. You should be able to find one wherever you purchased this book.

As described in the *Core Rulebook*, you also need:

- One or more other players. Friends are often the best.
- Three six-sided dice, one of which is a different color. Ideally, have one set for each player, including yourself.
- A blank character sheet for each of the other players.
- Pencils for everyone.
- A bit of time.
- A good sense of fun.

We assume you came loaded with plenty of the last one.

Marvel Expertise

You do *not* need to be an expert on all things Marvel to be able to run the adventures in this book. Each of them is written with plenty of details on the things you should know, including all sorts of ways to plan for contingencies that might crop up.

If you are a longtime expert on Marvel Comics, all the better, of course, but you don't need to understand the intricate details of the several decades of Marvel stories. There's a good summary of all that in the *Core Rulebook* if you want to check it out, though.

If you run into something that you're not sure about, that's okay. Maybe it's a particular piece of a character's history or a wild detail about the underlying ways their powers work or just a bit of trivia that could seem pertinent.

None of that matters. Well, it matters only as much as you want it to.

It's your game. One you share with your players. The universe in which your game happens closely resembles Earth-616—the default universe for Marvel Comics—but it's also its own place.

If things differ a bit in your universe, it's no big deal. That's just how they happen to be in *your* game.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

The Cataclysm of Kang has eight chapters in it, the first of which is this one. The next six chapters each feature an adventure in them that's scaled to a particular rank. The last chapter includes profiles for each of the new characters featured in this book.

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The Adventures

The adventures are:

- **Chapter 2:** Origin Story
- **Chapter 3:** Friendly Neighborhood
- **Chapter 4:** New York State of Mind
- **Chapter 5:** National Emergency
- **Chapter 6:** World of Trouble
- **Chapter 7:** Galaxy of Hurt

As you might notice, they expand in scope from personal to galactic (even multiversal) as they proceed. The first is designed for Rank 1 heroes, the second for Rank 2 and so on, until you reach the greatest challenges with Rank 6 heroes in the sixth adventure.

There are three ways for you to play these adventures.

Single Issues

The adventures are all written so that they can be run individually, as single issues. They come complete with descriptions, maps and even a list of suggested heroes for the players to use.

The profiles for these heroes appear in Chapter 8 in the back of the book or in the *Core Rulebook*. All the players have to do is copy the profiles for their chosen characters on to character sheets, and they're ready to play. Alternatively, of course, the players can come up with their own heroes who fit the suggested rank for each particular adventure.

If you like, you can play each of the adventures as a one-shot, a story that stands on its own. While the stories in the issues do connect to form an overarching plot, you can ignore that and just play the ones that appeal to you.

Ideally, you should start with Chapter 2: Origin Story, as that's a great way to introduce new players to the game. The challenges in that adventure are a little simpler, and there are fewer powers for the players—and even a new Narrator—to have to keep track of with Rank 1 heroes.

However, if you're ready to leap into the deep end of the pool, there's nothing stopping you from starting with any chapter you like. Most Marvel Comics stories tend to use heroes of Rank 3 or Rank 4, so if you're looking for familiar heroes—or at least power levels—you could check out Chapter 4: New York State of Mind or Chapter 5: National Emergency.

The final adventure—Chapter 7: Galaxy of Hurt—features some of the most powerful heroes and challenges in the Multiverse. You might want to work your way up to playing through that one, but again, it's entirely your call.

The Graphic Novel

The six adventures in this book can all be run together as a graphic novel too. To do so, you start with the first and play your way through in sequence all the way to the end in the sixth.

Chapter 2: Origin Story launches the entire campaign, and it's meant for Rank 1 heroes. Each adventure after that is designed for a rank higher than the one before it.

This requires more of a commitment than playing a single-issue game, but each adventure the heroes make it through gives them more context for—and a better appreciation of—the later adventures. As the heroes move from one adventure to another, they'll delve further into the overarching storyline and begin to realize just how deep the plot they've become embroiled in goes.

Plot Points in Ongoing Series

If you're planning a longer game of your own, you can use the adventures in this book as a part of that, weaving them in at moments that seem to fit best. In that sort of situation, there's no need to play each chapter one right after the other. Instead, you can play through one chapter, have the heroes go off on other adventures—either together or in smaller or different groups—and then come back to the next chapter when you feel ready for it.

The trick with using the book this way is to ensure that the players don't lose the threads of the bigger plot while they go off on their tangents with you. If the players like to take notes as they go, they can handle that issue for you. Either way, though, when you head back into this series of adventures, it can help to give the players a recap of what's happened before.

Most Marvel Comics offer this kind of a summary on the first pages of the comic. This makes sure that faithful readers—who must often wait a month between issues—get their memory jogged without having to go back and reread everything that came before.

A Narrator's recap serves the same purpose for your players. This can also serve to highlight things that they might have glossed over before but might want to give a second look to now.

If you're ambitious, you can tie your other adventures to the main plot. This allows the players to dive deeper into some bits that they might not otherwise have the chance to fully examine. Each chapter features some suggestions for such sidetracks.

It's possible for these sidetracks to become the main adventure—which is fine. Since you can tailor those new adventures directly to the characters involved, they can feel more personal. Remember, though, that before too long, you should get back to the plot threads you left dangling. Otherwise, they may gnaw at the players beyond simply keeping them in suspense.

PLAYING OUT OF SEQUENCE

If you started out playing through an adventure as a single issue, you might decide to continue on from there and complete the graphic novel—or to use the adventures as plot points. If you started with Chapter 2: Origin Story, that's simple enough. You can just continue on to the next chapter and play the adventures straight through like you normally would.

If you tackled a different adventure first, though, you might be confused about how to proceed. The most straightforward way is to go back to Chapter 2 and play through the adventures you haven't gotten to yet as a prequel to the one you did.

For instance, if you started out with Chapter 4: New York State of Mind, go back and play through the first two chapters as prequels to that. Once you manage that, you can take up the graphic novel again with Chapter 5: National Emergency and play through the rest of the book.

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Peeling Back

If you began with Chapter 7: Galaxy of Hurt, this gets a little trickier, as you have to go all the way back to the start, which gives you a long way to circle around to where you started. That can work fine, but there's another option that might work better for you: playing the adventures backward.

In this way, you start at the end and then play the next one before it until you reach Chapter 2 at the start. Every time you move backward, you let the players delve a bit deeper into the backstory of what they've already played through, right up until they find themselves at the start.

If you're playing with original heroes, you might consider bumping the characters back one rank each time they start a new adventure. They can go from being cosmic-level super heroes to maybe not having any powers at all. This is backward from how the progression usually goes, but it can make for a wonderful way to learn more about the heroes and what makes them tick.

THE HEROES

Each of the adventures comes with a list of suggested heroes the players can use in that adventure. The players don't have to play with those heroes, though, if they'd prefer to play someone else.

Playing the Suggested Heroes

The heroes listed in each chapter are easy to pick up and use. Players should copy the details over from the character profiles on to character sheets, and they're ready to go.

Each time you start a new adventure, the players simply take on a new hero. Instead of playing a single character throughout a graphic novel, they're taking more of a mosaic approach to the story, digging into the perspectives of not just one hero but many.

This is also easier on you as the Narrator because you don't have to worry about what kinds of powers original heroes might have that could possibly mess with the adventure in unforeseen ways. These are established heroes with their own histories and personalities, so you should have a better idea of what might crop up in play.

On top of that, this is a great way for the players to sample playing characters of different ranks. By the time they're all the way through the adventures in this book, they should have a good handle on the kinds of adventures they prefer, and you can tailor any further adventures to fit that particular rank.

Playing Original Heroes

Of course, some players may want to play their own original heroes, and that works fine too. This gives the players a chance to tinker with the character-creation system and see what works. It helps them to learn how to build the kinds of characters they want to play.

If the players are up for it, they can create new heroes for each adventure, just as if they were using the recommended heroes. If they play through the entire graphic novel, by the time they're done, they should each have six original characters of their own. This means that they should have a character ready to go for any future adventures you might want to run, no matter the suggested rank.

Ranking Up

Players might be interested in taking a single character and playing through the whole graphic novel with them, all the way from Chapter 2: Origin Story to Chapter 7: Galaxy of Hurt. That's a fine way to go as well, and it allows the players to follow their hero's story all the way from their humble origins to becoming cosmic power players.

If you're up for an ongoing game like that, let all the players know. They should start by creating heroes at Rank 1, and the rank cap for the game is Rank 6.

This is a good way for players to begin playing the game with an easy hero with few powers and then add to them as they bump up from rank to rank. They can learn more about the game and the options available to them with every bump in rank. By the time the heroes reach Rank 6, you and the rest of the players should all be experts at the game.

Strictly speaking, the players don't have to start off with Rank 1 heroes, though. They can start at any rank you like, although if they play through adventures that aren't meant for their rank, you may have to make some adjustments to keep them balanced between too easy and far too tough. See more on that in Ranking Up Marvel Heroes.

If the heroes start off at Rank 3, for instance, the first two adventures are likely to be a bit too easy for them. However, when they reach Chapter 4: New York State of Mind, they would be meeting the challenges there head-on, and assuming they rise in rank with each adventure, they would be well-matched all the way to the end.

Ranking Up Marvel Heroes

If you like, the players could start out with established Marvel heroes and rank them up from adventure to adventure as well. Daredevil, for instance, is a Rank 2 hero, but a player could start adding ranks to him as if they had created him as an original character.

If a player does this, they can choose how they want to customize the original character as they go. They can add new powers, traits and so on, just like with a character they made.

By the time they're done, that character might not look a whole lot like the Marvel character who inspired it, but that's okay. It's your game—which makes it your universe—and if the players and you are all having fun with it, you're doing it right.

THE VILLAINS

These adventures were designed to be easy to pick up and play, and for that reason, we provide profiles for all the villains who are included, either in this book or in the *Core Rulebook*. Just as with many other aspects of the game, though, you don't have to feel restricted to that.

When it comes to tinkering with the adventures, why should the players have all the fun? If you want to change out some of the villains for others—or even replace them with villains you've created yourself—go right ahead.

Small Steps

Although it's impossible for us to know which heroes your players are going to bring to the table, these adventures were all written with particular villains in mind. Some of them—especially the last one—rely heavily on the powers and abilities that certain villains have. This means you

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should take care when considering modifying those villains or outright replacing them.

The safest way to handle such changes is to start small at first. Use villains who have similar power sets or would act in similar ways. At the very least, the replacement villains should always be swapped out with villains of the same rank.

Besides just doing this sort of thing for fun, it can add something to the game. Players who are big Marvel fans might know a lot more about particular villains than their characters possibly could. They might have expectations for how those villains should act and how they might respond to things the characters do. If you replace those villains with new ones of your own, the players are going to be just as much in the dark about them as the heroes would be.

Take care with tinkering this way. A light touch is best. The players joined up with you to play a Marvel game, after all, and if you change everything in it, it can feel a lot less Marvel than they might like.

WORKING THE RANKS

It's entirely possible for the ranks of your players' characters to not line up nicely with those suggested for the adventures in this book. Maybe they're too powerful. Maybe they're too weak. Maybe they're all over the place. In any case, we have some suggestions for you.

Mixing Ranks

You might end up playing through a single issue—or even an entire graphic novel—with heroes of mixed ranks. That makes fitting an adventure to them a bit more of a challenge, but that doesn't mean it's impossible.

For starters, figure out the average rank of the players' heroes and see how well that matches up with the suggested rank for the adventure. If it's close—say, less than a point or so—you probably don't need to change anything. If the difference is off by a point or more, you should look at adjusting the adventure's difficulty, as suggested in the sections throughout this chapter.

In either case, it's up to you to make sure that the heroes of each rank have something valuable to do during the adventure. That's not as hard to manage if the heroes only differ in rank a little bit, but if they are off by more than a single rank, you likely need to spend some time on this.

The real trick is to make sure that each player gets some time in the spotlight and has the chance to feel like they can make a meaningful contribution to the team's goals. That might mean giving them a foe of their own rank to punch, or it could just as easily be doing something else that gives the other heroes what they need to make the team triumph. It can be a challenge to coordinate this, but no one knows your own players and their heroes better than you.

Punching Down

If the heroes have a higher rank than the adventure's suggested rank, you have a couple of different options. You can either weaken the heroes or toughen up the villains. It's far easier—at least from the players' point of view—if you just make the villains tougher, and there are two ways to go about that.

The rule of thumb is that two characters of one rank can take on a single character of the next highest rank. With that in mind, if you have the heroes facing off against a single villain for each of them, you can simply double the number of villains for every difference in rank. For instance, if the adventure features two Rank 1 villains but the two heroes

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are Rank 2, you can have them face off against four Rank 1 villains instead.

This can, however, quickly grow unwieldy when there are large differences in rank. If those heroes are Rank 5, you'd have to double the number of villains four times to make up the difference. Those two villains would grow into 32 villains, and that's a lot of characters for you to have to handle.

Instead, you can bump those individual villains up in rank. Instead of the Rank 2 heroes facing a pair of Rank 1 villains, they're now challenged by a pair of Rank 2 villains. You have the choice of advancing those villains another rank by hand—making all the choices yourself, just as a player would when their hero goes up a rank—or swapping out those villains for other existing villains of the appropriate rank. The first method results in much more tailored villains, but it's also more work.

If you want to weaken the heroes instead, you can set the adventure at some point in their past when they weren't quite as powerful—or at least as skilled with their powers. This requires the players to rebuild their heroes at that lower rank, which is a bit more work for them, but it can also be a lot of fun, as they get to play through a flashback to when their heroes were younger.

If you prefer to keep everything in the present, the heroes might instead be saddled with power dampeners that they cannot remove, or they can have their powers and abilities limited in some other way. Maybe they're under the effect of a spell or a weird science experiment that temporarily makes them younger.

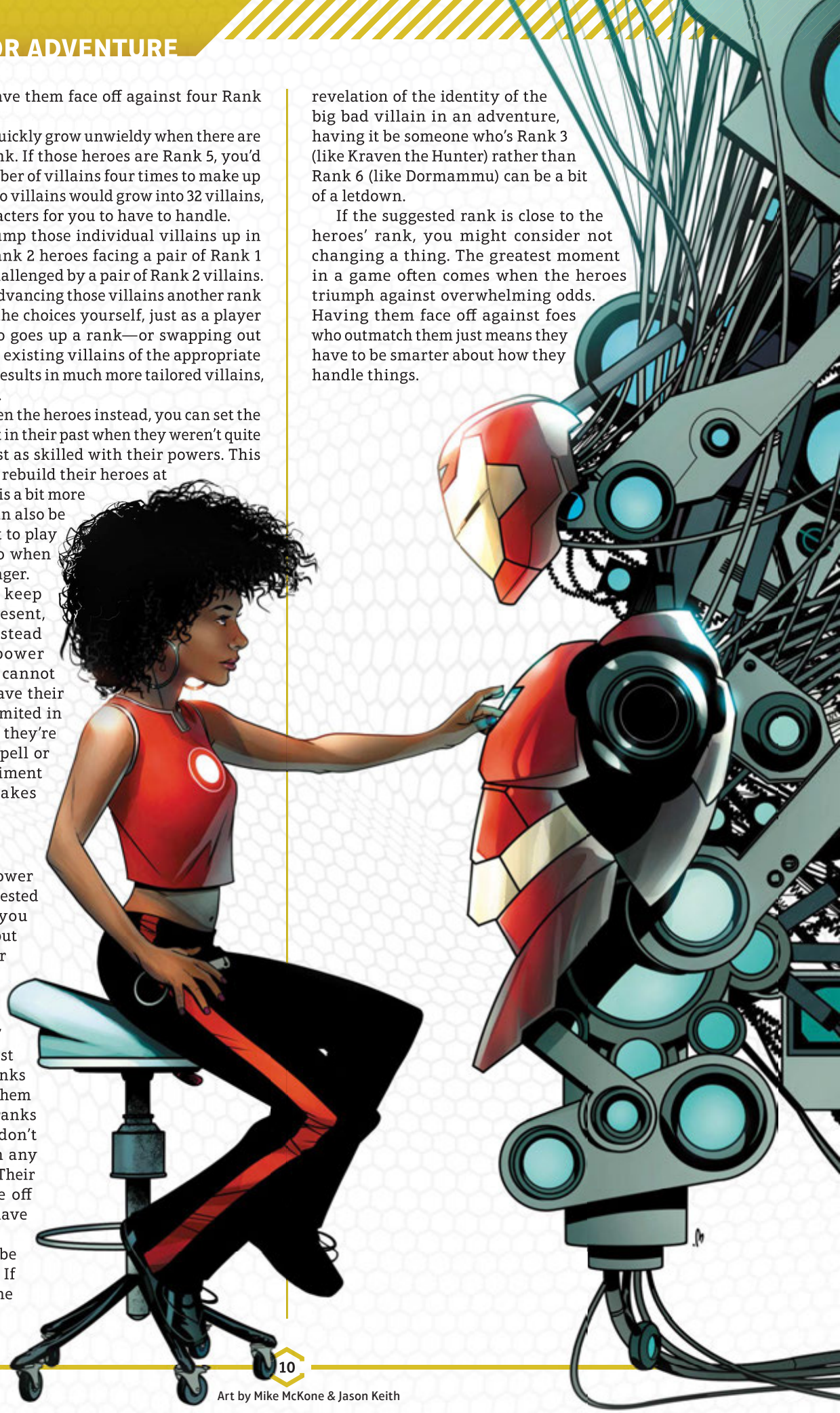
Punching Up

If the heroes are of lower ranks than what's suggested for the adventure, you have similar options but reversed. You can lower the threat the villains present, or you can upgrade the heroes.

From the players' point of view, it's easiest if you just lower the ranks of the villains to bring them more in line with the ranks of the heroes. They don't have to be involved in any of the extra work at all. Their heroes just get to face off against villains they have a prayer of beating.

But that might not be the most fun way to go. If you're leading up to the revelation of the identity of the big bad villain in an adventure, having it be someone who's Rank 3 (like Kraven the Hunter) rather than Rank 6 (like Dormammu) can be a bit of a letdown.

If the suggested rank is close to the heroes' rank, you might consider not changing a thing. The greatest moment in a game often comes when the heroes triumph against overwhelming odds. Having them face off against foes who outmatch them just means they have to be smarter about how they handle things.



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POWERING UP

If it still seems like the villains are too much of a challenge for the heroes, the more fun way to handle things is to give the heroes access to extra powers. These powers can come in the form of Iconic Weapons or other technology or tools that they can use for the duration of the adventures.

You can see examples of this in all sorts of Marvel Comics stories. When Spider-Man (Peter Parker) needs an extra boost, for example, he often heads to the lab to invent something that can give him the edge he needs. Maybe that's as simple as an insulated costume for a battle against Electro or a new way to use his web-shooters.

Sometimes, that's not enough, and Spider-Man has to turn to other people for help, like when Iron Man (Tony Stark) fashions an Iron Spider suit of armor for him. Similarly, in the epic crossover story *Fear Itself*, a number of heroes are outfitted with enchanted armor and weapons. In each case, the heroes get the tools they need to even the odds.

Evening Up

As a responsible Narrator, you should try to give the heroes the tools to give them a chance to succeed rather than things that guarantee their success. Few people like having a surefire victory handed to them. Uncertainty adds to the suspense and keeps players engaged and interested.

So how powerful should the tools you make available be? To determine that, first figure out how many ranks below the recommended rank for the adventure the heroes are. If they are Rank 2 heroes playing in an adventure designed for Rank 4 heroes, they are two ranks shy of where they should be. To even that out, you need to concoct something that grants them essentially two ranks' worth of powers and such.

Normally, for every bump in rank, a hero gains 5 ability points, 4 powers and 1 trait, and adds +1 to their damage multiplier and their Karma. A hero two ranks behind, then, would need 10 ability points, 8 powers, 2 traits and +2 to their damage multiplier and Karma to even things out.

If you want, you can simply give the hero a magic wand/helmet/bracelet/weapon/whatever that grants them the necessary advances. While they're using it, they are essentially that many ranks more powerful than normal, so things should even out to right where you want them.

Tailoring Devices

If you like, you can let the player design the device and choose the powers and such that go with it. It can be more fun, though, to design it yourself and let the hero figure out during the game exactly how the item works and what it grants them. They might think the bonuses aren't especially useful—but since you know what's coming their way, they might wind up being pleasantly surprised.

Keep in mind that it's all right if the device you grant them doesn't give them all the bonuses that would come with an increase in rank. It's hard to come up with a realistic means for a device to grant something like Karma, for instance—outside of magic—although it could have a feature that makes Karma easier to earn.

In many cases, it's enough to have the device grant the character access to the number of powers they would gain with a corresponding increase in rank. A device that allows someone to fly and become invisible, for instance, can be terribly useful, even if it doesn't add to the ability points of someone using it.

When creating such a device, try to imagine how it might work in the story. Something that grants levels of Sturdy and Mighty, for instance, might work best as a powered suit of armor that the hero has to wear. If it grants magic powers, you might consider making it a fancy wand or an ancient tome.

Powering Down

When the adventure is over and the heroes are ready to return to stories that better fit their ranks, it's time for them to give up the devices that helped even things out for them. To get back to basics.

There's a reason that Spider-Man doesn't always run around in the Iron Spider armor, after all. Such things change the basic nature of the character and how they interact with the world. Once the story that requires such tools ends, it's time for the tools to go away too.

If your players really love the devices that powered their heroes up, you can discuss making such advances permanent for them, but this should come with a commensurate advance in rank. Such an increase, of course, alters the nature of the game they're playing.

Heroes tend to rise to the challenges that their powers allow. Daredevil patrols Hell's Kitchen, for example, because that's what he's good at. That's the place where his powers can make the most difference. By the same token, the Fantastic Four faces off against Galactus rather than patrolling the streets around the Baxter Building. They could certainly make quick work of any muggers in the area, but their time and abilities are better spent tackling bigger challenges.

If you and your players play through every adventure in this book, you're likely to discover that there's a certain rank you all enjoyed best. That's where your game's natural rank cap should be. You can tailor adventures that rise above or fall below that, but that's the rank your game should call home.

THE CATACLYSM OF KANG

Narrators planning to run these adventures should read the whole book to fully understand what's happening. The chapters have a wide scope, starting with a brawl in Little Italy and wrapping up with a battle for the fate of the entire Multiverse at the dawn of time! If you're short on time, though, here's a quick summary of what you need to know about the worlds your players are about to adventure in.

Kang the Devourer

In an alternate reality, Kang the Conqueror sought out Galactus at the dawn of time and stole his power to become something even worse: Kang the Devourer. Like Galactus, Kang the Devourer hungers for primal energies, but while Galactus eats planets, this Kang consumes whole timelines.

At a later point, Kang the Devourer recruited the Red Skull from a doomed timeline to be his herald. This cosmically empowered fascist—now know as the Crimson Surfer—seeks out new universes for the Devourer to consume. While doing so, he works his own schemes, hoping to one day break free from the Devourer's control.

The Crimson Surfer has most recently come upon Earth-56438, where he hopes to finally amass enough power to betray the Devourer and start conquering worlds of his own.

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Earth-56438 or Hydra Earth

On Earth-56438, Hydra reigns supreme. During the Cold War, they infiltrated S.H.I.E.L.D. and took it over from within. From there, they grew their covert influence on American government until no one could stand against them.

They used the destruction of the Statue of Liberty during a super-powered battle to declare martial law in the United States, and they have not let go of their fascist stranglehold on the nation since. In fact, they have become even more blatant, introducing Hydra as the new law enforcement organization, complete with uniforms that people in the heroes' world would recognize on sight.

Many people recognize Hydra for what it is—a fascist group bent on world domination—and they lead the resistance against it. Even super heroes have a hard time standing up to the power of the entire United States government, though, especially when Hydra has plenty of their own super-powered agents to deploy.

Most of the super heroes the characters would recognize from their world have been arrested or killed on Earth-56438. Some of them have become part of the resistance. Others just do their best to keep their heads down and not attract any undue attention from Hydra or any other corrupted government organization.

There are several super-hero teams on Earth-56438, but their members are mostly people the heroes would consider super villains on their world. They're composed of people who don't care about the welfare of others and are happy to go along with their fascist government. In return, Hydra turns a blind eye to their awfulness.

With luck, the heroes won't run into any of those people—at least not until much later.

The Supremacy

Hydra of Earth-56438 decided they needed their own super-powered team to represent their ideals to the public. Like a dark reflection of Avengers Tower, the Supremacy uses a black skyscraper in Manhattan for its headquarters.

The members of this team are villains on our heroes' Earth, but on Earth-56438 they are Hydra's champions. Members of the Supremacy include the Abomination, Baron Zemo, Bullseye, Echo, Egghead, Elektra, Gorgon (Tomi Shishido), Hawkeye, Hive, the Hood, Killmonger, Spider-Woman (Jessica Drew), Titania, Viper (Ophelia Sarkissian) and the Winter Soldier. All of these characters have different levels of membership and have their own personal motivations.

When the Crimson Surfer found this team and this world, he made the Supremacy an offer. He would hold off Kang the Devourer for now, giving the people of Earth-56438 time to find a way to defeat the Devourer or to find another escape route. In doing so, the Crimson Surfer hopes to finally free himself from Kang's yoke as well.

If it becomes clear that the Supremacy can't make good use of the time the Crimson Surfer gives them, he plans to shovel their universe into the Devourer's maw before they can betray him. There are always other universes that can give it a try.

Godking Kang

However, there's another factor in play on Earth-56438: Godking Kang. When the Crimson Surfer arrives in a timeline, his first job is often to eliminate any Kangs living there. As part of his deal with the Supremacy, though, the Crimson Surfer has left the Kang of Earth-56438 to his own devices.

There are many who believe the Kang of Earth-56438—who calls himself Godking Kang—is the Crimson Surfer's superior, and the two of them are happy to let others make that mistake, as it keeps them from trying to find and alert Kang the Devourer to their treachery.

While the Crimson Surfer works with the Supremacy, Godking Kang is secretly planning to use Black Bolt's unlimited vocal powers to bring Kang the Devourer under his leash. Unfortunately for him, the Devourer is well aware of this and plans to use it to his own advantage.

To Sum Up

Working with the Crimson Surfer, Hydra explores their options, one of which is escaping to another world. To that end, they create a portal into the heroes' world and make a deal with Madame Masque and the Maggia of the heroes' Earth to help them infiltrate New York and its law enforcement. When these plans are waylaid by the heroes (in Chapter 2: Origin Story), Baron Zemo takes a more straightforward approach and leads a full invasion of New York City (see Chapters 3–4.)

When the invasion is thwarted, the heroes must find a way to take the fight back to Earth-56438 and defeat the Crimson Surfer (Chapter 5) to put an end to any future threat of invasion. This eventually leads to the revelation of Godking Kang's plan (Chapter 6) and finally the ultimate horror of Kang the Devourer (Chapter 7), both of which the heroes must stop if they hope to save the Multiverse.

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2

ORIGIN STORY

It's another sunny day in New York City. Only the occasional super hero jets overhead, barrel-rolling among the planes, and no aliens have invaded the place in weeks. Despite the city's track record as the center of planetary disasters, people seem like they're finally relaxing enough to enjoy themselves once again.

The peace won't last. It never does. But that's why New Yorkers make sure to take the time to savor it when it comes.

When that first shot rings out, most of the people who hear it don't even flinch. They know someone will do something about it.

Today, that someone is you.

THE BRIEFING

Chapter 2: Origin Story is a full-length adventure for four or five Rank 1 characters. It should take approximately two or three sessions to complete.

The Villains

In the course of the adventure, the heroes should encounter and defeat a number of Maggia toughs. The adventure winds up with them facing off against the remaining toughs and their leader, Madame Masque. Profiles for each of these characters can be found in Chapter 8: Characters.

The Locations

The adventure centers around a single city block in the Little Italy neighborhood of Lower Manhattan, right along Mulberry Street. Which actual block isn't important. There are several to pick from if you care to nail things down on a map.

The Plot

The Supremacy from Earth-56438 believe they have time before their planet is devoured, so they've decided to cautiously establish a beachhead in your game's Earth. To that end, they're working with the local Maggia to run all of the locals out of the block that they want to take over. Once they manage that, they hope to hollow out the buildings and open an interdimensional gateway to their world behind their neighboring facades.

THE HEROES

This adventure assumes that the heroes are all Rank 1. You should feel free to tailor it to fit the needs of your group.

Marvel Heroes

Most established heroes in the Marvel Multiverse are of Rank 2 or higher. In the *Core Rulebook*, for instance, the only heroes of Rank 1 are Young Lion (from the hero-creation example) and S.H.I.E.L.D. agents.

In Chapter 8: Characters, you can find profiles for Agent Sum (Hui Lin), Claire Dixon, Dakota North, Frog-Man (Eugene Patilio) and Maddy Cho, who are the default characters for this adventure.

Alternatively, if the players wish, they can all be ex-S.H.I.E.L.D. agents who have come back together to foil the plot they discover in the course of this adventure. In that case, they can each use the S.H.I.E.L.D. agent profile from the *Core Rulebook* as the basis for their character. They should each take the time to give themselves different names and details to differentiate themselves a bit from one another.

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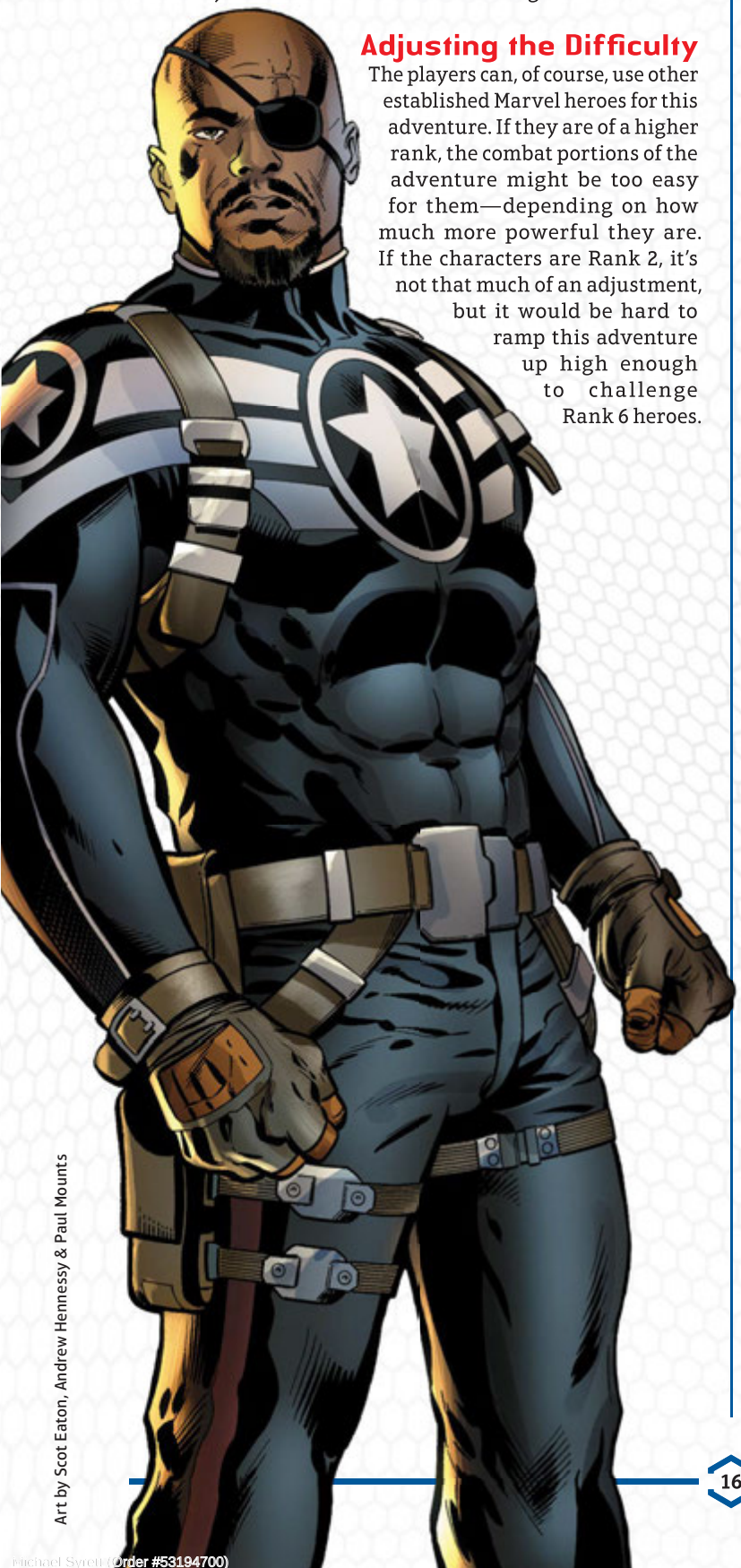
Original Heroes

If the players are creating original characters for the game, we suggest starting them at Rank 1 so they can be used with this adventure. If the characters don't have a rank cap, you could play through all the adventures in this book to raise them to Rank 6.

Either way, this adventure makes for an excellent and relatively low-stakes introduction to the game.



Art by Scot Eaton, Andrew Hennessy & Paul Mounts

Adjusting the Difficulty

The players can, of course, use other established Marvel heroes for this adventure. If they are of a higher rank, the combat portions of the adventure might be too easy for them—depending on how much more powerful they are. If the characters are Rank 2, it's not that much of an adjustment, but it would be hard to ramp this adventure up high enough to challenge Rank 6 heroes.

See the first chapter of this book for some suggestions on how to adjust this adventure for them. Note, though, that you don't *have* to adjust this adventure at all, especially if this is the first time that you and your players are going to be playing the game. While it may not prove much of a challenge for high-rank heroes, that's okay.

The intent is not to imperil the heroes but to introduce you and your players to the game and its mechanics. That can be plenty to deal with in an adventure without worrying about whether or not the characters can survive it.

THE HOOK

Nick Fury Jr. is a busy man. Although S.H.I.E.L.D. was dissolved after it was revealed that Hydra had absorbed it from within (see the *Secret Empire* series), as the son of the organization's former director and a man with a strong sense of duty, Fury refused to simply fade away. Making use of information taken from S.H.I.E.L.D.'s databases and his own spycraft, he still does his best to save the world, although on a freelance basis.

However, Fury has too many troubles on his docket to be able to investigate each one of them personally. He tries to focus on the biggest problems—like things that involve the Infinity Stones—while delegating smaller issues to other people he hopes he can trust.

That's where the heroes come in.

Fury contacts the heroes to ask them to work as a team to help him with a problem that's cropped up in Little Italy. According to his sources, someone has been purchasing up all the properties in a particular block one by one and leaning hard on the few people who refuse to sell. He doesn't have time to help the people on that block right now, but he hopes the heroes can manage it without him.

This recently came to a head with the arson of a restaurant that burned out the interior of the building down to its studs. Dozens of people were displaced, several were injured and three were killed.

With a little bit of luck, it should be a simple matter of going down to the block, figuring out who's hurting the folks down there and putting a stop to it.

Heroes are, of course, rarely that lucky.

FAQs

Players are always full of questions, and Fury tries to answer them as best he can. While we can't predict everything that the characters in your game might ask Fury, here are answers to the most common kinds of inquiries.

Why not call the police? Fury has informed local law enforcement of the issue, but a man calling up and claiming to be a former S.H.I.E.L.D. agent doesn't have much direct sway with the local law enforcement. The local police precinct is treating the fire as a simple arson. In a city that's often plagued by super villains and invasions from beyond the stars, pushing past that point to see if there's some kind of overarching conspiracy behind the fire isn't at the top of their list.

What authority do we have? None. Zip, zero, nada. And Fury doesn't really have any either. The heroes are essentially concerned citizens, just like most of the super heroes running around New York City. They want to help, but they're not the

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police. In fact, if they cause too much trouble, they might wind up getting arrested themselves. They should try to avoid that.

Can't someone else handle this? Sure. Fury will call the Avengers and see if they can fit it into their agenda. They might owe him a favor or three, but by the time they get around to checking this out, whatever's happening on that block is probably going to be over and done with.

ORIGINS

If you are playing with a group of original player characters, you can use it to tell the characters' origin stories. To do so, the players should design the characters as they normally would but without any powers. At some point in the adventure, the characters should finally gain their powers, but it's up to you when that happens.

You have a few options here.

In the Adventure

There are two spots in the middle of the adventure during which strange things happen that could—if necessary—give the heroes their powers.

The first happens when the heroes find the portal that the Maggia are using to travel back and forth between their world and Earth-56438. The second happens at the end of the adventure when the heroes destroy the larger portal the Maggia are helping build in the center of the block that they're taking over.

If the heroes destroy such a multiversal portal in a spectacular way, the energies that this unleashes could wash over them and give them a weird science origin. If the characters are being so cautious that such a stunning spectacle seems unlikely, the villains can make that happen instead. As they try to repair or prevent the damage the heroes do to the device, they accidentally do something that causes the device to explode.

With such an origin, the heroes can acquire pretty much any kind of powers that they might wish, especially for Rank 1 heroes. If the heroes would rather have another kind of origin, they could get it this way as well. Because the portal opens up a gateway into the Multiverse, the heroes could tap into other universes in which their variants have the kinds of origins and powers they want. The machine could transfer the powers from those variants to them in an instant.

Multiversal Problems

If this disaster simply copies the powers from one character to another, then there's no harm done. However, if the powers are drained from those variants of the heroes who had them, they might come looking to take them back at some future date. If and how that happens is entirely up to you.

Alternatively, the machine could swap the unpowered versions of the heroes with their powered variants from other parts of the Multiverse, and the players can start playing the variants instead. The fate of the original versions is up to you to determine. Were they killed in the explosion, or are they alive? Might they be able to figure out a way to get back to their home universe, or are they trapped in a different universe forever?

Other things to consider include whether or not the powered-up heroes want to get back to their home universe. Did they come from the same place, or were they gathered from multiple alternate universes? Are the original characters scattered across the Multiverse? And either way, can they reunite to find a way back home?

And what happens if they do?

All good questions for you and your players to explore. There are no right answers—just the answers that fit your group.

On Your Own Schedule

There are a few moments in between the sections of the adventure, and the heroes could acquire their powers during these times too. These bits might have nothing to do with the adventure as such, beyond being timed to do the heroes the most good.

One good place to insert the heroes getting their powers is after the Maggia goons beat them up. Just when the heroes are at their most desperate and don't think they have a chance to stand up to their attackers, that's a great time to find their powers.

Perhaps the heroes contact Nick Fury Jr. to complain that they're not cut out for this kind of work. In that case, he might be able to guide them to where they can get powered up.

How the heroes get their powers depends on their origins. If the players have a strong preference for a particular kind of origin, you should see if you can work with what they want. Otherwise, do your best to come up with something that fits their plans for their characters.

THE PLOT

The adventure takes place in roughly four parts.

1. The characters investigate the scene of the fire—an Italian restaurant called Nanni's. While there, the owner of the restaurant confirms that it was, in fact, arson—and not started by him. They also run into a couple of Maggia goons who warn them about poking their noses where they don't belong.
2. The characters regroup somewhere. If they don't have a place of their own, a local restaurant/bar will do. While they're there, a group of Maggia goons bursts in to beat some sense into them. Alternatively, the heroes go looking for trouble and find the Maggia goons instead.
3. The characters return to the block to figure out what's going on, and they zero in on another Italian restaurant around the corner. While investigating it, they discover a strange device that opens up a portal between universes. Madame Masque appears out of it with a few Hydra agents in tow. She flees, leaving the Hydra agents to cover her escape.
4. After defeating the Hydra agents, the heroes enter the courtyard behind the restaurants and discover that Madame Masque and Hydra have been building a larger portal there. When that portal activates, a variant of Steve Rogers emerges from the portal, begs the heroes for help and dies. Madame Masque appears after him with a larger force of Hydra agents and attacks the heroes to defend the portal.

You can run these together as quickly as you'd like or toss in other scenes to space things out a bit. It's entirely up to you and the pace at which your players want to keep things moving.

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THE SCENE OF THE CRIME

Nanni's is an Italian restaurant that sits on the western side of Mulberry Street, in the heart of Little Italy. Marta's—an upscale clothing boutique featuring Italian fashions—lies northwest of it and Nicoló's—a used bookstore—stands to the north. An Italian grocery store featuring delicious imported goods—Luciano & Matteo's—bustles with business across the street.

Like many places in Manhattan these days, Nanni's has covered outdoor seating across the sidewalk that spills out into the street. This still stands, but even it was scorched by the blaze that destroyed Nanni's, the front of which now sits open and blackened like a hole in an otherwise pretty smile.

Meet the Owner

No matter when the heroes arrive, they find Giovanni di Batista Ingellis sitting alone on a half-melted chair in the outdoor seating area of Nanni's. A broom and dustpan lean on the scorched table next to him, but he's ignoring them for the moment in favor of pouring himself a snort of grappa (a traditional Italian brandy) into a small glass and sipping it as he gazes into the darkened interior of the restaurant that's been in his family for generations.

If the heroes approach the man, he greets them with a wry smile. If they don't approach him, but he spots them gazing at the building or just wandering about, he gets up and greets them anyhow. As he does, he introduces himself as Nanni. *"Not the original one, of course,"* he says with a dry laugh. *"That was my great-grandfather, the original Giovanni Ingellis."*

The restaurant has been passed down through the family from generation to generation until his parents retired and it came into his hands. He and his wife and sons had been doing a fine job with it. In fact, they'd had enough money for the boys to open the grocery store across the street, but with this, he's wondering if he should give in and sell the restaurant. Maybe the boys can give him a job at their place instead.

What Happened

If the heroes question Ingellis about what happened, his open demeanor closes down a bit. He is happy to chat with folks who might share a drink with him or just commiserate over his misfortune, but he hesitates to share his fears and frustrations with total strangers.

Give the players a chance to talk him into it. They can try all sorts of tactics here. They can be kind to him, be gruff with him or even threaten him. When they're done playing that part out, have the player doing the talking make a Challenging check to see what happens.

If the hero tries to argue with Ingellis on intellectual points, this should be a Logic check. If they appeal to his emotions instead, make it an Ego check. For a Rank 1 hero, the target number (TN) of a Challenging check is 11 or better.

On a success, Ingellis tells the heroes what's been going on. The Maggia have been leaning on everyone in his block to sell their places to them. He doesn't know why the Maggia are doing this, but they haven't offered anyone a fair price—including him.

Despite that, several of Ingellis' neighbors have given in. Some of them had been close to retirement. Others didn't want any bad blood with the Maggia. Ingellis, though, had outright refused and threatened to call the police.

His place burned down the next night at 3 a.m.

If the players get a Fantastic success, Ingellis tells the heroes the names of the pair who threatened him: Annachiara and Paolo Laera, a sister-brother team of Maggia lieutenants in the Manfredi family. He knows them well, as they've been coming around to collect protection money from him for the past decade.

In fact, they went to school and grew up together. He'd relied on them for actual protection from time to time, to step in to lend a hand when the police were too busy. He never suspected that they'd turn on him like this.

If the players get a failure, Ingellis clams up. He decides that he can't trust the heroes. The Maggia must have sent them around to test him and see if he is asking others for help—which is sure to bring even more trouble down upon him and his family. Ingellis has already lost his family's restaurant. He doesn't want any harm to come to his family too.

Art by Simone Buonfantino & Rachelle Rosenberg

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The Maggia

The Maggia is one of New York City's largest and best-established organized crime rings. Originally rising from Europe—especially Italy—it now has branches around the world. Rather than being run like a hierarchical business, the New York Maggia is composed of several long-standing families who, long ago, divided the city into several territories in which each family has control over most criminal enterprises.

The most notable families in New York are the Manfredis (led by Silvermane), the Nefarias (led by Count Nefaria), the Hammerheads (led by Hammerhead) and the Libris (led by Isabelle Libris), although there are several others. Mulberry Street has long been the territory of the Manfredis.

Done Talking

After the heroes are done speaking with Ingellis, the Laeras show up. Just as Ingellis feared, the pair have been watching him, worried that he might do something stupid. Now it looks like he has—even if he clammed up instead of talking.

The two appear from the outdoor seating area's street side and glower at the heroes. No matter what Ingellis might have told the heroes—or not—he leaps to his feet to start shouting at the Maggia goons.

"How could you do this to me?" he demands. *"We were* kids *together!"*

The Laeras scoff at him. He knew what might happen. They'd warned him. It's not their fault he didn't take them seriously.

They pull their pistols, and Ingellis howls at them in disbelief. *"You're going to kill me? Over a burned-out building? You're going to deprive my children of their father?"*

The Laeras explain that they're on Ingellis' side. They didn't burn down his place—although the people their family are working with did. They made sure it happened late at night when no one was around, at least.

Now, though, they have to take care of these outsiders. They can't have the heroes going off and telling tales to others. That would be sure to bring their operation here the wrong kind of attention.

The Laeras level their pistols at the heroes. *"We warned you, Nanni, but you didn't listen. And now these poor saps are going to pay the price for it."*

Assuming the players let you get this far, it's time to roll for initiative.

The Fight

Use the Mulberry Street map on page 21. Ingellis is at the table in the center of the outdoor seating area. The Laeras are standing on the opposite side of him from the heroes—whichever side that is.

Use the profile for the Maggia Tough from Chapter 8: Characters for the Laeras.

In the fight, the Laeras attack the heroes directly. They fully expect the heroes to flee. Normally, they'd be happy to just run off such intruders, but they're under orders to kill any outsiders they catch Ingellis talking to.

With any luck at all, the heroes should prevail in this fight. The Laeras are overconfident, and there are only two of them.

If the heroes seem to be having a hard time of it, Ingellis grabs the table next to him and tips it over to use as cover. The heroes can join him there.

If any of the heroes are knocked unconscious—or, worse, killed—Ingellis decides he cannot remain on the sidelines any longer. He enters the fight on the heroes' side and helps them battle the Laeras too.

The Aftermath

If the heroes prevail in the battle, they have a few options.

If the Laeras didn't have a chance to flee, the heroes can try to question them. Unfortunately, the Maggia has a strict policy against telling their secrets to outsiders, and the Laeras take that seriously. On top of that, they don't really know why the Maggia is trying to take over the block, so even if the heroes can read their minds or otherwise persuade them to spill what they know, there's not much for them to tell. They just know they were ordered to make it happen.

That said, there are some details the heroes might be able to shake out of the Laeras, as they assume it's common knowledge in the neighborhood—and that Ingellis would have already told the heroes as much.

The two of them—along with other members of the Manfredi family—have been trying to pressure local businesses and tenants to vacate their buildings and surrender them to the Maggia. So far, they've only had moderate success, mostly due to the stubbornness of long-time fixtures like Ingellis. Because of that, they targeted Nanni's and leaned on Ingellis hard. They believe that Nanni's is a keystone business on the street. If it vanishes, everyone else who's been resisting them is going to have to take a much harder look at how stubborn they want to be.

As far as the Laeras know, this is simply a real-estate play that their bosses want to make. They don't know why here or why now. They just know they need to make it happen. They even tried to stick up for Nanni's, which they've eaten at since they were kids, but their bosses didn't want to hear it.

If the Laeras get away, the heroes can try to track them down, but they're not going to have much luck. The two of them grew up here and know the neighborhood cold. In any case, Ingellis can try to fill the heroes in instead. After this latest attack, he's furious at the Manfredis, and he's ready to talk.

If the Laeras were killed, the heroes may be in serious trouble. While the police don't often chase down people involved in fights, they take murder seriously. On top of that, although Ingellis might have been fed up with the Laeras, he didn't want them dead. He's willing to testify against the heroes.

Healing

If the heroes were hurt during the fight, this would be a good time for them to patch themselves up. They can just heal normally, of course, but those who spend a point of Karma can make a recovery check to gain back lost Health or Focus.

If the heroes are having a hard time of it already, be free with the Karma points. If the players know they can earn more of them by getting into the game, they shouldn't worry about running out of them by spending them now.

The Police

If gunshots were fired, the police should arrive soon. The heroes might not want to be around when that happens.

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If they don't figure that out themselves, Ingellis points it out to them.

Police recognize that established super heroes are a net good for the city and can help them protect citizens against super-powered criminals that the police otherwise would have no hope of stopping, much less arresting. However, as Rank 1 heroes, the PCs probably don't have much of a reputation in the city yet, and if the police don't recognize them, the most likely course of events is that the officers arrest everyone involved in the fight and let the system sort them out.

The only exception to this is Ingellis, whom officers from the precinct all know, as he and his family have been part of the community for generations. If Ingellis is able and willing to speak up for the heroes, though, there's a good chance the officers take him at his word and let the heroes go.

If the heroes try to flee, the officers give chase, but they don't shoot at them unless the characters seem to be endangering others. Assuming that Ingellis is able, he does his best to slow the police down to give the heroes a chance to get away.

AN ALTERNATE BEGINNING

If your players are less the "take guidance" type and more the "get sucked into it" sort, you can start the adventure in an entirely different way. Instead of having Nick Fury Jr. call on the heroes to help, simply have them wander by Nanni's at some point instead.

They could be:

- On patrol
- Grabbing dinner
- Out for a stroll
- On their way home after work
- Meeting to discuss strategy for their new team

No matter the heroes' supposed goal, when they head past Nanni's, they hear a cry for help. The Maggia goons who came to lean on Ingellis went ahead and got started without waiting for the heroes to show up.

This works pretty much the same way as described above. In that case, when the Laeras found Ingellis speaking with the heroes, they realized they had the chance to intimidate him by hurting the people he was speaking with. Without that impetus, they start torturing him directly instead.

When the heroes respond, they find Paolo twisting Ingellis' arm behind his back while Annachiara berates the restaurant owner for being so damn stubborn. If the heroes hold back too long, Paolo breaks Ingellis' arm, and he howls in agony, sure that no one in the neighborhood will step up to defend him against the Maggia.

If the heroes continue to watch instead of act, the Laeras pull out their pistols and threaten Ingellis' life. When he defies them, they shoot him.

If the heroes don't intervene at some point, they're not terribly good heroes. If the players are being too cautious, have a grade-school kid creep up behind them and start wailing for help. *"Gosh, ain't nobody gonna do nothing to help him?"*

They should get the hint.

After the heroes intervene, Nick Fury Jr. can contact them then. He saw the report of their heroics because he's been monitoring the situation in the area. He enlists them to help him figure it all out.

THE MANFREDIS

By now the heroes should know that the Manfredi family was behind the arson that destroyed Nanni's. What they want to do with that information is up to them.

There are two likely paths:

- The heroes decide to find the Manfredis and warn them off.
- The Manfredis decide to find the heroes and warn them off.

Finding the Family

If the heroes are proactive, they might go looking for the Manfredis. Finding them is easy in some ways and hard in others. Over the years, the Manfredis have become secretive about exactly who is in charge of the family and where they operate out of.

Silvio Manfredi has run the family that bears his surname for decades. He's an old man now, one who has cheated death a number of times, and his hair has turned white, giving him his codename, Silvermane. Over the years, he's fought with Spider-Man, Kingpin, and Cloak and Dagger. He even took over Hydra for a while and came into direct conflict with Nick Fury Sr. and S.H.I.E.L.D.

After a recent brush with death, Silvermane's head was mounted atop a robotic body that keeps him in some semblance of life. However, this has caused him to retreat from the public sphere, as he cannot stroll the streets without people recognizing that he is no longer fully human.

Still, Silvermane held court in a restaurant around the corner from Nanni's for untold years before fading from public life, a high-end place called Prano's. If the heroes are looking for him—or those who work for him—they might want to start there.

Anyone in the neighborhood can give them this information, if they ask. Most people will toss in a warning to be careful there, though, as the Manfredis have shot up Prano's more than once over the years. Nick Fury Jr. can even let the heroes know about the place if they check in with him—although he doesn't bother to warn them to be careful. In his mind, it's already too late for them to try that.

When the heroes arrive at Prano's, though, they find the place is closed up tight, and there's a sign on the front that reads, "SOLD! MOVING SOON TO NEW LOCATION!"

If the heroes look around the neighborhood, they find that a number of the places feature similar signs. About a third of the buildings on the block have been shuttered, although most of them are quieter about it than Prano's.

While the heroes are poking around, though, they draw the wrong kind of attention. At one point, they look around and realize that the traffic on the street has all stopped and a number of well-armed goons are stalking toward them with baseball bats and crowbars.

There are two goons for each of the heroes, and they're all spoiling for a fight. After what happened outside of Nanni's,

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Michael Sytell (Order: 53194700)

Art by Ron Garney & Matt Milla

the Manfredis are not messing around with the heroes any longer. They're there to give them the beating of their lives.

Don't hold back on the heroes here. Go ahead and toss the goons at them all at once. They're badly outnumbered and are looking at a tough fight. See how they handle it. Will they stand their ground? Run? Try something more cunning? It's up to them.

For this battle, just use an open map of a street.

The Family Finds Them

If the heroes don't go looking for the Manfredis, then the Manfredis go hunting for them. Wherever the heroes wind up after the fight, if it was at all possible for anyone to have followed them, the Manfredis now know where they are. When the heroes have their guard down, that's when the goons strike.

As above, there are two goons for each hero, and they're armed with baseball bats and crowbars. This time, though, to introduce themselves, they try to surprise the heroes. If they manage it, they toss a flash-bang into the center of the room where the heroes happen to be, and in the midst of all the chaos, they come in swinging.

For this battle, if the heroes are on the street when the attack happens, you can use the same open map of a city street. If they're someplace else, you may need to come up with a map of your own to depict where everything happens.

The Fight

The Manfredis aren't there to kill the heroes. They just want to teach them a lesson and make sure they give up on the idea of poking their noses into Maggia business ever again. They have two goons assigned to take out each hero, and if they succeed, they can go help their pals knock around any heroes still standing.

If the heroes manage to even the odds so that there are at least as many of them still in the fight as there are attackers, the goons realize that they've badly underestimated the heroes. They're not getting paid enough to take beatings instead of giving them out. They turn tail and run, leaving their pals behind.

If the heroes are defeated, the goons chortle and sneer at them and tell them in no uncertain terms that the next time anyone spots them in this part of town, they're dead. Then the goons stroll off to leave the heroes to lick their wounds.

The first fight was easy to introduce the players to the combat system and let them see how it works under the best conditions for their characters. This fight is meant to teach them how much danger a fight can put their characters in so that they don't get too cocky about being able to take out anyone they like. Ideally, this should put them in the right frame of mind for the climactic battle to come.

The Aftermath

If the heroes prevail in the battle, they should feel pretty good about themselves. They managed to overcome terrible odds. However, even then, the goons probably got at least a few good shots in, and the heroes should need some time (or need to spend some Karma) to recover.

If the heroes were defeated—which is more likely—allow them to gather themselves and leave the area for someplace safe. If they need immediate help, Ingellis is drawn to the fight by all the commotion, and he steps forward to bring them back to consciousness and get them on their feet.

If anyone looks like they might need an ambulance, Ingellis calls for one. The heroes can accept the assistance or wave it off, as they prefer. They shouldn't need more than a day to recover, though, whether they do it in a hospital or somewhere else. Hospitals can involve police reports, next-of-kin alerts and the possible unmasking of anyone with a secret identity, though—not to mention questions about insurance and who's paying for the hospital's services—so many heroes try to avoid them if they can.

This moment, of course, is when the heroes prove that they're actually committed to helping people, even at the risk of their lives. If they seem to be hesitant to keep at it,

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this is a great time for Nick Fury Jr. to check in on them with a call and give them a pep talk.

If Ingellis has the chance to speak with the heroes, he actively encourages them to stand up to the Manfredis—and not just for his sake. He stood up to the Manfredis himself, after all, and it cost him his restaurant, maybe forever. He understands if they don't think of this as their problem. But someone has to do it. Otherwise, the Maggia will take over the entire block soon enough, and the rest of the neighborhood can't be far behind.

If the heroes balk, Ingellis tells them he understands. He'll just have to take on the whole Maggia by himself then, as he has no choice. If he just gave in to them, he could never look his wife and sons in the eyes again, and that's not something he's willing to risk.

If the heroes ask how Ingellis managed to find them or get in touch with them, he just smiles at them. They know Nick Fury Jr., right? That's how they knew to check in on Nanni's in the first place.

Well, they aren't the only ones who have superspy friends. Ingellis was never a spy himself, but Fury and many other S.H.I.E.L.D. operatives liked to celebrate accomplishments with meals at Nanni's when they were in town. It's a tradition that started with Nick Fury Sr., and that fact helped Ingellis and his father and grandfather resist Maggia influence many times over the years.

When S.H.I.E.L.D. was dissolved, Ingellis immediately worried that the Maggia might come after his restaurant at some point in the future. The only thing that surprised him is that they took so long.

THE PORTAL

When the heroes are ready to press on, there are two options. If the players are not interested in detective work, Ingellis can do the spying for them. Otherwise, let the heroes start poking around the neighborhood again, asking more cautious questions, and they can learn the following information on their own.

Agent Ingellis

Fury contacts them to say that Ingellis reported that he's been doing a little spying of his own. With the restaurant out of business, the man has a lot of time on his hands, and he's been poking around the neighborhood, asking questions.

Ingellis learned that there have been a lot of people going in and out of Prano's despite the fact that the place is closed to the public. Some of them have been carrying crates in and out as well, although the biggest deliveries have been happening through the back alley that leads to the open courtyard behind the restaurant.

Ingellis can't say with any certainty what's going on inside of Prano's, but the folks moving in and out of it don't look like restaurant workers. He recognized a couple of them as supposed Maggia goons, though, so it's entirely possible that whatever the Maggia hopes to do with the block is centered on that place.

Oddly, Ingellis has also seen a few more buttoned-down types entering and leaving the place. They don't look like gangsters to him. More like college students and professors—the kind who hang out on the parts of campus where they teach science.

If asked, Ingellis promises to continue to keep an eye on Prano's—which he was going to do anyhow. If the heroes need him to find out anything else, though, he's willing to give that a shot too—within reason.

Poking Around

The heroes don't need to hear from Ingellis, though. They can find out much of the information he could provide from their own efforts. They just have to put in the footwork.

If the heroes ask around the neighborhood, most people are even more afraid to speak with them now than before. People ask them if they enjoyed getting beat up and wonder aloud if they somehow think this is all a joke. Some people stop and shake their hands for being so brave about the whole thing. Others shake their heads and give the heroes their goodbyes, as they fear this may be the last time they see them alive.

Staking out Prano's—say, from the coffee shop across the street or the roof of that building—gives the heroes much of the information that Ingellis otherwise would relay to them. People move in and out of the place at all hours—even in the middle of the night. They seem to come in two kinds—Maggia associates and technicians/scientists.

The Maggia goons wind up doing all the heavy lifting, which might seem suspicious as they're not particularly good at it. Perhaps that's because they don't trust any movers outside of the Maggia to do the work for them.

If the heroes send photographs or video of the traffic through Prano's front door to Fury, he cross-checks those against his database and manages to identify some of the people. A few of them are known members of the Manfredi family, which is absolutely no surprise to anyone.

Most of the technicians come up as college students, but a couple of them are in Fury's records as having worked in the past with A.I.M. (Advanced Idea Mechanics, a science-based terrorist organization). If they're working alongside the Maggia—even as consultants—something serious is up.

The heroes are free to do more than just watch Prano's, of course. They can go door-to-door around the block and ask people about the Maggia if they like. Most people are immediately uncomfortable with the subject and slam their doors in the heroes' faces. They're clearly scared of what might happen to them if they give the heroes any kind of information.

A few of them, though, are grudgingly willing to speak with the heroes. They tell them stories that line up with what Ingellis told them. The Maggia has been trying to buy up the entire block at cheap prices, and they've been happy to twist a few arms to encourage owners to accept their offers. By now, they've already gotten agreements from about two-thirds of the block, and with the arson of Nanni's, the others are getting ready to sell too. As far as anyone knows, Ingellis is the lone holdout—for all the good it did him.

The Block

If the heroes make or obtain a map of the block that contains both Nanni's and Prano's, they might discover something. There's a courtyard behind Prano's that many of the other buildings on the block abut upon and look down into.

Prano's recently took the long-neglected courtyard behind their place—which had been little more than a place for

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smoke breaks till then—and turned it into a dining room as large as any held within their building's four walls. This allowed them to serve their clientele in an open-air atmosphere that didn't have them hanging out in the street—which is why Prano's doesn't have a strip of tables out on its sidewalk like Nanni's does.

Despite noise complaints from the neighbors, Prano's kept their popular courtyard open. The complaints were dealt with by means of either payoffs or threats—and sometimes both. This usually included an insistence on blocking any view of access to the courtyard to eliminate the problem, whether the neighbors wanted that or not.

After Prano's was sold a few days ago, most of the neighbors would have expected the activity from their courtyard to trail off to nothing, but if anything, it's gotten worse. There are still people roaming around out there, now at any time of the day or night.

As it turns out, though, there's no one left to complain. All of the buildings that would have a view of the courtyard have either been sold or had their rear windows boarded over and the doors locked shut from the outside. The only exception was Nanni's.

Nanni's back door opens into an alley where Ingellis took deliveries, brought out the trash and so on. He'd been so focused on dealing with threats from the Maggia that he hadn't even noticed the changes going on over at Prano's. In fact, the closing of Prano's had led to a surge in his business that had nearly overwhelmed his staff, and until now, he hadn't had a reason to question that good fortune. He'd just figured there might be a big convention in town.

With the arson of Nanni's, the closing of access to the courtyard behind Prano's is now complete. This could lead to the heroes investigating what's so important back there.

If the heroes don't stumble upon this line of inquiry on their own, feel free to have Ingellis or Fury tip them to it. Give the players as much of a chance to figure it out on their own as you can, though. Even if they don't get a map, they might fly or swing over the buildings or even go prowling around the rooftops to figure it out.

The Courtyard

When the heroes finally have a chance to look into the courtyard, they discover a bustle of activity going on there. The alley behind the building has been blocked off to prevent intruders from stumbling upon the scene, and guards patrol the place at all times, casting their eyes up, down and all around. In a world in which super heroes wander around, you never know from what direction trouble might come.

While the guards might not appear armed to the uninitiated, any hero that can make a Vigilance vs. TN 10 action check can spot that the guards are all wearing pistols in shoulder holsters. The guards are dressed in regular clothes rather than uniforms, but they all wear jackets, and they're not terribly careful about covering up their weapons, especially back here where they don't expect to see anyone watching them.

There are normally two guards on watch at any given time. If they spot the heroes, they draw their weapons and shout for help. If the heroes flee once they're spotted, the guards do not follow them. They're sharp enough to not be drawn away from the place they're supposed to be protecting. They do report the intrusion to their bosses, though, and every guard is on the lookout for the heroes after that.

There are crates stacked all around the courtyard, especially in its four corners. If the heroes manage to open one of them up, they find a bunch of electronic equipment that they likely do not understand. It requires a Logic vs. TN 20 action check to identify these things as parts that can be used in a multiversal portal, something that most people have never encountered.

Inside Prano's

Prano's is an upscale Italian restaurant that occupies all three floors of the building that it's in. The top floor is used for offices, and the basement is used for storage. The first and second floors comprise the restaurant proper. The kitchen stands to one side of a corridor that leads out into the courtyard.

Much of the interior of Prano's has been left untouched since the sale and closure. Any important business files and computers have been removed from the top floor, although plenty of office equipment still clutters the place. The public part of the restaurant looks like it could be opened for business again the next day if the new owners were so inclined. The kitchen still has food in the cooler, and the Maggia guards and workers make liberal use of it.

A couple of the workers even keep the stove and ovens going, making pizzas for the rest of them so that they don't have to leave for meals. Some of the Maggia goons have even taken to napping in the booths in the restaurant under their boss' orders.

The real fun, though, is happening in the basement, which is one large room that extends the length and width of the building above.

There are two ways to get into it. There's a stairwell that leads down from the kitchen into it, and there's an outdoor service elevator that pops up through steel trap doors on one edge of the floor of the courtyard. Gaining access to either of these entryways requires taking out the people guarding them.

There are two guards in the courtyard at all times, plus an erratic line of people carting materials up from the basement via the service elevator. They always bring crates into the courtyard and leave empty-handed.

There are two more guards hanging out in the kitchen at all times too, although they are less attentive than their compatriots outdoors. They spend their time there chatting, cooking and sometimes stealing drinks from the restaurant's fully stocked bar.

Another pair of guards hangs out in the front of the restaurant, keeping watch on the front door. They answer it whenever anyone knocks, and they check everyone out before letting them in and—if they don't know them personally—frisking them for weapons.

The Basement

The basement of Prano's has changed a lot in the past few days. The stuff that was stored down there was all moved out and trucked away to make room for the maintenance of a multiversal portal that appeared down there after scientists in another universe (Earth-56438) punched a hole into this one.

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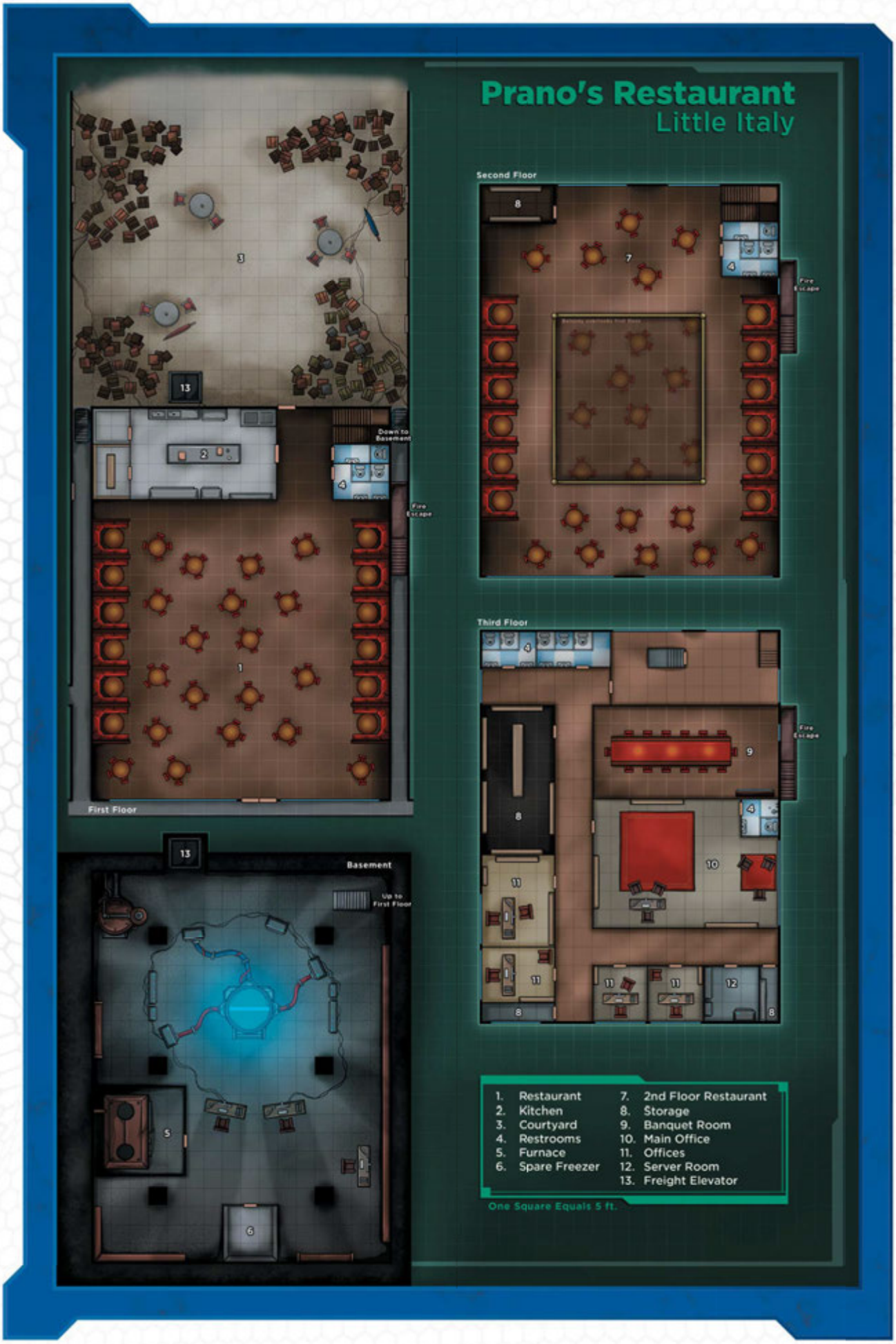

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The tech that the scientists are using allows for the temporary creation of such portals, but keeping them open requires a massive amount of energy. The only way to make the connection more stable and permanent is to replicate the equipment from one side of the portal on the other side of the portal—which is exactly what the Maggia has helped the people on Earth-56438 do here in Prano's basement.

The large glowing portal appears as a flat, two-dimensional circle no matter from what angle it is viewed. It is 7 feet wide and hovers 6 inches above a 10-by-10-foot platform of machinery that generates it. The machinery sprawls across the center of the basement's floor. The light of the portal has a bluish tint to it, and it crackles with electricity around its edges, implying that it might collapse at any moment.

Several thick cables snake out of the circle onto the ground that the portal hovers over. These run to computer banks built in a circle around the portal. Technicians sit at these computers, monitoring the stability of the rift between worlds and making small corrections as needed. Every time the lights in the portal flicker, the technicians scramble to apply adjustments, and a moment later, the flickering stops for another few minutes.

There are three technicians in the room at all times, and they look haggard but determined. This may be the wildest thing they've ever been a part of, but it's also the most dangerous. They know that if they let the portal fall apart, they are the first ones who will pay the price.

That said, if the heroes get close to the portal, the technicians try to shut it down. They're not willing to risk letting the heroes wander into the other universe if they can help it.

The Big Entrance

At an appropriately dramatic moment—which is entirely up to you as the Narrator—the portal flashes a blinding white, and a group of people steps through.

A number of things could trigger this moment, including:

- The heroes take out the technicians and start poking around their equipment.
- The heroes decide to destroy the portal and the equipment attached to it.
- The heroes sneak past the technicians and head for the portal.

In essence, if the existence of the portal is threatened or the heroes are about to try to step through it, then the moment has come.

First, a number of Hydra agents storm through the portal, one for each of the heroes. Then, hot on their heels, Madame Masque. She is dressed in her traditional black-and-white uniform and golden mask.

"What are we waiting for?" Madame Masque barks as soon as she appears. *"We don't have time to be fooling around here. We need to get the big hole set up. Now!"*

The Fight

The moment that Madame Masque realizes that the heroes are there, she shouts at the Hydra agents to take the heroes out. Instead of fighting by their side, she flees, leaping back through the portal. At that moment, it flashes even brighter and then disappears with a loud whoosh-whomp that makes the ears of everyone in the room pop from a drastic change in air pressure.

The Hydra agents (profiles for them can be found at Marvel.com/rpg or in the *Core Rulebook*) immediately attack the heroes. If there are any guards still available inside Prano's or its courtyard, they come running to help. If the technicians are still in the room and conscious, they dive beneath their desks to hide from what they are sure will be ensuing gunfire.

If the heroes stay and fight, the Hydra agents fight until they are taken down (unconscious or dead). The guards aren't quite as dedicated. Once the Hydra agents are taken down, the guards flee if they can. As far as they're concerned, anyone who can take out their visitors from another universe are tougher than they want to deal with on their own.

Art by Stefano Caselli & Tríona Farrell

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If things look like they're turning against the Hydra agents, one of them turns and fires their weapon at the equipment that maintains the portal. The technicians shout out a warning, but it's too late. The entire thing explodes.

Treat this as if a grenade went off in the space where the portal is. When it happens, a strange energy washes over everyone in the basement, including any heroes. (This would be a perfect time for any original heroes who haven't gotten their powers yet to receive them.)

The Aftermath

If the heroes are knocked unconscious, the guards take them upstairs and toss them into the walk-in cooler in the kitchen. They lock the door, trapping them inside. Hopefully, the heroes have some kind of power that can help them escape or a means to call for help.

Otherwise, breaking the door open from inside requires a Melee vs. TN 18 action check. The heroes can try this as many times as they like, but each time they fail, they take a standard damage roll with a ×1 damage multiplier.

If the heroes cannot manage to find a way out and cannot contact anyone else, consider having Fury send Ingellis in to see what's going on with the heroes. The restaurateur sneaks into Prano's and overhears the guards talking about what happened to the heroes. Opening the door from the outside isn't any trouble at all.

When the heroes emerge, they discover that they're alone and unguarded. The guards are too busy dealing with what's happening in the next section to worry much about defeated heroes.

It's far more likely that the heroes triumph in this battle. If they do, they can interrogate any survivors in the basement with them. The Hydra agents are all true believers who refuse to talk, but the guards can be persuaded or intimidated into blabbing with an Ego vs. TN 14 action check. The technicians are even easier to get to talk (TN 10).

The guards and technicians only know so much, but it boils down to this:

About a month ago, Hydra from Earth-56438 broke through from their universe into this one by way of this basement. They established contact with Madame Masque, who agreed to a partnership with them and set her Maggia group—the Nefaria family—to work on stabilizing the portal between the two worlds.

The Manfredi family has been in disarray with the uncertainty about the status of Silvermane, and Madame Masque had been looking for an excuse to move in on their territory and take it over. She'd taken to dining at Prano's as a prelude to that, showing her masked face in Manfredi territory and daring someone to do something about it. That's why the owners of Prano's had gone to her with the discovery instead of someone else, and she took advantage of that immediately.

The technicians are mostly dropouts from the graduate program at Empire State University, sent there by Yuri Pushkin, an adjunct professor who was recently let go for selling inflated grades to his students. Once they stabilized the portal, their only job was to monitor it while Maggia goons went through to Earth-56438 and brought back new technology that would help with an even bigger portal project. The pieces for that are all out in the courtyard, waiting to be activated.

Guard Names

- "Big" Billy King
- Bambi Libertini
- Jackie Esposito
- Maria Cataldi
- Martino Benedetto
- Mikey Mooney
- Ronan Laird
- Rosaria de Nitti

Technician Names

- Darren Watts
- Hakim Al-Mufti
- Jeannette Wilson
- Jie Wong
- Kevin Barrett
- Malaika Okafor
- Shubham Khan
- Silvia Hinojosa

THE BIG HOLE

When the heroes emerge from the basement, there's a massive ruckus going on out in the courtyard. They hear a rumble as if from a train passing beneath their feet. It feels like it's coming from all around them, but mostly from the direction of the courtyard.

If the heroes are in or near the courtyard, they also see a flash that blinds anyone in the area for a moment. When their eyes clear, they can see a new portal has appeared in the center of the courtyard. This one is 20 feet (4 spaces) high and wide, and it glows with the same white-blue light of the one in the basement, only it's more intense.

Soon after the heroes spot the new portal, the shadow of a man appears behind it. The man leaps through the blinding light and lands just outside of the portal's area. He collapses there, barely breathing.

He looks otherwise fit—with blond hair, blue eyes and a powerful build—but he's been battered badly enough that he's scraping against death.

If the heroes approach to investigate, the man pushes himself up onto his elbows and looks up at them, his face twisted in horror. *"You've got to stop them,"* he says in a weak voice. *"They're going to destroy everything—in my world and yours."*

With that, he falls unconscious and cannot be revived.

The man looks familiar, and anyone who likes can make a Logic vs. TN 10 action check to try to place the face. Those who succeed recognize him immediately as one of the best-known people in America, a super hero whose identity has long been public.

He looks just like the original Captain America, Steve Rogers.

He might be a bit older, perhaps—and he does seem close to death—but he could easily be a Super-Soldier-Serum-powered Steve Rogers from another world.

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The Rift Between Worlds

The heroes don't have much time to discuss what's going on. While they examine Rogers, a new shadow appears in the portal, larger than the one that appeared before Rogers showed up.

The heroes have enough time to prepare for the newcomers, whomever they might be. They could:

- Set up in positions for an attack
- Run
- Hide in the courtyard (perhaps behind the crates)
- Get ready to greet whomever comes through the portal
- Jump into the portal

If the heroes are wild enough to leap into the portal, they bounce right off it. There's already someone in the tunnel between the worlds that the portal connects, and there's no room for anyone else. Occupants in the tunnel can only go one way once they enter, and they displace any attempts to use it in the opposite direction.

If the heroes flee, they might miss out on the troubles to come. Before they get too far, though, Ingellis appears and asks them where they're going. He can't believe they're really going to abandon the entire block to the Maggia like this.

If Ingellis is close enough to see the portal at this point, he immediately recognizes Steve Rogers and gawks at the heroes in shock. *"You're not just going to let Captain America die like that, are you? What kind of heroes are you?"*

If the heroes stick around—as most likely they will—they see another massive flash, and Madame Masque appears along with a Hydra agent for each hero.

If the heroes are hiding in the courtyard (or nearby), Madame Masque immediately calls for the Hydra agents, Maggia guards and technicians she left behind. If they don't respond, she orders the Hydra agents she is with to fan out, search for the others and shoot any interlopers they encounter.

If the heroes left any of her underlings alive and able to respond, they shout for help. The Hydra agents haul such people before Madame Masque, where they tell her what happened. When they are done, she accuses them of having failed.

If the accused are Maggia members, Madame Masque shoots them dead. If they are Hydra agents, she lets the new Hydra agents shoot them dead, which they do without hesitation. There is no room for failure in their world either—maybe less. If they are technicians, she lets them live, as she needs them alive, but they know that they are doomed unless they manage to impress her more than they've already disgusted her.

If the heroes actually try to talk with Madame Masque, she's astonished at their foolhardiness and opts to banter with them a bit before killing them. She treats this as if she is a cat playing with her prey. The moment the heroes start to bore her, though, she orders the Hydra agents to kill them, and the battle begins.

The Fight

This battle should be even more pitched than the one that happened in the basement. If any Hydra agents or Maggia guards who took part in that fight are still around, they join in as well. If the Maggia guards decide to leave when the battle starts to turn against them, Madame Masque shoots them for their cowardice.

The Hydra agents fight as viciously as ever. They are not great tacticians, but they follow Madame Masque's orders to the letter. They move straight toward the heroes and try to shoot them, and they have no fear of death.

Madame Masque, on the other hand, is a bit more strategic and smart about the battle. She uses the Hydra agents as cover for her own attacks, and she takes care to get the measure of the heroes before she commits herself to risking her own skin to hurt them. She hasn't plagued heroes like Iron Man for years despite her lack of powers by throwing caution to the wind.

The moment Madame Masque seems like she's in danger, she cackles at the heroes. *"You think beating me is going to stop this? You fools are in for a world of hurt!"*

Her cackling rouses the fallen Steve Rogers, who struggles to his elbows once more and stabs a shaky finger at the portal. An even larger shape darkens it now, and this time, it's tinted red. *"The Crimson Surfer is coming!"* Rogers shouts. *"You have to stop him from breaking through!"*

If she can, Madame Masque takes an action to put a bullet into Rogers' head. Either way, he breathes his last and dies. Any attempts to revive him are doomed to fail. He's already lost far too much blood.

Hopefully, the heroes realize that they need to pull the plug on this massive portal before whatever it is that couldn't fit through the smaller portal comes zooming through. If not, feel free to drop an inadvertent hint from Madame Masque—something like, *"It's too late to stop it! Why even try?"*

If the heroes start trying to destroy the equipment maintaining the portal, they should discover that Madame Masque and her team weren't quite ready to do this yet. The heroes' interference forced her to push her plans forward, so she opened up this larger portal before it was ready to be stabilized. To shut it down, they just have to cut power to the electronics the portal hovers over.

There are several ways the heroes can attempt to do this:

- Sever the power cable
- Find the power button on the console in the corner of the courtyard closest to the service elevator
- Find the circuit breakers in the basement
- Somehow blow the power for the entire block

However the heroes manage it, they'd better hurry. Each round that the battle goes on, the shadow inside the portal grows a deeper and darker red as the danger behind it approaches closer. After four rounds of battle, the edge of a crimson surfboard appears through the portal, and a voice howls out in fury and hatred somewhere behind it.

Each round after that, make an Ego vs. TN 25 action check, using an Ego of 7. If it succeeds, the Crimson Surfer stuck in the portal manages to break through. Each round reduces the target number by 1. If the traveler breaks through, the portal explodes, doing 50 points of nonlethal Health damage to everyone in the courtyard. Because it is nonlethal damage, any character with less than 50 Health will be left 1 point away from death.

Hopefully, it doesn't come to that.

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The Aftermath

When the battle is over, there are a few likely outcomes, and they hinge on whether or not the heroes managed to shut down the portal.

If the heroes failed to shut down the portal in time, the Crimson Surfer breaks through from Earth-56438 into this one. (See the Crimson Surfer's profile in Chapter 8: Characters for all the details on him.) However, the portal's technology begins to fail as he appears. Before it explodes, he has a split second to decide what to do, and he opts to return to his home dimension rather than be trapped in this one. The heroes get just a glimpse of him before the explosion, and when they recover from it, he's gone.

If the heroes shut down the portal before that happens, they still have to deal with Madame Masque, who's now angrier at them than ever. While she might normally flee at this point when seeing the odds stacked against her, she's furious enough about the fact that her plans have all been thwarted that she demands revenge.

If the heroes defeat Madame Masque and her underlings, they can turn her and any other Maggia members over to the police. Or, if they don't get along well with local law enforcement, they can just leave their captives tied up there in the courtyard for the police to discover. If the heroes are in too much of a hurry to get away before the police arrive, Ingellis is happy to watch over the criminals and turn them over to the police in the heroes' stead.

If any Hydra members get turned over to the police, there's sure to be a great deal of confusion, as they don't belong in this world. Still, many of their counterparts in this world are known members of the Maggia, which perhaps helps explain why the first portal was opened up in the basement of Prano's and why Madame Masque was able to make such a fast connection with Hydra agents in another universe.

If any of the Hydra agents get away, there are sure to be all sorts of troubles as they try to blend into the background of a world in which they don't belong. Maybe they track down their counterparts and kill them so they can take their places. Maybe they join up and work alongside each other instead, looking for a way to get the displaced Hydra agents home.

DAMAGE CONTROL

Hopefully, the heroes manage to stick to at least the rough edges of the plot and triumph in the end. If they don't, there are all sorts of things that can go wrong.

Dead Heroes

With Rank 1 heroes, it's all too easy for one of them to get killed. Maybe they roll poorly and get hit by a Hydra bullet. Or they could stumble over the edge of a rooftop while trying to get away. Or maybe Madame Masque gets her revenge on them before the rest of the heroes get the best of her.

If this is your heroes' first adventure, this is a good time to take the group's temperature and see how they feel about playing heroes who die. If it's a one-shot adventure using premade profiles rather than original characters, letting such unfortunate characters go might be all right. The players, after all, can just take on the role of different characters in the next adventure.

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If the players plan to continue with these characters after this adventure, though, don't let random chance end their plans. Give the other heroes a chance to save them. If necessary, you can rule that the villains wanted to capture the heroes rather than—or at least before—killing them, so the last bit of damage the hero took was nonlethal.

Letting a hero die early on can set a darker tone for the game. If that's the sort of feel you're hoping for, maybe that's okay. If so, it can be better for a player to lose a character early on rather than when they've had much more time to become attached to them.

Captured Heroes

If the heroes somehow get themselves captured, you have two choices. The easiest thing to do is have them tied up or otherwise imprisoned in a way that they have no hope of getting out of on their own. This works if the other heroes then have a chance to save them, but it means that the captured heroes might feel less useful than usual, since they may not be able to contribute to progressing the plot much while captured.

The other choice is for the captors to do a poor job of securing the heroes. They might not, for instance, account for the heroes' powers, especially if they haven't actually seen the heroes use them. This would give the captured heroes a chance to use their powers to escape.

Once the heroes escape, they might be in a better position to stop the villains than they might have been otherwise. They might also have learned more about what's going on in this situation by listening to their captors talk—or by asking them pointed questions and gauging their reactions. In the end, they could turn their worst moment into a huge advantage.

Tactical Retreat

Sometimes heroes can be a little too cautious. They might hesitate to run toward danger or to risk their welfare to save the lives of others. While that's not exactly heroic behavior, it's understandable, particularly if the players are afraid of their heroes being killed.

If this becomes a real problem, you can allay the players' fears by promising not to kill their characters without their consent. That doesn't mean that the heroes can't fail at what they set out to do. It just means they won't pay the ultimate price for such failures. Such reassurances can help encourage players to take bigger risks with their characters than they might ordinarily be able to stomach.

If the heroes have trouble with the first fight in the adventure, it's okay to recalibrate everything to make it a bit less difficult for them. That doesn't mean that you can't challenge them just as hard in the final battle, but this can give you and them a chance to ease into it.

The Villains Win

Although it's not likely, it's entirely possible for the villains to triumph over the heroes in this adventure. If that happens, it's (hopefully) not the end of the world.

In a one-shot adventure, you can just explain that because the heroes weren't able to stop her, Madame Masque brought the Crimson Surfer into their world without any interference. Since the Crimson Surfer is the herald for something more awful than the heroes would wish to contemplate, this is bad, but the heroes—or perhaps the players controlling different heroes—might be able to disrupt the full plans in the future.

If you're playing in a graphic novel or an ongoing series, the heroes might still have a chance to make up for their earlier failure. The arrival of the

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Crimson Surfer makes the communication of reconnaissance information from the heroes' world back to the Supremacy on Earth-56438 much easier, and the Crimson Surfer will be able to whet his master's appetite for this world with personal descriptions of how ripe and ready it is for destruction. Those plans are still a long way from coming to fruition, though.

If you really want to shake things up, you can have a loss at this stage mean that the Crimson Surfer leads Kang the Devourer to the planet straightaway without any trouble at all. That is inevitably going to mean the complete and utter destruction of this world and timeline at that villain's hands. However, the creature's hunger is never fully satiated. The players can start over with new heroes trying to protect a new planet in the next adventure.

While the heroes of that new planet are unlikely to know of the failure to stop the villains this time, that failure can haunt the players and make them more intent on succeeding the next time around. Several other Earths have already met a similarly awful fate, but knowing that and having played through it are two different things.

THE EPILOGUE

Assuming the heroes triumph over Madame Masque and her Maggia underlings and Hydra allies, they have effectively saved the world—although they may not know exactly from what. While the rest of the people on the planet might not know that, Fury goes out of his way to point out this accomplishment and to thank the heroes for a job well done.

Now that Fury knows that he can trust the heroes to not only do the right thing but also succeed at it, he might well have more cases they can help him with in the future. The pay is lousy (most times, it doesn't exist) and there may be little glory in it (as happens when you defeat a threat no one else knows about), but these are opportunities for the heroes to do some real good in the world and make it a better and safer place for everyone who lives in it. How many people actually get the chance to do that?

Local Heroes

While the heroes' exploits might not appear on the news, Ingellis knows what they did for him, his neighborhood and the planet, and he's eternally grateful to them. He calls the police to come in and arrest anyone they can.

While this isn't going to do much more than put a dent in the control of the local Maggia, at least the police now have someone they can arrest for the arson of Nanni's. This means that the insurance money for the damages done should come through with much less of a fight, and because of that, Ingellis will be able to rebuild his family's restaurant better than ever.

Anytime the heroes are in the area, they are cordially invited to stop and dine at Nanni's. Ingellis promises to invite them to the grand reopening, and he vows that their money will never be any good at the establishment from now on.

Maggia Matters

If Madame Masque winds up in jail, that should at least slow down the Nefaria family's attempt to take control of a good chunk of Manhattan. They hoped to step into the power vacuum that Silvermane's retreat from public life inflicted upon the Manfredi family as a whole. It's hard to know if this might give the Manfredis a chance to rally back and retake their territory or if a third party might see the region as ripe for claiming.

It's also going to put a crimp in Madame Masque's plans to help the Crimson Surfer lead his master to this world. Some might wonder what might have led Madame Masque to betray her entire planet, but her answer is what it has always been—for power. With the help of these alternate people, she would have taken over the Maggia entirely.

If Madame Masque ends up in police custody, she is certain that this humiliation will not endure. If the Nefaria family has anything besides money, it's a cadre of incredibly well-paid attorneys, who are prepared to do whatever they can to get her free.

It may not be entirely clear what good that would have done her if the planet was destroyed, but Madame Masque had big plans for her life in a new world. Based upon assurances from the Crimson Surfer and his Hydra partners, she believed she would leapfrog ahead of her variant on Earth-56438 and become a power player in their society.

Now that she's failed at that, Madame Masque may retreat to Europe to the safety of the Nefaria family's holdings there. She might even be someone the heroes could call on at a later point for help. If the planet is going to be destroyed without a viable escape route for her, she knows who she would support—at least until she can betray them for her own gain again.

Righteous Fury

While Fury might have wondered about possible invasions from other universes, till the end of this adventure, he didn't even know about Earth-56438, much less feel the need to worry about it. Now that Madame Masque's plot has been revealed, though, that concern gets bumped right to the top of his list of things to focus on.

Fury will most likely be the character to give out the designation Earth-56438 to the heroes. However, the Narrator can pepper this info in anywhere after the portal is discovered.

If Fury can get a hold of Madame Masque, he is willing to do whatever he can to get her to talk. Unfortunately, with S.H.I.E.L.D. dissolved, Fury doesn't have any legal authority to arrest her, much less to interrogate her. If he wants to pump her for information, he's going to have to come up with off-book ways to do it.

Of course, Madame Masque wasn't the only person involved in this operation. The Maggia guards she had stationed in Prano's might know a thing or two that could prove useful, and the Hydra agents could possibly be even more informative.

Ranking Up

Whether or not it's time to have the heroes rise from Rank 1 to Rank 2 depends on your plans for the game. If you want to roll straight on into the second adventure in this book, then you should go ahead and let the heroes rank up right away.

However, if you have other adventures you want the heroes to engage in first, there's no need to rush. If the adventures you have in mind are suitable for Rank 1 heroes, then feel free to delay ranking the characters up until the time is right. You can delay this all the way until right before starting in on the second adventure in this book. That's recommended for heroes of Rank 2, and allowing Rank 1 heroes to take on its challenges gives them a much stronger chance to fail at it.

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If your players would like to rank their characters up sooner than later, there's likely little harm in that. Just make sure that you adjust your adventures to be challenging for their heroes at their new ranks. Adventures are most fun when they make the triumphs they offer meaningful.

If the heroes just gained their powers in the course of this adventure, it's probably better to put off ranking up for a little bit if you can manage it. Let the players test out the characters' new powers for a while before they have to press on.

The Next Adventure

The next adventure in *The Cataclysm of Kang* series takes the heroes from Lower Manhattan to Hell's Kitchen on the west side of the borough. The heroes might not have a lot of clues to lead them in that direction quite yet, but once they embark on that adventure, they may start to make connections with what's gone before.

In the next installment, the Hydra agents and leaders from Earth-56438 make a bigger play for establishing a base in this world's New York City. Rather than take over a single block, they want the whole neighborhood as a beachhead from which to launch their invasion.

While it might appear to the heroes that Hydra wants to conquer their world, the truth is far worse than that. Still, you should point the heroes in that direction so that when the real motives of Earth-56438's Hydra are revealed, they come as the shocking twist they're meant to be.

SIDETRACKS

While this adventure is complete, you and your players might not be ready to plunge straight into the adventure in the next chapter. Here are some suggestions for other things that your group can explore and have fun with in the meantime.

Nanni's

While Nanni's is going to be out of business for a while, that doesn't mean that Ingellis might not need some help. The Maggia knows—or at least suspects—that he was the one who ratted them out to the heroes, and they might want to show what happens to people who do that to them.

The rest of the neighborhood is on Ingellis' side and would be happy to rally around him—as long as it doesn't mean exposing themselves to danger as well. While he may have lost his restaurant, they still live in fear of the same thing happening to their own homes and businesses.

On top of that, Ingellis has more to lose. While Nanni's has been destroyed, Luciano & Matteo's—the Italian grocery store across the street from the restaurant—is still going, and the Maggia could torch it as easily as they did Nanni's.

Ingellis knows this, and he has set up cameras all around the store, including ones that point toward it from Nanni's. He tries to monitor them all the time, and when he spots someone that looks like trouble lurking about, he goes to confront them. So far, he's been able to chase everyone off, but that likely won't last forever.

Ingellis inevitably finds himself in over his head and calls for help. The heroes can become involved in a few different ways:

- Ingellis contacts them directly.
- Fury contacts them on Ingellis' behalf.
- The heroes hear gunshots or cries for help and come to the rescue.

The heroes can help drive the Maggia goons away, but the best way for them to help is to find the local Maggia leader and declare that Ingellis and his family and businesses are off-limits. Who that might be is a question, though, as control of the neighborhood is in flux. The heroes might have to make a few visits to the area to make sure the message gets through.

Prano's

Ingellis does a little investigating of his own, and he learns that the owners of Prano's didn't want to sell the place to the Maggia, but they weren't given a choice. Fortunately, the actual sale never went through, as Madame Masque was less concerned about cutting a real-estate deal than she was about stabilizing the portal in the restaurant's basement.

If the heroes can find the deed, Prano's owners might have a shot at taking it back. To get it, though, they first need to clear out the Maggia goons who have taken up residence in the restaurant since the defeat of Madame Masque. They've turned the place into a private party house until they figure out what to do with it.

Earth-56438

While the heroes have prevented Madame Masque from stabilizing the portals that led into Prano's basement and

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courtyard, that doesn't mean that the people from Earth-56438 have entirely given up on the idea of moving their forces into the heroes' world from there.

The Hydra agents and bosses working with Madame Masque move on to the next step in their plans relatively quickly, but others might not be willing to abandon this resource so fast. It's possible that ambitious rogue Hydra agents from Earth-56438 who are still on the heroes' Earth would use Prano's basement as a base. If they discover the Maggia goons who have set up camp there, they could decide to either ally with them or take them down and clear the place out for their own use.

Such Hydra agents quickly realize that wearing Hydra gear in Manhattan is a good way to bring the police and any local heroes down on their heads, so they ditch their uniforms soon after their arrival. At that point, the heroes might have a hard time distinguishing them from the local criminals. It might only be after investigating Prano's that they would find clues—like a stash of uniforms—that would link these people to Earth-56438.

Alternatively, Fury might alert the heroes to the issue. If one of the Hydra agents gets arrested, the fact that their identification and other items in their wallet come from another world might crop up—not to mention the fact that their local versions might get hauled in for crimes that their Earth-56438 counterparts committed.

THE WRONG WORLD

It's entirely possible for the heroes to wind up on the wrong end of the portal between their world and Earth-56438. If they do, they might wind up spoiling some of the surprises the players have waiting for them later on in this series of adventures, so take care not to reveal too much to them. While this isn't likely, heroes are a curious bunch who often find ways to get into situations they never should have discovered in the first place, so it pays to be prepared in case that happens.

The Other Masque

On Earth-56438, a scientific laboratory sits in the location where Prano's should be. The entire neighborhood was repurposed for research by the Maggia, which has been allied with Hydra for decades.

The leader of this project is a woman named Giuletta Nefaria. On the heroes' world, she's known as Madame Masque, but here she's the figurehead for the Hydra-run version of the American Maggia. Soon after the Hydra scientists of Earth-56438 broke through to the heroes' world, Nefaria reached out to her counterpart there and struck a deal to help stabilize the portal between the worlds for the benefit of them both.

On Earth-56438, Nefaria is much less willing to get her own hands dirty, as it risks the legitimacy of her position with Hydra. She's happy to cut loose her less-restrained costumed counterpart from the heroes' world, though.

Until a few weeks ago, Nefaria's research into piercing the veil between worlds was mostly academic, but recent events on Earth-56438 spurred Hydra into funneling a great deal of resources into it. The details about those events are so top secret that even Nefaria doesn't know much about them. She's only aware that her superiors have decided that they need to establish a large and stable gateway to another universe as soon as possible, and if she can't make that happen, then she will be summarily replaced.

Nefaria is all too aware that such a fall from grace would involve not only the loss of her position but potentially her life. It doesn't take much to be accused of being a traitor in Hydra's America on Earth-56438, and being convicted of such comes with the penalty of a painful and public execution.

This is why Nefaria made contact with her other self and used a convenient location over which Madame Masque could establish control—Prano's. It was because of Nefaria's insistence on secrecy in the heroes' world that the Maggia there then set about taking control of the entire block—which unfortunately attracted Nick Fury Jr.'s attention despite such ambitious precautions.

Visiting Earth-56438

If the heroes somehow manage to reach Earth-56438, they are not likely to get far. The site where Prano's stands in that world is a high-security research facility that was built there after the old restaurant was torn down. Breaking out of the building would be difficult, and if the heroes wind up in Lower Manhattan of Earth-56438, they should quickly recognize that they are in over their heads.

The Hydra flag flies atop most buildings, and their green-and-yellow insignia is splashed across many surfaces. Law enforcement patrols are everywhere, and the officers are all dressed as Hydra agents who often dispense justice on the spot rather than bother the already clogged court system. Anyone who displays any kind of super-powers, though—and who isn't well-known or doesn't have Hydra identification on them—is immediately arrested.

If the heroes are accosted and try to escape, the Hydra agents have orders to shoot to kill, and they are not afraid to do so. They instantly suspect that the heroes are part of the anti-Hydra resistance, and they are not about to let such violent terrorists run wild.

If the heroes are captured, they can expect a long wait for a sham trial, punctuated by enhanced interrogation techniques that are sure to make them regret every choice they made in their lives that led them to this world. If they break quickly and pledge their loyalty to Hydra, they might be given the opportunity to serve the country on one of the many "super-hero" teams, where they are considered dispensable at best and are constantly sent into lethal situations in which they are forced to either kill or be killed.

If the heroes are smart, they should try to return home as fast as possible, long before they are spotted. This would be the safest and wisest move for them, as Rank 1 heroes have little chance in such a malevolent world. If the heroes resist that, though, they could find themselves pressed into Hydra's service or dead.

It's up to you whether you should encourage your players to simply create or choose new heroes to play at that point. That would certainly be the simplest route.

Another option would be for the heroes to escape, make contact with the resistance and help lead the effort to overthrow Hydra's rule. Unfortunately—as players will learn later in the adventure—the fate of Earth-56438 is already on the line for other reasons, so the heroes might never get the chance to make that unlikely scenario happen, even in the best of cases.

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FRIENDLY NEIGHBORHOOD

Hell's Kitchen. Long known as some of the meanest streets in Manhattan, this neighborhood is home to people who take pride in sticking it out despite the brutal winters, scorching summers, tough gangs, organized mobs, corrupt officials and crumbling infrastructure. It's a home to the poor, the working class, new immigrants—in other words, folks who have to work twice as hard to get half as far.

Still stereotyped as a forgotten and abandoned corner of New York City, Hell's Kitchen is often ripe for exploitation. Which is why sinister forces have put it in their crosshairs. Still stinging from their defeat in Little Italy, Hydra agents from Earth-56438 have made these streets on the West Side of Midtown the center of their new plan…

…only they've forgotten the true heart of Hell's Kitchen is the Man Without Fear.

See Changing Face of Hell's Kitchen on page 36 for a more detailed—and up-to-date—discussion of the neighborhood!

THE BRIEFING

Chapter 3: Friendly Neighborhood is a full-length adventure for four or five Rank 2 characters. It should take approximately two or three sessions to complete. Optional objectives and shortcuts will be provided in the adventure to extend play or modify it for the needs of your group.

The Villains

As the adventure unfolds, the heroes will first encounter members of the Wrecking Crew doing what they do best—tearing up the neighborhood. After the heroes contain the initial threat, they watch as the city musters an inordinate response, instituting a draconian law-enforcement presence. While the authorities lock down the neighborhood, the heroes need to figure out they aren't real police at all, but Hydra goons in disguise! Investigating the motives behind the brutal actions of the Hydra agents leads the heroes to the mastermind of this nefarious scheme—Baron Zemo of Earth-56438.

The Locations

The adventure centers around Hell's Kitchen, a neighborhood west of the Theater and Garment districts, in the shadow of the city's core business hub and some of its most prominent buildings. Known officially as "Clinton," the Hell's Kitchen moniker dates back to sometime in the 1800s, though there are numerous theories as to its origin. It has a past of being home to immigrants, blue-collar workers and some of the toughest gangs ever to operate in the five boroughs. These days the neighborhoods are being gentrified and the old buildings replaced with million-dollar condos and boutique shops. The primary action occurs at several locations within the neighborhood:

- The Lincoln Tunnel
- The Midtown North Police Precinct (306 West 54th Street)
- The Convention Center (West 34th Street & 11th Ave.)
- Metro-General Hospital (West 58th Street and 9th Ave.)
- Fire stations
- DeWitt Clinton Park

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The Plot

In Chapter 2: Origin Story, Madame Masque and the Maggia were working with agents from Earth-56438's Hydra, a military fascist world power on their planet. The Hydra leader responsible for the plan is none other than Baron Zemo. Having failed with their more subtle approach, and anxious about running out of time, Zemo decides to marshal his forces to secure an entire neighborhood from which to establish a true foothold on this Earth.

Changing Face of Hell's Kitchen

The Hell's Kitchen neighborhood of Manhattan has undergone significant changes in recent years, with a stark contrast to its historical perception. For decades, the area was notorious for its high crime rates, gang activity and poverty, leading to its reputation as one of the most dangerous neighborhoods in New York City. However, today, Hell's Kitchen has undergone a significant transformation, which has caused the perception of the neighborhood to change drastically.

Historically, Hell's Kitchen was a working-class neighborhood with a high concentration of Irish and Italian immigrants. The area had a reputation for being rough, with violent gangs, prostitution and gambling dens. The neighborhood's nickname is believed to have originated from the harsh conditions experienced by its residents, including the cramped and unsanitary tenements, the violence and the corruption that plagued the area.

In the 1980s and 1990s, Hell's Kitchen became synonymous with crime and poverty. The neighborhood was marked by high rates of drug use and violent crime. The area's reputation as a dangerous and undesirable place to live made it an affordable option for those unable to move to better neighborhoods.

However, in recent years, Hell's Kitchen has undergone a significant transformation. As with many parts of Manhattan, gentrification has played a major role in the neighborhood's evolution. The area has seen an influx of young professionals and families, drawn to the neighborhood's central location, diverse dining options and entertainment venues. The construction of new luxury apartments and the renovation of older buildings has also played a role in the area's transformation.

Today, Hell's Kitchen is a vibrant, bustling neighborhood, with a thriving nightlife scene and a variety of trendy restaurants and bars. The neighborhood is home to many young professionals who work in Midtown Manhattan and who appreciate the convenience of living close to their offices. The area is also popular with tourists, drawn to its dining options and nightlife scene.

Gentrification and economic growth are transforming Hell's Kitchen into a cool, desirable place to live. Although the area's reputation for crime and poverty still lingers, the reality is that Hell's Kitchen is a vibrant, exciting part of the city, attracting a diverse group of residents and visitors alike.

It's up to you to determine whether you want to describe Hell's Kitchen as it was known (and depicted in classic *Daredevil* comics and various media properties), or whether your game should be more reflective of the current reality.

THE HEROES

This adventure is designed for four or five heroes of Rank 2. You should feel free to tailor it to fit the needs of your group, which can have a mix of heroes of Rank 2 or Rank 3 for this adventure. It can be adjusted for slightly more or less powerful groups by changing how much assistance they receive from the allied nonplayer characters (NPCs) or even the local authorities.

Marvel Heroes

The default characters for this adventure are Hawkeye (Kate Bishop), Colleen Wing, Patriot (Rayshaun Lucas), Mockingbird (Bobbi Morse), Prowler (Hobie Brown) and White Tiger (Ava Ayala). Their profiles are in Chapter 8 of this book, except for White Tiger, whose profile is in the *Core Rulebook*.

Alternatively, if the players used the default characters from Chapter 2 (Agent Sum, Claire Dixon, Dakota North, Frog-Man and/or Maddy Cho) and have upgraded them to Rank 2, feel free to continue the story with them!

Original Heroes

If the players have created original characters for your campaign and have reached Rank 2, they can be used with this adventure. If you want the players to create new, original characters, we suggest starting them at Rank 2 for this adventure.

Adjusting the Difficulty

With the Narrator's permission, the players can use other Marvel heroes for this adventure. A mix of Rank 2 to Rank 3 characters should manage well. If they are of a higher or lower rank, combat may feel too easy or far too difficult.

If it seems likely your group of heroes will overwhelm any one individual member of the Wrecking Crew, an easy fix is to put two or more of the Crew in a location as needed.

Chapter 3: Friendly Neighborhood takes the basics the players have learned in Chapter 2: Origin Story and ramps it up to the next level, for a thrilling, heroic experience.

The Man Without Fear

Daredevil is the guardian of Hell's Kitchen. It would be remiss not to include him in this adventure, as it takes place on his home turf. The recommendation is to include the Man Without Fear as an NPC who acts as a contact and ally. This will allow the Narrator to drop in information and help for the players if they need it.

However, if you want to include Daredevil as an optional player character, feel free to do so using his profile from the *Core Rulebook*. Private notes can be passed to the player with information that Daredevil would be privy to as a veteran of Hell's Kitchen. Furthermore, his occupation as a lawyer may come into play if the heroes pursue certain angles of investigation.

What Does Daredevil Know?

Daredevil is familiar with all the locations in Hell's Kitchen. Any questions of where something is or how long it will take the heroes to get there can be answered by him. Daredevil knows the details of the key locations and can judge the impact of the heroes' tactical decisions on the city.

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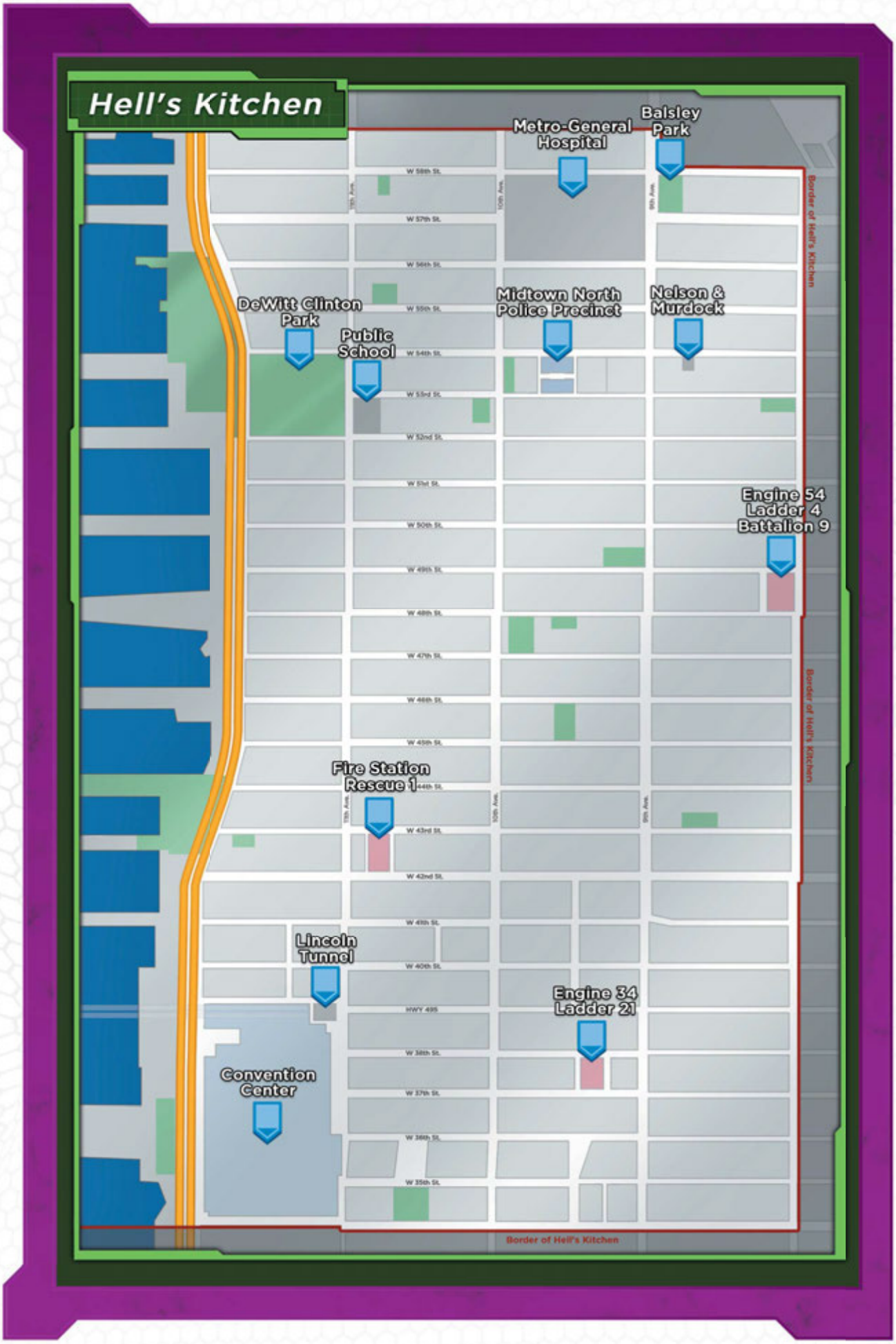

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Daredevil's Heightened Senses can be used when questioning the antagonists to gain additional information. The target number will be different depending on the individual. For example, use Vigilance vs. TN 10 for street thugs, goons, agents and normal people. The target number will be higher for higher-ranked villains. For example, the Wrecking Crew will fall into TN range of 12–16. Baron Zemo will be TN 18. Meanwhile, characters with unusual physiology (for instance, characters made of pure energy) will have an absurdly high TN for Daredevil to glean even a sliver of truth. The Narrator should use their best judgment on what a fair TN is based on the person under questioning and apply appropriate modifiers based on the situation.

Daredevil's alter ego, Matt Murdock, has extensive contacts in the legal arena, which may help the heroes unravel the schemes of Baron Zemo and his minions.

Finally, Daredevil is familiar with the local criminal elements in Hell's Kitchen, should the heroes need that information.

THE HOOK

There are several ways to start this adventure, depending on whether you are continuing from Chapter 2 or running this as a stand-alone adventure.

Graphic Novel

Assuming the threats in Chapter 2 were thwarted by the heroes, a week passes, allowing the heroes to manage their normal lives and carry on. Start with Life Returns to Normal.

Single Issue

Running this as a stand-alone adventure, players can either use the suggested characters in Chapter 8 or create original Rank 2 characters. In either case, jump right into Passing Through the Kitchen.

Life Returns to Normal

It's been a week of relative normalcy for the heroes since they managed to deal with Madame Masque and the Maggia. The heroes have a chance to take a breath, have a cup of coffee (maybe take an espresso with Nanni and see how he's doing) and otherwise catch up on work or school or spend time with friends and family.

Behind the scenes, on Earth-56438, Baron Zemo is adjusting his plans. Although he knows he's working under immense time pressure for the sake of his world, Zemo is nothing if not calculating. He takes direct control of the operation and maneuvers his forces into position…

What Happened to Madame Masque?

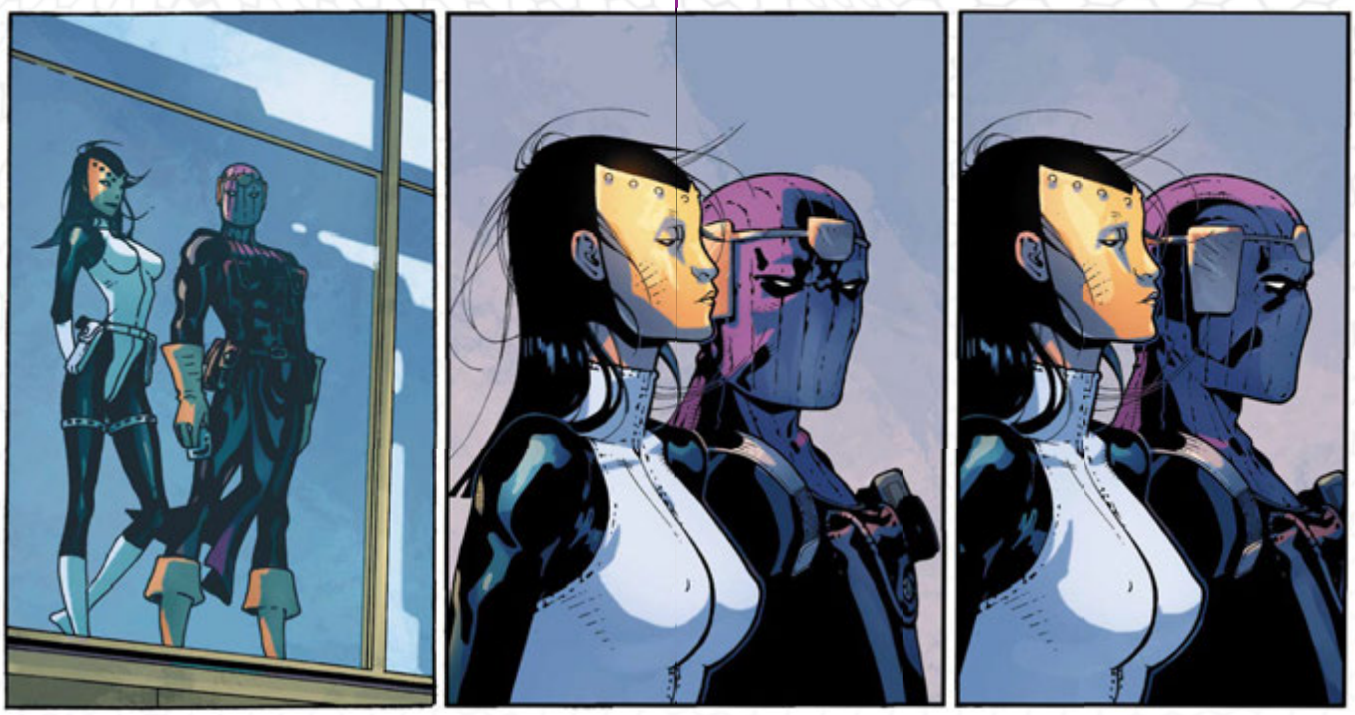
If Madame Masque was captured or fled in your campaign, then she's probably hiding out (in Europe) and hoping that Baron Zemo of Earth-56348 doesn't decide to tie up that loose thread. If the heroes decide to track her down, Nick Fury Jr. would be the best resource. However, that side adventure should likely be kept for after Chapter 3, which has the heroes dealing with more immediate concerns.

Giuletta Nefaria, Masque's Earth-56438 counterpart, does not fare so well. Zemo has her thrown into a black cell for her failure, to be forgotten about unless, or until, he needs her again.

Passing Through the Kitchen

The heroes need to be in or around the neighborhood of Hell's Kitchen one afternoon when the calm is shattered by a tremendous *boom*!

A cloud of smoke rises up from the heart of the neighborhood, accompanied by blaring of alarms and screams—one of the fire stations is ablaze. Time to act!



Art by Timothy Green II & Jean-Francois Beaulieu

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-1700)

THE PLOT

The adventure takes place in roughly three acts.

Act I

The characters spot a cloud of smoke and hear cries in the heart of Hell's Kitchen—rushing to investigate, they discover a firehouse ablaze. They must rescue several civilians and firefighters who are at risk.

Once that situation is under control, the heroes learn that a super-powered woman—using a giant wrecking ball—smashed the place up without warning and then headed off. She's known as Demolisher, and she's part of the Wrecking Crew on Earth-56438.

They learn about her whereabouts soon enough, as she's attacking another fire station!

As soon as they defeat Demolisher or drive her off, the heroes are contacted by an ally with more critical information. This is either Daredevil or Nick Fury Jr., who tells them that two similar terrorist attacks are occurring right now—the power grid for Metro-General Hospital was knocked offline (by Thunderball), and someone is throwing trucks at the entrance to the Lincoln Tunnel (the Wrecker). The heroes have to decide how to handle these simultaneous threats.

Once these incidents are resolved, there's a brief moment of respite. The heroes learn or realize that all of these super villains are members of the Wrecking Crew, but why have they been engaging in wanton destruction? And where are the last members of the Crew? The question is answered almost immediately as further emergency calls come in. The remaining members of the Crew—Bulldozer and Piledriver—are demolishing a police precinct in the Kitchen!

Act II

In the aftermath of the destruction caused by the Wrecking Crew, the heroes try to make sense of this unprovoked attack. The city and state send in emergency forces to quell the chaos, set up safety cordons, assist displaced citizens, deal with fires and keep the peace. This is all being done under the command of Incident Commander Siobhan O'Dwyer.

The heroes will likely try to figure out what motives were driving the Wrecking Crew, but they will be blocked and stymied by the emergency task force, who will grow increasingly cold and hostile to the heroes' presence.

What the heroes don't yet know is that the task force is completely made up of sleeper Hydra agents from Earth-56438, and they want to ensure their plans are not meddled with.

Zemo knows that he realistically cannot keep control of Hell's Kitchen for more than a few days, so his forces must work quickly and efficiently. As soon as a curfew is established and the streets are under their control, he'll bring in truckloads of supplies and equipment to be set up in a large staging area: the Convention Center.

Act II should end with the heroes discovering that the task force is not there to maintain safety and order and is there for its own unscrupulous agenda.

Act III

The heroes must figure out what to do now that they know the Federal Emergency Aid and Response (F.E.A.R.) are false agents with a clear antagonistic agenda.

The heroes will determine that even though F.E.A.R. has control over the majority of the neighborhood of Hell's Kitchen, their most formidable defenses are centered on and around the Convention Center.

Once they've determined that, the heroes will have to find a way to avoid patrols and get around (or through) F.E.A.R.-controlled roadblocks to make their way to the Convention Center.

The Convention Center will be a tough nut to crack for heroes of this power level. It has hardened checkpoints on each corner of the building and bristles with defenses and security protocols.

Within the Convention Center, Zemo's engineers are completing a new portal device, with the potential to create a far greater gateway to Earth-56438. The heroes will have to face F.E.A.R. agents, Baron Zemo and possibly any members of the Wrecking Crew who are still loose.

Zemo's goal is for his technicians to power up the gateway and stabilize it so that a legion of Hydra forces can cross over—soldiers, followed by armored tanks and attack helicopters. If it gets to that stage, the heroes of our Earth are in real trouble…

ACT I

Introduction

Baron Zemo of Earth-56438 has determined that in order to save his world from Kang the Devourer, he needs to improve and expand on Madame Masque's portal experiment. He needs an enormous site to construct it, and he needs his technicians to be undisturbed for the delicate work of assembly and calibration.

(If you skipped Chapter 2: Origin Story for whatever reason, you can assume that Madame Masque failed for any number of reasons and can focus instead on the current events.)

Zemo knows that the neighborhood of Hell's Kitchen, despite being prime real estate on the island of Manhattan, has often been relegated to a forgotten and ignored district. The police and social systems are chronically underfunded, and the area barely has any super-hero presence—Zemo dismisses Daredevil as a second-rate costume.

If Zemo was planning to use Hell's Kitchen as a long-term base of operations, he'd be more concerned with interference from various crime bosses and heroes, but his strategy is short-term and immediate. He needs to upset the status quo quickly and use the chaos to establish a lock on the area.

In order to pull this off, Zemo enlists the help of the Wrecking Crew from Earth-56438. On his Earth, the Wrecking Crew is a tactical unit of the Supremacy, used as a demolition force. This version of the Crew consists of the Wrecker, Thunderball, Piledriver, Bulldozer and Demolisher. His instructions to them are simple: Cause as much devastation and havoc in the area as possible. Target emergency services, such as fire stations and hospitals; target major infrastructure; and target areas of public gatherings. All of this is to create a wave of terror and upheaval.

The Wrecker, the leader of the Crew, sends his minions after the following targets:

Fire Departments

Demolisher, the youngest member of the Crew, is sent to take out the three fire stations that service Hell's Kitchen.

Michael Syrell (Order # 5319470)

Engine 54 (8th Avenue & W 48th Street)

The fire department's Engine 54 station, located on the edge of Hell's Kitchen and Midtown West, is a small building at the end of a block of businesses, including a coffee shop, a beauty supply store, an upper-floor preschool, a pain clinic and a listening library. The station is two floors, with living quarters upstairs, above a two-bay garage. The larger bay holds two fire engines, and the smaller one holds an EMS crew pickup truck.

Demolisher struck here first. She put her wrecking ball through the cabs of both big fire engines and flipped the smaller EMS truck on its side. She also ripped the garage doors off their frames and put a huge hole in the front of the building, exposing the upstairs kitchen to the outdoors.

Luckily, injuries were relatively minor.

Daredevil heard the cries right after she left and did what was needed to ensure none of the firefighters were left at risk. Once he'd assisted them, he was quick to follow her trail.

Rescue 1 (530 West 43rd Street)

This is the second station Demolisher hits, and the first one the heroes learn about. Rescue 1 is a narrow three-story gray granite building sandwiched between a dull six-story brown brick apartment building and a newly renovated 35-floor apartment tower.

By the time the heroes arrive, the fire station is ablaze—and the fire threatens both the smaller apartment on the west side and the taller tower on the east. Alarms blare. People are screaming. The station's ultra-heavy-duty rescue truck is wrecked halfway out of the station, trapping a number of firefighters inside. The truck was crushed in the middle by a massive weight (Demolisher's wrecking ball), and it's crushed all four of the truck's rear tires. Gouts of toxic black smoke are filling the station, and flames are licking up the sides of the walls.

The heroes must deal with several of the following issues (the suggested amount of crises is one more than the number of players you have, so if you have a group of three players, choose four items from the list):

- **Crushed fire truck:** Any super-strong character can move the fire truck out of the way with a Melee vs. TN 16 action check. Alternatively, a character can use a working fire truck to haul the broken one out of the way with a Logic vs. TN 12 action check.
- **Clouds of black, toxic smoke:** With a successful Resilience vs. TN 14 action check, a hero overcomes the smoke and gets out any victims, or smothers the cause of the smoke, making it safe for others to pass through the area. Failure results in minor damage and a forced retreat.
- **Fire racing up the sides of the building:** Succeeding on a Vigilance vs. TN 15 action check, the hero has the situational awareness needed to use the existing equipment to head off the fire and control it.
- **Trapped firefighter (panicked):** The hero can create a rapport with the stressed and panicked firefighter, calming them and making rescue possible, on a successful Ego vs. TN 13 action check.
- **Trapped firefighter (unconscious):** With an Agility vs. TN 14 action check, the hero moves an unconscious firefighter out of the danger area.

As soon as the situation is under control, a distress call comes over the emergency system—another station, the third firehouse in Hell's Kitchen, is being attacked!

Engine Company 34 (440 West 38th Street)

The third fire station that services Hell's Kitchen is located toward the southern side of the neighborhood, overlooking a section of highway. It's a squat, two-story brick building with concrete crenelations along the rooftop, bordered by an empty lot on one side and a six-story mixed-use retail and apartment structure on the other. The empty lot is bordered by a chain-link fence covered in tall crabgrass for nine months of the year. The other side of the lot is a five-story, red-brick tenement building.

The station has two garage bays, one for a full-size fire engine, and the other for a smaller EMS truck.

Demolisher has already thrown her ball into the front of the fire engine, crushing the cab, and she's put several holes into the brick front of the building.

When the heroes arrive, she's hoisted the EMS truck above her head and is about to hurl it down into the mass of traffic below. A handful of firefighters are trying desperately to stop her, but if the heroes don't intervene right now, those brave firefighters are about to be turned into roadkill.

Demolisher is happy to smear the firefighters into red paste if they won't get out of her way. But if the heroes try to distract her or annoy her or outright attack her, she's happy to throw the truck at them instead.

As the youngest member of the Wrecking Crew, Demolisher feels she has to try hard to constantly prove herself. And she doesn't expect this group of costumes she's never heard of to give her much of a challenge. Demolisher tends to be brash and smart-mouthed, trash-talking the heroes and trying to get under their skin.

Time to roll for initiative.

Demolisher: Aftermath

Once Demolisher has completed her mission (of destroying all three fire stations), her instructions are to get out of Dodge. Although Demolisher could probably handle any hero one-on-one, a group of heroes should have her reeling. She's not stupid, and once the fight starts to turn against her, she'll look to make a getaway. She may return to her original plan of trying to throw something heavy off the overpass into rush hour below, or she might try to do more structural damage to the fire station, so that the heroes are forced to spend precious time getting civilians out of harm's way.

If she gets a clear path out, such as jumping into a sewer drain and collapsing the tunnel behind her to prevent pursuit, Demolisher takes it. Once back to a safe point where she left a change of clothes, she can blend in as a civilian and await further instructions.

On the other hand, with so many heroes around, there's a good chance Demolisher will be defeated or knocked out. In either case, her attitude shifts from smart-alecky to tight-lipped.

But that's okay, because the heroes are about to get a visit from an ally.

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-1700)

FRIENDLY NEIGHBORHOOD

Michael Syrett (Order #53194700)

Contact

In the aftermath of Demolisher's attack on the third fire station, the heroes will be contacted by an ally—Daredevil, the Man Without Fear.

If one of the players is using Daredevil as their character, the contact can come from Nick Fury Jr.

Daredevil (or Nick Fury) tells them that this series of brash attacks by this super villain is only the first thrust of what seems to be a series of attacks all over the Kitchen. He's aware that Demolisher already hit the other two fire stations in the area and how the heroes helped out at Rescue 1 Station. However, there are two more critical situations happening right now, and he needs the heroes to intervene at once.

- A super villain (Thunderball) is rampaging at the north end of the district. He has destroyed a transformer and broken water mains. Critically, this affects Metro-General Hospital. If the rampage continues, it could knock out the hospital's backup generators too, putting all of the patients in critical care at risk.
- To the southwest, another super villain (the Wrecker) has smashed a number of vehicles and caused a blockade on the Manhattan-side entrance of the Lincoln Tunnel. Worse, the attack has caused fissures in the tunnel, so water from the Hudson River is starting to flood it, threatening all the civilians trapped inside.

The heroes have only moments to hash out a plan for dealing with these simultaneous threats, at opposite ends of the Kitchen.

If the heroes split into two groups, Daredevil will offer to accompany the weaker side, to help them out. If the two groups are evenly balanced, Daredevil will join the heroes dealing with the Wrecker, as he's arguably the more powerful of the two villains.

If the heroes decide they all want to go to one location first, Daredevil goes to the other crisis point to try to delay the super villain until they can get there.

FAQs

The players may have many questions, and some of this information can be relayed to them by Daredevil (or by Nick Fury Jr., if he is the heroes' main contact).

Can the police help? Not easily. The authorities are responding, but the super villains striking the neighborhood are a step above their capability. It's up to the heroes to try to stop the villains and contain the damage. Eventually, help may arrive from farther out than the immediate neighborhood, but not in time to assist the heroes.

What authority do the heroes have? None—the heroes are on their own as vigilantes. Daredevil has a challenging relationship with the authorities and doesn't expect much help or recognition from those in charge.

Nick Fury Jr. is also in a similar position, where the local forces don't support him and may cause more harm by interfering with him and the heroes' actions.

In fact, when a task force finally arrives to cordon off the destruction and assist in relief efforts in Hell's Kitchen, the heroes find little to no support from that quarter.

Where are the other heroes? New York is home to a vast array of superhumans—from web-slingers to the Fantastic Four to the Avengers—however, one must assume the others are otherwise occupied or away at the moment. The Fantastic Four might be off world, the Avengers could be dealing with Ultron on the West Coast, Spider-Man is tied up with the Green Goblin, etc. Use whatever creative reasons you want as to why the heroes are on their own for the moment.

Metro-General Hospital

Metro-General Hospital (located at 58th Street and 9th Avenue) is a full-service medical center with a 24-hour emergency department that serves Hell's Kitchen and the surrounding areas of the West Side of Manhattan. It is a large facility, with over five hundred beds for patients, and offers numerous clinical specialties—meaning there are hundreds of patients, families, nurses, doctors, orderlies, technicians and support staff all in the danger zone.

Thunderball (Eliot Franklin) is the smartest member of the Wrecking Crew by far—having a career as a brilliant

Art by Darick Robertson, Wayne Faucher & Matt Milla

Michael Syrett (Order #53194700)

physicist before gaining his super-powers—and he and the Wrecker often clash over the direction of the group, with Thunderball knowing he's smarter but chafing due to his reliance on the Wrecker for his powers, and because the rest of the crew looks to the Wrecker first. Thunderball decided that he would impress Zemo by taking out the major hospital for Hell's Kitchen by himself, hoping to gain more prestige and authority with the forces back home.

Thunderball first destroyed the power transformer central to the area surrounding Metro-General. Then, with the surrounding streets blacked out, he started making his way toward the hospital, smashing water mains to cause shortages and flooding. He knows the hospital has a backup generator in the basement, so he's on his way there unless the heroes stop him first.

Because he's trying to outshine the Wrecker and the rest of the crew, Thunderball doesn't call for help. Nor does he back down easily. While he won't fight to the death (his death, at any rate), he assumes these green heroes will be a cakewalk for someone who has tussled with Thor and the Hulk. But he also won't be easily dissuaded from his goal to destroy the generators, so he's more likely to hurl an annoying hero out of his way than try to chase them down and destroy them.

On the other hand, if the heroes seem to be turning the tide against him, Thunderball is smart enough to make a strategic withdrawal. He causes more collateral damage for the heroes to deal with and takes the opportunity to get away if he can. If apprehended, he remains silent and asks for legal representation.

If the heroes deal with the Lincoln Tunnel disaster first, and Daredevil comes here to delay Thunderball, Daredevil manages to get under his skin enough to lure him to a small park (Balsley Park) a couple of short blocks away.

Lincoln Tunnel Entrance

The Lincoln Tunnel is a massive tunnel network that passes under the Hudson River and connects Manhattan to Weehawken, New Jersey. The tunnel itself is really three tunnels, each of which carries two lanes of traffic. Counting both directions of traffic, the tunnel sees an average of well over 100,000 vehicle crossings daily.

As leader of the crew, the Wrecker thinks of himself as a cut above the rest of his gang. And some say he's physically the most powerful member of the group, even if other members outshine him in other ways (such as Thunderball being far more intelligent, or Bulldozer being… well, even more hardheaded).

The Wrecker knows that Zemo wants Hell's Kitchen isolated and in a state of panic and chaos, so what better way than to target one of the major transit routes that connects the island to New Jersey? So he's taken this job on for himself, while sending the rest of the crew to target other key sectors.

There are two different entrances to the tunnel on the New York side—the Wrecker focuses on the side-by-side entrances at Tenth Avenue between 38th and 39th Streets (the eastern tunnel is accessed up by 11th Avenue).

Running up the Lincoln Tunnel Expressway—an eight-block-long, four-lane-wide arterial road that leads from Midtown to the tunnel entrance—the Wrecker happily flips cars, smashes trucks with his crowbar and flings motorcycles as far as he can (which is pretty far!).

By the time the heroes get there, the situation is going south quickly. The Wrecker has smashed and crashed a number of vehicles into the two tunnel entrances, causing an impassable roadblock for vehicles trying to leave the tunnels. Some people near the entrance have abandoned their cars and are trying to scramble over the wreckage, but it's dangerous—broken glass, razor-sharp metal and pools of burning gasoline are everywhere.

Meanwhile, the Wrecker has also struck the tunnel structure hard enough in a few places that he's cracked it all the way through to the foundation, allowing water from the Hudson River to flow in. There are many cars trapped in the tunnel, and people are panicking.

If the heroes don't act now, the loss of life could be enormous. The Wrecker needs to be dealt with so emergency crews can begin rescue operations in the tunnel.

- **Battle the Wrecker:** This is a good opportunity to try out the advanced tactics for battling a major villain. Feel free to suggest to the heroes to try the team maneuvers from the *Core Rulebook* combat section in order to subdue the Wrecker.
- **Civilians trapped in the tunnel:** A group of civilians are trapped behind some cars that have been spun sideways, closing off many lanes of the tunnel entrance. Additionally, there is a truck that's been flipped over blocking the remaining lanes (six in total) that Wrecker has made impassable. The heroes only need to clear one lane to allow the civilians a route out. A Melee vs. TN 12 action check by a super-strong character clears a lane. Otherwise, a hero winning a Logic vs. TN 14 action check can direct drivers to maneuver their vehicles in such a way as to clear an opening, provided the Wrecker has been dealt with.
- **Civilian trapped in a car:** One of the cars the Wrecker has tossed into the tunnel to block the lanes is lying upside down, and a person can be seen trapped in the driver's side, unconscious and bleeding from a head wound. An Agility vs. TN 15 action check is needed to free the driver and move them to safety.
- **Flooding tunnel:** When the Wrecker was smashing up the entrance of the tunnel, a wall was damaged and it created cracks in the tunnel allowing a rapid trickle of water into the area, slowly flooding it. The Wrecker needs to be dealt with before he can cause any more structural damage, and then the Port Authority needs help clearing the way so they can get in with equipment to shore up the tunnel to prevent further flooding.

The Wrecker is very arrogant and believes he can take on the heroes. He goes toe-to-toe with anyone who challenges him and taunts the heroes to invoke such a confrontation. The heroes will likely have to team up to take him down and knock him unconscious, as the Wrecker does not go so quietly into the night.

Wrecker Sayings

"Keep out of my way, you punks, and you won't get hurt!"

"Okay, pals, don't say I didn't warn ya! I can handle this crowbar better 'n a surgeon can handle his scalpel!"

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"You must be crazy ta think you can threaten the Wrecker 'n' get away with it!"

"Let 'er rip!"

"Get outta my face!"

"One hundred percent, Grade-A, pure, enchanted Asgardian power!"

If the heroes deal with Thunderball at Metro-General first, Daredevil will come here and manage to delay the Wrecker long enough for them to catch up. Daredevil can't really hurt him, but he can distract him. In this case, the tunnel flooding should just be starting as the heroes arrive.

A Brief Breather

Once these incidents are resolved, there's a brief moment of respite.

Daredevil (or Nick Fury Jr.) either drops in on the heroes or gets them to join him on an isolated rooftop.

The heroes may recognize that the villains they've faced are part of the Wrecking Crew—if not, Daredevil will fill them in. The Wrecker and Thunderball are well known, although Demolisher is a new face. Still, her MO clearly matches that of the Wrecking Crew.

Daredevil takes stock of what's occurred. The three fire stations that patrol and serve Hell's Kitchen have been put out of commission, the main hospital has been seriously damaged and one of the major routes into and out of the neighborhood has been critically affected.

Daredevil puts several questions to the heroes. Why have the Wrecking Crew been engaging in wanton destruction? What's the purpose of the targets they've attacked? Where is the profit or value in it for them? And perhaps more importantly, where are the last members of the Crew?

The last question is answered almost immediately as further distress calls come in over the emergency broadcast network:

Two super villains matching the descriptions of Bulldozer and Piledriver are demolishing a police precinct in the Kitchen!

Midtown North Precinct

The core police precinct that covers Hell's Kitchen is Midtown North at 306 West 54th Street. It's a stately building with a long tradition, going back to the Irish families who first built up the neighborhood. Nowadays, the police force is much more representational of the diverse community it supports, but you can still see the Irish roots memorialized in its plaques of officers killed in the line of duty.

The officers on duty are doing their best to hold off Bulldozer and Piledriver. Unfortunately, Midtown North is a normal police unit, and while they have the heavy gear to deal with occasional gang activity or riots or crowd control, they are outclassed by these two heavy hitters of the Crew.

The four-story limestone-and-marble structure was built in the late 1930s, occasionally rebuilt in recent decades as necessary but kept to the original facade. Police vehicles (both white-and-blue squad cars and unmarked black sedans) are parked in front, and also in the courtyard between the two wings.

The north wing is more administration and control. It includes a lobby, interview rooms, a training classroom, the communications/dispatch center, administrative offices, detectives' bullpen, records room, traffic office, youth/D.A.R.E./School Resource Officer office and evidence lockers.

The south wing has an area for the patrol division, including a large roll call briefing room, locker rooms for the patrol officers, lunchroom and a gym. It also has an armory, with riot gear, and SWAT weapons and armor. This wing also has a prisoner-processing area, detention cells and evidence lockup.

Bulldozer and Piledriver may not be killers, per se, but these two versions from Earth-56438 are not only a little wilder and crueler than their counterparts, they regard the citizens of Earth-616 as a joke—playthings that are not quite real or significant. They harbor less animosity toward cops (as they've been imprisoned far less frequently in their world), but they still don't have any respect for local law enforcement.

Bulldozer is as direct as his name. He tends to run headfirst into whatever he wants to destroy—headbutting and ramming are his specialties, and his custom-made helmet provides armor for his head, neck and shoulders.

Piledriver comes across as a "good ol' country boy" and is likely the member of the gang most loyal to the Wrecker. Piledriver isn't afraid of getting his hands dirty, and he tends to grab on to things and pull them apart directly.

The attack unfolds as follows:

- Bulldozer goes straight down West 54th Street. There's a line of white-and-blue squad cars and black unmarked sedans, and he barrels through them, knocking them about like billiard balls.
- At the same time, Piledriver works his way up from the southern entrance on West 53rd. He'll grab and flip over a half dozen parked cars to block the alleys from the precinct courtyard, essentially closing off the southern side of the building.
- From that point, Bulldozer and Piledriver start demolishing the precinct wings (north and south) from both ends.
- Bulldozer crashes into the front lobby of the north wing and immediately tears into things, hurling desks, ripping out wires and smashing through interior walls to locate the communications/dispatch room. He ignores everything else until that area is wrecked.
- At the same time, Piledriver tackles the south wing. He crashes through the briefing room and then rips up the locker room and gym (dumbbells and treadmills both go flying!).
- Piledriver then makes his way into the prisoner-processing area and the detention cells; he rips down the cage and busts open the cells, freeing about a dozen prisoners in lockup.
- Finally, Piledriver aims for the armory. A handful of those who were in the holding cells follow in his wake, trying to grab weaponry.
- Piledriver isn't interested in the evidence lockup, but should he compromise it, it will contaminate evidence linked to dozens if not hundreds of cases.
- Meanwhile, once Bulldozer has destroyed the communications room, he'll go to town on the detectives' bullpen—hurling desks and computers about—and then tear through the administrative offices.

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-1700)

Art by Stuart Immonen, Wade von Grawbadger & Dave McCaig

You can decide at what point the heroes arrive, but barring any unusual tactics on their part, they should arrive on the scene right before Piledriver gets to the prisoner-processing area (the sixth bullet point).

Of course, the police headquartered at this station don't take kindly to this intrusion, but they don't have the weaponry or armor to handle a threat of this magnitude. However, they'll do their best to slow the super villains down and to rescue each other from harm's way.

If the heroes managed the earlier members of the Crew with few problems, then Daredevil sends them on their own while he surveys the rest of the neighborhood. On the other hand, if the heroes struggled against their opponents, Daredevil lends a hand or could suggest ways for them to work as a team to divide and conquer their foes.

Piledriver Sayings

"He ain't nothing but a glorified athlete with a few fancy special effects!"

"One good shot oughta bust him up for good!"

Bulldozer Saying

"You guys hit us fast enough to catch us napping—but that don't mean squat against the Wrecking Crew!"

If the heroes take too long to wrap things up, and/or you want to make the encounter more difficult, Demolisher could show up to help the other two hurry up their mission.

Timeline

The Wrecking Crew doesn't seem like a group that would get up early in the morning. Probably takes them a couple of hours to shake off the previous night's cobwebs and hangovers. One can assume that the first incidents (Demolisher at the fire stations, the Wrecker at the Lincoln Tunnel) happen around 2 p.m., with Bulldozer and Piledriver hitting the police precinct by 5 p.m. or so. Whatever happens to the Crew, the Emergency Task Force—Zemo's special unit—rolls into the neighborhood by early evening (say between 6 and 8 p.m.). By nightfall, they set up controlled corridors and cordon off areas, announcing a 10 p.m. curfew as their militarized police vehicles sweep the streets.

Aftermath: Midtown North Precinct

The heroes can't stop the members of the Wrecking Crew from heavily damaging the Midtown North Precinct—the question is how much damage they are able to contain, and whether they are able to defeat and capture Bulldozer and Piledriver (or the two get away).

Option 1: The Crew Escapes

This is the easier option—Bulldozer and Piledriver do all the damage they were instructed to do, utterly degrading the police station's capabilities to aid the neighborhood, and then they bug out. They may enjoy mixing it up in a good brawl, but there's no money in going ten rounds with a bunch of do-gooder heroes, so like their fellow members, they try to arrange a disaster for the heroes to deal with and then take off. They can escape into the sewers, like Demolisher, or Bulldozer can smash through an adjacent building (risking bringing the whole building down behind him), and the two can vanish into the dust.

Once they get clear, the Wrecking Crew members ditch their costumes for civilian clothes and find a place to hang out and cool their heels.

In this case, the heroes need to console themselves with what good they managed to do—what lives they were able to help or save and perhaps rounding up the criminals that were freed when Piledriver tore open the holding cells.

Daredevil (or Nick Fury Jr.) wants to do a debriefing as soon as they catch their breaths.

Are any of the Crew captured? If so, what do they know? (See Option 2: The Crew Is Captured, page 46.)

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However, if any or all of the Wrecking Crew is still free, what should the heroes expect or plan for next? The heroes—or their contact—should notice the Crew struck hard but then vanished. What is the common thread of their targets, if any? (You shouldn't necessarily answer that at this point, but it's good to get them thinking.)

Then jump ahead to Act II: Law and Order.

Option 2: The Crew Is Captured

If the Wrecking Crew is defeated and captured, it opens a new vector of possibilities.

On a normal day, most police precincts aren't equipped to imprison and manage super villains, and with the destruction to Midtown North, there's no chance these villains can be held in the neighborhood.

Daredevil (or Nick Fury Jr.) has enough contacts in high places that he can alert the authorities who specialize in detaining super-powered individuals under arrest and awaiting trial. Depending on the timeline of your game, a unit could be dispatched from the Raft (near Ryker's Island, New York), the Vault (Rocky Mountains, Colorado) or the Lang Memorial Penitentiary, A.K.A. the Ant Farm (New York).

Regardless of where the Crew end up, the heroes have a small window in which they can interrogate the Wrecker and his cronies before they are picked up and taken away—likely far outside of the characters' current reach.

Which Crew?

When Daredevil reaches out to his contacts to arrange a pickup for these super-powered thugs, he learns an important detail—the Wrecking Crew is listed as currently imprisoned in the Raft. So who are these guys? (The heroes might overhear the conversation where the contact says, *"Wait, the Wrecking Crew are locked up already. Who DO you have there?"*)

Regardless of who the criminals are, they need to be taken to a secure facility. It will take approximately an hour or two for suitable transport to arrive.

Daredevil's contact at the Raft double-checks and yes, the Wrecking Crew is definitely locked up at the moment. All accounted for.

If the heroes think to check facial recognition or biometric data, the Crew they've captured matches those in jail exactly, except that there are five of them (including Demolisher), whereas the 616 Crew normally consists of only four: Wrecker, Piledriver, Bulldozer and Thunderball. Any of the Crew from Earth-56438 who is caught is tight-lipped about who they are or where they are from. Zemo instructed them to give up no details on pain of death.

Demolishwho?

The one exception is Demolisher, who has no record as a super-powered criminal (on this world). She's a super villain on Earth-56438. Demolisher of Earth-616 is a mercenary who joined the Wrecking Crew to work on a contract for the Kingpin to demolish Public School 20, where she ran afoul of Moon Girl and Devil Dinosaur. This Demolisher was never captured by police or charged/convicted of a crime, so she has no criminal record. In that case, it's up to the Narrator to decide what happens if the heroes track down Demolisher-616 and hear what she thinks about her namesake smashing things up in the city.

ACT II: LAW AND ORDER

Hell's Kitchen is in turmoil. Local emergency services—fire, police, medical—have all been devastated, not to mention the restriction of travel from off the island to the west. Those injured in the wake of the attacks are in jeopardy of not getting the help they need. People have had vehicles damaged or destroyed, and homes are affected by the loss of basic necessities (water, heat, electricity) or, worse, have been damaged (broken windows, cracked walls, ripped-up sidewalks or driveways) or even destroyed.

Art by Stuart Immonen, Wade von Grawbadger & Dave McCaig

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Night Falls

As night falls, Hell's Kitchen is dark in patches, smoke and dust are in the air and people are in shock. The heroes can help out here or there, but there is a glimmer of hope as the main streets start to rumble with the presence of a convoy of heavy-duty emergency vehicles.

These vehicles—transporting a disaster-relief task force—enter the area from the north, south and east sides and set up a number of security corridors.

Daredevil (or Nick Fury Jr.) suggests the heroes patch themselves up (if hurt), grab a bite and maybe get some rest. They've had a long day, and it's okay to allow someone else to take charge for a little while.

Federal Emergency Aid and Response (F.E.A.R.)

The task force claims to have been deployed by the Office of Emergency Management (OEM) and is officially known as the Federal Emergency Aid and Response, or F.E.A.R. And while there is precedent for calling in the National Guard or a FEMA team during a national emergency, this force was prepped by Zemo and was waiting in the wings.

Note that though it is referred to as F.E.A.R. in this text, the task force members will always refer to it as the Federal Emergency Aid and Response team. F.E.A.R. rolls into the area of Clinton with a mandate to restore order. There are three divisions to the task force, all under the authority of Incident Commander Siobhan O'Dwyer.

F.E.A.R. acts with the following powers:

- **Evacuation orders:** The task force can issue mandatory evacuation orders and can forcibly remove people from their homes or businesses as necessary to maintain order.
- **Curfews:** The task force can impose curfews and restrict the movement of people within the area to maintain order. This limits the exercise of certain rights, such as free speech and assembly.
- **Search and seizure:** The task force can enter homes and businesses without a warrant if they have reasonable suspicion of dangerous activity or if there is an imminent threat to public safety.*
- **Use of force:** The task force can use force, including deadly force, to protect themselves from harm, to maintain order and to control any potential civil unrest.
- **Emergency powers:** The task force can claim "emergency powers" to take control of resources and infrastructure necessary for responding to the crisis and to protect public safety.* This includes suspending the operation of businesses or schools, publication bans and so forth.

***Public Safety:** The F.E.A.R. task force claims they are there to maintain order and keep people from harm, but their true motive is to secure the area to allow Zemo's engineering division to carry out their mission unimpeded. As such, they will do whatever they feel is necessary and claim it is in the interest of "public safety" even when it is clearly not about that at all.

Note that F.E.A.R.'s forces refer to the area as "Clinton," not "Hell's Kitchen," because that's how it's known on their world.

Plans Within Plans

When Baron Zemo first deployed Madame Masque (in Chapter 2: Origin Story), he knew there was a high chance she would fail, and so along with the forces she brought over (who were dealt with by the heroes), Zemo sent over small batches of sleeper agents as a precautionary measure. Over a period of time, they were able to import, build or steal trucks and jeeps, weapons and equipment to outfit a small force.

Zemo is aware that his F.E.A.R. force is not enough to hold Clinton for longer than a few days against the city's heroes, let alone the proper authorities of New York State or the United States of America, but he also knows that the local populace of Earth-616 is in the dark about dimensional realities. It will take them precious hours and days to unravel what's going on—enough time, he calculates, to pull off his grand scheme.

Commander Siobhan O'Dwyer

Repressing the chaos of humanity is the principle that drives Incident Commander Siobhan O'Dwyer. Sure, the Hydra regime can be heavy-handed at times, but the alternative of a society out of control is unacceptable. Force is not the first tool O'Dwyer would reach for to solve an issue, but she always has a weapon strapped to her hip to ensure the conversation goes her way.

O'Dwyer inspires a fierce loyalty in the troops underneath her. She is known to lead from the front, get her hands dirty and protect her people. Which is an interesting position to hold in Hydra, especially when working for Baron Zemo.

O'Dwyer knows the stories that describe Zemo as an opportunistic snake, but so far, she's never seen that side. Thus, as long as Zemo holds true to his word and doesn't set O'Dwyer up to fail or throw a tantrum when problems arise, she'll stick to Zemo's side. On the other hand, if Zemo defaults to classic, over-the-top melodramatic villainy, O'Dwyer's main interest is defending her people. This might be a wedge the heroes can use.

Use the Cole North profile from Chapter 8: Characters for Commander O'Dwyer's stats.

What F.E.A.R. Does

Within an hour or so after the Wrecking Crew is dealt with, the F.E.A.R. convoy descends upon Hell's Kitchen. They roll in from where they were stationed, hidden in Riverside Park South among the old rail yard, waiting for the call.

The convoy travels down Riverside Boulevard before one division splits off, driving down 59th Street, setting up blockades at 11th, 10th, 9th and 8th Avenues.

The second division heads southwest on Riverside Boulevard toward West 66th, then continues down Empire State Trail until it becomes 12th Avenue and merges with the Hudson River Greenway. They take it all the way until West 30th, where they exit and set up checkpoints at 11th, 10th, 9th and 8th Avenues, effectively blocking access from the southern part of Manhattan.

Meanwhile, the third division separates from the second up at West 42nd Street and then turns south on to 11th Avenue, bringing it right to the Convention Center on the corner of 11th Avenue and West 34th Street. The trucks disgorge a number of soldiers who secure the street and move into the Convention Center, assuming control and kicking out any

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security staff who are there overnight (though they claim to be "evacuating them for their own safety").

As this is happening, a number of large trucks carrying portable power generators pull up and park. Engineering units immediately get to work setting up the generators and running thick power cables into the Convention Center.

Closing the Kitchen

The first two divisions essentially close off Hell's Kitchen from the rest of New York.

- Checkpoints are set up at all major roads leading into (or out of) Hell's Kitchen.
- Guards at these checkpoints ask for "papers, please," but there's nothing nice or friendly in their demeanor. They are checking I.D.'s and denying most people passage into or out of the "security zone."
- Once checkpoints are set up, the F.EA.R. force declares a 24-hour-a-day curfew, restricting citizens to their homes.
- Local businesses are ordered to close—in particular, those closest to the Convention Center.
- With curfew imposed and most businesses closed, traffic is nonexistent on the streets. Any non-F.E.A.R. vehicles immediately draw attention and are stopped, with the driver and all passengers questioned and possibly detained.
- Public transit is halted, and any traffic coming to the 42nd Street Port Authority Bus Terminal is turned away.
- They ban journalists and students from entering Hell's Kitchen.
- If journalists or students are encountered within Hell's Kitchen, they are either detained (in the case of the former) or escorted out of the zone, and told they will be allowed to return once safety and order have been restored.
- Any legitimate law-enforcement agents (police) or emergency services (firefighters, EMTs, etc.) are told to stand down and that they do not have jurisdiction in the "security zone." If they have any issues with that, they should take it up with the chain of command.
- F.E.A.R. soldiers questioned about their jurisdiction essentially won't answer, only saying that they are following orders and to take it up with their commanding officer. See Chain of Command, below.
- If any of the heroes directly confront a F.E.A.R. officer, they'll be told their kind ("vigilantes") aren't wanted or welcome here and they should make themselves scarce before they are locked up.

Chain of Command

If someone asks a soldier to speak to their commanding officer, F.E.A.R. soldiers will challenge that person and order them into their homes or detain them, whichever appears easier.

If someone manages to talk to a commanding officer, said officer will indicate that orders originally came from the Office of Emergency Management, which sounds like something the Mayor of New York City or the Governor of New York State would know about. However, if anyone can actually reach either the mayor or the governor, they don't know what in the world is going on. ("Who did what now?" is not something you want to hear a chief executive ever say.) And in the chaos and confusion, F.E.A.R. is allowed to get away with running the 'hood for at least 24–48 hours, assuming the heroes don't put a wrench in their plans.

The Convention Center

The Convention Center in Hell's Kitchen is a massive structure that spans several blocks in Manhattan. It was built in the 1980s and has since become a hub for conferences, conventions and other large-scale events. The building's exterior is composed of glass and steel, and its architecture is modern and sleek. The main entrance leads into a vast lobby with high ceilings and a glass facade that lets in natural light.

The bottom floor of the Convention Center is where attendees first arrive, passing through security checkpoints and ticketing stations before entering the main exhibit hall. The exhibit hall is a vast, open space, and when a convention is happening, it is filled with booths, displays and other exhibits, with a large stage set up at the front of the exhibit hall for keynote speakers, panels and presentations.

F.E.A.R.'s presence around the Convention Center is even more defensive and hostile than in the rest of the neighborhood. The security corridor is tighter, and the soldiers are more alert.

- The streets adjacent to the Convention Center building are lined with portable power-generating trucks. Thick cables run into the building, and the trucks are patrolled regularly. There are also technicians on standby if anything happens to the generators.
- Blockades have been set up all around the Convention Center. No one who is not authorized is allowed into the area.
- There are guard posts at every entrance and exit. No one is allowed in or out.
- Hardened checkpoints are located on each corner of the building at street level, with concrete barriers set up to control ingress/egress. These guard stations are built with sandbags surrounding a machine gun nest and have communications equipment installed in order to stay in touch and call in reinforcements.
- Snipers are stationed along the rooftop of the Convention Center.
- A control tower, which deploys armed air drones for security monitoring and possible engagement, has also been set up on the roof. These drones are armed with Adhesive X guns.

Rolling in Heavy

The heroes watch as the F.E.A.R. units roll in, at first assuming this is standard operating procedure for when things go pear-shaped in the city.

However, Daredevil (or Nick Fury Jr.) should comment that this level of response is unusual. Sadly, the city has had many super-villain attacks in its history, and the government doesn't normally roll out the National Guard and declare martial law. At a minimum, their contact should tell them, *"Better keep an eye on how things progress. It could get ugly out there."*

Over the next several hours (in the storyline), the heroes should get a clearer picture that things are far from okay.

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Art by Marcelo Ferreira, Roberto Poggi & Rachelle Rosenberg

Heavy-Handed Policing

Here is a list of possible encounters—things for the heroes to witness and, if necessary, intervene in. Individual F.E.A.R. soldiers aren't tougher than an average Hydra agent (profiles can be found in the *Core Rulebook*), and one-on-one, shouldn't be much of a match for a Rank 2 hero. However, there are many F.E.A.R. agents operating in Hell's Kitchen tonight, and if the heroes aren't careful, an agent can call in reinforcements to mob the heroes.

- They overhear a group of F.E.A.R. soldiers on a break making disparaging remarks about the area's inhabitants. Perceptive heroes might pick up on comments like:
  - *"This place is trash. I can't believe they waste prime real estate this way."* [remark made about a public school or library]
  - *"Back home, this area is all tech centers and data hubs."*
- They may observe a group of F.E.A.R. soldiers patrolling the streets and barking orders at store owners or residents. Owners are told to close up their shops and restaurants immediately, and residents are told to return home at once or risk being found in violation of curfew.
- An armored jeep full of F.E.A.R. soldiers stops teenagers breaking curfew. It's tense, and it won't take much to spark violence.
- A man is arrested for loitering—when he claims he's just waiting to pick up his daughter from a night class, soldiers handcuff him and put him in the back of a van.
- F.E.A.R. soldiers beat up a homeless man in an alley. If questioned, they say he was a security risk (too close to an important location, such as a checkpoint or, worse, the Convention Center).
- At a checkpoint, soldiers are conducting warrantless searches of citizens and detaining anyone who can't provide proof of residence within Hell's Kitchen. They grab a young woman who was visiting with her boyfriend and was trying to get back to her dorm at Empire State University. However, because she's a journalism student, they detain her.
- F.E.A.R. soldiers are harassing a family-run bodega, demanding free food and drinks. When the owner refuses, the soldiers destroy the store's merchandise and threaten the family.
- A group of freaked-out citizens are shopping at a late-night grocery store. They are paying for everything, and the owner is helping them buy emergency supplies, but the F.E.A.R. soldiers don't like that people aren't respecting curfew. Harsh words spark a riot, and people start looting and trying to take off with grocery carts packed with water, toilet paper and other essentials.
- Petty criminals attempt to take advantage of the lack of regular police and curfew and break into a number of electronics or jewelry stores to try to make a quick haul.

Pushed to Act

Presumably, the heroes will take the initiative to intervene in some of F.E.A.R.'s brutish actions, or at least scout around for more information (See Character Action Options by Occupation, page 52), but if they are paralyzed by choice or indecision, Daredevil or Nick Fury Jr. should push them into action.

- They need to be careful moving around while the neighborhood is under curfew, or else risk confrontations with F.E.A.R. soldiers.
- Their contact acknowledges that this level of military law is unprecedented and a grave injustice—raising the questions who is behind it and for what purpose?
- They should try to find where F.E.A.R.'s forces are most heavily concentrated, and to learn what they can of their command structure and any orders that are being disseminated.
- They might talk about contacting proper authorities, but most civilian power structures are awash in confusion and disinformation, with lots of finger-pointing and scapegoating, and most other heroes are temporarily busy with other equally urgent difficulties.

Detention

F.E.A.R. sets up a detention center at PS 111, a public elementary school located on West 53rd Street. Although not the most secure building, they can easily lock in thirty to forty people per classroom.

Any troublemakers, criminals or citizens they don't like are brought here and roughly processed before being locked in a classroom.

F.E.A.R. may set up other similar detention centers in the area. These centers would be ad hoc; thus, the facilities would be improvised and neither high-tech nor particularly secure. They are intended to hold civilians, not super heroes, so obstacles to break out should be Challenging difficulty.

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Blood Spills

At an appropriate time (likely once the heroes start to get a clear picture that something is wrong with F.E.A.R.), a crowd begins to gather at DeWitt Clinton Park—a large public park on the west side of the neighborhood between West 54th and West 52nd Streets. The group is made up of people from the surrounding streets who are shocked and appalled by the iron-fisted authoritarianism that has descended upon their homes and businesses.

The crowd is multigenerational, multiethnic and from a range of social classes, all unhappily protesting what they believe is an overreach from the local, state and federal governments. They are primarily congregating around the football field, under the bright floodlights. At the center of the protest are a number of eloquent speakers—men and women—who talk about how unfair and unjust the situation is.

Meanwhile, along the three streets that border the park, F.E.A.R. soldiers appear. At first, in pairs and trios, and then more and more, until it looks like a wall of uniforms containing the angry and agitated gathering within the park.

Shouts escalate into threats, and then rocks and bottles are thrown at F.E.A.R. jeeps and soldiers. The soldiers retaliate and shots are fired! The crowd panics and rushes toward the soldiers, and in some places, the F.E.A.R. wall breaks.

One young man, Charlie, is struck and injured. His friends drag him out of the confrontation, desperate for help. Charlie needs medical help very soon or he will bleed out. Can the heroes help?

Beyond Charlie's immediate need, there are lots of things the heroes can do to help in the swirling chaos. However, any time they spend in the spotlight (especially helping against F.E.A.R.) is going to fuel the task force's desire to capture the heroes, drive them out of the neighborhood or eliminate them.

Charlie

Charlie is a young man from a multigenerational family that has always called Hell's Kitchen home. Although something of a self-described hustler who has occasionally been in trouble with the cops, Charlie's heart is in the right place, and he's quick to protest the martial law imposed by the authorities.

If the heroes manage to save Charlie, the other citizens of Hell's Kitchen will hear about it and become more likely to support or aid the heroes in big or small ways.

If Charlie should die, however, his death becomes a rallying cry for the neighborhood, who will not forget the tragic loss of one of their own.

What if the Heroes Get Captured by F.E.A.R.?

While the heroes should be able to handle any small groups of F.E.A.R. soldiers, if they are careless, reckless or unlucky, they could easily find themselves overwhelmed due to the sheer numbers of opponents patrolling the streets.

In a situation where some or all of the heroes are defeated and captured, they are taken to a detention center, such as the one in PS 111 (see Detention, page 49).

Incident Commander Siobhan O'Dwyer wants to interrogate them, so if they are not able to break out before then, O'Dwyer interviews them one-on-one.

O'Dwyer wants to know:

- What have they discovered about what's happening in Hell's Kitchen? (Remember, she doesn't want to give away her secrets.)
- How many more heroes are out there?
- Have they had any contact with allies outside of Hell's Kitchen?
- Do they know anything about a resistance movement among the people of Hell's Kitchen?
- And O'Dwyer might ask, *"What do you think I should do with you now?"* (She's trying to figure out if they might prove useful to her, or if they would make good candidates for the Supremacy's reeducation program.)

O'Dwyer is a polished officer and a trained commander and tries not to give away any clues as to F.E.A.R.'s (Hydra's) plan or their origins, but astute heroes might pick up hints based on the questions. Further, if the heroes catch on to the notion that F.E.A.R. is from a parallel Earth, they may be able to confirm their suspicions in talking with O'Dwyer, or even get O'Dwyer to give up more info than she intended.

O'Dwyer has many other tasks to see to, however, so her time with the heroes is short. After the commander leaves, the soldiers might relax a bit (letting their guard down), and/or it would be a good time for a friendly face like Daredevil to help them out. Ideally, an ally would get them a weapon or tool they need to help free themselves, rather than doing all the work for them.

To the Convention Center

Ultimately the heroes need to be drawn to the Convention Center. While they can fight against F.E.A.R. patrols in the neighborhood indefinitely, Zemo's plan culminates here. There are several ways to push them in that direction, starting with more subtle clues and eventually using a giant spotlight.

- The security cordon gets tighter with more frequent patrols, and more alert guards, the closer one gets to the Convention Center.
- The majority of people forced out of their homes and businesses are those in proximity to the Convention Center.
- Heroes might overhear a comment like, *"Why does my store have to close when the stores on 10th Avenue are still open?!"*
- The truck convoy parks around the Convention Center, and portable generators are hooked up.
- There are aerial drones that constantly sweep the airspace above the Convention Center.
- There is a lot of activity happening around there, despite the late hour, with officers and technicians constantly going in and out. These people do not seem to be doing anything to directly help the citizens of Hell's Kitchen.
- Finally, if many hours pass and the heroes still haven't investigated the Convention Center, the rest of the neighborhood experiences a major blackout—the whole of Hell's Kitchen goes dark except for the Convention Center, which is bright as day.

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Days Go By

The events of this chapter are described as happening over one intense day—almost as if it's a series of crises unspooling over a 24-hour period. It's supposed to be go, go, go! And to give the players a sense that bad things are happening *now*. However, one could easily draw out the occupation of Hell's Kitchen by F.E.A.R., and have many more small and intimate encounters where the heroes see firsthand how Zemo's forces are upending the lives of the inhabitants, and how the citizens are trying to push back. Regardless, you'll still want to keep things focused on the neighborhood and have explanations for why other heroes aren't showing up and how F.E.A.R. is keeping the real police (and possibly the National Guard) chasing their own tails trying to figure out who is in charge.

Character Action Options by Occupation

During Act II, the heroes have a lot of freedom to investigate and respond and act as they see fit. But some groups may need a bit more direction, so use Daredevil (or Nick Fury Jr.) to guide them. Use the following list as a guideline to actions that their contacts might suggest for them, based loosely on their characters' background occupations. Of course, these are just suggestions, and some ideas might work better for certain characters, regardless of their noted occupation. And feel free to add any of your own ideas to the mix. The point is to give players a few concrete goals they can work toward. This way, they will feel like they are learning things and responding to the threat, and won't be paralyzed by having too much freedom of choice.

By the end of Act II, the heroes should realize that F.E.A.R.'s forces are converging around and focusing on the Convention Center. It is the location in Hell's Kitchen that is the most heavily fortified, and the trucks with portable generators should be a big clue that something bad is going down there.

Assassin: Using stealth, the character can take out various checkpoint guards with either a silenced range weapon or a sneaky melee strike. There are several critical sites that can be neutralized with an Agility vs. TN 16 action check for ranged or Melee vs. TN 16 action check for close combat. Three successes clears the way for the heroes to the Convention Center.

The Narrator should discuss with the player if their hero uses lethal strikes (such as bullets or arrows) or nonlethal attacks (tranquilizer rounds or, well, blunt arrows), and discuss the ramifications of such actions.

Failing on any one of the action checks to neutralize the checkpoint guards will result in placing the remaining forces on high alert. Alarms will sound, and reinforcements will respond to the site under attack.

Criminal: While an Assassin might directly neutralize a guard, a character with a Criminal background could steal identity credentials from a F.E.A.R. officer or an electronic security badge or even an electronic tablet outlining some of their instructions and orders.

Alternatively, a person who knows how to break in/out of places could help get prisoners out of the detention cells or try to determine the best way into the Convention Center.

Educator: A character with an Educator background might help organize community efforts in protesting the draconian martial law imposed on the area. Or, if they aren't a key organizer, they could tap into the network of invested citizens who are on the front lines. An Educator might be able to pick up on many of the injustices perpetuated on the neighborhood residents. Additionally, an Educator might directly or indirectly learn how at least one school is being turned into a detention center.

Engineer: A character with an engineering background would be perfect for noticing the excessive number of portable power stations rolling into Hell's Kitchen. A successful Logic vs. TN 12 action check will allow the character to determine that this amount of power generation is way overkill for portable-relief centers. All this power must be intended for something else.

Entertainer: A person with a background as an Entertainer could be plugged into the community and, like an Educator, might be asked to lend their voice to community support. Anyone who knows how to speak or rally a crowd is a valuable asset. Further, an Entertainer might recognize that the Convention Center is a really big space, and it's odd that F.E.A.R. seems to be based around it, yet also forcing residents away from the area (as opposed to, say, turning it into a large relief center).

Health Care Worker: During a protest that evening at DeWitt Clinton Park, one of the residents of Hell's Kitchen, Charlie, is shot (see Blood Spills, page 50). Charlie bleeds from a chest wound and needs critical assistance. The hero needs to perform makeshift surgery to stanch the injury. A Vigilance vs. TN 18 success will allow Charlie to be saved from immediate death. Transport to a hospital out of Hell's Kitchen (due to the damage the Wrecking Crew did) is necessary to eventually stabilize him.

Investigator: There are two tracks that the hero can follow. One, look into F.E.A.R.—the military forces occupying Hell's Kitchen. A successful Vigilance vs. TN 14 action check will reveal that none of the forces are registered with the state or local precincts. The second track is to follow up on the Wrecking Crew and figure out their motives. A successful Logic vs. TN 14 action check will reveal that the wanton damage caused by the Wrecking Crew was a catalyst to trigger the imposition of martial law in the area.

In the case of the Wrecking Crew, if they escaped from the heroes earlier, another avenue to potentially pursue is: Where are they now? Any of the Crew who remain free are under instructions to lie low until they receive further instructions from Zemo. They change out of their costumes and into civilian clothes and find a bar to hunker down, grab some grub and watch the chaos unspool around them. A good location would be a nondescript bar like Eddie's. Tucked into the basement of an unassuming brownstone, it feels like you are walking into a basement apartment until you smell the beer and hear the heavy metal.

Journalist: Much like an Investigator, a hero with a background in journalism may want to follow up on the essential question of *why* these things are happening in Hell's Kitchen, starting with figuring out the goal of the Wrecking Crew, and now who or what is behind F.E.A.R. and what its purpose is. Additionally, a character with journalism contacts may hear stories of reporters or journalism students being hassled, kept out of the neighborhood or detained without cause.

Law Enforcer: A character with a background in law enforcement (or friends or family from that world) would be well suited to suspect something is amiss. Using contacts in the police forces, the hero can determine on a successful Ego vs. TN 13 action check that the occupying forces are not

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Art by Javier Saltares & Jamal Campbell

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in the command structure of the local or state authorities. What's more, it should be readily apparent that the F.E.A.R. forces are corrupt—from interfering with local authorities (and threatening to suspend or detain them, if they get in the way) to harassing residents and so forth.

If a character with connections to law enforcement wants to try to connect to the mayor's office or governor's, it would be an Ego vs. TN 16 action check, but even if they manage to speak to someone in authority and explain what's going on, it takes many hours for proper authorities to mount a response, hours the heroes don't have.

Lawyer: A character with a background in law (such as Daredevil) would be able to investigate the chain of command in a similar fashion to a Law Enforcer, although they might have an easier time understanding the proper role of authority (TN 14). Additionally, people with a law background have an ear to the ground hearing citizens' complaints, similar to a Journalist or Educator.

Leader: A Leader may have resources that can be called upon for some geopolitical advantage. On a successful Ego vs. TN 15 action check, the hero could rally local police to help combat the occupying forces. A Leader might also be able to sort out some of the bureaucratic mess that F.E.A.R. has taken advantage of, at least as far as reaching the governor's office and informing them of what is unfolding around them.

Military: A successful Logic vs. TN 14 action check will allow the hero to learn that the presence of the occupying force is abnormal and not a proper deployment for such an operation. Further, studying the placement of F.E.A.R.'s forces, and a Logic vs. TN 16 action check, will reveal that F.E.A.R. has stationed their strongest security and defensive measures around the Convention Center.

Scientist: A character with a Scientist background will take point on understanding the portal technology once they are able to get inside the Convention Center (or have some other way to scan the building for electromagnetic readings). With enough time to study the portal machinery, a Scientist could determine the gateway leads to another dimension, as well as understand that they are preparing to "punch" a permanent hole between the worlds.

Spy: A Spy character might use drones, remote surveillance, hacking of the enemy's communication network or covert action to gather intel. A successful Vigilance vs. TN 18 action check will allow the hero to learn that the deployment of the occupying F.E.A.R. forces is unprecedented. In fact, while Commander O'Dwyer has orders, as such, they do not come from anyone in the proper chain of command (such as the governor of New York). A Spy would also notice that their equipment and technology is more advanced than what is available to the police or National Guard.

Character Roles

If your players are using the profiles for this chapter (see The Heroes, page 36) or from the previous chapter, you can use these guidelines to give them further hooks into this sequence of the adventure.

Hawkeye (Kate Bishop): Kate has connections to the privileged elite, due to her family background, and also has many friends and contacts among the working-class everyday folks because of the time she's put in as a working hero and private eye. She could use her acrobatics to stealthily avoid patrols and her keen sight to spot clues and ferret out information.

Colleen Wing: As a private eye and former bail bondsman, Colleen has a lot of connections in NYC, including through her regular partner, Misty Knight (a former police officer). As a highly skilled martial artist, Colleen might take a proactive approach in confronting patrols, especially when citizens are being harassed.

Patriot (Rayshaun Lucas): As a skilled detective and strategist, Patriot would gather information about F.E.A.R.'s activities in Hell's Kitchen, trying to discover who is giving the orders. He could also rally law-enforcement agents to join the heroes in assisting the citizens or coordinate rescue missions.

Mockingbird (Bobbi Morse): A veteran espionage agent, Mockingbird might be drawn to sneaking into command centers to learn as much as she can about F.E.A.R.'s plans so the heroes can get to the source of the problem. She likely has contacts in law enforcement and government, but would be quick to realize they are cut off from the outside world and have to solve the problems on their own.

Prowler (Hobie Brown): With a past as a criminal and the brilliant mind of an electronics expert, Prowler likely has contacts among the city's downtrodden and the passion and smarts to fight injustice. Prowler might be inclined to try to hack into the F.E.A.R. information network to gather intel and disrupt their operations.

White Tiger (Ava Ayala): A skilled martial artist infused with the power of the White Tiger, she would likely use her abilities to navigate the occupied city, staying out of sight where possible and confronting the opposition forces when necessary. With strong ties to the local Hispanic community, Ayala could lean on her connections for information and lend them her strength in resisting. She might even be able to tap into the mystical White Tiger spirit to gain insights or access hidden information about Zemo's plans.

And if your players used the set characters for Chapter 2: Origin Story, here are a few ways they might hook into this part of the adventure.

Agent Sum: Due to his incredible wisdom and life experience, Agent Sum could zero in on more minute clues than most, and might be more perceptive to the dimensional differences of those from a parallel Earth. In addition, Agent Sum would be able to talk to local disempowered law-enforcement agents and possibly reach out to people in power outside of the neighborhood.

Claire Dixon: With a history of law enforcement, Claire could use her skills to talk to other law-enforcement personnel or civil servants in the area, as well as recognize that F.E.A.R.'s soldiers are acting in an unlawful manner.

Dakota North: As a globe-trotting freelance private eye, North has an experienced nose for rooting out lies, and it would be clear to her that F.E.A.R. does not pass the smell test. She has contacts around the world, and while they might not be able to help directly, they could answer specific questions to help her put together this puzzle. Additionally, she has worked with Foggy Nelson and Matt Murdock, and the reporter Ben Urich, any of whom could be allies.

Frog-Man: Frog-Man's blend of fortune, flukiness and serendipity often proves the adage that it's better to be lucky than good. A wild card in his actions and results, Frog-Man's suit and earnest desire to do the right thing could have him stumble into all sorts of opportunities to learn about Zemo's plan.

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Maddy Cho: A brilliant student, Maddy could hear about students being harassed and detained, or be connected to those calling for resistance to F.E.A.R.'s control. Maddy is also bright enough to be able to start analyzing what's going on at the Convention Center if she can get close enough to study it.

ACT III: PEELING THE ONION

Zemo's plans focus on securing and holding the Convention Center long enough for his technicians to set up and stabilize an interdimensional portal back to Earth-56438. Everything else is secondary to him at this stage.

Zemo knows that the F.E.A.R. task force is not enough to withstand a prolonged assault by this world's heroes or military forces, so he has a fully armed battalion on standby to come through as soon as feasible. This combined-arms assault force has orders to invade New York City and establish it as a fortified beachhead for their future plans (see Chapter 4: New York State of Mind).

The final act of this adventure takes place at the Convention Center. The multiple layers of security will be challenging and require detailed planning for the heroes to overcome.

Success vs. Failure

The finale for Chapter 3 is stacked heavily against the heroes—despite their bravest attempts, there is a good chance Rank 2 heroes will fail against Zemo's forces. And that's as designed. If you are running this as a full *Cataclysm of Kang* campaign, the story moves more smoothly from Chapter 3 to Chapter 4 if the heroes suffer a defeat at this stage.

On the other hand, if you are playing this scenario as a stand-alone adventure, then it can play out however the dice roll. If you are worried the opposition forces are too strong, however, see Evening the Odds on page 59.

The First Layer

By now, the heroes should realize that Zemo's forces are most highly concentrated around, and invested in, the Convention Center. They may or may not have clued into the fact that Zemo's forces are from another world, and/or that Zemo is trying to open a portal to his home for no good purpose.

As mentioned under The Convention Center (page 48), the approach to the building is protected by hardened checkpoints at each of the four crossroads leading to the area. Each of these checkpoints is composed of a squad of soldiers entrenched behind concrete barriers and a machine gun nest ringed by sandbags. Parked adjacent to the checkpoint is a light armored vehicle with a machine gun turret. The guards have communication equipment and will not hesitate to call in reinforcements if attacked or put other squads on alert if they see something fishy.

A normal roster includes two soldiers manning the machine gun nest, two stationed in the vehicle and another four guards controlling the checkpoint (verifying I.D.s, patting people down, investigating any vehicles, etc.), so one can assume 8–10 soldiers at each hardened checkpoint.

The Second Layer

Beyond the immediate soldiers at street level, there are spotters stationed on the four corners of the roof of the Convention Center. Each station has a pair of veteran Hydra soldiers: one spotter and one sniper. Each pair has a "zone of control" that they are responsible for, watching both the streets and the skies for possible opposition.

Their primary function is to call in information to the forces on the ground, helping direct them to deal with any issues. In many ways, information is their primary weapon; on the other hand, it doesn't hurt that one of each pair is armed with a high-powered sniper rifle for fire support. Or maybe it does hurt, if they line up a hero in their crosshairs.

The Third Layer

Located in the middle of the Convention Center roof is a mobile drone hangar and control tower, manned by four agents. They pilot surveillance drones armed with Adhesive X sprayers that can be maneuvered to provide aerial support to any zones that come under attack.

The mobile hangar has supplies to rearm the drones and repair any minor damage. There is also a supply of Solvent X, in case of any accidents that occur with Adhesive X.

Adhesive X Air Drones

The drones are piloted by agents of Hydra and, as such, attack with their Agility score (1 for a typical agent) and can use their Ranged Weapons powers for attacks as well. The flying drones also use the agents' defense scores to avoid attacks and have a Health of 40 each. The Adhesive X weapons work exactly the same as the Webcasting power. On a successful ranged attack, the adhesive pins down the enemy and a Melee vs. TN 20 action check is needed to break free. Adhesive X is impossible to break; instead, it's whatever its adhered to that crumbles and allows freedom. Only Solvent X can remove Adhesive X once it's on something.

The Fourth Layer

Inside the Convention Center, there are twice the number of forces as stationed outside. These troops are housed in makeshift barracks and rotate with the on-duty soldiers every eight hours.

If an exterior position calls in for assistance, a number of soldiers can be mustered quickly and sent out to reinforce that zone. On the other hand, if a general alarm is raised, many of the soldiers inside will go on alert, and they will perform sweeping patrols of the Convention Center.

The Grand Portal

The large open space of the main floor of the Convention Center houses the portal equipment. There is additional equipment and supplies stacked up on pallets or in crates—often in the way—with massive electrical cables snaking in from the power generators outside the building.

There are approximately 100 technicians and engineers setting up the portal machinery, checking the power levels and ensuring the overall stability of the device. The techs are largely noncombatants, though most have standard-issue pistols for defense. However, they will surrender or flee if the fight is brought into the Convention Center.

Command Structure

Baron Zemo is on site here to direct the portal operation. He wants to ensure there is no chance of things going sideways. He doesn't have a specific command center, but rather floats around as needed, looking in on various officers and

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TICKING CLOCK: OPTIONAL MECHANIC

Players like to discuss their plans for as long as possible. Sometimes this is a fantastic role-playing opportunity, and sometimes it threatens to bog down the kinetic energy big scenes require to keep things moving.

As an optional game mechanic, the Narrator can track how much time is ticking away starting from when the portal goes online. From that point, for each minute of real-world time that passes, another Hydra unit comes through the gate. Thus, it is imperative for the heroes to make their plans quickly and act to shut down the portal.

Each time a unit passes through the portal, the heroes might notice a flicker of the energy field or feel another bass note vibrating through the area.

- **Minutes 1–5:** Hydra soldiers come through in groups of 2–4.
- **Minutes 6–10:** Light armored vehicles roll through.
- **Minutes 11–14:** Tanks cross over.
- **Minute 15:** An assault helicopter passes through.

Troops are mustered in one of the large staging areas of the Convention Center, while vehicles are marshaled through the giant bay doors.

While it's certainly not safe for tanks—let alone attack choppers!—to transit through a building, Hydra's not overly concerned about safety protocols. They want to get their forces across as rapidly as possible to reinforce their position until the next phase of their plan (which will be revealed in Chapter 4).

technicians to inspire them through a mixture of respect and fear—mostly fear—to keep on task. If alarms are raised, Zemo heads outside to lead his troops in fighting the heroes.

While Zemo directs things at the Convention Center, he trusts his right hand, Commander O'Dwyer, to handle any situations that arise across the neighborhood. She knows that anything that disrupts Zemo's plan will jeopardize her life and her career, roughly in that order.

Crew on the Loose

If any members of the Wrecking Crew are still on the loose, Zemo will instruct them to report to Commander O'Dwyer. Zemo doesn't want a group of muscle-bound lunkheads too close to the delicate machinery that operates the portal. On the other hand, if O'Dwyer is taken out of play, or if the heroes mount an unexpectedly strong offense against the Convention Center, Zemo can call upon the Wrecking Crew to back him up as a last resort. Anytime the Crew does not have specific instructions, they are more likely to find a bar to chill out in or set up deck chairs on a rooftop with a cooler full of beers, and watch the havoc unfold. On the other hand, if any of their members are captured, they might scheme to break them out. Whether or not that's something to concern the heroes will depend on their interests and how everything else is playing out.

Blackout

At an appropriate point, assuming the heroes have not managed to throw an unexpected monkey wrench into Zemo's plans, the portal will come online.

When is an appropriate time? If the heroes have come to the realization that the Convention Center is the heart of Zemo's operation, then right after or right before they penetrate into the inner core of the building would make for a riveting scene. Alternatively, if the heroes are struggling to find purpose and direction, and/or are distracted by the smaller crises throughout the neighborhood, that might also be a good time to step things up.

When this moment occurs, if the heroes are anywhere within sight of the Convention Center, they will see the whole complex crackle with an electrical charge and the structure of the building will begin to reverberate with incredible energies, almost as if one is looking at it through a heat haze. A sharp smell of ozone will permeate the surrounding area.

If the heroes are somewhere else in the neighborhood when this occurs, then they may hear the powerful bass rumbling throughout the whole region that signals the portal machinery coming online. What they can't miss, however, is that even with the portable power generators, the Convention Center needs to supplement its energy needs from the surrounding area, and the whole neighborhood of Hell's Kitchen will be blacked out.

Ticking Clock

As a way to put pressure on the heroes (and to increase Zemo's odds of winning a strategic victory in this encounter), once the portal is up and running, Zemo will begin redeploying troops from Earth-56438 to Earth-616.

What Do the Heroes Need to Do?

In brief, to stop Zemo's plan, the heroes need to do the following things in roughly this order:

- Discover the operation is centered around the Convention Center.
- Realize there are high-energy devices that Hydra is powering up that will certainly lead to bad things happening to the heroes or New York or likely both.
- Determine the best way to shut down the machinery. (See Damaging Equipment, page 59.)
  - Cutting power to the generators will buy them time, but generators are easily repaired.
  - The generators need to be permanently put out of commission to depower the portal.
  - Each generator that is taken offline will delay troops coming through the portal by a few minutes.
- If the heroes manage to infiltrate the Convention Center, they may try to smash the control modules or even to take possession of the portal. The Hydra forces inside the building are formidable and will likely overrun the heroes.
- Zemo needs to be defeated and captured. Once the head is cut off this particular Hydra, it will not grow back twofold, but instead the body will wither away.
- The Hydra forces that have made it across the portal must be defeated, disarmed and rounded up.

Closing the Portal

Ideally, if you are intending to continue the campaign into Chapter 4, even if the heroes are incredibly lucky or tactically

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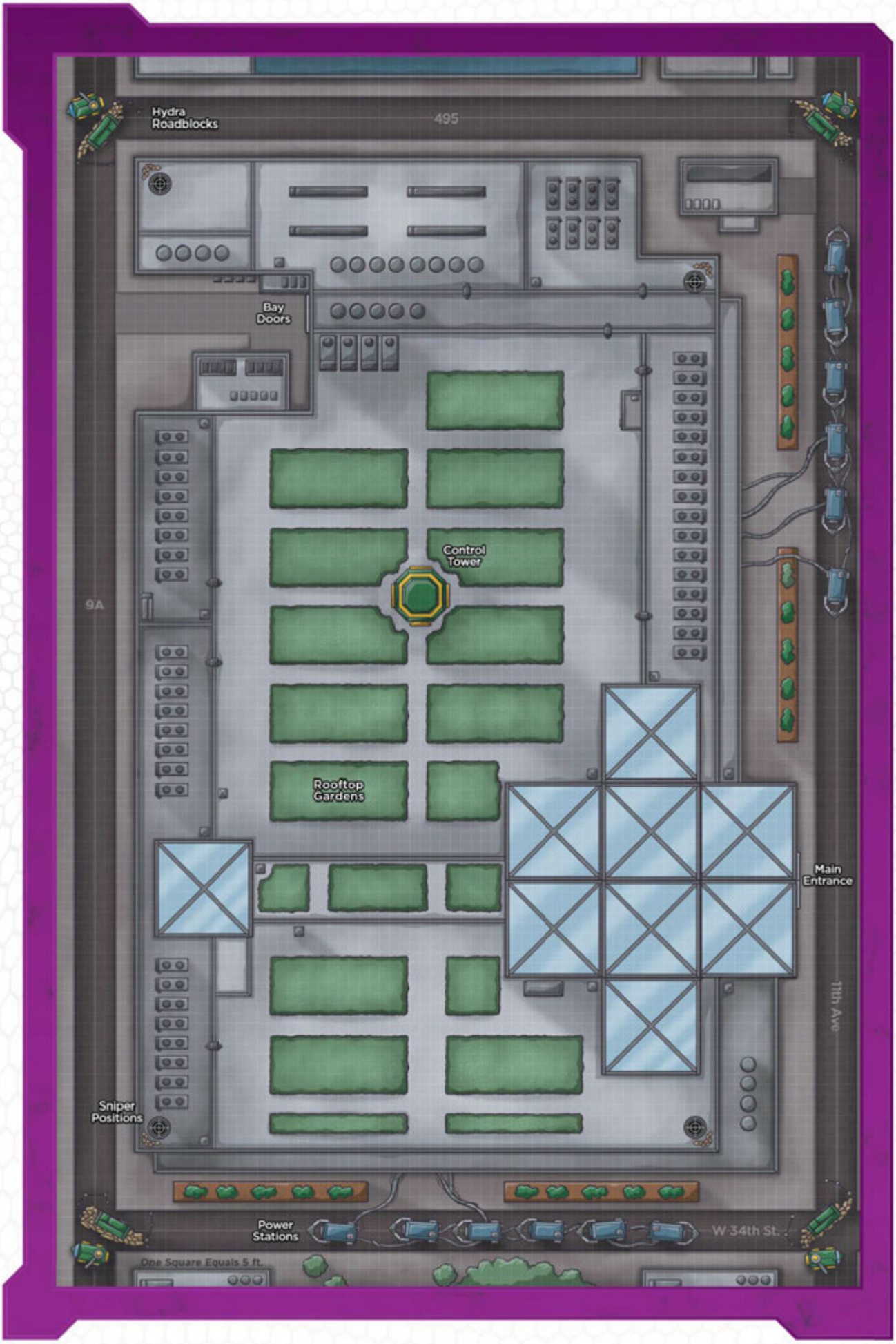

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brilliant and manage to defeat Zemo, the portal will not be destroyed at the end of this adventure.

If the heroes simply deactivate or power down the portal, it would still exist but simply be offline (closed) for now. It could thus be restarted and reopened.

Alternatively, if the heroes have destroyed the control modules and seemingly shut down the portal permanently, one could say that the multiversal veil has now been thinned here, and a strong-enough force from the other side might be able to punch through.

Another way to reopen the portal is to chalk it up to government incompetence or malfeasance. Assuming a proper government agency takes over the cleanup of the area, it's not out of character for a bumbling or corrupt official to reactivate the portal in a twist of fate.

Damaging Equipment

Power generator (located outside the building)—12 in total

- 100 Health total to destroy one.
- 50 Health to knock offline, but easily repairable.
- If half the generators are offline or destroyed, it will double the transit time through the portal.

Control modules—4 in total

- 25 Health each.
- As long as one control module is functional, the portal can be kept operational.

The control modules are located within the Convention Center, and thus, protected by the full force of Zemo's garrison.

Evening the Odds

Facing such insurmountable foes at the Convention Center, the heroes may come up with ideas for how to even out their chances.

- If the heroes began the campaign in Chapter 2, Nanni could show up with some friendly tough guys from around his neighborhood to lend a baseball bat or two.
- If any leadership skills are used to organize the neighborhood into a mass protest (likely at DeWitt Clinton Park), this civil disobedience draws one-third of the Hydra forces away from the Convention Center.
- Again, using leadership, the remaining police/fire forces can be mustered into a task force to assist the heroes in the assault on the Convention Center. These forces are no real match for Hydra, but another third of the Hydra forces will be distracted by this task force.
- Daredevil can similarly be used to help target one aspect of Zemo's forces, or can help guide the heroes with a few words of wisdom if they are overwhelmed by too many choices.
- Nick Fury Jr.—if he is the primary contact—can also give the heroes some tactical advice. Additionally, if the heroes are in danger of being overwhelmed, Fury could be a good voice in their ear to tell them to withdraw and regroup.

We Learn From Failure—What Happens Next?

If the heroes are defeated, here are some possible outcomes:

- **Imprisoned:** The most likely outcome is the defeated heroes will be captured. There are then two obvious paths:
  - If you want your players to continue using these same heroes into Chapter 4: New York State of Mind, they should be imprisoned somewhere local and have a chance to break out. For example, you could use a makeshift holding area, such as PS 111 (see Detention on page 49) or the like.
  - Alternatively, if you want to give the players a chance to use new, higher-ranking characters for Chapter 4 (or even spin the adventure in a totally different direction, exploring Earth-56438 from a prisoner's point of view), Hydra can ship the captured heroes over to Earth-56438 for "reeducation" or, failing that, forced-labor camps. Why waste a perfectly capable superhuman when, with the right incentives, you can get so much more out of them?
- **Killed:** Highly unlikely, as Hydra is not incentivized to kill the heroes, but they won't shed a tear if some die in the battle. If this is a grittier, darker campaign, casualties might fit the tone. The players will have to take on another role to continue the fight. For a lighter tone, you can have the heroes burn Karma and by some contrived miracle, they survive or are rescued.
- **Tactical Retreat:** The Narrator should impress upon the heroes at some point that too many Hydra forces have gated in, and they will not be able to defeat them. There is no shame in a tactical withdrawal to live to fight another day. The heroes will have to withdraw beyond the borders of Hell's Kitchen (possibly a small challenge in itself) and begin contacting whatever resources they have to plan another attack on the Convention Center (see also Chapter 4).

Succeed Against the Odds

If you're running this adventure as a single issue, the heroes should have a fair chance of winning. They need to shut down the portal and capture Zemo. Following that, all the Hydra forces running around Hell's Kitchen will need to be mopped up. Even then, weeks of investigations will be needed to ferret all the sleeper agents out of the system. And of course, various government agencies want to weigh in on what to do with these extradimensional prisoners of war. These can be sidetracks the Narrator can run as a follow-up to using this adventure as a one-shot, depending on the players' interests.

Next, dealing with Zemo…

Zemo Defeated

If defeated, Zemo appeals to the heroes' sense of mercy. He tells them that he was just trying to save his world and that they would do the same in his place. In fact, why don't they help him save the other Earth? Zemo may even invite the

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heroes to Earth-56438 to try to solve the crisis from that end. (That path is not covered directly in the further adventures of this campaign, so the Narrator will have to come up with their own story, but see Chapter 5: National Emergency for some ideas to get you going.)

Zemo's secondary motive for conquering New York was to have an escape plan for select folks from his doomed world. He hoped that if they failed to save their world, they could carve out a new empire on this one. Remember, even if Zemo seems to ask the heroes for aid, he's still a snake and will try to come out ahead one way or another.

Low Point

For playing this adventure as part of the full campaign, it is highly recommended that the heroes fail to prevent the operation of the portal. In terms of narrative, this is the dark before the dawn. A low point is needed in the story for there to be a triumph in the climax.

The best outcome is for the heroes to simply retreat in the face of overwhelming Hydra forces. Of course, some players never consider they might lose and would rather break themselves on the weapons of their foes before considering retreat. One tactic is to use the heroes' allied character to suggest a tactical withdrawal if the players don't consider the idea themselves. Daredevil (or Nick Fury Jr.) can prompt them by saying things like:

"As much as I hate to leave the fight, we need to regroup and find more muscle to deal with this situation."

Small Wins

Another way to push the heroes toward making a strategic exit is to give them one or more small wins or to reflect on the good they've done so far.

- If the heroes have learned about the interdimensional portal and now know some of what Zemo's up to, their ally might consider that a win. (*"Now we know what we're up against. Let's pull back and figure out how we need to deal with it."*)
- If the heroes manage to capture a high-ranking enemy, such as Commander O'Dwyer, or a key technician, they can pull back in order to interrogate them and glean more information.
- Saving Charlie (page 50) and evacuating him to proper medical services may not seem like a big endeavor, but their ally should remind them that it's a good win and the type of thing that does make a difference.
- If the heroes made sure services were operational at Metro-General Hospital or the fire and police stations, they can be reminded that's another type of life-changing impact in service of the residents of Hell's Kitchen.

Tenacious to the End

If the heroes ignore all advice and want to continue, they probably end up captured or killed. Daredevil (or Nick Fury Jr.) will retreat, however, and look to regroup with more heroes powerful enough to deal with this threat level.

Either way, this low-point ending will be a great segue to Chapter 4.

Shadows in the Portal

If some of the heroes are in a position to see the portal, after a number of armored units and attack helicopters come through, there is another discharge of electricity and several ominous shadows are seen forming in the portal.

These are the vanguard of the Supremacy and will lead the charge into the future (and into the next chapter).

DAMAGE CONTROL

Hopefully even with the odds stacked against them, the heroes manage to learn what Hydra is doing and then get out, even if they fail to defeat Baron Zemo and his invasion force. Things can always go sideways, and players are a creative bunch when it comes to finding trouble. Here are a few final notes on dealing with situations where things have gone wrong.

Dead Heroes

As suggested, in a campaign with a lighter tone, there are ways to allow the heroes to avoid this fate. For a darker note, let a character die. This can make for a poignant, emotional scene and give the other heroes something to rally around. The player can rejoin with a new character or even pick a profile from Chapter 8: Characters that shows up to help (when dramatically appropriate). While a character's death is regrettable, there is still plenty of story in the campaign to build a rapport with a new character for a satisfying conclusion.

Captured Heroes

If the heroes are captured, you have a few options.

1. Conclude the adventure with a recap of Hydra's triumph and summation of the invading forces pouring in from Earth-56438 for a full-on invasion of New York. The captured heroes are detained in a local facility (which they have to break out of), or you can let the players take up new characters (see Chapter 4 for ideas) who will break their old characters out as one of their missions.
2. For a totally different direction, the captured heroes could be shipped to a prison camp on Earth-56438 and have to deal with the ramifications. At this point, they can be rescued by the resistance forces on that world, and that story can be run as a side adventure where the heroes eventually return to Earth-616 and continue the campaign. See Chapters 4 and 5 for some ideas on that thread.
3. The captured heroes are processed and fed into the Hydra machine and never heard from again. This ends their story, and it's time to begin anew with different characters.

Tactical Retreat

This is the ideal ending to this adventure. The heroes will regroup and can continue the fight in Chapter 4: New York State of Mind.

The Villains Win

The villains have won this battle, with the portal up and running, but the war is just beginning. Squads of Hydra regulars equipped with full Hydra uniforms and high-tech

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gear march through the portal. Hydra tanks are taking control of more territory. Attack helicopters and air drones are patrolling the sky. Finally, some heavy hitters of the Supremacy are coming through to step up the invasion…

THE EPILOGUE

Assuming the ending is the "darkest before the dawn" option for this chapter, here are some details on where things stand at the end of this adventure.

Local Heroes: Daredevil

Clearly Baron Zemo taking over Hell's Kitchen does not sit well with Daredevil. But he is smart enough to know that more help is needed to deal with this level of threat. Daredevil will attempt to use his connections to get more heroes to rally to his cause. Use Daredevil as a lead into Chapter 4.

Ranking Up

Depending on the direction you want to take this campaign, it might be time to rank up these heroes—even if they lost, there is much experience gained in failure. If you plan on continuing to Chapter 4 with these characters, raise them up to Rank 3, as they will need to be more powerful to deal with the threats in the next part.

If you plan on running side stories first, you can leave them at the lower rank to complete those missions. Once you are ready for Chapter 4, rank up the heroes.

The Next Adventure

The next adventure in *The Cataclysm of Kang* takes the heroes from Hell's Kitchen to the full-on invasion of New York!

SIDETRACKS

While this adventure is complete, you and your players might not be ready to plunge straight into the next chapter. Here are some suggestions for other things that your group can explore and have fun with in the meantime.

Earth-56438

If the heroes have been captured and transported to Earth-56438, there is an opportunity to run an adventure in that setting. The basic plotline will be that they are freed by the resistance heroes of that world and can take the fight to Hydra on their home front.

Mopping up Hydra Forces

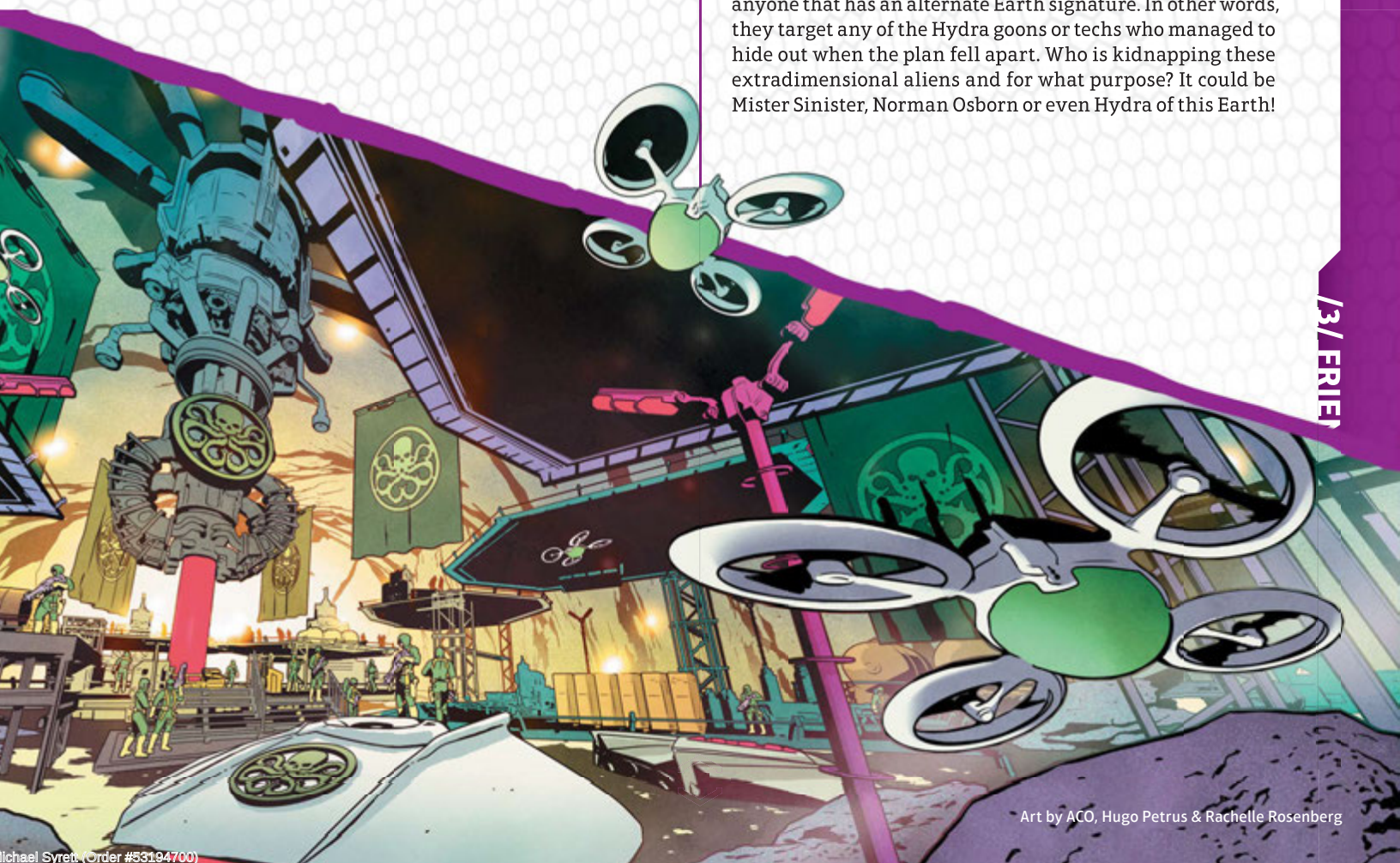
If Zemo is defeated, the heroes must clean up the remaining Hydra forces scattered to the winds. The invaders will quickly try to conceal themselves in law enforcement, emergency services or organized crime (especially as they are something of blank slates on this world).

Crew vs. Crew

If the Wrecking Crew is still out and about, they try to make some easy cash and find a nice pad to hole up in. However, the real Wrecking Crew is still around and can call in some markers to try to wipe out these punks who are ruining their good name, or even better, they'll find a way to bust out of the Raft, and all hell breaks loose. The heroes have to get in the middle of a Crew war and try not to get flattened.

Alien Abduction

Someone who is highly interested in the cross-dimensional portal energies is drawn to the area and begins kidnapping anyone that has an alternate Earth signature. In other words, they target any of the Hydra goons or techs who managed to hide out when the plan fell apart. Who is kidnapping these extradimensional aliens and for what purpose? It could be Mister Sinister, Norman Osborn or even Hydra of this Earth!



Art by ACO, Hugo Petrus & Rachelle Rosenberg

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NEW YORK STATE OF MIND

With Hell's Kitchen established as a foothold into Earth-616, the Hydra forces of Earth-56438 have launched a full-scale invasion. The immediate goal is to secure more beachheads into New York to take control of this important city as a prelude to wide-scale conquest.

The portal has been in constant operation, gating in equipment, squads, vehicles and superhumans to flood the streets with their presence.

All of New York City is a battleground, with clashes happening at a number of important landmarks: the Baxter Building, Stark Research Center, the Convention Center, Prince's Bay Lighthouse, LaGuardia Airport and so on. To put a stop to this, the heroes must defeat the Supremacy and force them to retreat to Earth-56438.

THE BRIEFING

This is a full-length adventure for four or five Rank 3 characters. It should take approximately two or three sessions to complete. Optional objectives and mission shortcuts allow you to tailor it to the needs of your group. Additionally, there is a random-encounter system that can greatly increase the number of battles the heroes get involved in, should you favor that style of adventuring.

The Villains

The adventure continues from where it left off in Chapter 3. The heroes have lost the battle for Hell's Kitchen, and likely retreated to regroup and strategize how to deal with the recent developments. The villains, however, are not resting on their laurels and are following the next stages of their invasion plan. Coming through the portal are the vanguard of the Hydra Supremacy to lead special missions. Joining Baron Zemo are Arnim Zola, the Taskmaster, M.O.D.O.K. and the Fenris Twins (Andrea and Andreas von Strucker). Additionally, platoons of Hydra soldiers, armored vehicles, air drones, attack helicopters and other assorted military equipment bolster the Hydra forces.

The Locations

The adventure takes place in New York City. While the invasion is felt across all of New York, only the key locations are described herein. The Narrator should remind the players that battles with Hydra forces are happening all around them. Most of the heroes and police forces of New York are engaged in combat and cannot aid the heroes directly in their missions.

The primary action occurs at these locations:

- The Baxter Building (42nd Street and Madison Avenue)
  - Hydra target for intel.
- The Howard & Maria Stark Center for Galactic Research at Empire State University (Stark Research Center for short)
  - Hydra target for intel.
- The Convention Center in Hell's Kitchen
  - Portal location.
  - **Propaganda Monument:** Obey and Prosper.
- Prince's Bay Lighthouse (Staten Island)
  - **Propaganda Monument:** Individualism Is Chaos.
- LaGuardia Airport (Queens)
  - **Propaganda Monument:** Sacrifice to Thrive.

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- Wall of Remembrance (Coney Island)
  - **Propaganda Monument:** Freedom Is Hydra.
- Untermyer Gardens Conservancy (945 N Broadway, Yonkers)
  - **Propaganda Monument:** Cut Off One Limb, and Two More Shall Take Its Place!
- Long Beach Boardwalk
  - **Propaganda Monument:** Strength Is Hydra.
- Nick Fury Jr.'s makeshift command center, a public library (108-19 71st Avenue, Queens)

Other iconic New York locations such as the Brooklyn Bridge, Central Park, the Empire State Building, the Statue of Liberty, Times Square, One World Trade Center, the Rockefeller Center, the Flatiron Building, St. Patrick's Cathedral or any other iconic place can be swapped in for the locations above if that better suits your game. The locations were chosen for balance and strategic importance for Hydra.

All of these key locations are noted on the New York area map on page 65.

The Story So Far

After their first incursion under the direction of Madame Masque failed (in Chapter 2: Origin Story), Baron Zemo led the next mission into the field. In Chapter 3: Friendly Neighborhood, Zemo and his forces took Hell's Kitchen and used the Convention Center to open and stabilize a portal between Earth-616 and Earth-56438. With fresh forces pouring in, the assault on New York continues. Members of the Supremacy are on the loose, executing the next stage of Hydra's plan. A monument has been erected in front of the Convention Center to the glory of Hydra. It crackles with sinister energy, implying a deeper sense of purpose than just propaganda.

The heroes have fallen back (or been captured or worse), and the good guys are flat-footed and on defense. It's time for them to pick themselves up and stop this madness!

Ranking Hierarchy

Baron Zemo may be seen as analogous to Captain America (Steve Rogers) of Earth-616, a living embodiment of Hydra's ideals as much as Cap is the embodiment of freedom and liberty. While Zemo is regarded as the field general of the operations on Earth-616, the members of Hydra and the Supremacy are following the commands of their leaders back on Earth-56438. That said, the members of the Supremacy tend to act on their own initiative and work hard to outmaneuver their compatriots for individual gain and prestige. They will not directly sabotage the mission objective but are not above skullduggery to improve their rank in the pecking order.

Depending on the nature of your group—and whether the players prefer intrigue to direct action—they might be able to exploit the weaknesses in Hydra's organization. For example, the heroes can offer one of the villains clemency and refuge on Earth-616 for betraying the others with a key piece of information, perhaps.

The Supremacy

Much like their Earth-616 counterparts, the Avengers, the Supremacy are Earth-56438's "Mightiest Heroes." The roster of members is huge and ever evolving. The Narrator should feel free to add whomever they wish to the team that makes narrative and thematic sense. For this adventure, however, we only deal with a select few characters and their mission on Earth-616.

The Supremacy has two major goals at present:

1. To install the Hydra monuments in key locations that give them control of the area. Once they are all operational, the entire region of New York can be contained in a force-field and thus controlled. This also secures the portal and allows the Supremacy to gate in even more sinister threats. The ultimate goal, of course, is to conquer Earth-616.
2. The Supremacy is also on the hunt for any data on cosmic entities or objects of power that may help them with their crisis back home. In particular, they are pursuing information on the Silver Surfer. To that end, Hydra has hacked many information systems and established key targets such as the Baxter Building and the Stark Research Center for deeper dives into this area.

THE HEROES

Chapter 4: New York State of Mind is designed for four or five heroes of Rank 3. The Narrator should feel free to tailor it to fit the needs of the group, which can have a mix of heroes of Rank 3 or Rank 4 for this adventure. The difficulty can be adjusted by changing how much resistance the heroes encounter fighting the Supremacy. Likewise, the number of troops and military equipment can also be adjusted to even up the odds in whichever direction is needed.

Marvel Heroes

The suggested characters for this adventure are Cloak, Dagger, Tigra, Iron Fist (Lin Lie) and Luke Cage. All the heroes' profiles are in Chapter 8, with the exception of Luke Cage, whose profile is in the *Core Rulebook*.

Alternatively, the characters from either Chapter 2 or Chapter 3 can be upgraded to Rank 3 and used.

Original Heroes

If the players have created original characters for the campaign and have reached Rank 3, they can be used with this adventure. If you want the players to create new, original characters, we suggest starting them at Rank 3.

Adjusting the Difficulty

With the Narrator's permission, the players can use other Marvel heroes for this adventure. A mix of Rank 3 and Rank 4 characters should manage well. If they are of a higher or lower rank, combat may feel too easy or far too difficult.

Chapter 4 takes the experience the players had in Chapter 3 and ramps it up to the next level for a citywide, large-scale heroic experience.

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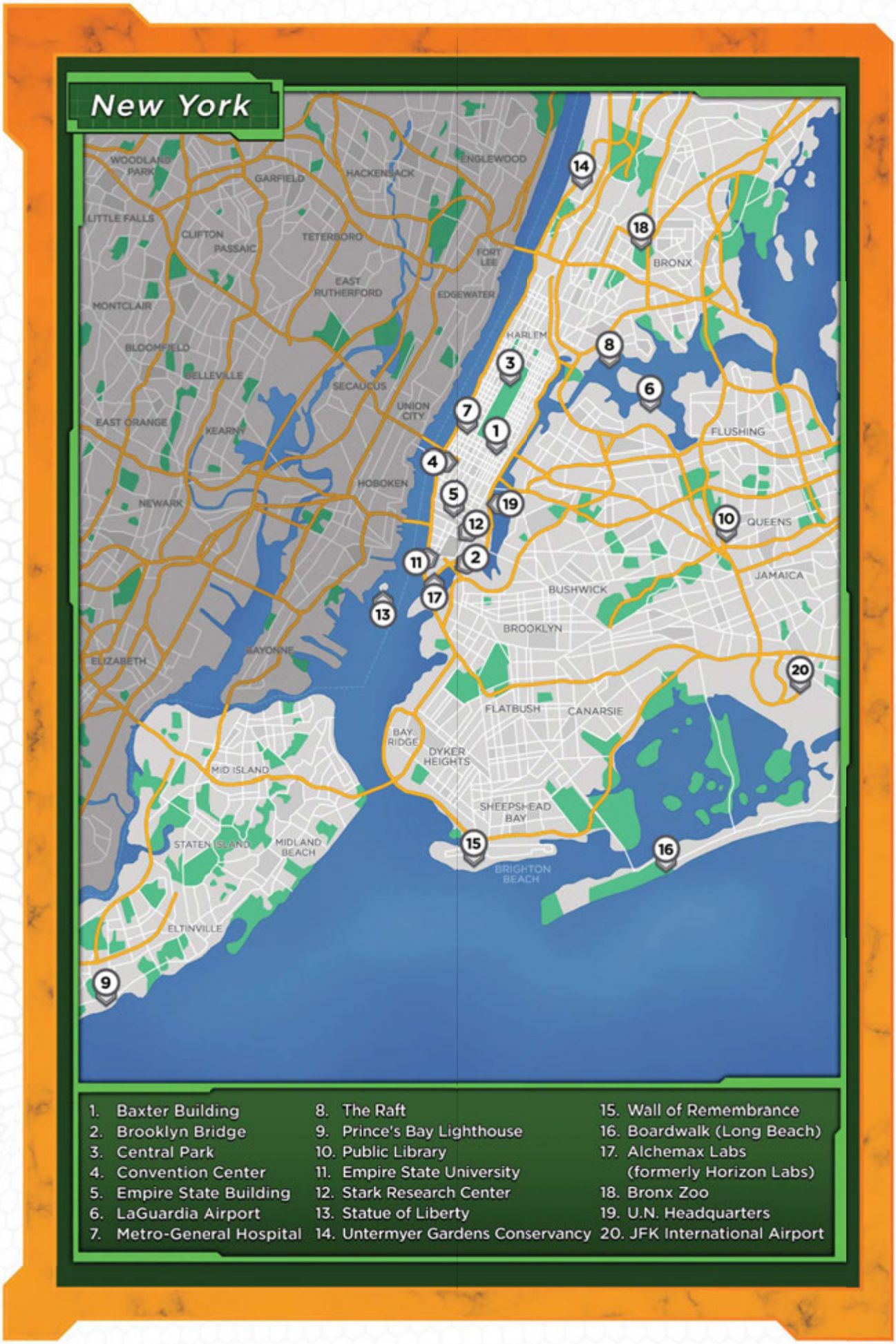

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Art by John Cassaday & Laura Martin

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THE HOOK

There are several ways to start this adventure depending on whether you are continuing it as a graphic novel from Chapter 3: Friendly Neighborhood or running it as a single-issue adventure.

Graphic Novel

If you continue this adventure from Chapter 3: Friendly Neighborhood:

The heroes have retreated to a safe distance and are regrouping to assess what steps to take next. Hydra is in control of Hell's Kitchen and forces are pouring out to spread across greater New York.

- The heroes need a safe house to regroup in. This could be something one of the players suggests, or it could be a callback to Chapter 2, using the former Prano's restaurant as a safe house or even having the heroes be taken in by Nanni to his own home.
- Daredevil meets with the heroes to take stock and discuss their options. Narrator/Players decide if they want to continue with their same characters (and rank them up), or use new Rank 3 characters (either selecting from the profiles or using new characters). Alternatively, some groups might want a mix of choices.
- An easy explanation for new characters to the story at this point is that Daredevil called in some markers, and these heroes were previously tied up with something else. But now is the time for them to focus on today's threat.

If the heroes were captured in the last chapter, there are several possible ways to begin.

- **New Faces:** One option is that Daredevil has called in his markers and the players are all taking on the role of new characters (either from the profiles or original), and one of the missions includes trying to save the old heroes. See Freeing Prisoners on page 76.
- **Breakout:** Another option is to begin with the heroes in prison, and they need to break themselves out, likely with help from Daredevil or other prisoners. See Detention in the previous chapter on page 49 for some ideas. It would be logical that Hydra would establish more secure facilities than their previous classroom lockups, but during the first hours where they take control, there is a great deal of confusion and several opportunities to escape. This should feel like a high-tension scene, but the events should play out quickly. You don't want to spend too much time in the prologue.
- **Break In:** A variant is if some of the players take on the role of the backup Daredevil has called in, and their first mission is to break out the captured heroes. This works well if the group wants to play a mix of old and new characters. As above, a few obstacles (a couple of Hydra guards, a spotlight to sneak by, a few locked doors) should be enough to set the tone.

If the heroes were killed last chapter, this one should begin with an even more somber tone. Daredevil calls the new heroes together and gives them a quick summary of what happened before Nick Fury Jr. arrives on the scene. This is similar to the single-issue start, with the exception that the players may have knowledge of what came before, and the Narrator may plan to continue into the next chapter of the campaign.

In this case, the players should use profiles or make new characters.

Single Issue

If you are running Chapter 4: New York State of Mind as a single-issue adventure, players can either use the suggested profiles from the back of this book or create their own original Rank 3 characters. In either case, jump right into Daredevil's Recap.

Daredevil's Recap

In short, Daredevil tells the heroes the following:

- It started with Madame Masque's Maggia enforcers trying to muscle out the locals in Little Italy, in order to buy space and privacy for some sinister friends of theirs who turned out to be from a parallel dimension.
- When that scheme was shut down, we here on this Earth hoped that was the end of it, but it was only the beginning. The second sortie kicked off when the Wrecking Crew—a version of them, at least—turned Hell's Kitchen into an emergency zone. Their destruction appeared wanton but was a ruse to justify an emergency-task-force lockdown of the neighborhood.
- The task force consisted of Hydra agents in disguise, who occupied the Convention Center to rebuild their portal on a massive scale, allowing heavily armed Hydra squads to storm through.
- Hydra hit hard and hit fast, and the heroes were unprepared for it. It's time to pick ourselves up, regroup and strike back.
- Daredevil can remind the group of any other information that the Narrator thinks pertinent.

Wherever they are during this moment with Daredevil—on a rooftop, in the back room of a restaurant, in a garage—there's a rumble of bass and a slight vibration of the windows. Daredevil goes on high alert for a moment before visibly relaxing. It appears there's another guest for this little party.

Right outside the building or on the rooftop or however appropriate, a small, sleek, surprisingly quiet VTOL jet has touched down. (If the characters are outside and astute, they'll likely see the jet coming out of stealth mode right before landing.) Out steps Nick Fury Jr.

Holding the Line

Nick Fury Jr. isn't alone—he's accompanied by a handful of strategic communications specialists (who operate communication and information technology) and signal intelligence specialists (who analyze intercepted enemy communications).

Fury thanks Daredevil for pulling the heroes together, and tells them they can't work as independent operators anymore. The threat from Zemo and Hydra is too great. He's going to

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take them under his wing and direct them to the most critical tasks. That's the only chance they have to hold the line.

Fury tells them his team is receiving continuous intel from eye-in-the-sky drones and various "spylink" satellites and that they've discovered the following:

- Hydra forces continue to pour out from the Convention Center in Hell's Kitchen.
- Hydra's tech specialists are attempting to hack into local, national and international databases. They appear to be targeting:
  - Strategic and tactical info on the U.S. armed forces and reserves.
  - Intel on local heroes who might interfere with their plans.
  - Data on cosmic beings and energies.

All of those topics are concerning, with the first two giving them the information superiority that allows them to continue their schemes unmolested. And the third is worrying for all sorts of reasons.

Fury's briefing is short and snappy. He tells them:

- Hydra forces include armored vehicles and attack aircraft.
- In addition to Hydra's military forces, a few super-powered individuals wearing Hydra's colors have been spotted, so beware.
- Hydra has set up a massive monument outside the Convention Center as a marker to their victory. It's up to the heroes to show them that was premature.
- A small vanguard force tried to hit the Baxter Building, but its automated defenses drove them off. That's good, because the Fantastic Four have not been seen in weeks. But Fury's spies indicate a much stronger force is en route to the building—it will be devastating if they are able to get their hands on any of Reed Richards' technology.

Fury offers the heroes his VTOL jet as transport, but whether they take it or make their own way, there's no time to lose!

- The jet has stealth capabilities, helping them avoid most Hydra patrols.
- If the heroes have no one skilled in piloting, Fury sends a pilot with them. (Use the S.H.I.E.L.D. agent profile from the *Core Rulebook* for the pilot.)

But What If...the Heroes Won?

Chapter 3 is set up to be very difficult for the heroes to win and shut down the portal—but due to luck, brilliance or sheer grit, some groups might be able to defeat Zemo in Chapter 3. In that case, here are a few suggestions for how to bridge that ending with this adventure.

- One option is that the government agents that "take control" of the machinery at the end of Chapter 3 are Zemo's deep cover agents. They move the machinery to a remote section of Brooklyn, the innocuous NYC Department of Transportation Streetlight Warehouse, and create a new portal that leads to the Hydra invasion.
- Another option is that even if the heroes win in Chapter 3, the machinery is damaged in such a way that the portal remains permanently open. Any attempts to close it threaten to turn it into the equivalent of a black hole. While the heroes try to figure out how to contain it, Hydra rushes through the gap.
- A last Hail Mary for Hydra could involve people on Earth-56438 abandoning the portal machinery—because it's too hard to maintain—and instead creating a gateway harnessing the powers of one America Chavez. On Earth-56438 she is a captive of Hydra and forced to open and maintain one of her star-shaped portals, even though the strain could eventually disable or kill her.

For the first two ideas, the Narrator might want to build a little bit of time in with various sidetracks in order to keep the mystery alive and inject variety across the missions.

THE PLOT

The adventure takes place in roughly three acts.

Act I

The story begins from where it left off in Chapter 3. Hydra's armed forces are running rampant across the city, and the heroes regroup and figure out how to respond. Nick Fury Jr. sends them to intercept a Hydra attack force trying to breach the Baxter Building for reasons unknown—but with the Fantastic Four away, someone has to keep Hydra from getting their hands on whatever Richards has locked up. The heroes arrive to see Arnim Zola and his agents landing on the roof, and it's up to them to confront him. Meanwhile, a secondary force led by Taskmaster waits on the street to breach the building once the automated defense systems are put out of commission. The heroes have a lot on their hands, keeping Hydra from accessing the sublevel vaults and the Fantastic Four's information systems.

Act II

The heroes fight members of Hydra's Supremacy at the five locations where Hydra is attempting to install the new monuments. As soon as the Baxter Building is secure, Nick Fury Jr. radios the heroes and orders them to get over to the nearest monument and take it down. The heroes' secondary goal is to learn exactly why Hydra is so hell-bent on erecting these pieces. Likely the first location features the Fenris Twins leading a mix of A.I.M. techs, mech-suits, Hydra units and transport vehicles. The main arc of this act is not only to push back against Hydra's incursions but to solve the mystery of the monuments. This is crucial to defeating Hydra and the Supremacy in the following scenes.

Act III

This is a full-on counterattack by Earth-616 to defeat Hydra and take back the city. The final objective is to take control of the portal and take the fight to Earth-56438. This is an epic battle involving many heroes across New York City. The players' heroes have a critical mission to deactivate the force-field around the Convention Center to open the floodgates, allowing Earth-616's forces to strike back against the Supremacy in full. Nick Fury Jr.'s tech-specialist operatives provide the heroes with special equipment to achieve this important mission.

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Table I: Random Encounters

d616	Encounter	Notes
4–6	Hydra tank and squad of power-armored Hydra soldiers	See ***Hydra Tank Squad***
7–8	Attack helicopter, air drones and jetpack Hydra soldiers	See ***Attack Helicopter Group***
9–10	Small squad of Hydra agents on foot patrol	See ***Hydra Squad***
11–12	Armored vehicle and Hydra foot soldiers	See ***Hydra Squad With Armored Vehicle***
13–14	A.I.M. elite troops in mech-suits	See ***A.I.M. Elite Squad***
15–16	Minor villain of the Supremacy	Roll 1d6 on Table II.
17–18	Major villain of the Supremacy	Roll 1d6 on Table III.
6M6	Friendly ally that helps the heroes with the current mission	Roll 1d6 on Table IV.

Monuments to Hydra

The monument erected in front of the Convention Center is more than just a brutalist art piece. It's a device that projects a force-field that allows Hydra to control the local grounds, keeping out unwanted visitors. At the same time, Hydra units and personnel seem to be able to pass through without difficulty.

The monuments might seem like garish oddities as they depict Hydra leaders and soldiers working hand in hand with civilians on civil projects. They also have placards with slogans like "Obey and Prosper" and "Individualism Is Chaos" and other propaganda. Additionally, they have a sound system that plays the Hydra national anthem, political messages and other propaganda on a loop.

These art pieces are reminiscent of Soviet-era monuments built to inspire the population in the ideology of the state. These will seem anachronistic and alienating by current sensibilities, but back on Earth-56438, they invoke fear in the populace and remind them constantly of who is in control. They are omnipresent and represent the boot that is on the neck of the people.

More practically, the devices can generate variable-size force-fields (up to a mile radius) that control who can enter or leave an area. Multiple fields can join together to create an even larger bubble that can blanket an entire city.

These devices have self-contained quantum power supplies that let them operate 24/7 without interruption. The force-fields can be overloaded by massive damage (1 million damage!), which results in the device exploding like a low-yield nuke, taking out everything in a mile radius and causing devastation for several more miles. Or the quantum battery can be drained, causing it to shut down safely.

Hydra personnel are not hindered by the force-fields at all. They wear transponders that double as Hydra insignia that allow the wearer to harmonize with the frequency of the force-field and transit it without hindrance.

Random Encounters

There are many other things happening in New York while the adventure is taking place. As such, the heroes can encounter myriad things to deal with en route to their missions. Table I: Random Encounters represents random encounters that can be sprinkled into the various acts to add as much chaos as the Narrator desires.

You can run these together as quickly as you like or space them out and toss in other scenes to balance things out a bit. It's entirely up to you and the pace at which your players want to keep things moving.

Roll d616 on the Random Encounters table to determine what the heroes encounter.

Hydra Squad

A small squad of 2–5 Hydra agents is on foot patrol. They are likely heading from point A to point B and thus can be avoided or engaged with as the heroes see fit.

But for more specific encounters, choose from the following scenarios or invent your own:

- Setting up a checkpoint at a strategic location (such as a bridge, tunnel or major intersection) to control the movement of civilians.
- Conducting door-to-door searches looking for any outspoken civilians who have been rallying people against the invaders.
- Engaging in acts of vandalism, looting or theft to terrorize the populace.
- Indulging in a classic slice of New York pizza from one of the city's many pizzerias.

Hydra Squad With Armored Vehicle

Like the Hydra squad previously, these troops might be executing a minor objective or broadly moving to support one of their positions. The inclusion of an armored vehicle (for example, a self-propelled artillery piece, a self-propelled antiaircraft gun or an armored personnel carrier fitted with loudspeakers) makes it more likely that the squad has a specific mission, rather than just cruising through the city.

- Reinforcing a checkpoint, using the armored vehicle to control the location.
- Engaging in combat with local law enforcement.
- Carrying out a targeted attack on a government building.
- Spreading propaganda by cruising through a trendy neighborhood in Brooklyn, like Williamsburg, Dumbo or Brooklyn Heights, and broadcasting Hydra's messages of fear and obedience.
- Taking a smoke break and grabbing some New York bagels with lox and cream cheese. Hydra's gotta eat, right?

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Hydra Tank Squad

This is a more specialized and higher-powered combined arms force consisting of a main battle tank and support squad in powered armor. The squad may be in transit, but they definitely have something bad on the agenda. Their mission orders might be:

- **Attack the *Daily Bugle*:** To disrupt media coverage, control information or try to control and intimidate key personnel.
- **Target the power grid:** This squad's mission is to disrupt city life, furthering chaos and terror.
- **Hit financial institutions:** Targeting banks or Wall Street would cause severe economic disruption and panic.
- **Strike landmarks:** Iconic landmarks such as Times Square, Central Park or the Statue of Liberty might be targeted to try to break the will of the people.

Attack Helicopter Group

A formidable force, this unit is composed of advanced attack helicopters, ranging from sleek and agile gunships to larger, heavily armed platforms for air-to-air and air-to-ground combat. Their advanced weaponry would include guided missiles, rockets, heavy machine guns and even energy-based weapons and/or experimental technology.

The attack helicopter group normally works in coordination with ground forces, providing air support during ground operations or conducting independent air strikes against key targets.

The helicopters are also supported by a squad of Hydra airborne soldiers equipped with jetpacks (the Narrator should use the Hydra agent profile in the *Core Rulebook*).

The attack helicopter group's orders might be to:

- Target Grand Central Terminal to disrupt one of New York's main arteries, the nexus where the Metro-North Railroad and the 4, 5, 6, 7 and S subway lines converge. Any of the 750,000 daily visitors might be at risk in Hydra's attack.
- Strike Penn Station to assault the busiest transportation facility in the Western Hemisphere. This railroad station is located beneath Madison Square Garden, in Midtown, close to the Empire State Building and Koreatown. Twenty-one tracks pass through here, connecting to points in Boston, Philadelphia, Washington, DC, and locations in between.
- Attack JFK International Airport to damage planes parked there and destroy control towers and the runways so outside forces can't land there.

A.I.M. Elite Squad

On Earth-616, A.I.M. (Advanced Idea Mechanics) was originally conceived of as an experimental think tank to develop advanced technological weaponry. On Earth-56438, they were long ago openly incorporated into Hydra's military structure. This squad of futurist science-soldiers are equipped with heavy power armor that will give most heroes a run for their money. Their targets would be high value in nature, such as:

- Prominent research facilities, laboratories or scientific institutions where they can steal advanced technology, scientific data or experimental prototypes.
- Data centers, communications networks or power plants so they can steal or control information.
- VIPs, such as leading scientists, thinkers, politicians or entrepreneurs, all of whom hold a position of prestige or influence in the city.
- Oscorp, a prominent corporation with a dark history that still houses many secrets.

Minor Villain Encounters

There are several plot hooks provided for each of the antagonists on Table II: Minor Villain Encounters. Narrators should feel free to mix and match or to add the minor villain to one of the main story encounters if they want to increase the difficulty and keep the heroes on their toes.

Hawkeye

Hawkeye (Clint Barton) on Earth-56438, like on Earth-616, originally ran away to join a circus, where he was trained by the Swordsman and Trickshot. However, on that Earth, once he hooked up with Black Widow, the two never reformed or redeemed themselves. Rather, they fell in with Hydra's Supremacy as minor but important members.

- **Empire State Building:** Hawkeye attempts to sabotage the iconic landmark, causing widespread panic.
- **United Nations Headquarters:** An emergency meeting of the Security Council, or another high-profile emergency session, is targeted by Hawkeye trying to assassinate one or more leaders.
- **Hero assassination:** Hawkeye sets up an ambush (perhaps by sabotaging a public work or arranging for a terrorist attack to cause casualties) and then lies in wait for a do-gooder to arrive. The heroes could be the targets, or they could come across Hawkeye trying to kill another one of Nick Fury Jr.'s agents.

Titania

Titania on Earth-56438 is arrogant and full of herself, much as her counterpart on Earth-616, and similarly, despite her immense strength, is something of a coward. On her Earth, she rarely faces any real opposition except for people above her in the Supremacy, who scare her to death. Thus, if the heroes show a brave face against her, it might cause her to turn tail and run.

- **Metropolitan Museum of Art:** Titania attempts to steal priceless artifacts, either to bring back to her world or to set herself up in luxury here.
- **The New York Stock Exchange:** Titania runs rampant on Wall Street, in particular targeting the NYSE, to cause widespread economic chaos.
- **The Bronx Zoo:** Titania releases any number of animals for the fun of it.

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Table II: Minor Villain Encounters

d6	Encounter	Notes
1	Hawkeye (Clint Barton) (evil version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 179
2	Titania (version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 249
3	Echo (evil version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 166
4	Bullseye (version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 150
5	Elektra (evil version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 167
6	Winter Soldier (evil version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 258

Table III: Major Villain Encounters

d6	Encounter	Notes
1	Crossbones (version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 155
2	Black Widow (evil version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 146
3	Silk (evil version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 234
4	Green Goblin (version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 176
5	Doctor Octopus (Otto Octavius) (version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 161
6	Abomination (Emil Blonsky) (version from Earth-56438)	See *Core Rulebook* Page 134

Table IV: Friendly Ally Encounters

d6	Encounter	Notes
1	Ant-Man	See *Core Rulebook* Page 139
2	Captain America	See *Core Rulebook* Page 151
3	Iron Man	See *Core Rulebook* Page 189
4	Vision	See *Core Rulebook* Page 253
5	Wasp	See *Core Rulebook* Page 256
6	Moon Knight	See *Core Rulebook* Page 209

Echo

On Earth-56438, Maya Lopez was a loyal Hydra sergeant rather than an enforcer for the Kingpin. Her unique skills were spotted, and she was enlisted in an assassination squad under the leadership of Elektra.

- **The United Nations Headquarters:** Echo breaks into the UN to steal sensitive information on other countries' military capabilities and super-hero-response initiatives.
- **Local Maggia hangouts:** The local organized crime syndicates of Earth-616 don't take kindly to Hydra's invasion, which is a major threat to their lives and livelihood. A number of their leaders gather in a warehouse or restaurant or other clandestine location, such as a shipping container at the harbor. Unbeknownst to them, Echo has been sent to eliminate them as a threat.
- **The Raft:** If the Wrecking Crew were captured in the last adventure, Zemo sends Echo to break them out. She is skilled enough not to release any other prisoners held within that facility, unless she wants to. (This might be in opposition to Bullseye's mission, below.)

Bullseye

Unchecked by various heroes and authorities, Bullseye has risen to a place of prominence in the Supremacy of Earth-56438. He is one of Hydra's top killers and sees himself as a rival to Elektra (although he would be distressed to learn that she barely thinks of him at all). Bullseye sees the invasion as a chance to prove himself the superior assassin.

- **The Raft:** If the Wrecking Crew were captured in the last adventure, Bullseye is sent to eliminate them for their failure. He has no problem leaving a bloody trail or freeing other powerful prisoners if he thinks they add to the chaos. (This mission might be used instead of Echo's, or Bullseye might have been given conflicting orders by someone higher up.)
- **Bar With No Name:** Many of the super villains from Earth-616 won't take kindly to Hydra's invasion. A number of mid-to-high-level criminals gather in the Bar With No Name to discuss fighting back, and Bullseye is there to eliminate the ringleaders and force the others to join or scurry into the shadows.
- **Wet work:** Hydra knows that Nick Fury Jr. (or someone similar) will fight back against them, so Bullseye is sent to take out whoever he can find in the resistance and work his way up the ladder.

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Elektra

On Earth-56438, Elektra rose through the ranks of Hydra and is a commander of their assassination squad.

- **Chinatown:** Elektra targets the organized-crime syndicates that use Chinatown as their base of operations. She has sufficient backup in case her targets attempt to flee or fight back.
- **The New York Public Library:** Elektra seeks ancient manuscripts that detail cosmic events, treating them not as myths and legends, but as real as Fin Fang Foom or the Chupacabra.
- **The Waldorf Astoria Hotel:** A high-profile target is using the luxury hotel as a base of operations. It could be a politician, business magnate, celebrity or even an informant of Nick Fury Jr.'s, but whoever it is, Elektra means to end them.

Winter Soldier

Although Steve Rogers fought against Hydra and the Supremacy on Earth-56438 until he was killed (in Chapter 2: Origin Story), Bucky Barnes never freed himself of the warped conditioning that turned him into the Winter Soldier. As such, he's one of the most feared of the Supremacy's street-level enforcers.

- **The Federal Reserve Bank of New York:** Winter Soldier breaks in to steal gold reserves to disrupt the economic stability of the country.
- **The F.B.I. Building:** Winter Soldier infiltrates the F.B.I. to steal sensitive information about the superhumans who operate throughout the United States.
- **Ambush:** Winter Soldier is sent to directly target one of the heroes or an ally in the city. He may strike out of the blue while the heroes are in the middle of something else, or he might arrange a setup, such as striking at a hero's friend or loved one.

Major Villain Encounters

Here are several hooks for each of the antagonists on Table III: Major Villain Encounters. Narrators should feel free to mix and match or to pull ideas from the minor villain table as desired.

Crossbones

Crossbones is, through and through, a dedicated member of the Supremacy. He wants to make a name for himself to be recognized back home.

- **The New York City subway:** Crossbones sabotages the system by planting explosives and disrupting the train network, causing mass chaos and destruction.
- **Government targets:** Crossbones hits the mayor's office or City Hall and tries to capture a high-profile target. However, if the plan goes awry, he has no problem killing any hostages.

Art by Stuart Immonen, Wade von Grawbadger & Marte Gracia

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- **Police armories:** Crossbones leads a series of coordinated attacks on various police stations in and around the five boroughs to steal weapons and equipment and disrupt local law enforcement. He commands various Hydra armored units for this operation.
- Crossbones might enlist Titania to add some muscle to any of his operations.

Black Widow

On Earth-56438, Natasha Romanoff never had a crisis of conscience and never found her way to the side of the angels. Rather, she perfected the arts she learned in the Red Room and eventually joined Hydra as the dominant political and military superpower on that world. She's now their top spy.

- **Homeland Security:** Black Widow infiltrates any local offices of Homeland Security to gain a detailed understanding of the U.S.'s potential threat response to Hydra's invasion.
- **The Raft:** Black Widow breaks into the Raft either to secure important powerful villains to their cause or to eliminate future potential threats.
- **Eliminate rivals:** Black Widow knows there are local Hydra cells in and around New York, and it's up to her to root them out before they cause trouble.
- Black Widow might draft Hawkeye to help winnow out rivals, starting with the Maggia and working their way through all the crime families in New York.

Silk

On Earth-56438, Cindy Moon was the student bitten by a radioactive spider, and when she demonstrated her abilities, she was quickly drafted into the Supremacy. She worries that on Earth-616, she will be displaced by any of a number of Spider-people, and hopes to capture or kill them to try to steal their powers or reverse-engineer their technologies.

- **Spider-Man and friends:** Silk targets any of the obvious people around Spider-Man to try to lure him out and capture him. Spider-Man may or may not be in New York during the Hydra invasion, so the heroes might have to intervene if Silk kidnaps Mary Jane Watson, Flash Thompson or this world's version of her long-lost brother, Albert Moon.
- **Extra extra:** Silk infiltrates the *Daily Bugle* and other major news organizations to force them to broadcast Hydra propaganda and suppress news of any resistance to the invasion.
- **Medical strike:** Silk coordinates an attack on several hospitals across the city, stealing medical equipment and supplies.
- **Stark Enterprises:** Silk and Echo team up to assassinate one or more leading figures at Stark Enterprises, such as Bethany Cabe (Co-Chief Executive Officer) or Dr. Erica Sondheim (Director of Medical Division).

Green Goblin

Green Goblin is a dangerous member of the Supremacy. Although far from the most powerful, his intellect, savage cunning and desire for power make him dangerous to foes and friends alike.

- **Target the Avengers:** Green Goblin is looking for a weak link in the Avengers, perhaps a valued staff member like Jarvis or an ally like Sharon Carter. He targets them for leverage against possible confrontations with the Avengers. However, as the Avengers are off-planet dealing with another crisis, it is up to the heroes.
- **Kidnap bankers:** Goblin launches an attack on one or more key financial institutions. He knows that white-collar crime can be more lucrative than dressing up in a costume, but there's no quicker way to earn a million dollars than to threaten to blow up the head of an investment bank with a pumpkin bomb.
- **Attack the Brooklyn Bridge:** The Goblin attacks the Brooklyn Bridge to further isolate the city and cause terror. This Green Goblin doesn't necessarily have specific history with the bridge, but any heroes with long memories may recall that this was the site of a tragic battle between Spider-Man and Earth-616's Goblin, where Gwen Stacy was killed.
- **Oscorp takeover:** Goblin is fascinated by the power and innovations developed by his counterpart unfettered by the restraints of working for Hydra. Goblin takes Bullseye with him to track down this world's Norman Osborn to threaten him to give up all his secrets on pain of death.

Doctor Octopus

One of the scientific geniuses of the Supremacy, Doctor Otto Octavius from Earth-56438 wants to master the dimensional portals and energies of the different worlds. He ultimately wishes to improve his standing in the Supremacy or break away for his own ambitions.

- **Power grid:** Doctor Octopus attacks key substations in order to hijack the city's power for his own schemes and to run his own mechanisms, perhaps derived from those of Zemo's scientists.
- **Alchemax labs:** Doc Ock targets the research facilities at Alchemax's laboratories, formerly Horizon Labs, located in Lower Manhattan, in an attempt to kidnap some of their leading scientists and steal their research (if any) related to dimensional portals and multiple Earths.
- **Empire State University:** Doc Ock knows that some of the brightest minds teach and research at Empire State University, so he makes it a priority, focusing on prominent folks like Dr. Sydney Lanning (Quantum Mechanics), Dr. Maxwell Lubisch (Studies in Extradimensional Power Sources) and gifted students like Anna Maria Marconi.
- **Intrepid:** Doctor Octopus and Elektra team up to target the Intrepid Sea, Air & Space Museum, for it is not just a relic of military history but contains a cache of secret weapons—military technology and equipment once hidden away by S.H.I.E.L.D.

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Vehicles and Military Equipment

Vehicle or Equipment	Speed	Powers	Health
Hydra jetpack	20 spaces	Flight 2	15 Health (jetpack only)
Light armored vehicle	25 spaces (roads only)	Sturdy 1 Elemental Burst (Energy) Elemental Blast (Energy)	100 Health
Hydra tank	15 spaces (all terrain)	Sturdy 2 Elemental Burst (Energy) Elemental Blast (Energy) Elemental Barrage (Energy)	200 Health
Hydra air drone	20 spaces	Flight 2 Elemental Blast (Energy) Heightened Senses 1 (Visual) Webcasting (Adhesive X)	40 Health
Hydra attack helicopter	16 spaces	Flight 1 Sturdy 1 Elemental Burst (Energy) Elemental Blast (Energy) Elemental Barrage (Energy)	150 Health
A.I.M. mech-suit	20 spaces	Mighty 1 Jump 1 Flight 2 Elemental Blast (Energy) Elemental Burst (Energy) Shield 2 Sturdy 1	60 Health

Other Vehicles

Vehicle	Speed	Powers	Health
Nick Fury Jr.'s VTOL jet	36 spaces	Flight 2 Elemental Burst (Energy) Elemental Blast (Energy) Elemental Barrage (Energy)	150 Health
Fantasti-Car	32 spaces	Flight 2 Shield 2 Sturdy 1	200 Health

Abomination

On Earth-56438, the Abomination was not a foreign spy but teenage Rick Jones, whom Bruce Banner did not manage to push into a trench when the Gamma Bomb went off. Instead, both men became gamma-powered monsters—Banner as the Hulk, and Jones as the Abomination. The Abomination was eventually drafted into the Supremacy due to his massive strength and invulnerability; they hoped to deploy him against cosmic threats.

- **Resistance base:** A fortified bunker (whether a converted police station, government building, consular building or bank) used by people resisting Hydra is targeted by the Abomination, who uses his massive strength as a battering ram.
- **Beasts of a feather:** Despite his monstrous appearance, in his chest still beats the heart of Rick Jones, who is worried about the animals in Central Park Zoo being left unattended and possibly being hurt by the fighting. He goes to take care of them and/or free them.
- **Making the grade:** Abomination rampages across Empire State University campus looking for key professors, scientists and grad students focused on theoretical physics and cosmic sociology.
- **For science:** Abomination and Winter Soldier team up to ransack the Stark Research Center (conveniently also on the ESU campus), looking for any useful data they can plunder on cosmic beings and threats—in particular, the Silver Surfer.

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Friendly Ally Encounters

Any encounter that is lucky enough to include a friendly guest star should give the heroes a good boost. The Narrator can involve the friendly hero in the middle of the action that the heroes come across, or they can show up once the heroes are fully engaged to lend a helping hand. However, the Narrator needs to be careful to ensure the guest star does not overshadow the players or dominate the scenario. A good rule of thumb is that after an encounter, the friendly ally must leave on another pressing mission. There are more than enough threats all across the city for everyone to have their hands full.

Vehicles and Military Equipment

Hydra's arsenal of armored assault vehicles and military equipment is vast. See the Vehicles and Military Equipment table on page 75. Here are guidelines on how to use them.

- The Health and powers listed are granted to the pilot/occupants/users of the vehicle or equipment as long as they are piloting or wearing the equipment, unless otherwise indicated.
- If the vehicle/equipment takes 50% damage, it slows to half speed.
- Receiving 100% damage renders the vehicle destroyed and removes any benefits for pilot/occupants.
- All actions use the base stats of the pilot/occupants/users.

Freeing Prisoners

Another side mission that Nick Fury Jr. can deploy the heroes on is to rescue any heroes that were captured in the previous chapter. Although this is a very important task, Fury is the type of cynical commander who places the greater strategic plan ahead of any individual's fate. This may mean sacrificing individuals in a worst case scenario, or, as in this task, leaving prisoners to languish until there is time and opportunity to liberate them.

This mission can be used if there is a lull in the action or the heroes are having trouble determining their next course of action. It could also be used after a victory at one of the landmarks to continue to press Hydra's forces. On the other hand, it could also be used as a way to bolster their forces or improve their morale if the heroes suffer a loss or setback.

The specific details of the mission need to be determined by the Narrator, but a few simple guidelines are listed here:

- **Security and surveillance:** Hydra has a medium-security presence guarding the prisoners, based on the makeshift quality of the situation. Look to the Convention Center security in Chapter 3 or the details on Hydra squads in this chapter for ideas. At a minimum, there would be armed guards, physical locks and limited security lights or camera systems.
- **Hostages:** Prisoners can easily be turned into hostages if the heroes are not careful. The prisoners may be under constant surveillance or threat of harm, making it crucial for the rescue team to have a clear understanding of the situation. (Narrators need to be careful not to overdo this, as an encounter could easily spin out of control in ways the players aren't comfortable with.)
- **Hydra reinforcements:** With so many Hydra troops in the area, if the heroes aren't careful to avoid being spotted while dealing with guards, backup forces can quickly be called in.
- **Extraction:** Once the prisoners are freed, the heroes need to extract them safely and quickly. Any delays would alert Hydra, who would send in greater forces. As well, in addition to any super-hero prisoners, Hydra might have any number of civilians or political or military prisoners locked up, whom the heroes might also have to help get to safety.

FAQs

The players may have many questions, and some of this information can be relayed to them by Daredevil (or by Nick Fury Jr., if he is the heroes' main contact).

Can the National Guard or the armed forces help? Not easily. The authorities are responding, but the super villains striking the city are a step above their capability. It's up to the heroes to try to stop the villains and contain the damage. Eventually, help may arrive from farther out but not in time to assist the heroes.

What is the United States doing about this? Not much. All the armed forces are geared to respond to external threats outside the borders of the country. It takes time for the forces to get organized and respond. Consider them not a factor for this adventure.

Where are the other heroes? New York is home to a vast array of superhumans; however, one must assume the others are otherwise occupied or away at the moment. Use whatever creative reasons you want as to why the heroes are on their own for the moment. Keep in mind with all the action going on, the players are bound to run into other nonplayer character (NPC) heroes, and certainly by the end of the adventure, there will be a huge convergence. The idea here is to keep the play experience in check without having to manage the greater population of New York's heroes.

Who put Nick Fury Jr. in charge? Nobody—he just kind of shows up and people listen to him. Fury is coordinating not only the heroes in their endeavors but also many of the other heroes resisting Hydra and the Supremacy.

ACT I: DATA BREACH

A transport helicopter filled with A.I.M. techs is en route to assault the Baxter Building. It contains two of the Supremacy members: Taskmaster and Arnim Zola.

They are also accompanied by:

- Eight jetpack Hydra soldiers and a Hydra officer also equipped with a jetpack;
- Two attack helicopters that flank the soldiers to provide support.

Arnim Zola and the A.I.M. techs land on the roof and disable the Baxter Building's defenses and security systems. Once this is completed, the techs radio Taskmaster to enter the main floor with his force to get into the basement and locate the vault.

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Baxter Building

The Baxter Building, located in Midtown Manhattan, is the iconic headquarters of the Fantastic Four. Standing tall amid the city's skyscrapers, the futuristic structure boasts cutting-edge technology and otherworldly aesthetics.

Originally designed by Reed Richards, its unique blue and white exterior and distinctive 4 logo are both symbols of innovation and exploration. Constructed using advanced technology and alien materials, it features experimental laboratories and cutting-edge research facilities, training areas for super-powered beings and living quarters for the Fantastic Four.

Over the years, the Baxter Building has undergone numerous upgrades and renovations, reflecting the ever-evolving nature of the Fantastic Four and their adventures—including being damaged and even destroyed and rebuilt several times. The current structure is reinforced carbon-aramid thread, with diamond-carbon-lattice windows, all highly resistant to damage. The upper floors are even more heavily reinforced and are protected by automated security systems and a sentry robot (a H.E.R.B.I.E. variant unit).

Richards' extensive collection of high-tech gadgets and inventions are kept in various workshops. The Fantastic Four's array of specialized vehicles are housed in a hangar, including a vibranium-lined silo for their rockets, with an adjacent maintenance shop for repairs. Other features include a reception area (staffed by a robot receptionist, another one of the H.E.R.B.I.E. variant units), a main computer complex, storage rooms, geographic tracking/map room, conference room, archives, recreational room, infirmary, meditation chamber, trophy room and more.

The more specialized areas include a Negative Zone portal, an armory and a stasis vault.

The building's security is based on the biosignatures of the Fantastic Four. If none of them are present, much of the top floors are in lockdown, and the majority of the high-tech functions are inoperable.

The lower floors house public reception areas, an array of shops and other businesses, notably the Fantastic Store (which sells licensed FF merchandise), offices for support staff and a variety of restaurants in a world-class food court.

Back to the Action

Arnim Zola, the diabolical science genius, is ready to pit his skills and knowledge against Reed Richards' safeguards in order to take down the Baxter Building. He wants to plunder its futuristic treasures to fuel his rise in the Supremacy. Luckily for him, the FF are not currently home; otherwise, he might have bitten off more than he can chew. Zola only needs to contend with H.E.R.B.I.E. and a few pesky security bots and the spoils of victory are his.

Zola has enlisted Taskmaster in his mission to provide additional muscle in case they run into unexpected resistance. Taskmaster and a group of A.I.M. techs are deployed a block away to make their way on foot to the Baxter Building for a two-pronged assault. Meanwhile, Zola has a squad of Hydra jetpack soldiers and attack helicopters standing by to do his bidding.

A blast from Zola's ESP Box takes the A.I. running the Baxter Building offline. A transport helicopter then drops Zola and several A.I.M. techs on the roof. They immediately start unpacking computer terminals and tools. A.I.M. techs open panels and strip wiring in the observatory located on the roof to hack into the Baxter Building's systems. The H.E.R.B.I.E. assigned to the observatory cowers helplessly in the corner.

Heroes to the Rescue

The heroes are deployed by Nick Fury Jr. to deal with this threat. They can arrive in any of several ways:

- The most direct route is to use Fury's VTOL stealth jet to race there.
- Heroes might have their own vehicles or commandeer a Hydra vehicle.
- Alternatively, heroes might fly, swing, run, ice slide and so forth.

If they use the VTOL stealth jet, they'll have a few moments to scope out the situation before they engage. They see Zola lording over the A.I.M. techs as they scramble to hack the systems, while H.E.R.B.I.E. shakes and cowers.

The heroes could fly, leap, teleport or parachute down to the roof.

Zola's Response

When Zola becomes aware of the heroes, he deploys his jetpack soldiers to intercept them. If the heroes show particular caution on approach, give them an edge on their initiative check.

Zola has two to four jetpack-wearing soldiers on the roof, with an equal number hidden around another building. Once they are alerted to the heroes' presence, they try to shoot them out of the sky with blaster rifles.

If the heroes appear to be a match for the Hydra jetpack soldiers, Zola radios for the attack helicopters to swoop in and take them out. The helicopters would target the VTOL jet first, any flying heroes second and then any heroes on the roof who are not engaged with Zola or his forces.

However the heroes get to the roof, it's time to dance with Arnim Zola and his cronies. Assuming the heroes win and utterly thrash Zola, he jumps to a new body (see Arnim Zola Immortality, page 80). The Hydra soldiers and A.I.M. techs surrender or attempt to escape as soon as Zola abandons them.

Zola's last order to the attack helicopters is to wipe out anyone and everything on the roof, heedless of friendly fire.

Piloting the Jet

If one of the heroes pilots the jet, it can be used to recon or even attack the enemies. However, if none of the heroes are skilled pilots (or if they want to remain in the cockpit), they could switch the plane to automated hover and evade mode. Alternatively, if the heroes ask Fury (or if they need a little help), he can assign them a pilot to assist as needed.

Breaking Into the Building

In most scenarios, the arrival of the heroes distracts Zola's forces from getting into the building. However, if the heroes dally too long, the A.I.M. techs break into the observatory. They don't care about what is contained in the top-floor hangar, but they will try to access one floor below, where the astro-science labs are located, connected to the observatory. If Zola's forces get this far, they will try to hack into the computers, pulling any and all data on cosmic radiation, cosmic powers and cosmic entities—in particular, the Silver Surfer.

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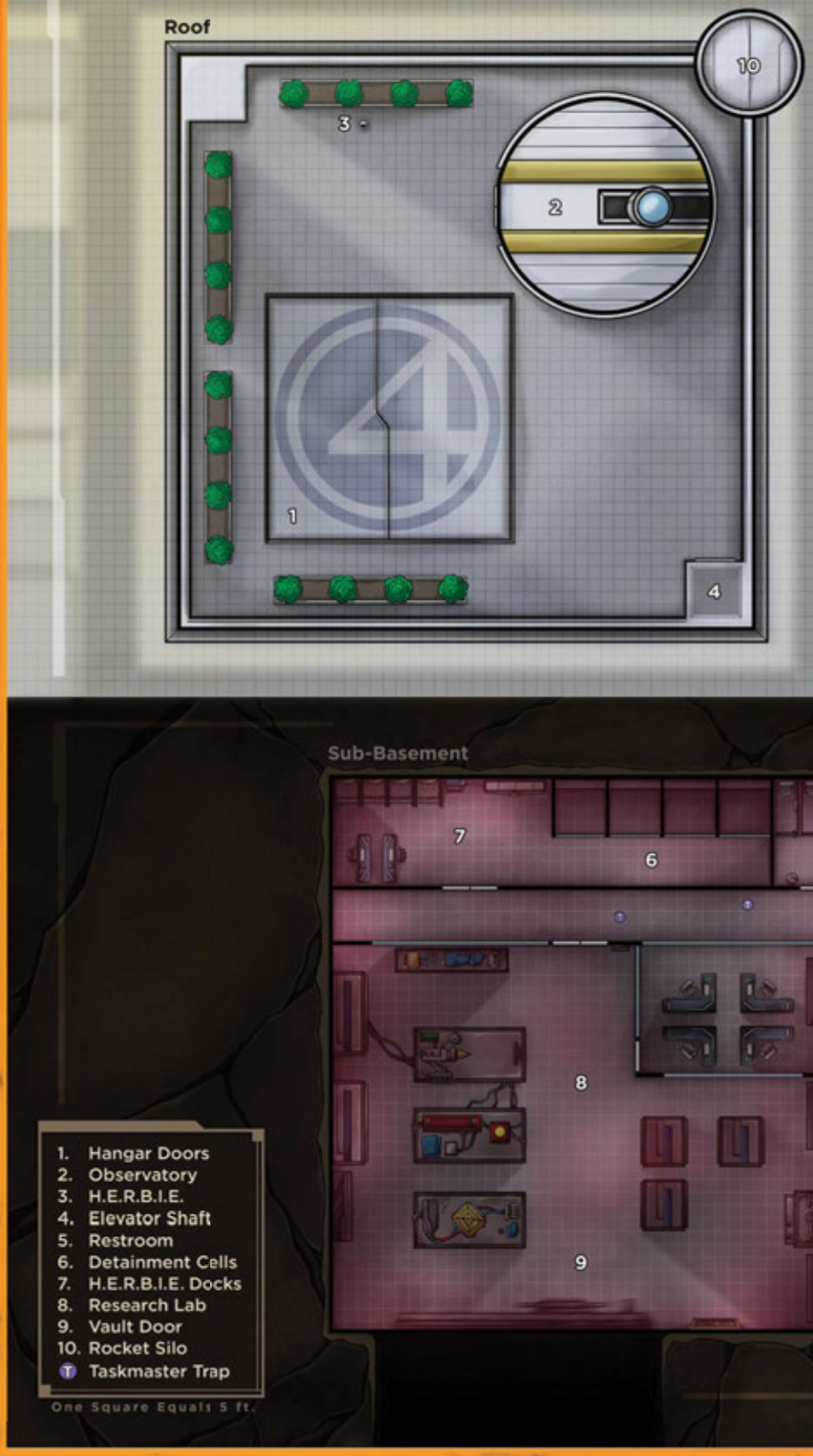
The Baxter Building



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H.E.R.B.I.E.

H.E.R.B.I.E. (Humanoid Experimental Robot, B-type, Integrated Electronics) was created by Mister Fantastic and Master Xar of the Xandarians, who hoped that the robot could aid their search for Galactus. There are numerous versions of the robot about the Baxter Building, performing duties such as running the gift shop, security, receptionist and maintenance.

The particular unit on the roof observatory was the first prototype tasked with surveying the cosmos to keep an eye out for cosmic threats. This unit is strictly for research and has no offensive or defensive capabilities. It does, however, have a very advanced A.I. that can interact with the heroes to protect the Baxter Building.

Once the heroes have dealt with the villains and the rooftop is safe, H.E.R.B.I.E. pipes up:

"Greetings! Hostile entities neutralized! Friendly units identified and added to the biometric database! Emergency! Security systems offline! Building compromised! Emergency!"

The heroes can interact with H.E.R.B.I.E., which has at least human-level intelligence. H.E.R.B.I.E. continues screeching while waving his arms about:

"Emergency! Secondary forces penetrated the ground level and have entered the sub-basement sections! Vault under attack! Rebooting security systems!"

H.E.R.B.I.E. starts interacting with the panels and computer systems of the building.

"Systems damaged! Will require rerouting! Estimated fifteen minutes reboot time! Assistance required! Delay the intruders! Emergency elevator access!"

H.E.R.B.I.E. zips over to the rooftop elevator access and jacks into a panel and mechanically opens the doors. There is no elevator there, just a deep, dark chasm. A ladder mounted on the side wall leads into the bowels of the Baxter Building. It's a long climb down.

"Requesting friendly units descend to sub-basement and delay hostiles!"

Art by Pete Woods & Celeste Woods

Express to the Sub-basement

The heroes can take the ladder down, or they can repurpose any remaining functional Hydra jetpacks for the descent. The elevator doors at the basement level require a Melee vs. TN 12 action check to successfully open. Once open, the empty hallways flickering with emergency lighting give the area a sense of foreboding.

The Taskmaster has set up a number of traps along the path to the vault area.

- The first one is a trip-wired claymore mine. The leading hero can make a difficult Vigilance vs. TN 16 action check. Success reveals the trip wire, and failure explodes the mine, resulting in damage based on the skill of the Taskmaster's ranged attack. Any other heroes in close proximity can attempt to dodge the damage. Failure to dodge (hit the floor) results in them taking half damage.
- There are three more such traps, which are easier to spot (TN 10) now that the heroes are aware. The Narrator should give a bonus on the Vigilance action checks if the heroes utilize creative ways to navigate the path.

Eventually, the halls lead to a large open laboratory filled with computer banks, desks, research equipment and all sorts of other scientific machinery. Two A.I.M. techs are working some apparatus against the far wall—what appears to be a massive vault door that takes up the majority of the wall. More techs are working on the computer banks. Taskmaster and two A.I.M. mech-suits guard the entrance to the lab.

If the heroes detonated any of Taskmaster's traps, he should be prepared for them. However, if they managed through diligence and luck to avoid setting them off, they might catch him unawares.

Taskmaster yells out:
"We got company! How long is this going to take?!"

The heroes may hear the A.I.M. tech respond:
"Sir, the vault appears to be out of phase—some dimensional-distortion security protocol! We don't have the equipment to get in!"

Taskmaster:
"You get the data, at least?"

A.I.M. tech:
"Affirmative!"

Taskmaster:
"Okay. Lay down some suppressing fire and let's pack it up!"

Combat with the heroes unfolds; however, the villains' primary goal is to escape. If Taskmaster gets the upper hand, he uses the opportunity to get away instead of trying to defeat the heroes. The heroes don't necessarily need to defeat all their foes directly. Simply fighting defensively or with stalling tactics to delay Taskmaster gives H.E.R.B.I.E. time to reset the Baxter Building's defensive A.I. and bring it back

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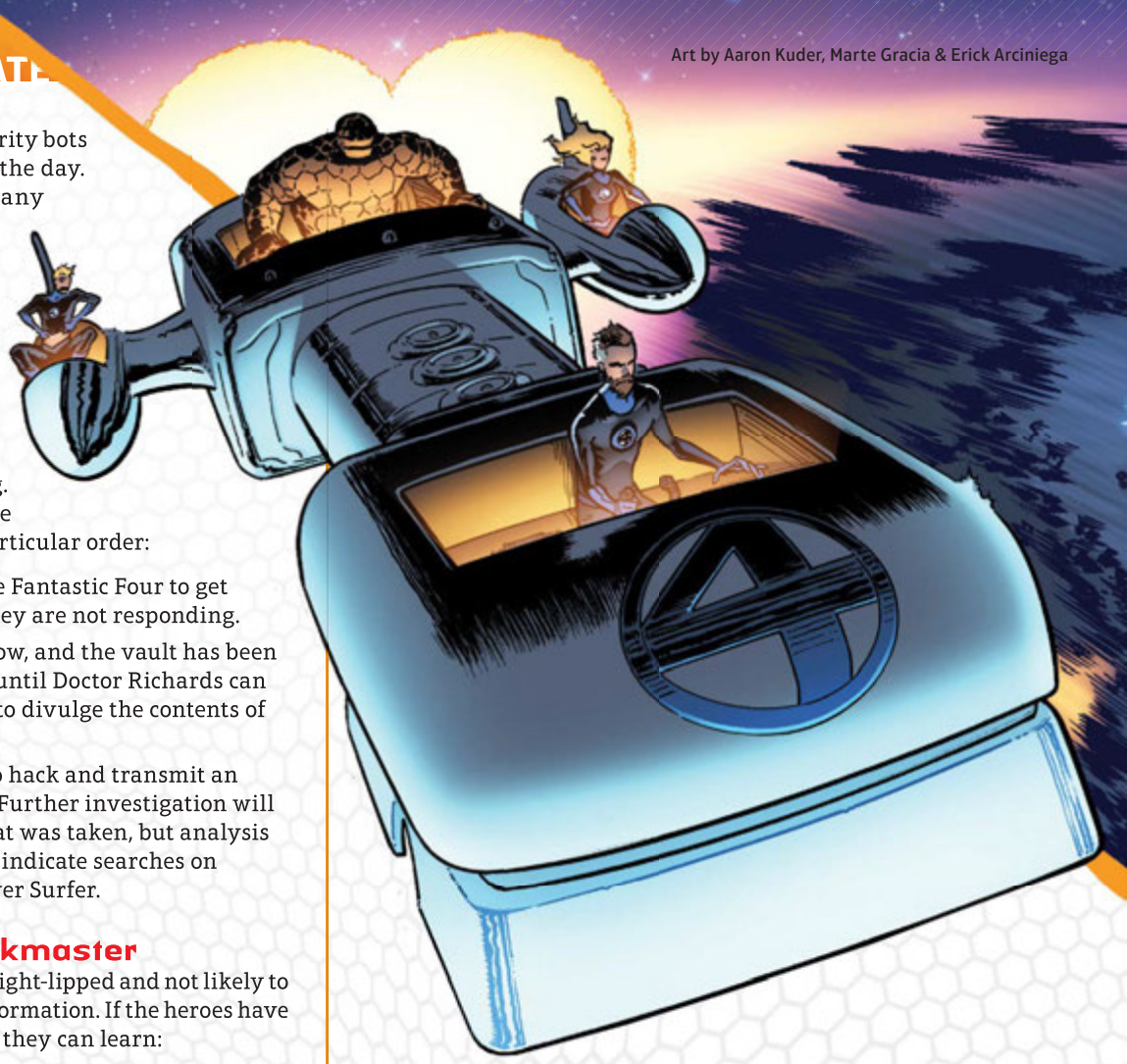

Art by Aaron Kuder, Marte Gracia & Erick Arciniega

online. The A.I. dispatches security bots to back up the heroes and win the day.

If Taskmaster and company are defeated, the security bots escort them to cells in another part of the basement designed to contain superhuman prisoners. If Taskmaster gets away with the data, consider it a win for the bad guys. Either way, H.E.R.B.I.E. calls the heroes back to the roof for a debriefing.

H.E.R.B.I.E. relays the following information in no particular order:

- A signal has been sent to the Fantastic Four to get them to return home, but they are not responding.
- The building is secure for now, and the vault has been phase-locked out of reality until Doctor Richards can reset it. H.E.R.B.I.E. refuses to divulge the contents of the vault if asked.
- The A.I.M. techs were able to hack and transmit an unknown quantity of data. Further investigation will be needed to determine what was taken, but analysis of queries used for the hack indicate searches on "cosmic entities" and the Silver Surfer.

Wrapping up the Taskmaster

If caught, Taskmaster remains tight-lipped and not likely to be intimidated into yielding information. If the heroes have some method to read his mind, they can learn:

- The main mission was to access the vault/armory of the Fantastic Four and secure any cosmic objects of power, specifically the Cosmic Cube. However, they were unable to access the phased vault.
- Their secondary objective was to raid databases and gather information on the Cosmic Cube; other powerful weapons, such as the Nega-Bands and the Ultimate Nullifier; cosmic entities, in particular the Silver Surfer; and any other tactically advantageous information to facilitate the invasion and the Supremacy's future goals.

The A.I.M. techs are much easier to interrogate and give up essentially the same information with less attitude. Any captured Hydra soldiers know little more than that they were assigned to the mission to be muscle for Arnim Zola.

Bigger Fish to Fry

After the encounter, Nick Fury Jr. calls to check in:

"Have you secured the building yet? Because we don't have time to mess around."

- Hydra is dispatching more of their monuments (via transport helicopters) to various parts of NYC, and Fury needs the heroes to deal with them.
- Fury is also coordinating other groups of heroes to deal with other Hydra and Supremacy threats.

Fury sketches out their orders (see Act II: All Hail Hydra), though the heroes can take a few moments to collect themselves. If the VTOL jet was trashed in the conflict or the heroes need other transport, H.E.R.B.I.E. offers the loan of the Fantasti-Car.

Arnim Zola Immortality

In the event Zola is defeated or destroyed, he transfers his consciousness to a backup body waiting at the Convention Center. He will be ready for round two in Act III. How many bodies Zola has is up to the Narrator. It's recommended to use at least one extra body to showcase all of Arnim Zola's powers. For either a more horrific tone or for comedic effect, the Narrator could keep bringing him back over and over, based on the overall tone of the adventure.

ACT II: ALL HAIL HYDRA

By now, all of New York City is overrun by Hydra and battles are taking place in every neighborhood. Wherever Hydra can gain ground, they are installing checkpoints and trying to establish zones of control. Their grand strategy involves the deployment of propaganda monuments, which, once operational, give them a shielded position to act from. The key is to install a ring of these around New York and link them together to create a much larger force-field that covers the whole city.

The heroes have a choice of where to go next. Fury advises them to head out to the nearest location and engage the installation. He is also organizing other heroes to critical

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Hydra strongholds at the same time. The heroes have at their disposal the VTOL jet (if it survived the rooftop fight), the Fantasti-Car and whatever other means they possess (Flight, Teleport, Dimensional Travel, etc.) to reach these locations to engage Hydra.

At each location, either the monument is being set up or it has recently been deployed and brought online. The suggestion is to run two encounters from the five locations and resolve the rest by narration, explaining that Fury dispatched other heroes to deal with them. Or if your players have the appetite for many encounters, run them through all five. Additionally, the Random Encounters table (page 70) can be used to generate more conflict if desired.

Splitting Up

With so much happening across the city and several forms of travel potentially at their disposal, some groups of heroes may want to split up and tackle several sites simultaneously. There is nothing wrong with this; however, be aware that each site is designed to be a challenge to a full group of heroes, so smaller teams may be overwhelmed. Further, when splitting the players into two or more groups, it can be challenging to give each player enough time in the spotlight, and players who aren't in the active scene may have a lot of downtime before it becomes their turn again.

Heroic Tactics

At each encounter, the heroes have multiple ways to engage their foes and deal with their objectives: primarily, understanding the monuments and dealing with Hydra's forces under the command of their Supremacy officers.

The heroes may approach these objectives in any number of ways. A few suggestions are outlined here:

- **Reconnaissance:** The heroes might fly by the area, taking note of the number and placement of Hydra soldiers, the location of the monument and any potential weaknesses or vulnerabilities in Hydra's defenses.
- **Divide and conquer:** The heroes may split into teams, some using the jet or Fantasti-Car to distract or draw away Hydra forces, while the others move in on foot to take out key targets or secure the monument.
- **Infiltration:** The heroes may attempt to infiltrate Hydra's base of operations, either by posing as civilians or location staff or by using stealth and infiltration techniques to bypass security. Particularly ingenious heroes may even try to capture a number of Hydra uniforms and enter in disguise. See Act II Aftermath, page 85.
- **Strategic assault:** The heroes may launch a coordinated assault on Hydra's forces, using their flying vehicles to provide air support and ground forces to engage in close-quarter combat.

Win, Lose, Draw

These encounters are designed for the heroes to slowly piece together Hydra's plan, building up to a decisive third-act counterattack. In many of these encounters, the heroes may not succeed in deactivating or destroying Hydra's monuments, and that's perfectly acceptable, as it makes turning the tide feel even more euphoric. But where possible, the heroes should learn at least one critical piece of information and feel like they've helped some of the good people of New York.

If the heroes manage to drive Hydra's forces within their force-field domes, it may lead to something of a standoff, where the heroes can't do enough damage to break down the force-fields (nor should they—see Act II Aftermath, page 85) but feel determined that they need to do *something*. In cases where the heroes have basically finished the encounter but aren't sure what to do next, have Nick Fury Jr. call them and tell them another monument is being erected and they need to get to that location immediately!

Monument Force-Fields

Each monument, when activated, projects a nearly invisible dome around a small radius. The domes distort the air, and observant characters can spot them.

The force-field domes form a complete sphere—one cannot dig under them.

The force-fields do allow gas exchange, but not much else. (Somehow, they don't interfere with power lines, water lines and so forth. They are just that good.) The heroes might try to gas the Hydra units inside a force-field—this is a clever tactic and could very well work once. However, after that, Hydra wises up to this strategy and deploys gas masks and atmosphere-supplying respirators (clean air tanks).

A character who can teleport might be able to make it through the force-field (Narrator's discretion) but would likely be outnumbered and outgunned by the Hydra forces on the inside. It could get messy, fast.

The force-fields have variable size settings—when one is first activated, it may be as small as a 4-space radius, but once powered up, it can be extended to nearly 1 mile. However, New York is approximately 302 square miles; the island of Manhattan alone is nearly 13 miles from Battery Park to the Henry Hudson Bridge. Thus, it would be impossible to cover NYC in Hydra monuments. Instead, once they are all in position, the A.I.M. techs need to recalibrate and synchronize the energy fields so that they can be "stretched" to overlap each other and create a super-sized dome approximately 30 miles in diameter.

Encounter the Monuments

LaGuardia Airport: Sacrifice to Thrive

LaGuardia Airport (LGA) is a civil airport in East Elmhurst, Queens, New York City. LGA operates domestic flights servicing mostly the East Coast and central areas of North America. It's of strategic importance for Hydra to control the ability of people to leave the New York area and control who can land to prevent reinforcements.

LaGuardia is approximately 5–10 minutes away from the Baxter Building, if the heroes can fly there. Otherwise, it's close to a 20-minute drive, depending on Hydra's patrols and other minor crises and encounters. The Fenris Twins are overseeing the installation of the Sacrifice to Thrive monument. The monument depicts peasant farmers and Hydra soldiers working together to harvest wheat. Accompanying the twins are half a dozen A.I.M. techs setting

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up the installation. Two Hydra squads are on crowd-control duty, consisting of eight soldiers, an officer and a Light Armor Transport Vehicle for each unit. They have deployed at the crossroads of the two main runways of LaGuardia.

Hydra's actions:

- The Fenris Twins want to get the monument set up and then strut their stuff, taking control of the airport for Hydra. They are arrogant and superior and happy to terrorize any civilians or staff caught at the airport.
- When the heroes make themselves known, the Fenris Twins first send some of their soldiers to engage them.
- If the heroes deal with the guards easily, the Twins grow irate and charge the heroes directly. They are smugly overconfident and assume they can easily defeat the heroes and use that to further prove how powerful they are.
- Andrea and Andreas can be drawn away from the monument or from the other Hydra forces easily, but due to the nature of their powers, they won't be separated from each other except by force.

The Hydra forces may be defeated here, potentially even before the monument is activated. If the heroes attack quickly and decisively and target the A.I.M. techs, they may be able to keep them from completing their mission.

More likely, the heroes first engage the soldiers and then the Fenris Twins—they may well defeat all of them but fail to stop the techs from activating the monument. In that case, while the heroes have cleared LaGuardia of Hydra's occupation, the monument is still an untreated wart on the tarmac.

Long Beach Boardwalk: Strength Is Hydra

The Long Beach Boardwalk is one of the most popular attractions in New York. Spanning about 2 miles, it offers stunning views of the ocean beaches. The boardwalk sits just outside the reach of the Atlantic Ocean and offers ample space for strolling, jogging, biking and Rollerblading. It's only a short walk from downtown Long Beach.

For more than a century, the boardwalk has played a central role in the Long Beach community and served as a destination for New Yorkers looking to spend a nice day at the beach. That was until Hydra decided to drop in with a monument depicting a Hydra uniformed coach overseeing several young people exercising, with a placard declaring, "Strength Is Hydra."

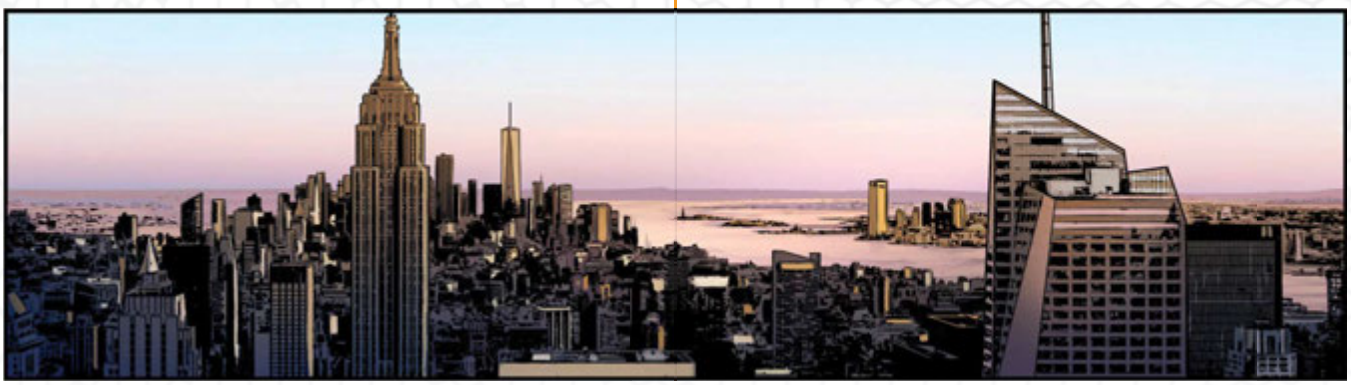
Two transport helicopters have landed, one with the monument and A.I.M. techs, and the other with two squads of Hydra soldiers. Each squad consists of eight troops, one officer and a communication specialist who is controlling an air drone equipped with Adhesive X guns.

The techs have got the force-field operational and set it to a small perimeter to shield themselves and one squad inside. The other squad is retreating toward the force-field from a large, hostile crowd that is chasing them. Bottles, rocks, refuse and small-arms fire appear to be the motivating force behind their withdrawal. One transport helicopter has been set on fire by the mob and the other one is surrounded.

Half the second squad has passed through the force-field to safety, while the other half is being thrashed by the mob. One soldier is banging with his fists on the force-field yelling to be let in but is unable to pass through the force-field like the rest of his unit. He is bloodied and his uniform is torn up. The mob soon catches up to him and likely kills him. The heroes need to decide if they want to save the Hydra soldier… or leave him to his fate.

The heroes' dilemma:

- The Hydra soldiers caught outside the force-field will surely be killed by the furious mob. Maybe they deserve it for depriving New Yorkers of their home and liberty, or maybe the heroes' code of morality is a step above "eye for an eye" and they intervene.
- The mob will not attack the heroes and generally defers to their authority. There will however be boos and jeers, and a few of the aggressive folks still try to pelt the Hydra soldiers with refuse. Ideally, the heroes should turn the other cheek to this minor abuse and try to defuse the situation, by doing something such as:
  - Taking the Hydra soldiers caught outside the force-field into custody and departing, leaving the monument active and other Hydra soldiers trapped inside.
  - Intimidating the mob to disperse them (Ego vs. TN 18 action check). This may work or might backfire and turn the mob hostile (if the Ego check fails). The heroes can lay a serious beating on the mob, but this results in bad publicity and future stigma for these heroes.
  - Tossing the Hydra soldiers into the force-field for their own safety. However, the one soldier with the torn uniform cannot pass through the field and "bounces" off. Thus, they'll have to figure out what to do with him.



Art by CAFU & Frank D'Armata

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Whether or not the heroes fully defeat Hydra here, the important takeaway from this encounter is to recognize why the one Hydra soldier was unable to pass through the force-field. Perceptive players may realize that the torn uniform is missing the Hydra insignia (which is a transponder that allows bypass of the force-field). If the players don't make this connection, allow the character with the highest Vigilance to make a check vs. TN 14 to become aware of this fact.

Once the situation has been resolved, or at least defused, Fury sends the heroes to the next location.

Coney Island: Freedom Is Hydra

Coney Island is a neighborhood and entertainment area in the southwestern section of New York City in the borough of Brooklyn. Coney Island is known for its amusement park (Luna Park), Wonder Wheel and New York Aquarium. One of its more recent and somber landmarks is the Wall of Remembrance, composed of three granite walls laser-engraved with the images of 417 men, women and one dog (Sirius) who lost their lives on September 11, 2001. The monument has been dropped off right in front of the Wall of Remembrance near Maimonides Park. The Freedom Is Hydra monument depicts a female Hydra soldier and a civilian, both with their arms stretched out and hands open, releasing a dove into the air.

The Narrator can randomly determine if the force-field is active (d6: 1–3 active, 4–6 not active), or if the previous encounter already had the force-field active, then it is not yet active here or vice versa.

Additionally, it is suggested that the Narrator use one of the minor or major villains from the tables on page 72 or another encounter with Arnim Zola as a Supremacy member to lead this excursion.

Because of the variable nature of this encounter, the focus is on the Hydra forces terrorizing the locals and making their presence felt.

If the heroes arrive before the force-field has been set up, they can proceed to engage and possibly stop them from activating it. If the field is up, however, most of the Hydra forces retreat behind it and taunt the heroes for being unable to get to them. Of course, if the heroes find a way to manipulate the Supremacy member, they might draw them out into the open.

If the heroes attack the force-field, the Hydra units poke their guns outside the force-field and shoot at the heroes. Otherwise, the Hydra forces are content to wait behind their protective position. If enough time passes in this stalemate, generate another random encounter to determine reinforcements arriving for this location.

Prince's Bay Lighthouse: Individualism Is Chaos

The Prince's Bay Lighthouse is an active lighthouse on the highest point of the southern shoreline of Staten Island, New York. The area is pastoral, offering New Yorkers a place to picnic or enjoy the breeze from the bluffs surrounding the lighthouse. This is the most southern part of NYC, making it a logistical target for Hydra; otherwise, there is little else here.

Two transport helicopters have landed, one with the monument and A.I.M. techs and the other with two squads of Hydra soldiers. Each squad consists of eight troops, one officer and a communication specialist who is controlling an air drone equipped with Adhesive X guns.

The propaganda monument has been set up and is fully operational. "Individualism Is Chaos" reads the placard for this one. It depicts a circle of Hydra soldiers saluting the Hydra skull and tentacles in the center.

The Hydra units assigned to this mission are, however, much less professional. A group of them have picked up a casual soccer game. A few more have broken out lawn chairs and are enjoying bottles of beer from a portable cooler. Their ease is understandable, as they are safely behind a force-field. Once the heroes arrive and are spotted, they pick up their arms and become more attentive.

The heroes can't do much to them unless they can bypass the force-field. If the stalemate goes on for a bit or the heroes start beating on the force-field, one Hydra soldier makes a show of putting down his weapon, holding his hands up in a peaceful gesture, and slowly walking to the edge of the force-field to parley with the heroes from just inside the field.

"Hey, let's talk…"

The heroes can listen to what he has to say, or they can try to lure him out to attack and capture him. If they attack him, the rest of the soldiers form up and poke their guns out of the force-field to fire at the heroes. This gives them protection and the ability to attack with impunity.

However, if the heroes listen to the Hydra agent, he says:

"Hi, my name's Robert.

You can't get through the force-field. Even if you beat it down eventually, the projector will explode like a nuke and take the whole neighborhood with it. Maybe let's not do that?

We have a bit of a stalemate. Can I propose we leave it that way?

Eventually, reinforcements will show up to help us hold this location. You may as well surrender or flee now. How about it, heroes? Can we make a deal and call it a day? We even have some extra chairs and beers if you want to sit outside the field and chat."

However the encounter ends, the heroes have learned that these monuments are very dangerous to overcome using force. If the heroes find another way around the force-field, they can engage the Hydra units and neutralize the monument. The other option is to take up Hydra Robert's deal and leave them to play soccer and drink their weird Kraken-brand metric unit (500ml) beers.

If Robert is asked about Hydra's overall plans, he doesn't know much more than the obvious. He doesn't know why they have invaded this world other than that's what their superiors in Hydra and the Supremacy ordered them to do. He does know that the commanding forces seem a little antsier than usual, as if something is pushing them, but he doesn't know what's driving their timetable.

Untermyer Gardens Conservancy: Cut Off One Limb, and Two More Shall Take Its Place

Untermyer Gardens was developed beginning in 1916 by Samuel Untermyer, a prominent lawyer and civic leader. In its heyday, it housed over 60 greenhouses and had 150 acres of garden space, including lavish pools and architectural wonders. The park's principal feature is the Walled Garden,

Michael Syrett (Order - 53194700)

Art by Pasqual Ferry

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inspired by ancient Indo-Persian gardens, in which is found a small Grecian-style open-air amphitheater. Untermyer donated the gardens to the city of Yonkers in 1919. This was in keeping with a long-standing and continuing tradition of prominent New Yorkers donating to the public good.

Today, the conservancy is enjoyed by New Yorkers for the beautiful gardens, plays performed in the amphitheater and other classical statues and temples found on the grounds. Hydra, of course, would like to make their own contribution by way of a monument depicting a doctor wearing a Hydra uniform, with a beatific smile on his face, using his stethoscope to examine a baby that is held out by worried parents with outstretched arms.

The Narrator can randomly determine if the force-field is active (d6: 1–3 active, 4–6 not active), or if the previous encounter already had an active force-field, then it is not yet active here or vice versa. As before, use one of the minor or major villains from the tables on page 72 or another encounter with Arnim Zola as a Supremacy member to lead this excursion.

If the heroes have been stymied by Hydra too often in this act, with too few successes, then have them arrive before the force-field has been activated, so that they have a chance to get to the monument and examine it. It could be that the monument was damaged in transit, with A.I.M. working furiously under the harsh glare of their Supremacy superior to get it back online.

Act II Aftermath

Everything the heroes learn about Hydra's activities and in particular, their focus on the monuments—what they are, where they are placed, what they do and how they function—should be communicated to Nick Fury Jr. and his staff, who are devising a tactical plan on how best to deal with the many tentacles Hydra has wrapped around New York.

The primary information gained should be:

- **Placement:** Hydra has placed monuments at several key strategic places around the greater New York area. Beneath the trappings of fascist propaganda, each monument houses a powerful force-field generator.
- **Power supply:** The force-fields generated by the monuments are localized and driven by a self-contained power supply. In theory, this battery could be drained if a genius-level hero can get close enough to study it and make a Logic vs. TN 16 action check.
- **Force-field strength:** A force-field can withstand tremendous damage (1 million Health) before the device is overloaded and explodes with the yield of a small nuclear bomb. This would be catastrophic to the surrounding area.
- **Force-field regeneration:** Over time, each field regenerates (100 Health per minute).
- **Insignias:** Hydra units have transponders incorporated into their uniforms and vehicles to allow seamless passage through the force-fields. The insignia has microcircuitry embedded into it that is the transponder. Nick asks the heroes to collect as many as possible (anywhere from half a dozen to two dozen), so they can be studied and used as a possible way around the Hydra defenses.
- **Synchronized field:** If all the monuments can be brought online, they can synchronize and link up, creating a much bigger force-field that can isolate all of New York. A hero with a scientific background in particle physics or energy studies can make a Logic vs. TN 14 action check to deduce this aspect. (If the monuments are synchronized, Hydra has won and the heroes have to flee New York. Otherwise, they are caught up inside the field and firmly dealt with as more and more Supremacy members are gated in.)

The heroes can learn all of the above from running through as many of the encounters in this act as the Narrator deems useful.

If the heroes are more brawlers and less scientific detectives, Fury's tech specialists could give them a few hints. As well, one of the missions might be redefined as "secure a monument for Fury's team to analyze," rather than decoding it themselves.

Alternatively, if they miss a critical piece of information, one of Nick Fury Jr.'s other teams could discover it, though this tactic should be used rarely or else the players will feel like bystanders to their own adventure. Once a critical mass of information has been gathered, Fury calls everyone back to his command center at the library to lay down a cohesive strategy to take the fight to Hydra.

ACT III: NEW YORK, NEW YORK

The battles rage on for New York. By now, at least one of the monuments should have been neutralized or under the control of the heroes. However, the Convention Center in Hell's Kitchen is still an active hive of Hydra's power, spewing out a continuous stream of forces to join the invasion. Any information gained about the monuments and the tactical capabilities of the enemy should have been relayed back to Fury at the command center by now.

Knowledge Is Power

Fury summons the heroes to return to the library where he's set up the command center. He has a mission for them that should turn the tide of battle. However, radio communications might be compromised by Hydra, so he wants to see the heroes in person. The heroes can make their way back by using the Fantasti-Car, VTOL jet or other means. The streets remain perilous to navigate, so a random encounter is still an option.

The temp command center has more forces and staff that have answered Fury's summons. A medical field tent has been set up, which the heroes can use to tend to any injuries. Also, there is a kitchen where they can get a hot meal. After a brief respite, all are gathered in the tactical room for a briefing.

Nick Fury Jr.'s Plan

It's time to take the fight back to Hydra and solve this problem once and for all. That means gaining control of Hydra's dimensional-portal machinery at the Convention Center. So far, the evidence indicates that only New York is being targeted, as no other reports of incursions have occurred. Thus, it's critical to stop them before they can expand their invasion to other parts of the world.

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Fury outlines the mission—a surgical strike to take out the force-field covering the Convention Center, followed up by a concentrated effort to take control of the portal machinery. Fury stresses that they can't just beat them back and destroy the machinery, because there's nothing to stop them from breaking through the dimensional barrier again, perhaps this time in Grise Fiord, Nunavut.

Distraction sorties lure off as many of the forces at the Convention Center as possible while the heroes deal with the monument.

The heroes need enough Hydra insignia to equip all of them so they can get through the force-field around the Convention Center. If the heroes don't have enough for the group, it's possible that Fury has managed to gather a few more through other sources. He ensures each member of this core group has an insignia.

The heroes must deactivate the Convention Center monument at all costs.

Hydra and the Supremacy are aware that the portal is both their strength and their weakness, so heavy resistance is expected.

The heroes need to be aware that any of the forces they've battled previously might be called up for defense of the Convention Center.

Assuming the force-field is brought down, the rest of the forces can hit the center hard and win the day.

Eyes in the Sky

Fury can give the heroes a status report of any/all of the following, depending on who is still on the loose, and tailored for your group:

- **Arnim Zola:** Spotted in and out of the Convention Center, often in conversation with Baron Zemo.
- **Taskmaster:** Leading a Hydra patrol to root out any resistance members.
- **The Fenris Twins:** Clashing directly with U.S. military and local police forces.
- **The Wrecking Crew:** They appear to have found a bar they are fond of and have essentially moved in, running up a huge tab they'll never pay for and making the life of the proprietor a nightmare.
- **M.O.D.O.K.:** Spotted patrolling the area! (Some Narrators may prefer to surprise their group with the Mental Organism Designed Only for Killing, while others like to foreshadow what the heroes will face. How much Fury's team knows is up to you.)
- Heightened security around the area (see Chapter 3 for the security around the Convention Center).

E.M.P.!

Fury has some makeshift ammunition that can assist the heroes in this mission. The techs have been able to modify a few grenades into electromagnetic-pulse (E.M.P.) devices that should knock the monument offline. This is based on the intelligence gathered by the heroes in the previous act, though Fury warns it's still more theory than fact. Since time is of the essence, these will have to be field-tested. Each of the heroes is given one E.M.P. grenade and shown basic steps to arm and use them.

- A successful easy range attack lands the E.M.P. grenade next to the monument.
- The E.M.P. grenade goes off unless it is defective (see below) and fries the circuitry hidden inside the monument, taking it offline and deactivating the force-field.
- Hydra technicians can repair the fried circuit boards, but this requires an hour of uninterrupted service time.

Since these are untested, there is a good chance a device fails. Roll d6 for each device deployed, and on a roll of 1 or 6 that grenade is a dud. Unfortunately, that means the action is wasted for the round. Note that M.O.D.O.K. and Arnim Zola, both more robot than human, are also susceptible to an E.M.P. attack. If caught in the blast, they take 50 focus damage from each successful grenade hit.

Time to Roll Out

Fury tells the heroes to take whatever brief time they need to get ready and then to head out with their stash of E.M.P. grenades and whatever else they might need. They also have a small window to get themselves into position, depending on how they want to define it.

The heroes may wish to fly close in the stealth VTOL jet, use the Fantasti-Car, or disguise themselves as Hydra soldiers (using their captured insignia to pass through the force-field) or any number of other options.

Hell's Kitchen is completely closed off to non-Hydra personnel—roadblocks and drones and armored patrols have the whole area on lockdown. Citizens are told to stay in their homes or risk detention or worse. Occasionally, Hydra sends through food-relief trucks, distributing resources haphazardly. Hydra knows their strict curfew will cause food shortages, so they are trying to keep citizens fed, and less likely to riot.

When the heroes are ready, they are to radio a message to Fury to launch the distractions, which may include some of the friendly allies from Table IV (page 72).

The Narrator should describe it in broad strokes, without worrying too much about the details. For example:

- Ant-Man could become Giant-Man and draw off a number of armored vehicles and attack helicopters.
- Vision might swoop down, blasting at the control tower atop the Convention Center, then draw off the Adhesive X drones (who can't really hurt him due to his ability to change his density).
- Daredevil and heroes like Blindspot, White Tiger and/or Frog-Man could launch an attack at a crucial checkpoint, occupying the Hydra soldiers while the heroes rush by toward the monument.
- Fury's agents can smuggle arms to resistance forces in the neighborhood, so they rise up and force Hydra to focus on them.

Target: Monument

The propaganda monument at the Convention Center was the first one Zemo's forces installed. It depicts a blindfolded female Hydra officer holding up a pair of scales. On one side is a civilian kowtowing, while the other holds a prosperity tree, with the phrase "Obey and Prosper" inscribed upon the placard.

With a large percentage of Hydra's forces distracted by Fury's feint, it's go time for the heroes. But it's no cakewalk.

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Depending on how the heroes approach, the Narrator should place one to several obstacles in their way, either consecutively or simultaneously, depending on the strength of the group.

- Any villains that generated strong reactions from the players in previous encounters are good to bring back (in either the "love 'em" or the "love to hate 'em" camp).
- Arnim Zola has multiple bodies, so he is a good candidate for a final pop-up from beyond the grave.
- M.O.D.O.K.'s appearance can be absurd but should also be somewhat terrifying.

It would not be unreasonable for one obstacle (a Supremacy villain, a squad of A.I.M. mech-suited guards, etc.) to intercept the heroes before they reach the monument, and another 1–3 foes (or groups of foes) to appear as a last-ditch defense.

Clever heroes use their E.M.P. grenades to try to take out the monument as soon as possible. If they fail to use them successfully, their secondary option is to find a way to drain the battery. This should involve a Logic vs. TN 16 action check, with an edge given if they've had a chance to study the monuments up close earlier in the scenario.

It takes only one successful E.M.P. grenade to deactivate the monument.

Monument Down

Once the monument has been deactivated and the force-field around the Convention Center is taken down, the heroes have achieved a major victory.

Of course, there might still be villains on the scene as an immediate threat—the heroes will want to finish off the Hydra and Supremacy forces in the vicinity. However, even if the fight turns on the heroes and they lose, are knocked out or worse, they win because Fury sends the rest of New York's super-heroic finest into the fray.

At that point, the heroes can elect to guard the monument to keep any A.I.M. techs away from it so they don't reactivate it, or they can storm the Convention Center along with the rest of Fury's forces.

If the heroes are worried about leaving defeated or unconscious foes (like M.O.D.O.K.) unsupervised, Fury can send a division of guards equipped with high-tech restraining gear to neutralize them.

Secondary Goals

If the heroes press on into the Convention Center, they can have as many small- or large-scale conflicts as the Narrator desires. However, as there have been many battles over the course of this scenario, it might be best to montage the final scenes, as appropriate.

- **Storm the Convention Center:** Deal with any Hydra soldiers remaining on guard.
- **Capture any of the leadership of the Supremacy they can:** In particular, Baron Zemo or any of his high-level techs.
- **Secure the portal machinery:** Defeat or drive away the guards from around the chamber, and lock it down.
  - Fury orders the heroes, *"Don't destroy the portal machinery! We need that for what's to come."*
- **Rescue any captured heroes:** This could tie into the previous chapter or pick up story threads from this scenario.
- **Help the injured:** Move any injured combatants out of harm's way and get them medical support.

The Aftermath

Nick Fury Jr. believes the world got lucky this time—because of their arrogance, the Supremacy chose to invade New York, giving the heroes a chance to push back. If the Supremacy had gone to some remote location and gathered their forces, it would have been far harder to learn what they were up to and respond in time. There is every reason to think the Supremacy will open another portal to, say, Antarctica or Wyoming and try again.

Fury knows they have to get to the other side of the portal and shut this thing down permanently. Capturing any of the Hydra leadership is an important step in what's to come afterward. Questioning them may also lead to some answers on the nature of the invasion—why did they come here in the first place? Was it purely for land expansion or to control resources, or was there something in particular they were looking for on Earth-616? And how close did they come to achieving it? Hydra and the Supremacy certainly came closer to taking over New York than Fury would like to admit.

Art by Greg Land, Matt Ryan & Justin Ponsor

Michael Syrett (Order #53194700)

At this point, the heroes control the machinery, but don't know how to operate the portal. It could go to *any* Earth, to worse places or not open at all. Fury doesn't want any of the heroes playing with the controls until his top people study it.

Fury knows that Hydra and the Supremacy brought so many agents across that there must be quite a number who have gone underground. One of his top priorities is to hunt them down to ensure they don't cause any more grief and to find out whatever else they might know. (This is one way to lead into Chapter 5.)

While Fury and the heroes (and probably the players) may want to question any high-value captive immediately, it is suggested that the Narrator decide what to reveal before continuing the adventure into Chapter 5. Most of Hydra's leadership is tight-lipped and scornful of Fury and the weaklings of this Earth. While they may feel defeated, and even mourn for what they expect to lose on their world, they may feel some relief that they are still alive, even if imprisoned on this Earth.

Captives may reveal some or all of this information as the Narrator decides is appropriate and true (or, if not true, something a captive would lie about).

- Can Hydra open more portals? Yes, they still have the technology, but they only have the capability to open small, temporary portals (for groups of maybe four people to cross over, but no more than that. That was how they began this invasion, after all—bringing over small caches of equipment and building it up from there).
- There are no heroes on Earth-56438 (well, none that they want to admit to).
- If asked about the stolen data on cosmic powers and beings, a captive might reveal that they hoped to make the portals permanent by tapping into the Power Cosmic. Even Zemo is reluctant to give away more information about what may be coming at this point.

DAMAGE CONTROL

As has been said, no plan survives contact with the enemy. There are many ways this chapter could go in unexpected directions. Here are a few final notes on dealing with some of these situations.

Art by Kev Walker, Jason Gorder & Jean-Francois Beaulieu

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Dead Heroes

While regrettable, death is one of the outcomes of engaging in prolonged conflicts. In a serious campaign, let a character die if the scene warrants it. The player can rejoin with a new character or even pick a profile from the next chapter that shows up to help (when dramatically appropriate). In a less serious campaign, feel free to cheat death with miracle saves and injured/captured heroes who can be rescued to adventure again another day.

Captured Heroes

If some or all of the heroes get captured at one of the earlier encounters—such as against the Fenris Twins or against the Taskmaster or Arnim Zola—they would be brought into Hell's Kitchen and detained at a more secure facility near the Convention Center.

If this happens very early in the adventure, say at the first or second locations, Fury might have to rally another more experienced crew to step in.

However, if this happens closer to the end, once a number of critical pieces of information have been successfully gathered and conveyed to Fury, it might be more fun to have the heroes freed during Fury's assault on the Convention Center. In this situation, Fury or some of his trusted agents have likely snuck into the area in disguise, using Hydra insignia, and may free the heroes (or give them the tools they need to free themselves). Perhaps they've even smuggled in a shielded case with a handful of E.M.P. grenades, and they need the heroes to make a desperate run at that Obey and Prosper monument…

Exploding a Monument

If the heroes only seem to have a hammer in hand and view every problem as a nail, it's not impossible that they might accidentally destroy one of the monuments, setting off the equivalent of a small nuclear strike. The Narrator should give them several opportunities to realize the error of their ways before committing to this act—because it's bad news for everyone involved.

Anything in the immediate area would be subject to catastrophic damage, with an enormous toll in lives lost and property destroyed. Hydra forces behind remaining force-fields would be protected, but any heroes or villains caught in the blast would be grievously injured if not killed.

The Villains Win

Hydra and the Supremacy are challenging foes, and it's far from impossible that, due to bad luck or bad planning, the fight goes poorly for the heroes. In that case, Hydra has a lock on the greater region of New York, and draws forth a full-strength armada to plant a flag on Earth-616.

Look to the following chapters for ideas on how to advance the story, as you desire. For example, Chapter 5 details higher-ranking members of the Supremacy, who would now emerge from the portal to continue their schemes for this Earth.

If still free, Nick Fury Jr. would become a highly prized target—Hydra wants him dead or alive. Whether any of the other heroes are still alive, free and capable of helping him depends on how this chapter concluded.

THE EPILOGUE

Assuming the heroes triumph in whole or part over Hydra and the Supremacy, it's a time for rest and recovery. While the world, and New York in particular, sees its fair share of crises and devastating tragedies, it still takes time to pick up the pieces and start to rebuild.

The heroes have gained a solid reputation not just in Hell's Kitchen, where much of the action took place, but across the five boroughs, as they traveled the breadth and width of the Big Apple to put things right.

Additionally, New York's other heroes—groups like the Fantastic Four and the Avengers—have likely heard good things about them and might call upon them for aid or assistance in future endeavors. It never hurts to have a reputation as being a reliable, stand-up, good guy.

The Next Adventure

The next adventure in *The Cataclysm of Kang* takes the heroes from this world, Earth-616, to Hydra Earth-56438.

SIDETRACKS

While this adventure is complete, you and your players might not be ready to plunge straight into the adventure in the next chapter. Here are some suggestions for other things that your group can explore and have fun with in the meantime.

Mop up at the Convention Center

Wrap up by cleaning up any loose ends running around New York after the Convention Center has been taken down. There are still plenty of Hydra agents on the run and up to mischief.

Play out more detailed encounters in and around the Convention Center, such as confronting the leadership of Hydra and the Supremacy.

Fantastic Heroes

Team up with the Fantastic Four—H.E.R.B.I.E. told the FF, upon their return, what had transpired. And the FF calls up the heroes and tells them that something important *is* missing from their fabulous headquarters, and they want to work together to retrieve it.

Cosmic Data

What happened to the data that was stolen from the Baxter Building (and potentially from ESU Stark Research Center) by the Abomination or the evil Winter Soldier? Perhaps an enterprising Hydra agent struck out on their own after the failure of the invasion with other nefarious plans.

Face Off

Any of the villains from Earth-56438 who manage to slip away likely come face-to-face with their Earth-616 counterpart at some point. Characters who are seen as heroes on this world—like Bucky, Hawkeye or Black Widow—do not want their doppelgangers running around causing havoc. Villains like Doctor Octopus and Green Goblin also won't want to share the shadows with some second-rate knockoff with aspirations of grandeur. However, the enemies from Earth-56438, while they don't have as many resources on this world, also have freedom from constraints and deep knowledge of their counterparts to exploit. There are plenty of stories to run with here for as long as the Narrator wants.

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Art by Ruairi Coleman
& Jesus Aburtov

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5

NATIONAL EMERGENCY

After a tumultuous ordeal with the Supremacy, our heroes find themselves safe, not far from Hell's Kitchen.

After taking some time to mend wounds both physical and mental, it is time to figure out where the villains came from, how they got here and who is behind these attacks on the city…possibly even on all of Earth itself.

Rumors are circulating that heroes and villains have been seen in the area around the Convention Center acting out of the ordinary. Even Spider-Woman has been spotted around town in the escort of armed guards, which doesn't make much sense. Could they be agents of the invading Supremacy who have somehow remained on the heroes' Earth? Once again, it is time to go back out into the field to fight to protect Earth and its citizens. Perhaps sometime soon you'll get a break from the action, but today is not that day.

THE BRIEFING

Chapter 5: National Emergency is a full-length adventure for four or five Rank 4 characters. It should take approximately two or three sessions to complete.

The Villains

In the course of the adventure, the heroes should encounter and defeat Hydra guards while in Hudson Yards, as well as various locations on Earth-56438, and the Supremacy team including Killmonger, the Hood, Viper (Ophelia Sarkissian), Abomination, Sabretooth, Gorgon (Tomi Shishido) and Egghead. Lastly, the heroes come face-to-face with the Crimson Surfer, who is serving as a herald of Kang the Devourer to scout out new timelines to consume (though few yet know his true master and think he is leading Galactus).

See Adjusting the Difficulty tables throughout for information on which villains to include for hero teams of different sizes.

The Locations

Earth-56438 Convention Center: Once the portal is accessed, the heroes emerge into the alternate Hydra Earth in the exact same Convention Center in the middle of the night, but strangely, the machine isn't here, where they may expect it to be.

The Supremacy Headquarters: On Earth-56438, Hydra funds a super-powered team of villains called the Supremacy. Inside their headquarters, top Hydra agents work alongside the Supremacy to devise their evil plans to maintain control of their whole world…and plot to take control of other worlds.

The Resistance Hideout: The ragtag group of super heroes still left to fight Hydra is called the resistance, and their modest hideout is where information about how to destroy the portal can be found. The heroes can gain additional insight and clues if they go to the resistance for help.

Horizon Labs: On Earth-56438, Horizon Labs is run by Hydra and was never absorbed by Alchemax as it was on the heroes' Earth. Through investigation of notes and paperwork found here, the heroes discover that Kang, with the help of Egghead, has created technology to pass through to other worlds.

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The Plot

The Supremacy have created a way to travel to the heroes' Earth, and now players must figure out who is behind this plan, travel to the other Earth and find the dimension-hopping machine, and destroy it to keep them from coming back.

A Supremacy agent has set up shop somewhere nearby, and the heroes must follow any leads that can guide them to the source of the threat against their Earth.

THE HEROES

This adventure assumes that the heroes are all Rank 4. You should feel free to tailor it to fit the needs of your group.

Marvel Heroes

The default characters for this adventure are Captain America (Sam Wilson)—whose profile can be found in Chapter 8: Characters—and Beast (Hank McCoy), Black Panther (T'Challa), Moon Knight, Ms. Marvel (Kamala Khan) and Wasp (Janet Van Dyne)—all of whose profiles can be found in the *Core Rulebook*.

Alternatively, the profiles from any previous chapter can be upgraded to Rank 4 and used.

Players may want to choose other Rank 4 characters from the profiles in the *Core Rulebook*, which is okay. Some may have abilities that are a bit overpowered for specific challenges in this adventure. While this issue won't affect the gameplay too negatively, take note as the Narrator to adjust difficulty levels on the spot if, say, a character has a power that allows them to blast through a heavy steel wall that would otherwise provide a fun challenge in the story.

Conversely, certain characters are more conspicuous and have more trouble disguising themselves on the mission, which may make the adventure more difficult. If a player chooses a character that is easily spotted as a super hero and cannot take on a human alias, consider making it more difficult for the Hydra agents to spot them, for the sake of balance.

Additionally, there are a few alternate-universe Rank 4 characters that the heroes encounter in the adventure. If a player chooses one of these characters, it can provide for role-playing opportunities, fun conflict and interesting solutions to the challenges. However, choosing those characters is not optimal for gameplay. As the Narrator, make sure to review the nonplayer characters (NPCs) under the section Heroes in Hiding to make a decision on whether you wish to allow such choices.

Lastly, Spider-Man (Peter Parker) is a Rank 4 character that a player may want to use. Because May Parker plays a role in this adventure, use the choice as an opportunity for some heartfelt role-playing opportunities, but take care not to let it get in the way of the main objective or place the spotlight on only one player.

Original Heroes

If the players have created original characters for the campaign and have reached Rank 4, they can be used with this adventure. If you want the players to create new, original characters, start them at Rank 4.

Adjusting the Difficulty

This chapter is designed for five players of Rank 4 characters. However, the combat encounters within this adventure may be scaled for teams of various sizes. Check the table below each combat description for a guide to adjust the encounter.

THE HOOK

There are several ways to start Chapter 5: National Emergency depending on whether you are continuing it as a campaign from Chapter 4 or running it as a stand-alone adventure.

If you're continuing from Chapter 4, under the leadership of Nick Fury Jr., the heroes saved New York, routed the Hydra threat and closed down the portal at the Convention Center. The portal is under the control of the authorities and interrogations of Earth-56438 Hydra prisoners have begun. While some Hydra stragglers remain in New York, most have retreated back through the portal.

While the major threat of invasion has been stopped, it is feared that Hydra may have other, smaller portals. The threat remains and the heroes must decide their next steps.

If you're using this chapter in a stand-alone adventure, here are a few additional hooks to get players interested in pursuing the Supremacy members:

- Super-powered villains have been spotted in Hell's Kitchen and Hudson Yards, but not the villains the heroes encountered before. Various clues (or perhaps a direct notification from Nick Fury Jr., if he fits into the story) lead to the revelation that something strange is afoot in the city, and the heroes must get to the bottom of it.
- In addition to villains in the city, sightings of Spider-Woman in Hudson Yards, fraternizing with obvious Hydra agents acting as her security patrol, have been brought to the heroes' attention. However, the heroes have intel that Spider-Woman is actually on a classified mission somewhere in Europe, so who is this impostor and what is her intention?
- Strange glowing lights have been witnessed in the middle of the night at the Convention Center. Contacting any supervising agency, such as the Department of Homeland Security (DHS), reveals that an interdimensional gateway has been opened into this Earth. But who is behind it and why?

THE PLOT

The adventure takes place in roughly four parts.

1. The characters, on a mission to use the portal gateway in the Convention Center to travel to Earth-56438 and destroy the Multiverse-hopping technology once and for all, must find the correct codes to enter into the control panel. They investigate the rumors in Hell's Kitchen that Spider-Woman (Jessica Drew) is still at large and has been spotted at Luq, a restaurant in Hudson Yards. She is their best bet to retrieve the secret code to access the portal and the trajectory to the correct alternate Earth.

   Spider-Woman is an undercover resistance member from Earth-56438, posing within the Supremacy ranks, left in this dimension to manage a small Hydra contingent looking for any opportunity to regain control of the portal at the Convention Center. She has the code but cannot reveal her true allegiance, so the heroes must either figure out her motives and meet with her discreetly or plan an attack to get the code. During this exchange, players learn of the resistance movement on Hydra Earth.

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2. The characters encounter Hydra security agents on their way back to the Convention Center from Luq. Once clear of the Hydra agents, the code can be used to access the correct universe via the portal, allowing travel to Earth-56438. Obstacles include combat with the Hydra agents, which could lead to damage to the portal itself if the heroes are followed, as well as tension that Spider-Woman may have set the heroes up for a trap.
3. The characters teleport to Earth-56438, where they suffer side effects from the travel and are surprised that the machine is not in the counterpart Convention Center as was suspected.

   Using the information from Spider-Woman and speaking with the citizens of Earth-56438, the characters may choose to investigate the Supremacy headquarters or find the resistance movement.

   The Supremacy headquarters has information about the portal and its location, as well as potential early combat, but the Supremacy retreat and come back more powerful for the final showdown if any combat is initiated. If the heroes gain access to records within the Supremacy headquarters, they gain maps and work orders for Horizon Labs. Proper investigation of the various offices will reveal evidence that America Chavez is on the premises.

   If the heroes go straight to the resistance movement, they are not trusted at first, as they are seen as potential threats disguised as heroes. Once they earn the trust of the resistance members, they are told about the portal at Horizon Labs, as well as the fact that America Chavez is being held against her will somewhere in the Supremacy's headquarters.
4. The characters arrive at Horizon Labs, where they encounter the Supremacy team and confirm the existence of the portal. Here they combat the Supremacy team members and figure out a way to destroy the machine, and return to their own dimension.

These parts are meant to be run in order over the course of multiple play sessions, but they may also be interspersed with other scenes in a custom storyline or spread out further over time. If characters increase in power or number, be sure to adjust the challenges using the Adjusting the Difficulty sections in this chapter.

HIJINKS IN HELL'S KITCHEN

Located in the western part of Manhattan, Hell's Kitchen is a place where the streets were once stained with the blood of countless gangsters and criminals, but in recent times, new businesses and housing developments have replaced the feeling of desperation and despair.

Still, the buildings are tall and imposing, casting long shadows that seem to swallow up anyone who walks beneath them. The streets are home to businesses, warehouses and brownstone apartments, lined with dark

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alleyways and spotted with abandoned buildings that seem to whisper secrets of the past.

At night, the only lights come from flickering neon signs and the occasional streetlamp, casting an eerie glow over the cracked pavement. The sound of gunfire is now a rare backdrop to life in Hell's Kitchen, but the distant sirens are a reminder to its residents that danger is always just around the corner.

Regardless of the chaos and violence that breaks out when villains are afoot, the city is rife with pockets of hope and humanity. There are people who believe in justice and are willing to fight for it, even if it means risking their own lives. Known heroes like Daredevil and Jessica Jones call Hell's Kitchen home, using their unique abilities to protect the innocent and bring down the corrupt, but currently, the threat that infiltrates the city is bigger than what even they can handle on their own.

The threat to the city may have been thwarted by dismantling the portal in the Convention Center, but the fate of the rest of the world now hangs in the balance, at least until the portal technology is destroyed completely.

Word on the Street

When the heroes step onto the streets of Hell's Kitchen during the day, rumors abound that super-powered beings are still being spotted in town. Interviewing residents or eavesdropping on local chatter reveals the following:

- Spider-Woman was spotted with several shady-looking men, wearing jetpacks and armored in tactical gear bearing Hydra logos. The man who witnessed the incident regales a woman with the details, to which she questions audibly, *"Isn't Spider-Woman an Avenger?"*
- A crew from the construction company Damage Control, Inc. with the same branded trucks seen in front of the Convention Center a few weeks earlier has just finished a job in Hudson Yards. Two workers wearing Damage Control uniforms are having lunch at a kabob stand on the street, discussing openly that Ms. Drew arranged for special dinner reservations at Luq as a thank-you for their hard work.
- Luq is a brand-new restaurant and hotspot that is open in Hudson Yards, an emerging housing and retail development near the Convention Center. Reservations must be booked in advance, and there are none available for the next five weeks.

Damage Control Inc.

Damage Control is a specialized construction company that focuses on repairing and rebuilding properties damaged by superhuman battles and disasters throughout New York City. With a team of highly skilled employees, the company has a proven track record of delivering high-quality projects on time and within budget, offering a wide range of specialized construction services.

The company has gained a reputation in the city for quickly responding to disasters and catastrophic events. With many jobs of this nature in their work history, Damage Control has curated specialized teams that can safely contain and dispose of hazardous materials left behind after a superhuman battle.

This specialty notwithstanding, with its unique range of services, specialized equipment and a proven track record of success, Damage Control is a reliable choice for any construction job. Their materials and techniques used to reinforce buildings to better withstand superhuman battles and other hazards make them a superior choice for mundane construction projects as well.

Recently, Damage Control construction trucks were seen outside the Convention Center while they performed renovations to lower-floor rooms inside. Two of the crew members from the Convention Center job, Jerry and Mike, frequent the food carts in Hell's Kitchen on their breaks. If questioned, they willingly brag about the fine work they did on the job, but they do not reveal that Jessica Drew hired them unless the heroes make an Ego vs. TN 14 action check.

While their initial discussion about having reservations at Luq the following evening can be overheard with clever eavesdropping, neither Jerry nor Mike reveal full details without a Fantastic success on a Challenging Ego check. Appealing to either man's ego allows a success of this type to draw specific details about how Jessica Drew was in charge of the Convention Center remodel project to house some specialized machinery that only she knows how to operate and that she will be dining at Luq at the same time as the pair, albeit at a different table. How exciting just to be in the same room with someone so famous!

Spider-Woman

If the heroes look into the whereabouts of Spider-Woman, all intel points to her being off on a classified mission somewhere in Europe. Contact with Nick Fury Jr. or any supervising agency confirms that while her exact location cannot be revealed, Spider-Woman is on an assignment with other trusted individuals who have confirmed her presence. All sightings of her exploits in New York must be false or a sign that someone is impersonating Spider-Woman. If players do not determine that the Spider-Woman seen recently is from the other Earth, it can be revealed with a successful Logic vs. TN 14 action check.

Characters who have worked with Spider-Woman or who are familiar with her history know that she was once in league with Hydra, later joining up with both S.H.I.E.L.D. and S.W.O.R.D. and later still working with various super-hero teams, such as the Avengers, for good and not evil doings. However, it cannot be determined whether the Jessica Drew of Hydra from Earth-56438 has followed the same path.

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SUBJECT: JESSICA DREW

Codename: Spider-Woman
Date of Birth: Unknown

Background

Jessica Drew's origins are shrouded in mystery, but according to our sources, she was born to Jonathan and Miriam Drew, two scientists working on an experimental serum to create Super-Soldiers. When Miriam was exposed to dangerous levels of radiation during her pregnancy, she was injected with an experimental serum to save her life, which also had the unintended consequence of altering Jessica's DNA, giving her superhuman abilities.

Training & Abilities

As a teen, Jessica was trained by Hydra to be an assassin. Her exceptional physical and combat skills were honed by this ruthless organization, optimizing her superhuman strength, agility and endurance. She can cling to walls and surfaces like a spider and has the ability to emit powerful bio-electric venom blasts from her hands.

Evaluation

Given her unique set of abilities and her history with both S.H.I.E.L.D. and Hydra, Jessica Drew could be a valuable asset in certain circumstances. However, her past affiliation with Hydra should be taken into consideration when determining her level of trustworthiness.

Characters unfamiliar with Spider-Woman can either request information from Nick Fury Jr. or attempt to research old S.H.I.E.L.D. or other agencies' archives, revealing the limited information found on an intake report dated years before Jessica Drew's full acceptance within the Avengers. See SUBJECT: JESSICA DREW above.

If Spider-Woman is on the current hero team, it is a given that the Spider-Woman spotted in Hell's Kitchen with Hydra agents is either an impostor or a different version who has come through the portal. Do not worry about this situation, as it can foster interesting role-playing opportunities should the player character and NPC meet.

LUCK AT LUQ

After hearing various clues around Hell's Kitchen, the heroes should know that a Jessica Drew not of Earth-616 will be dining at Luq in Hudson Yards in the next 24–48 hours. They may choose to make a plan to intercept her to retrieve the secret code by coercion or force, or they may attempt to get the code another way.

There are a few paths to gaining the code:

- The heroes engage Jessica Drew with hostility either outside the restaurant or inside if they want to cause a scene, likely triggering combat with Spider-Woman and many Hydra guards.
- The heroes attempt to meet Jessica Drew at the restaurant calmly, either to gauge her loyalty to Hydra or to try to convince her to choose a more noble path.
- The heroes lay a trap to arrest/abduct Jessica Drew, in order to extract the code another way on their own turf.

Hudson Yards

Hudson Yards is a gleaming new neighborhood on the West side of Manhattan, rising like a futuristic metropolis amid the gritty, industrial backdrop of New York City. It's a place where towering skyscrapers and sleek, modern buildings seem to touch the sky, a stark contrast to the low-rise brownstones and tenements of nearby neighborhoods like Hell's Kitchen.

The entire neighborhood is an architectural marvel, with cutting-edge designs and state-of-the-art technology at every turn. Inside these buildings are some of the most exclusive living accommodations in the city, catering to a wealthy and discerning clientele. From spacious penthouses to modern apartments with sweeping views of the city, Hudson Yards offers a lifestyle that's second to none.

There is a plethora of shops to visit in Hudson Yards, dotted between acres of lush gardens, public plazas and art installations. The heroes are able to find everything they may need, from snacks at a local bodega specializing in cheese to high-end custom leather clothiers to advanced-technology dealers. The courtyard in front of Luq restaurant features a circle of carved stone benches, installed as part of a local art initiative, with a shimmering reflection pool made of steel and obsidian in the center, in a stark clash of aesthetics, representing the city's diversity.

Hydra guards patrol the area surrounding Luq, while Jessica Drew dines inside. See the table under Adjusting the Difficulty on page 98 for how many guards should be present. The guards do not leave their posts unless they are engaged, hear trouble from inside or spot suspicious behavior or super-heroic activity. The Hydra guards can see a sneaking hero by making a successful Vigilance check against the character's Agility defense.

Fromage et Vino

Next door to Luq is a charming cheese specialty bodega called Fromage et Vino. There is a sign displayed prominently in the window that says *"Fromage et Vino is the proud cheesemonger for Hudson Yards' newest restaurant: Luq."* It goes on to describe that the shop is renowned for its extensive assortment of artisanal cheeses, including rare and hard-to-find varieties from France, Italy, Spain and other countries.

Upon entering the bodega, the heroes are greeted by the aroma of freshly baked baguettes and a diverse selection of cheeses from all over the world. The shop is cozy and compact, with wooden shelves lining the walls and a large display case filled with cheese and charcuterie. Additionally, there are a few small tables and chairs where visitors can sit and enjoy a cheese plate or a glass of wine. The tables are adorned with fresh flowers and candles, creating a romantic and intimate ambiance.

The owner of the shop is a 40-year-old French expat named Jacques, who moved to the United States several years ago to pursue his passion for cheese. Jacques takes great pride in sourcing only the highest-quality cheeses and offering personalized recommendations to his patrons. In the back of the shop, there's a small counter where customers can place their orders and chat with Jacques about his latest offerings. Jacques has a naturally calm demeanor and endearing naivete to business outside of his knowledge of the cheese industry.

If the heroes question Jacques about Luq, he praises the restaurant and comments that he eats there often. With continued conversation, he brags openly about his partnership with Luq and other restaurants around town, speaking in detail of his connections to each restaurant's manager and his ability to get a reservation at the best

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tables whenever he wishes. It's important to note that restaurant reservations are often highly sought after and can be difficult to secure, even with the help of a well-connected individual like Jacques. However, with his knowledge of the industry and his close connections to the managers, Jacques would certainly be able to call in a favor and secure a highly coveted reservation for his most-valued customers.

The heroes can convince Jacques to make a reservation in their name with an Ego vs. TN 12 action check. This check gains an edge if a hero is especially complimentary of the bodega or convincingly displays a great knowledge of cheese.

If the heroes choose not to interact with Jacques, they can discover that the back door of the bodega leads to an alley that shares trash cans with Luq—and its own back door.

Luq Restaurant

At the heart of Hudson Yards lies Luq, the newest restaurant hotspot, a place where culinary artistry meets impeccable decor and ambiance that exudes sophistication. The restaurant is a stylish space, with floor-to-ceiling windows that offer breathtaking views of the city. The clientele is a mix of business executives, socialites and other high-net-worth individuals, all drawn to the upscale atmosphere and unique dining experience. This is a place where deals are made over exquisite meals and where the elite come to see and to be seen. A discerning player may wonder why Jessica Drew aims to be seen at all, especially now.

Inside, the decor is a modern masterpiece, with clean lines and bold colors creating a striking visual experience. The menu is equally impressive, featuring innovative dishes that push the boundaries of traditional cuisine. Each dish is a work of art, carefully crafted by expert chefs who are passionate about their craft.

If the heroes enter via the front entrance, they're greeted by a host of impeccably dressed staff, all eager to cater to their every need. A party cannot be seated without a reservation, although with a successful Ego vs. TN 10 action check or a well-placed bribe, the host is able to "miraculously" find a table.

- If the heroes attempt to hide their identities, the host and waiter each roll to determine if they are recognized. If unrecognized, the heroes are seated in a corner booth in the restaurant, with enough line of sight to spot Jessica Drew dining at her own table nearby. The waiter or host recognizes a hero with a succesful Vigilance vs. Vigilance action check. Use the Average Civilian profile from the *Core Rulebook* for the waiter or host's stats.
- If the heroes did not attempt to disguise themselves (or if they are recognized from the roll above), the host audibly gasps when they enter and makes a big show of seating them at the centermost table in the room in order to show off what types of "celebrities" the restaurant attracts to other diners. This makes the heroes visible to Jessica Drew immediately.

If the heroes enter via the back-alley door, they must navigate through the lower kitchen prep area and up the elevator to the food-check and service area, which connects to the main restaurant through swinging double doors.

- The lower kitchen has a storage and receiving area where heroes can find waiters' uniforms, kitchen trays, serving ware and anything required by the restaurant.
- In the lower-kitchen prep area, three chefs diligently cut vegetables and do not look up unless disturbed.
- The main cooking is done in the upper kitchen, which is a chaotic scene of sous chefs and kitchen staff working with great speed and focus. They do not stop their orders unless someone or something gets in the way of them plating food on the service counter on time.
- The service counter houses plates of dinners, which are picked up by waiters to be delivered to tables and replaced immediately.
- If the heroes navigate the kitchens without causing a disturbance or blend in as chefs or waiters, they make it to the dining room and spot Jessica Drew easily. Any disruption in the kitchen causes an audible kerfuffle, alerting Jessica Drew to a potential problem. A disruption that is not quieted quickly causes the restaurant host to go downstairs to contact the Hydra guards outside for help.

Dinner With Drew

Once the heroes approach Jessica Drew, they have a few options on how to engage. The heroes may or may not know that Earth-56438 Jessica Drew is secretly a double agent with allegiance to the resistance, while pretending to oversee the agents sent here for Hydra. Even with this knowledge, the heroes may not trust her or any information she gives them. However, Jessica Drew quietly helps the heroes in earnest, putting on an act of hatred if any Hydra guards are within view.

If the heroes trust her, she finds the correct time out of earshot of any guards or outsiders to reveal the secret code.

However, if the heroes do not trust her, they still have options to obtain the information. Jessica Drew has the secret code (choose whether it is deciphered or not) written on a napkin in her pocket, but the heroes need to find it if she doesn't give it to them willingly due to their mistrust.

- If the heroes question her in an accusing way, she does her best to appease their concerns while pleading with them to stay calm and quiet.
- If the heroes attack her with intent to kill, she causes a distraction to attempt to escape, dropping the napkin conspicuously for the heroes to find but leaving them to deal with her guards, who arrive to defend her.
- If the heroes attack her with intent to capture, she makes a show for the guards but does not attack the heroes, going along willingly without putting up too much of a fight. The Hydra guards will attack if they see Drew get captured. Once the heroes bring her to a safe location away from the guards, Jessica Drew tells them about the resistance on Earth-56438 and hands the heroes the napkin with the deciphered code.

Aside from the code, Jessica Drew has other vital information for the heroes. If the conversation is cooperative, she gives more information than if combat ensues. Due to her role as a double agent within the Supremacy, the Hydra team of super-powered individuals on Earth-56438, as well

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Art by Emma Ríos & Antonio Fabela

as her role within the resistance, she can share the following if asked, as long as no Hydra agents are within earshot:

- The Supremacy headquarters is not only home to the offices of Hydra figureheads, containing records, dossiers and plans for future projects, but it is literally where the Supremacy members live while on duty in the tristate region of New York, New Jersey and Connecticut.
- The portal must be completely destroyed from the Earth-56438 side in order to stop Hydra from replicating the technology to send armies through to this Earth in different countries for a mass invasion. That "mother" portal is located in a laboratory somewhere in New York City.
- The resistance has a secret hideout in Hell's Kitchen. They meet in the upper floor apartment of a brownstone above a shuttered bookstore, once called The Book Nook.
- Resistance members on Earth-56438 include America Chavez, Maria Hill, J. Jonah Jameson, Nighthawk (Kyle Richmond), Stick, May Parker, Storm and formerly Steve Rogers, who was recently killed in action. She assures the heroes that any of these members can be trusted if encountered.

Secret Code

Jessica Drew can't simply hand over the code for the portal without being seen and outed as a traitor to Hydra. However, once the heroes convince her that they will go to Earth-56438 to destroy the portal machine and sever the link to this Earth, she says, *"Look at my* eyes *and then order"* and gives them the following secret code to decipher (see page 98):

A spicy ahi tuna with wasabi glaze appetizer is on the way.

The watermelon and mint salad was highly recommended.

The special tonight is lobster saffron risotto.

The bartender's premium cocktail is a Thai basil and ginger mojito.

The best dessert here is the matcha tiramisu.

You may decide that the secret code puzzle isn't right for your play group or that it will add encounter time that doesn't meet the requirements of your play session. Regardless, if you wish to cut the deciphering of the code out of the mission, Jessica Drew simply pulls a paper napkin (on which she has written the already-deciphered code) out of her pocket and hands it to the heroes, risking being caught in the act.

Getting Out of Hudson Yards

If the heroes manage to obtain the secret code from Jessica Drew without incident, they may attempt to sneak out of the restaurant and back through Hudson Yards toward the Convention Center without being detected. Once again, any Hydra guard on alert at their post sees a sneaking hero with a successful Vigilance check against the character's Agility defense. If the guards were not called to the restaurant, they remain at their posts, and it takes three checks, representing three guards at posts on the way from Luq to the Convention Center to make it out of Hudson Yards without incident, requiring all heroes to succeed against the guards' rolls.

A guard who spots an undisguised hero leaving the restaurant alerts all other undefeated guards to the problem, advancing the encounter to The Fight, as described below.

If the heroes succeed in stealthily exiting Hudson Yards, the guards do not pursue, skipping The Fight.

The Fight

The Hydra guards pursue and attack the heroes until Jessica Drew commands them to stop, as long as she has their trust.

If the heroes attempt to outrun the guards, the guards continue to follow their trail to the Convention Center, taking the fight to the portal, which may put the machinery at risk.

If the guards have any inkling that Jessica Drew has helped the heroes, they act as if they are running away from the combat. Instead, they disappear until the heroes are inside the Convention Center, where they appear once more with reinforcements to try to stop the heroes from using the code. This adds one extra guard for every two player characters.

If the heroes are defeated, the guards keep them alive, if possible, for further questioning from their commanders. They are taken to a warehouse in Hell's Kitchen and locked in

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an aluminum storage container until the following morning, when Hydra commanders arrive.

In the meantime, the heroes may attempt to escape using powers, calling for assistance or breaking through the aluminum, which requires a Melee vs. TN 16 action check. Failed attempts to break the container result in a standard damage roll with a ×1 damage multiplier.

Adjusting the Difficulty

Use the following table to adjust the encounter for teams of various sizes:

Number of Heroes	Luq, Hudson Yards
3	6 Hydra guards
4	7 Hydra guards
5	8 Hydra guards
6	9 Hydra guards
7	10 Hydra guards

INTO THE UNKNOWN

Once the heroes are safely inside the Convention Center with no other Hydra guards pursuing them, they must decipher the code (see Deciphering the Code, below) to set the portal to the correct Earth designation in order to travel to Earth-56438. Once the code is entered correctly, the portal is ready for use.

The Convention Center

Tonight the Convention Center is dark. The lights that were seen emanating from the glass windows of the building over the last few weeks have gone now that the gateway is back under the heroes' control. With the imminent threat gone and the portal under government control, two U.S. DHS guards stand at attention at the main entrance of the building, checking credentials of anyone who tries to enter the building and keeping general watch on the area.

If the chase from Hudson Yards continues to the outside of the Convention Center, the DHS guards engage in the combat, taking their action at the end of the initiative order. Use the S.H.I.E.L.D. Agent profile (in the *Core Rulebook*) for the DHS guards, with their allegiance unwavering to the U.S. government and the heroes.

The large, open convention space now only houses the framework of the gateway, with a simple control panel that creates a ring of light with the correct code. Until then, if a fight breaks out in the building, the heroes can at least rest assured that there is plenty of open space away from endangering any citizens.

Portal Damage

If the fight from Hudson Yards is taken to the Convention Center and into the room with the portal, every time an attack is missed against either an NPC or a hero, roll a d6. With every 1 that is rolled, the portal takes damage as shown on the following table.

Damage Portal Effects

Damage	Effect
1	All characters make a Resilience vs. TN 10 action check. Any character who passes through the portal but fails the check is demoralized and their Focus drops to 0.
2	All characters make a Resilience vs. TN 12 action check. Any character who passes through the portal but fails the check is demoralized and their Focus drops to 0.
3	All characters make a Resilience vs. TN 12 action check. Any character who passes through the portal but fails the check suffers –1 to their Resilience until they are able to recover.
4	All characters make a Resilience vs. TN 14 action check. Any character who passes through the portal but fails the check suffers –1 to their Resilience and is shattered until they are able to recover.
5+	The portal shorts out all technology carried by anyone who travels through it. All characters who use the portal lose all of their technology-related powers until they are able to recover. All characters make a Resilience vs. TN 14 action check. Any character who passes through the portal but fails the check remains conscious but with 1 point of Health remaining.

The portal works and carries the heroes to Earth-56438, regardless of the damage. However, they suffer the resulting effect.

Any of this damage can be fixed prior to teleporting if the heroes choose to return to Hudson Yards and pick up parts from the technology store there. While the portal mechanism is difficult to understand, with a rare chance that any of the heroes have seen such technology before, any hero can make a Logic vs. TN 14 action check to identify and match a broken part with a new one at the shop.

Alternatively, if the players played through Chapter 2: Origin Story and encountered the crates in the courtyard at Prano's, they can return there to find parts or use any they may have taken.

Deciphering the Code

The code given to the heroes at the restaurant has five sentences. The computer terminal on the portal is set to receive a 5-digit number as a target destination. Entering "56438" to get to Earth-56438 is incorrect, giving the heroes a message of *"Error: Destination Not Found."*

Instead, the heroes must determine that Jessica Drew's words "Look at my eyes" really refer to the number of letter

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I's that appear in each sentence, and enter them in order into the computer terminal.

The solution is "62473," solved as follows:

- A spicy ahi tuna with wasabi glaze appetizer is on the way: **6**
- The watermelon and mint salad was highly recommended: **2**
- The special tonight is lobster saffron risotto: **4**
- The bartender's premium cocktail is a Thai basil and ginger mojito: **7**
- The best dessert here is the matcha tiramisu: **3**

If the players are not engaged in solving this puzzle or seem to be stuck, ask each hero to make a Logic vs. TN 10 action check to get a clue that each sentence is associated with a number. If the player rolls a 15 or more on the Logic check, the hero realizes that "eyes" really means the letter I and that is what should be counted.

A Flash of Light

Using the control panel causes a burst of crackling blue light to fill the Convention Center. As the hum of the electricity grows, the blue light condenses into a perfect circle, forming the gateway back to Earth-56438.

Once the heroes pass through the gateway and suffer any ill effects, they find themselves standing in an empty version of the Convention Center. A broken wooden pallet sits in the corner of the room and a few discarded flyers lie strewn about the bare floors, but the rest of the hall is barren. There is no portal here.

ANOTHER WORLD: EARTH-56438

The history and briefing on the current state of Earth-56438 can be found in Chapter 1: Ready for Adventure. However, it is likely that the heroes never saw Earth-56438 before now, unless some early mistakes were made in their mission.

In the few weeks since the smaller portal in Prano's was destroyed, changes have been made on Earth-56438 as well, and the makeshift laboratory that was on their world has been moved to a more secure facility.

The streets of Manhattan are crowded as usual during the day, but after 7 p.m., the streets lie barren, save for the occasional Hydra agents patrolling the area. The Hydra flag flutters high and proud atop most buildings, a constant reminder of the brutal regime that now controls the city. Green and yellow insignias, the colors of Hydra, are painted on each building, mailbox, fire hydrant and billboard, demonstrating the hold Hydra has on both government and civil businesses, as if the city itself has been infected by their ideology.

Art by Jonathan & Joshua Luna

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Hydra Agents and the Supremacy

Hydra law-enforcement officers are a ubiquitous presence, with their distinctive green-and-yellow uniforms and ominous masks. They patrol every corner of the city, dispensing swift justice on the spot for even the slightest infractions, bypassing the overwhelmed court system. The fear of being arrested or worse still, executed, is palpable among the residents of Manhattan. This fear is seen on the faces of the citizens, who keep their eyes forward and set their strides at a quickened pace to their destinations, lest they dawdle and get caught up in needless trouble.

Hydra's obsession with suppressing any form of superhuman ability is evident in their approach to crime prevention. Anyone displaying even the slightest hint of superhuman powers is immediately arrested and detained without trial. The only exception is if the individual has Hydra identification or is well-known to the authorities. Hydra's ruthless approach to law enforcement ensures that they are always one step ahead of the resistance, striking fear into the hearts of any potential dissenters.

Upon inspection of flyers and billboards in the city, it is evident to the heroes that there is a distinction between the typical Hydra agent patrolling the city and a leading force of Hydra members called the Supremacy. These super-powered Hydra members are Earth-56438's equivalent of the Avengers, with a very different agenda. Propaganda posters around the city feature the Supremacy's main figureheads, some of whom the heroes may recognize and some who may be unfamiliar: Spider-Woman, Egghead, Viper, Sabretooth, Killmonger, Abomination, Gorgon (Tomi Shishido) and the Hood.

Depending on the heroes' interaction with Jessica Drew back on their Earth, they may or may not be surprised to see her face on the posters. If they know she is a spy within the Hydra ranks, hopefully they take care to protect her secret.

Heroes in Hiding

Hydra's regime on Earth-56438 is particularly dire for the heroes or anyone who attempts to aid them. The mere presence of a non-Hydra super hero is enough to attract the attention of Hydra agents, who immediately assume that they are part of the resistance. If a hero tries to escape arrest, the agents have orders to shoot to kill, and they do not hesitate to carry out those orders. Hydra views heroes as nothing more than violent terrorists, and they will not allow them to run wild in their city.

Whispers of the resistance are scarce, as the general public does not speak openly of them out of fear of torture or punishment. Overall, the citizens of this Earth are supportive of Hydra. Whether this allegiance to Hydra stems from brainwashing and indoctrination from childhood, simple fear or legitimate belief, there are more that choose to follow and live with Hydra's control than those who choose to fight it.

However, the resistance movement on Earth-56438 grows in secret, with Jessica Drew's help as one of their leaders. She has been infiltrating the Supremacy for years, and her resistance heroes fight from the shadows. Finding their whereabouts requires investigation, unless she has traveled back to Earth-56438 with the group. If she was left back on the heroes' Earth, they must find the resistance on their own.

Art by Roland Boschi & Chris Chuckry

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In addition to Spider-Woman, the known resistance members on Earth-56438 are as follows (and have the same base-character statistics as their Earth-616 counterparts).

America Chavez

Chavez's indomitable spirit and unwavering courage inspire those around her to keep fighting, even in the darkest of times. Her ability to punch through dimensions and travel through time has proven invaluable to the resistance, allowing them to follow Hydra forces as they scout the Multiverse for targets. However, her dimension-hopping powers make her a valuable target for Hydra and the Supremacy as they research new ways to gain access to other worlds.

Captain America (Steve Rogers)—rumored as deceased

A symbol of hope and freedom on Earth-56438, just as he is on the heroes' Earth, Steve Rogers inspires countless others to join the resistance and fight against Hydra and the Supremacy. He is the public voice of the resistance, risking it all to spread the vision of the American ideals of liberty and justice they are fighting for. He is an invaluable asset on the front lines, where he leads by example and inspires others to follow that lead.

Rumors of his death on another Earth have reached the resistance movement here, where they are actively trying to keep the news from the public for the sake of morale and peace. If the heroes played through Chapter 2, they can confirm Rogers' death for the resistance members.

Ironheart (Riri Williams)

Ironheart's belief in the power of individuality and the importance of free thought counters a Hydra-run world in every facet. As someone who values education, creativity and the ability to push boundaries, Riri is determined to resist Hydra's attempts to stifle innovation and impose their will on the people. She uses her genius-level intellect and her Ironheart suit to fight against Hydra's forces, both in open conflict and in covert operations. Her technical expertise and mechanical plans to build counteractive measures against the machines in the Hydra lab, as well as her technological analysis of the portals, have been invaluable in the resistance's attempts to stop Hydra from continuing their invasion.

J. Jonah Jameson

After Hydra forcibly closed the *Daily Bugle* and called for J. Jonah Jameson's arrest for posting anti-Hydra sentiment, he became a fiery, passionate resistance fighter against the tyrannical regime. A natural leader with an uncanny ability to inspire and rally his fellow fighters, Jameson's experience as a journalist and his keen eye for detail make him an invaluable asset to the resistance. He is always on the lookout for new sources of information that can be used to undermine Hydra's grip on power. His wit, quick thinking and willingness to take bold risks have made him a thorn in Hydra's side. Despite his gruff exterior and no-nonsense attitude, Jameson is fiercely loyal to his friends and comrades in arms, and he would do anything to protect them and the cause for which they fight.

Maria Hill

On Earth-56438, Hill was never a S.H.I.E.L.D. agent, though her natural tactical and strategic mindset that would have led her down that path make her a valuable asset to the resistance. Hill's sharp intellect and keen eye for detail make her an expert in gathering intelligence and planning operations to undermine Hydra's grip on power. Her combat skills and resourcefulness in the face of adversity have proven crucial in many battles against Hydra's forces. Despite the constant danger and high stakes of their mission, Hill remains focused and determined, knowing that the fate of their world hangs in the balance.

May Parker

On any Earth, May Parker knows right from wrong and when it is time to stand up for the latter. On Earth-56438, May is a bit tougher with a darker past, but she remains a wise and compassionate mentor figure. May's sense of responsibility and her deep love for her fellow human beings drive her to fight against Hydra's control of the world. Her wisdom, natural charisma and ability to connect with people from all walks of life help her rally people behind the cause. Moreover, her ability to blend in with the population of New York City as an older woman makes May a perfect spy.

Mockingbird (Bobbi Morse)

Hydra's tactics of fear and intimidation are a direct affront to Bobbi's sense of justice and fairness. As someone who has always stood up against bullies and those who seek to exploit others, Bobbi sees Hydra as the ultimate bully and is determined to defeat them. Bobbi was formerly in law enforcement but left when she understood the cruelty of Hydra, and her training gives her the ability and skill to develop and execute effective plans to take down Hydra.

Nighthawk (Kyle Richmond)

Kyle Richmond, better known as Nighthawk, is a skilled and deadly super hero with a sharp intellect and strategic mind. His proficiency in hand-to-hand combat, as well as his advanced technology and weaponry, have allowed him to take down some of Hydra's most dangerous agents. Despite his reputation as a loner, Nighthawk has formed close bonds with his fellow fighters, and his unwavering loyalty to the cause has earned him their respect and admiration. He is known for keeping a cool head under pressure and his willingness to take calculated risks to achieve the resistance's goals, but he wouldn't think twice before laying down his life for the cause, if necessary.

Shang-Chi

Shang-Chi is a skilled martial artist and defender of the innocent, and Hydra's manipulation and control of citizens for their own gain are anathema to his sense of honor and justice. As an immigrant from China who watched Hydra's control of all governmental organizations spread across the world and into his own homeland, he recognizes Hydra as a dangerous and powerful enemy that must be stopped before their reign spreads to other Earths as well.

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Stick
Stick's years of experience as a martial-arts master and leader of the Chaste have honed his combat skills and strategic mind. His heightened senses and ability to perceive his opponents' movements make him a formidable opponent on the battlefield. He is an expert in guerrilla warfare, using his knowledge of tactics and strategy to disrupt Hydra's operations and sow chaos among their ranks. Despite his brusque demeanor and tendency to work alone, Stick cares for his companions, and his unwavering commitment to the cause inspires them to keep fighting. He is known for his unorthodox methods and willingness to take risks, even when the odds are against him.

Storm (Ororo Munroe)
As a hero and a leader, Storm has a strong motivation to fight against Hydra's oppressive rule. Hydra seeks to dominate and control all aspects of society, suppressing individuality and freedom. As someone who values independence and equality, Storm views Hydra's actions as a direct threat to her beliefs. Additionally, as a mutant, Storm is part of a group that is often targeted and discriminated against by those in power, making Hydra's actions against mutants (and all super-powered heroes) particularly egregious in her eyes. Storm's ultimate goal is to protect the rights and freedoms of all people, regardless of their background or abilities, and in this world, that means taking down Hydra, once and for all.

The Thing (Ben Grimm)
When Reed Richards was being pursued by Captain America for being part of the Illuminati, Hydra recruited Susan Storm (also known as the Invisible Woman) as an agent, convincing her that with their help, she could help her husband. Once she fell under Hydra control, a rift was formed within the Fantastic Four on how to proceed as a super-hero team. Ever since, the Thing, also known as Ben Grimm, has fought to bring Hydra down, turn Susan Storm back to their side and reunite their family. Hydra's efforts to control every aspect of society and eliminate those who stand in their way is a constant challenge to the Thing's sense of accountability and self-determination. As someone who values strength, bravery and perseverance, he sees Hydra as the ultimate foe that must be defeated. The Thing is willing to risk everything to ensure that his fellow heroes and the people he cares about are protected from Hydra's control.

The members of the resistance want to help the heroes destroy the portal once and for all, but they cannot risk decimating their limited forces. Any of the characters can be introduced into the story to aid with information, research and strategy, but once combat begins, the heroes are basically on their own, unless they choose to find America Chavez or can convince a few resistance members to tag along. It is recommended that only two join the party, if needed for better balance (depending on the player characters) and contribute to combat only when necessary. This is the heroes' fight and their Earth to defend, after all.

Mission Targets
The main objective of the heroes while on Earth-56438 is to find the portal, figure out how to destroy it and return back to their own Earth somehow while doing so. The last bit, and the order in which to accomplish it, is the tricky part, but there are multiple ways to succeed.

In order to find the information to destroy the portal, the heroes may interact with citizens on the street, visit the Supremacy headquarters, find the resistance hideout or discover the portal itself, in any order. However, the latter can be difficult without completing at least a few of the previous steps. In any case, the heroes may do any or all of these, and there is no need to lead them in the direction in which they are presented. Simply jump to the heading necessary once the group decides where to go.

Citizens in Distress
The people of New York on Earth-56438 have a vastly different demeanor than those known by the heroes on their Earth. Here the average citizen's life is one of constant fear and uncertainty. The streets are patrolled by Hydra agents and people are forced to live under their watchful eyes. The city is a bleak and oppressive place, with little hope for change.

Those who are not in direct employment of Hydra or in middle-class (or above) households are forced to live in cramped and squalid conditions. Housing and food are scarce and expensive, especially in the city. Many citizens are forced to rely on Hydra-issued ration cards. These cards are often difficult to obtain, and while the people tend to fall in line with Hydra ideology, they do know that the resistance are the only ones who have made an effort to make living conditions better for those who can't afford more in a Hydra-run world.

The people most negatively affected by the Hydra regime are also the ones with their ears closest to the ground. Spending time on the streets makes a person observant and available to listen in on passersby. If a hero succeeds on an Ego vs. TN 10 action check against a citizen, they are told one of the following rumors:

- *"I heard Hydra has spies posing as normal citizens, looking and listening for clues to the whereabouts of the resistance."*
- *"The resistance and all who are seen with them are targets. America Chavez wasn't the first to be taken, and she won't be the last."*
- *"The Supremacy Headquarters is home to a lot of secrets, and I'm not just talking about what's behind their coffee bar."*
- *"I heard Hydra is doing illegal scientific testing on prisoners being held at Horizon Labs."*
- *"Stay away from Horizon Labs in Manhattan—it's a Hydra research facility, and if you trespass, they'll arrest you…if you're lucky."*
- *"My cousin was tricked and then executed by a Hydra agent claiming to be a resistance fighter. Once she showed interest, he called her a traitor, and there's no going back from that."*
- *"Hydra has been building something strange in the city, and it's making everyone nervous."*
- *"My brother works for Hydra, and he told me we'll all be leaving this Multiverse very soon. It's going to save our lives!"*

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THE SUPREMACY HEADQUARTERS BUILDING

The Supremacy headquarters looms large in the center of the city, a dark and foreboding fortress that serves as the beating heart of their nefarious operations. The building is a towering monolith of steel and concrete, bristling with turrets, searchlights and other ominous features that mark it as a place of danger and intrigue. Draped from the balconies that line the top floor of the building are swags of green and yellow, signifying the allegiance and service to Hydra.

Inside the building, lower floors house the offices of the Hydra elite in a maze of winding corridors and shadowy chambers, each filled with the latest in surveillance equipment and high-tech gadgetry. Secret document rooms are hidden away behind locked doors and guarded by heavily armed security teams, ensuring that only the most trusted members of Hydra have access to the organization's most closely guarded secrets.

Despite the air of secrecy and danger that permeates the Supremacy headquarters, there is a sense of order and efficiency that is impossible to ignore. Hydra's leaders demand nothing less than complete devotion and excellence from their agents, and those who fail to live up to their standards are swiftly and ruthlessly dealt with. The building itself is a symbol of Hydra ideals: a place of darkness but also of terrifying competence and chilling resolve, where the forces of evil plot and scheme against those who would dare to stand against them.

Art by Roland Boschi, Ed Tadeo, Scott Hanna & Chris Chuckry

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Supremacy Headquarters

First Floor

Second Floor

Third Floor

1. Lobby / Reception
2. Coffee Bar
3. Storage / Reverse Engineering
4. Secret Elevator
5. Office
6. Restroom
7. Armory
8. Boardroom
9. Executive Washroom
10. Kitchenette
11. A/V Room
12. Server Room
13. Storage
14. Private Meeting Room
15. Secured Documents Room
16. Research Labs

One Square Equals 5 ft.

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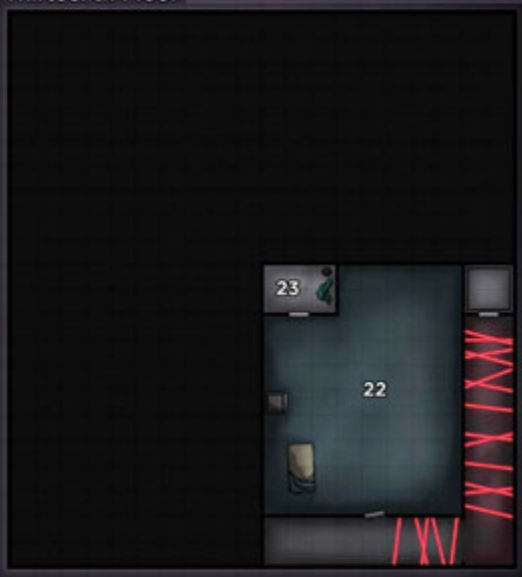
Supremacy Headquarters

(SECOND HALF)

Fourth Floor

Thirteenth Floor



Floor Example (15th thru 22nd)

17. Security Checkpoint
18. Archives
19. Command Center
20. Training Center
21. Security Office
22. Living Quarters
23. Makeshift Washroom
24. Foyer
25. Dining Room
26. Kitchen
27. Bedrooms
28. Restrooms
29. Living Room
30. Office
31. Balcony
32. Storage
33. Utility Closet
34. Pantry

One Square Equals 5 ft.

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First Floor: Offices

If the heroes enter through the front doors and into the lobby, they encounter a large reception desk manned by a burly guard in full Hydra regalia. Beyond the desk, there are several elevators and an emergency stairwell leading to the upper floors. If recognized, the heroes are detained on the spot, unless they want to immediately engage in combat to bypass the first round of guards.

To the left of the reception desk is a set of double doors that leads to the back offices. These doors are guarded by two Hydra agents armed with advanced weapons and cybernetic enhancements. The agents are highly trained and do not hesitate to attack anyone who appears suspicious or threatens the security of the building.

If the heroes manage to distract or get past the guards to the back offices, they find a series of rooms that are dimly lit, with flickering fluorescent bulbs overhead casting a sickly green glow over everything. The walls are adorned with posters extolling the virtues of Hydra and warning of the dangers of traitors and dissidents.

Inside the offices, desks are arranged in rows, each one cluttered with papers, computers and other equipment. The furniture is spartan and functional, with metal file cabinets lining the walls and lockable drawers for secure storage of sensitive materials. A search of the file cabinets turns up nothing, and it should be made clear to the heroes that this is not the correct area of the building for what they seek. They must first reach the highly secured offices, where classified information is stored under a much stricter lock and key.

Despite the lack of pertinent information in these back offices, there is one room that is dedicated to the processing and storage of confiscated items and artifacts. It is filled with crates and boxes, with labels indicating their contents, ranging from advanced technology to mystical artifacts. A team of technicians and scientists work tirelessly to reverse-engineer or harness the power of these items for Hydra's use. If you wish to use this opportunity to give your players an item they may need for another adventure, this is a great time to do so. Conversely, if you don't want to give your players a special item or gadget, you may use this room to tempt them to take something anyway, with the consequence that an alarm sounds the moment an object is carried past the threshold of the doorway.

In the room directly next door, there is a small armory where weapons and equipment are stored for emergency use. This room is secured with a heavy metal door that requires a key card to enter, ensuring that only authorized personnel have access. Through the reinforced glass window on the door, the heroes can easily see rows of weapons lining the walls, including firearms, explosives and other deadly implements. Various types of armor and other protective gear are also stored here, including shields, helmets and body armor. If the heroes find a way inside this room, treat it just like the one above, allowing them to remove items if you wish to grant them a boost or using it to tempt them into setting off an alarm.

Back outside in the center of the lobby is a large staircase that leads to the boardroom on the second floor. The staircase is guarded by two additional Hydra agents who watch for any potential threats.

To the right of the desk is a general reception area with three green couches and a self-serve coffee bar. Hidden behind one of the couches is a false wall leading to an elevator with only one button to push.

Thirteenth Floor: A Secret Room

Once inside the elevator, pushing the button takes the heroes to the thirteenth floor, which is unreachable by any other means, including the emergency stairwell (there is no landing at the thirteenth floor) or the main elevators, which do not stop on this floor. This area is protected by advanced security measures, including laser trip wires and motion sensors, and is accessible only by a secret passageway known to a select few high-ranking Hydra officials. Noticing the trip wires requires a Vigilance vs. TN 12 action check by any hero.

Once the security measures are identified and explained to the other heroes, bypassing them requires a successful Agility vs. TN 13 action check from each hero who wishes to pass. Alternatively, a hero may attempt a Logic vs. TN 15 action check to dismantle the security measures altogether, allowing all heroes to pass without an Agility check.

At the end of the hallway is a steel door, found ajar. Inside the adjoining room are squalid living quarters, with a thin mattress on the floor, a cooler with rotten food and a makeshift washroom. With a Vigilance vs. TN 12 action check, a hero knows that the rotten food means the room hasn't been occupied in several days. This room is lined with a metallic substance, and thorough investigation leads to the realization that the metal is lead. A search of the room turns up an etched area in the lead floor, scratched with something sharp, with the letter A, then a five-pointed star and a letter C.

Second Floor: Boardroom

At the heart of the Supremacy headquarters on the second floor is the boardroom, a place of power and decision-making that is reserved for only the highest-ranking members of the organization. Here, the elite plot their next moves, strategize against their enemies and discuss the latest developments in their twisted plans for world domination.

Whenever the heroes discover the boardroom, it is empty. There is a phone on the desk, lit up with buttons that call any other department in the building. Additionally, there is a pad of lined paper on the desk from a previous meeting. A hero who inspects the pad may make a Vigilance vs. TN 10 action check to see indentations of writing in the top sheet. This can be read either by holding the paper to a light source or by doing a pencil rubbing, allowing the hero to read *"Chavez to be transferred to Horizon."*

Third Floor: Research and Development

To the right of the third-floor elevators is a door that leads to a secure document room. This room is protected by a biometric thumbprint scanner that only allows authorized personnel with a Hydra key card and the correct thumbprint to enter. Inside the room, there is a bank of computers, as well as filing cabinets where heroes can find a few useful confidential documents and information on Hydra's plans and operations. Each hero may make a Vigilance vs. TN 14

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action check. For every successful check, a hero finds one of the following:

- A filing cabinet of dossiers on all super-powered individuals. At the front of the first set of folders is a full dossier on America Chavez, describing her powers in full, with notes that reflect her capture by Hydra, scientific tests performed to replicate her dimension-traveling powers and a notice that she is set to have her blood drawn before termination three days from today. This dossier is obtained without any further research. If a hero wishes to continue to look for a specific dossier, including any known Supremacy members, they may do so with a secondary Vigilance vs. TN 17 action check, and upon success, they may read that character's profile.
- A photocopy of the deed to Horizon Labs, located in Manhattan's historic South Street Seaport, along with a floor plan of new construction within the building. Paper-clipped to the plans are two Horizon Labs employee badges.
- A computer that can be hacked with a Logic vs. TN 12 action check. If successful the heroes spot a folder on the desktop that is labeled "Mother." Inside, there are partial blueprints that look very much like a large-scale version of the smaller portal seen at Prano's and in the Convention Center to any hero with a Logic score of 2 or higher. Each of the blueprints has a logo of a rising sun over the word "Horizon" in the bottom right corner.
- Research and development files on a new type of remote detonation device that works between Multiverses. The files document how the device works, the intent to try to use it as a last-ditch effort to stop Galactus before he can reach Earth-56438 and where the prototypes are stored at Horizon Labs on the third floor. In the margins of the notes next to the map of the third floor, the words "WALL SAFE, CODE 8219" are written in all caps.
- A report filed about the Crimson Surfer details the plan to lead Galactus to other Earths in order to spare Earth-56438 from destruction. As a fail-safe, if Galactus comes to Earth-56438, Hydra's plan is to invade an alternate dimension using newly developed portal technology and create a mass exodus to escape imminent destruction. Upon reading this report, it is clear to the heroes that Galactus is coming in either scenario. (The Crimson Surfer has not revealed to Hydra of Earth-56438 that "Galactus" is actually Kang the Devourer.)
- Various directives about building "a device" and plans for a mass migration from this universe with an indiscernible signature of what looks like four letters that begin with a K.

While on the third floor, keep count of every additional check made past the initial round of Vigilance checks to find the information. Once the number reaches 4, alarms sound in the building.

If the heroes stay in this room and continue to look for more information, Hydra agents arrive after two more checks of any type. If the heroes leave the area, they must move stealthily within the building from now on, as Hydra agents are on the lookout for them.

If the heroes engage in combat in this area, the Supremacy arrives on the scene at the beginning of the third round. While it isn't optimal for the heroes to fight the Supremacy so early in the encounter, they do not just let invaders steal documents from their headquarters. If the battle begins to turn against the Supremacy, the remaining members will make a tactical retreat to recover and attack at their advantage before the heroes have time to heal up, likely at Horizon Labs.

Fourth Floor

If the heroes ascend to the fourth floor, the corridors become more labyrinthine, with a maze of rooms, all heavily secured. This is where the most sensitive information is kept, and only the highest-ranking members of Hydra are allowed access

Art by Humberto Ramos, Carlos Cuevas & Edgar Delgado

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to these areas. One room is a command center, where Hydra leaders can monitor operations and communicate with their agents all over the world. The room is filled with at least a dozen agents at any moment around the clock, seated at individual stations with their backs to the entrance and facing a wall-to-wall screen with a map of the world, lighting up at various points on the map in coded display. Down the hall is a training room where Hydra agents undergo grueling physical and mental exercises to hone their skills. Security measures on this floor are the tightest in the entire building, with multiple layers of biometric scanners, armed guards and automated turrets to ensure the utmost protection of Hydra's secrets.

The heroes may try to investigate here or use the facilities to enact a plan, but if they do, they are certainly seen, calling the attention of the Hydra guards immediately. As on the floor below, this triggers the appearance of the Supremacy after two rounds of combat.

Upper-Floor Residences

The Supremacy headquarters is more than just a place of work for Hydra agents. It is also a home, a place where the most loyal and ruthless servants of Hydra can rest and prepare for their next mission. Each member of the Supremacy has a floor of the building to themselves as a penthouse apartment, appointed with every convenience in addition to the most advanced security and safety monitoring systems known to this world. Exiting the elevator on any of these floors requires a retina scan and six-digit code, programmed only to the Supremacy member who lives on each floor. Identical security measures are in place at the doors in the emergency stairwell, and the only way to bypass them is to use a Hydra security card while the building is in emergency lockdown mode.

Each Supremacy member is in their own penthouse at night, unless called away. There are balconies on each level, leading to the living room of each penthouse, but the penthouses start at the fifteenth floor with no outside access (such as perrons or fire escapes).

THE RESISTANCE HIDEOUT

Tucked away on the upper floor of a nondescript brownstone in the heart of Hell's Kitchen is the resistance hideout. The barren and deserted storefront below was once a bustling bookshop and cornerstone of the community before Hydra's enforcers of "community standards" took notice of the shop and its potential for dissidents. The dimly lit space occupies the entire floor, which once was a set of apartments. It is furnished with only the bare necessities and has a makeshift training area in the back of the large, open floor plan. The walls are adorned with maps of the city and classified Hydra documents procured through risky operations. The members of the resistance move quietly about their tasks, always on alert for any sign of danger, discussing plans and strategies for thwarting Hydra's latest schemes. The atmosphere is tense, with everyone acutely aware of the danger they face under the Hydra regime's all-seeing eye. But despite the odds stacked against them, the resistance soldiers on, fueled by their conviction and the hope that one day, they will restore peace and freedom to the city.

Sensitive Information

When the heroes arrive at the hideout, they have a few options on how to approach. If they simply knock on the door, an elderly woman cautiously opens it just a crack, leaving the security chain affixed, as if this were a normal apartment. The heroes won't likely recognize her as May Parker.

If the heroes are not disguised and are recognizable, she is surprised to see them and calls to others in the room, who approach with weapons drawn. If the heroes are disguised, she asks their business, but any attempts to fool her requires an Ego vs. TN 15 action check. May is no fool.

Unless Spider-Woman is with the group or has already made her way back to the resistance hideout and informed them of the heroes' presence on Earth-56438, they cautiously approach, unsure if these newcomers are friend or foe. They demand to know the super heroes' identities and their reasons for being there.

May, an elderly but tough woman with gray hair, asks the newcomers for any kind of proof that they are not Hydra agents, as they have been betrayed before by false allies. If the heroes are honest about their intentions and provide proof through identification, examples of conversation with Spider-Woman or any sign that they come from another dimension, they are granted entry with an Ego vs. TN 10 action check.

Once inside, the resistance members tell the heroes that they have been trying to fight Hydra and foil their attempts to create a Mother Portal that leads to the destruction of other Earths. Unfortunately, their numbers have been depleted, through either arrests or deaths. The arrival of reinforcement heroes couldn't have come at a better time. May tells the group that the last detainment was of America Chavez, captured weeks ago. They believe she is being held illegally in the Supremacy headquarters. Because Hydra has been working on portal technology, they assume they need her powers to aid their efforts.

REST: A NEEDED SIDE QUEST

If the heroes encounter any combat or suffer effects from multiversal travel, it is critical they rest and heal to ensure they can continue their journey. However, in a city run by Hydra, finding a safe place to rest can be a daunting task. The heroes may need to take shelter in abandoned buildings, makeshift camps or any place where they can find cover from Hydra's agents. But these places may not be entirely safe, as they could be monitored by Hydra or the Supremacy or already occupied by others in hiding who may not want to share their turf.

If the heroes have not yet met the resistance or simply don't trust them, their side quest to find shelter can provide you with some leeway for a drop-in encounter, if you wish.

The heroes may also need to deal with injuries sustained during battles with Hydra's agents. Healing in such an environment can be tricky, as medical supplies may be limited or nonexistent. Remember that a character who is not dead or shattered regains lost Health and Focus equal to the character's rank every hour they rest, and that rate is doubled if they sleep.

The heroes may face the challenge of staying hidden while they rest and heal. Hydra's agents may be actively searching for them, making it crucial for the heroes to

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Horizon Labs

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remain vigilant and avoid drawing attention to themselves. They may need to take turns keeping watch to ensure they are always prepared for any unexpected encounters. Relying on their survival skills, mental fortitude and trusted allies to find safe places to rest and recover is extremely important, but the heroes must remember that taking care of themselves is just as important as their mission to defeat Hydra.

You can't save the world if you're dead.

HORIZON LABS

Horizon Labs was a research and development facility that was acquired by the chemical corporation Alchemax, located in the South Street Seaport area of Manhattan. Focused on cutting-edge science and innovative inventions, the facility is equipped with advanced labs, research stations, and testing facilities that house state-of-the-art equipment and machinery with staff that includes top scientists, engineers and technicians who work together to create groundbreaking technologies for a better future. Or at least, that is how the heroes know Horizon Labs on their Earth.

Here on Earth-56438, what was seen back home as the welcoming lab to many visitors that hosted Peter Parker as one of the leading scientists is now a quiet building, and the stunning white and silver decor has been replaced by the sinister green and yellow Hydra insignia. The entrance is now heavily guarded, with armed Hydra agents checking the identification of everyone who enters. The lobby, which was once filled with the sounds of scientists working, is now mostly empty except for a few more Hydra agents keeping watch. The labs themselves have been converted to manufacture weapons and technology for Hydra's use. The scientists who worked here were forced to work for Hydra or have been replaced with Hydra loyalists, and any hint of resistance is met with swift and brutal punishment. The once-innovative labs have been turned into a Hydra stronghold, with plans and blueprints for weapons of mass destruction scattered across the desks and tables.

If the heroes obtained the deed and map of Horizon Labs from the Supremacy Headquarters, each room is marked on their map, allowing them to navigate the building with ease. However, since the area is crawling with Hydra, they must make their way through the building undetected, in disguise or with another clever method to avoid a conflict. Once the heroes are spotted in Horizon Labs, Hydra agents waste no time calling in the Supremacy to remedy the situation.

First Floor: Lobby

The ground floor of Horizon Labs serves as the main entrance and reception area, with a large lobby and security desk. Outside the main doors, four Hydra agents stand post to check that only cleared individuals gain entrance to the building. Inside, a woman sits behind the reception desk, flanked by two additional Hydra guards with another pair at the security desk.

The woman, named Lindsay Wood, is an entry-level Hydra lackey who was placed at reception because she couldn't handle basic Hydra deliveries. Her job is to grant specific security access to visitors, or rather, simply keep them out. However, she strives to be well liked and to prove herself as a good employee, so her ego takes a toll in lieu of pleasing others. If a disguised hero attempts to convince Lindsay that they should enter the lab, the following results apply. Note that only one hero visible in a group can make this attempt for the whole group, and once the attempt is made, it cannot be reattempted:

- With a successful Ego vs. TN 14 action check, Lindsay allows the heroes access with a lab docent as their guide.
- With a successful Ego vs. TN 16 action check, Lindsay believes that the heroes are visiting scientists themselves and grants them access to all areas that aren't high security without a guide.
- With a successful Ego vs. TN 18 action check, Lindsay believes that the heroes are specialists called in for a classified project and grants them access to all areas that don't require biometric scanning.

Beyond the lobby, there is a central atrium that spans multiple levels, with a glass ceiling that allows natural light to flood the space. This atrium is surrounded by various labs and offices, including the chemistry lab, robotics lab and biomedical lab. An elevator and stairwell oppose each other at either side of the back wall of the atrium.

Second Floor: Laboratories

The second floor features additional offices and laboratory space, as well as a large conference room. The largest room on this floor is the secret research laboratory, where scientists and engineers work tirelessly on developing new technologies to further Hydra's goals. All rooms on this floor are marked on the map found at the Supremacy headquarters.

When the heroes reach the second floor, a successful Vigilance vs. TN 10 action check allows a hero to notice a security camera at the end of the main hallway. Regardless of their check results, they also see a bald man in a white lab coat exiting a smaller research room and entering the secret laboratory. The heroes may recognize the man as Elihas Starr, more commonly known as Egghead, as even those who haven't met the man have heard of his unmistakable egg-shaped head.

Egghead, an atomic scientist of remarkable talents, was once employed by the government on the heroes' Earth, but he was fired under charges of espionage. After his fall from grace, he employed his formidable intellect toward a life of crime, becoming a notorious mastermind. Seeing him in a Hydra-run lab here shouldn't shock the heroes. With a Vigilance vs. TN 10 action check, it is easy for the heroes to track Egghead's movements, switching between the two rooms every twenty minutes. If the heroes can time his pattern correctly, they can avoid being seen by Egghead. Each hero must successfully make a Logic vs. TN 12 action check to understand the pattern and avoid detection. If they are detected, Egghead immediately alerts the Supremacy, unless the heroes can talk their way out of the situation, requiring an Ego vs. TN 18 action check.

The smaller of the two rooms contains the research, materials, plans and parts for the portal. Entering the room requires a Horizon Labs key card. If the heroes can view the plans, they can make a Logic vs. TN 13 action check to identify a weak spot in the portal.

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A second set of blueprints for a small canister device is on the table in this room, marked "Plasma Grenade." Notes in the margin state that the Plasma Grenade has a 10-foot blast diameter and does substantial damage to all known materials in an instant, with the exception of vibranium.

The larger of the two rooms houses the portal itself. Entering the room requires a Horizon Labs key card. Inside, the portal whirs as it is run through various tests for strength and reliability. The portal has been updated so it can open gateways in multiple cities around the world on the heroes' Earth. If the heroes see the portal after viewing the plans, it is easy to tell with a Vigilance vs. TN 10 action check that the portal is near ready. Hydra will soon move the portal to a site large enough to move armies over to the heroes' Earth. Destroying the portal is now or never.

Egghead Explains

Egghead won't allow the heroes any respite if they fail an Ego vs. TN 18 action check, at which point he calls the Supremacy. However, each hero has the opportunity to try if they wish, unless any previous attempt fails by 10 or more.

If Egghead is lured into conversation, he maintains his allegiance to Hydra but answers any relevant questions with the following information:

- He has heard about the Egghead of the other Earth, and he believes he is much more intelligent.
- He is under orders from Hydra to make the portal work, but the true mastermind behind the plan is Kang.
- America Chavez is in the building, but the heroes will never find her.
- This portal opens gateways all over the heroes' Earth, and while Earth-56438 is sacrificed, its people will live on.
- He is scared, and he truly believes something terrible is coming to destroy Earth-56438, but he can't bring himself to say what.

Other Laboratories

In addition to the two rooms in which Egghead is working, there is a chemistry lab, robotics lab and biomedical lab, all encircling the upper portion of the atrium. Each of these labs is accessible to anyone with a key card, and there is a Hydra scientist working alone in each, doing research and tests for future Hydra projects, all unrelated to the portal.

The Hydra scientist names are:

- Marvin Doheny, chemistry lab
- Alex Billingsby, robotics lab
- Jasleen Ahluwalia, biomedical lab

If a hero talks with any of these scientists, they are fearful of their Hydra overlords and stress that they cannot be bothered and must get back to work. However, an Ego vs. TN 14 action check warms one of them up to reveal the layout of the lab or what they've heard about the portal. With an Ego vs. TN 18 action check, they help the heroes.

Alternatively, if the heroes wish to attack the scientists for any reason, they use the same profile as the A.I.M. agent found in the *Core Rulebook*.

Third Floor: Storage

As the heroes enter the third floor of Horizon Labs, it's immediately apparent that something is amiss. Instead of the laboratory space on the lower floors, the heroes instead see a labyrinth of storage facilities housing a vast array of weapons, some of which appear to be advanced Hydra technology.

The weapons are carefully organized and maintained with the precision of a military operation. There are racks of rifles and pistols neatly arranged in lockers, shelves of grenades and other explosives, and even entire rows of experimental weapons still in development.

The room is kept cool and dry and the floors are spotlessly clean. Each locker is protected by a laser grid system to prevent anyone from removing the weaponry. An attempt

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to take anything from the lockers results in a standard damage roll with a x2 multiplier to whatever object (be it a hand, stick, metal rod, etc.) is inside the locker. The laser grid cannot be shut down from within this floor.

While the heroes investigate the lockers, a Vigilance vs. TN 12 action check allows a hero to spot one laser grid that doesn't seem to be working. The grid lines flicker at an inconsistent rate, but every once in a while, they shut off for long enough to reach inside, where a few highly technological devices are stored. A hero that succeeds on an Agility vs. TN 10 action check can reach inside at the exact right moment and remove the three devices, which match the blueprints of the Plasma Grenade found in the second floor research room.

If the heroes obtained the research for the remote multiversal detonation device from the Supremacy headquarters, they also have the exact location of where it is stored on this floor. The heroes may follow the map to a wall safe, enter the code 8219 into the keypad and access the detonator, which has the strength to work between dimensions.

Fourth Floor: Observation Cells

The top level of Horizon Labs is a distinct feature of the building's architecture, complete with gabled roofs and other unique details, making the lab instantly recognizable from afar.

The elevator doors open to the fourth floor, leading to a sterile white hallway lined with a series of heavy steel doors to research and development labs. The doors are labeled with warning signs and barred with heavy locks. At the end of the hall, a reinforced titanium door leads to a holding cell, meant for test subjects that must be kept under close observation. The cell is a small, windowless room, illuminated by bright fluorescent lights. The walls are lined with lead and are nearly identical to the room hidden in the Supremacy building, and the only entrance is a thick steel door with a biometric lock with a key card reader and a small porthole-style window made from 10-inch-thick leaded glass.

Inside the cell, a young woman can be seen strapped to a medical table, hooked up to various machines and monitors, with tubes and wires running in and out of her arms and legs. The air inside the room is heavy with the smell of antiseptic and chemicals, and the only sound is the constant hum of machinery. The woman is America Chavez, the missing resistance super hero.

Getting into the cell is no easy task, although heroes may attempt to break in with the following methods:

- Three successful Melee checks with a target number of 18. The heroes can try this as many times as they like, but each time they fail, they take a standard damage roll with a ×1 damage multiplier.
- Using one of the Plasma Grenades found on the third floor. The grenade dissolves a hole in the door with no problem, but any heroes caught in the 10-foot blast diameter suffer 100 damage to their Health.
- The biometric lock accepts the thumbprint from any high-ranking scientist or lab worker in the building. A hero may consider using the thumb of a scientist found elsewhere in the lab, including Egghead.

  Convincing anyone but Egghead to help them requires a compelling argument in addition to an Ego vs. TN 14 action check. Egghead requires a TN 20. Alternatively, anyone of high rank may be defeated and taken directly to the door to use their thumbprint.
- Any other creative method that the heroes come up with that is reasonable to the Narrator. The more super-heroic, the better!

Once America Chavez is unhooked from the machines, she regains her strength and is able to move with the group on her own. She thanks the heroes and lets them know that if they can destroy the portal, she can take them back to their own Earth with no issue.

The Supremacy Is in the Building

If at any point the heroes are recognized by Hydra agents or Egghead, or once the heroes rescue America Chavez or enter the portal room with any type of explosive, the Supremacy are called in to dispatch the intruders. Use the table below to determine which members of the Supremacy join the fight to protect their portal and rid Earth-56438 of the unwanted heroes.

If combat reaches a definitive end and the heroes prevail, they may continue to destroy the portal and return to their Earth.

If the heroes are defeated, the mission has failed. Perhaps a new team of heroes comes back to finish the job in a new session, or perhaps the portal is never closed, which affects the rest of the campaign in unique ways. Without giving any clues to the players, it may be worthwhile to keep the portal open in preparation for Chapter 6, but as far as the heroes know, this would result in a complete failure of the mission.

Adjusting the Difficulty

Use the following table to adjust the encounters for teams of various sizes:

Number of Heroes	Supremacy Team
3	Egghead, Viper (Ophelia Sarkissian), and Sabretooth
4	Egghead, Viper (Ophelia Sarkissian), Sabretooth and Killmonger
5	Egghead, Viper (Ophelia Sarkissian), Sabretooth, Killmonger and Abomination
6	Egghead, Viper (Ophelia Sarkissian), Sabretooth, Killmonger, Abomination and Gorgon (Tomi Shishido)
7	Egghead, Viper (Ophelia Sarkissian), Sabretooth, Killmonger, Abomination, Gorgon (Tomi Shishido) and the Hood

It is possible for the heroes to destroy the portal before concluding combat with the Supremacy, and if they feel outnumbered, there is no reason why they shouldn't flee. However, if they return to their Earth without destroying the portal, the Supremacy follows and finishes the job in

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any dimension, still leaving a working portal for Hydra to enact their plan to invade their Earth.

Once the heroes either defeat the Supremacy or approach the portal with any intent to dismantle it, the portal activates with a blinding blue light, as electricity buzzes in the air.

The Herald Emerges

To the heroes' surprise, the portal springs to life without anyone controlling it from this room, As their attention snaps to the machine, a dark figure begins to emerge from the contrast of the bright circular blaze, riding what looks to be a blood-red surfboard.

Heroes who played through the events of Chapter 2: Origin Story recognize the Crimson Surfer, who nearly broke through the portal in the courtyard at Prano's on their Earth before it shut down. The memory of the cries of anguish and fear from Steve Rogers echoes in their minds: *"The Crimson Surfer is coming! You have to stop him from breaking through!"*

This time, it is too late to stop the Crimson Surfer from coming through from another dimension, and he is compelled to keep the portal active to lead Kang the Devourer to other universes, with his sights set on the heroes' Earth next. As he fully emerges from the light, he declares in a booming voice, *"There is no stopping what fate has begun! You can try as you might, but he is coming, and he will devour all!"*

Any attempts to reason with the Crimson Surfer go ignored, and he strikes at the heroes unless they surrender. If the Supremacy is already defeated, the heroes face the Crimson Surfer with no other distractions, but they do not have time to recover from the previous wave of combat unless they spend the Karma and action to do so.

If any members of the Supremacy are still undefeated, this is a chance to clue the players in to the fact that the Supremacy doesn't want the Crimson Surfer in their universe either. Any Supremacy member still alive shouts to the Crimson Surfer, *"Lead him somewhere else!"* followed by *"At least help us leave before he gets here!"*

A hero may attempt an Ego vs. Ego action check against a Supremacy member to sway them to help defeat the Crimson Surfer, but that does not stop the Supremacy from doing everything in their power to keep the portal from being destroyed, including betraying any temporary alliance and attacking the heroes once again.

The Crimson Surfer only retreats into the portal if he believes it will be destroyed before he defeats the heroes.

- If the Crimson Surfer is defeated, the heroes are finally clear to destroy the portal and return home.
- If the heroes destroy the portal before he is defeated, the Crimson Surfer continues to attack them, shouting *"You've ruined everything, and now you will pay! He will still come! He always hungers!"*
- If the Crimson Surfer retreats into the portal prior to being defeated, he parts with the final words, *"You shall see … he will find another way to your world. What breathes life shall be devoured!"*

The Mother Portal

The Mother Portal is the "final boss" portal after all of the smaller portals have been destroyed in previous chapters. Once destroyed, all of Hydra's work and research is lost forever.

The portal is destroyed once it takes 100 points of damage or if it is hit with a Plasma Grenade. When attempting to destroy the portal, hitting the weak spot identified on its blueprint deals 2× the normal damage per hit.

Welcome to Earth

Once the battle with the Supremacy has concluded, the heroes must make their way back to their Earth. While a few methods have been explained, a quick recap of potential ways to teleport back to the correct dimension include:

- A player character hero has the Multiversal Portal power and uses it after destroying the portal.
- America Chavez has been rescued and can use her Multiversal Portal power after the heroes have destroyed the portal.
- The heroes return to their Earth using the portal before destroying it, but after setting up a timer to detonate an explosive device.
- The heroes return to their Earth using the portal before destroying it, using the multiversal detonator to trigger an explosive device.
- If the heroes do not obtain the multiversal detonator, they can ask Ironheart, if she is around, to create a remote device with a timer that allows the heroes to get back home and then detonate the machine.

DAMAGE CONTROL

With any luck, the heroes successfully defeat all villains and destroy the portal, but all combat has casualties, even if they aren't immediately apparent…

Dead Heroes

It should be a goal for the heroes to survive and "win" this small battle in a great war to come. However, should any heroes be killed, there are a few options for the story ahead:

- At this point in the story and character rank, players know the risks of death for their heroes. A player can have the option of taking on a new character that joins the team once the others return to their Earth. If character death has been discussed and approved with the group prior to beginning play, this is the grittiest but most realistic option.
- If you know that character death is not okay with the group, there are clever ways out of the scenario, beyond just allowing the other heroes to try to save them. If the heroes return through the portal, allow the hero with the highest Logic score to make a Logic vs. TN 13 action check, and if successful, they "feel" that the jolt of electricity from the portal may just revive a stopped heart. If nobody makes the check, allow an Ego vs. TN 10 action check to compel a hero to never leave a fallen hero behind, and when they pass through the portal again, they are surprised with the same revelation.
- The heroes are currently in perhaps the most sophisticated laboratory and research center in the world. There are scientists here that can be persuaded to revive a fallen hero by pleas or threats, both made with an Ego check.

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Captured Heroes

If the heroes are captured, there is likely no way for the portal to be destroyed, and this mission fails.

This does not completely derail the story, however, and there are several points in Chapter 6 where this ending can be mended to a place where these worlds connect again. Perhaps it means that the portal remains open, allowing the Supremacy to evacuate Earth-56438 into the heroes' Earth before Kang the Devourer arrives to consume their timeline. Or perhaps it means that Kang the Devourer immediately proceeds through the portal directly to the heroes' Earth. This choice can be made by reviewing Chapter 6 and determining where in the storyline you would like to begin after this mission fails.

Another option is to add in a short encounter where the heroes escape their capture before returning to the portal to finish the job they started. With this choice, it gives the heroes more time to complete the mission with an added encounter to break free from imprisonment, and then the storyline can continue from the beginning of Chapter 6.

Tactical Retreat

If the heroes find a method to escape combat with the Supremacy and shut down the portal, forcing the Crimson Surfer to retreat to his own world while still finding a way home themselves, then that is a tactical retreat worth rewarding! A great plan is a great plan, after all, and as long as the heroes destroy the portal with the proper parties on their correct worlds, the mission is a success!

The Villains Win

If all heroes fall in battle with nobody left to save or revive them, the villains win. This is an unlikely scenario, especially with ally characters from the resistance that can be brought in to help stave off total team destruction, but it can happen, especially if the vibe of the game is agreed to be especially gritty or dark. This can be a fitting end for the current heroes, allowing the Supremacy to invade their Earth while Kang the Devourer consumes Earth-56438.

From there, if players wish to continue, they may choose new characters to begin Chapter 6, using the suggested profiles or ones with equivalent rank, ready for Kang the Devourer to move on and consume the life energy of their world next.

THE EPILOGUE

Once the heroes return to their Earth with the portal destroyed, they have severed all ability for Hydra to bring their armies through en masse. This doesn't mean that Hydra from Earth-56438 doesn't still know how to reach this Earth, but they must do it the old-fashioned way: through super-powers.

Like many strange occurrences that happen within New York City, otherworldly or not, the news of this epic adventure to save Earth is swept under the rug by authorities and forgotten quickly by any civilian witnesses. However, the heroes receive a call with congratulations and commendation from Nick Fury Jr., and they finally can rest easy after weeks of being on call to save the day…or so they believe.

If the heroes take note of Kang's involvement in the creation of the portal, they may choose to inform Fury (or any supervising agency) to figure out what future issues that may entail.

Ranking Up

Once the heroes have completed the mission in this adventure, they should rank up to Rank 5 to be ready for the next chapter in this book.

You may wish to have your players encounter additional challenges or missions prior to starting the next chapter, and if so, waiting to allow them to rank up is perfectly acceptable. However, the proportion of combat and heroics in this particular adventure does seem worthy of a step up, so don't deny your players their reward unless you have something planned in which Rank 5 characters would simply be too powerful.

The Next Adventure

The next adventure in *The Cataclysm of Kang* surprises the heroes with a twist that may make them feel uneasy about their decisions in this part.

That's okay.

Heroes take on the responsibility of saving the world from the threats they know and staving off imminent danger, but they cannot be held responsible for consequences they can't anticipate.

In the next installment, the heroes receive a plea for help from Earth-56438. However, with the portal destroyed and all of the gateways now disconnected, it is up to the heroes to choose whether they should build that bridge once again.

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6

WORLD OF TROUBLE

It's not good.

Fresh on the heels of your trip to Earth-56438, A.K.A. Hydra Earth, and the destruction of the dimension-hopping machine, all should have been well. And for a few precious days, it was. The sun seemed a bit warmer, the birds sang a little sweeter and your world seemed safe.

Unfortunately for you—and perhaps fortunately for the people of *two* worlds—you're being called back to Hydra Earth for one more mission.

THE BRIEFING

World of Trouble is a full-length adventure for four or five Rank 5 characters. It should take approximately two or three sessions to complete.

The Villains

In the course of the adventure, the heroes should encounter a number of the Inhuman Royal Guards. The heroes also encounter the otherworldly heroes known as the Inhumans—Lockjaw, as well as Black Bolt, Medusa, Crystal, Gorgon and Karnak—under mind control, who they may also do battle with, pending their decisions. Once they travel back in time, they encounter and defeat a number of Godking Kang/Rama Tut's robotic servants. The adventure winds up with them facing off against Godking Kang himself, as well as encountering Kang the Devourer. Black Bolt's profile is in the *Core Rulebook*; the rest are in Chapter 8 (though usually as their Earth-616 counterparts).

The Locations

This adventure takes place in a wide variety of settings. The heroes begin in their headquarters before making their way to Attilan, which is located on the Blue Area of the Moon orbiting Hydra Earth. From there, they'll head to Rama-Tut's palace and Godking Kang's Time Ship buried underneath the Sphinx in ancient Egypt circa 2950 BCE, all on Earth-56438.

The Plot

If this adventure is being played after Chapter 5: National Emergency after shutting down the portal, the Supremacy disappeared in the aftermath. However, the heroes' defeat of the Crimson Surfer has caused a much larger unintended consequence.

It turns out that the Crimson Surfer was the only thing keeping his master at bay, and with him gone, the Devourer is on his way to destroy Earth-56438. However terrible that world may be, there are literally *billions* of innocent people there, so our heroes must spring into action to stop his arrival!

The resistance erroneously believes that their universe's Kang is the real threat, the one the Crimson Surfer has been protecting them from. And they're not entirely wrong. That Kang is striving for godhood so that he can control the Devourer and take his power for himself.

THE HEROES

This adventure assumes that the heroes are all Rank 5. You should feel free to tailor it to fit the needs of your group.

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Marvel Heroes

Most established heroes in the Marvel Multiverse are of Rank 2 or higher. Rank 5 heroes are mythic level; most of them can protect the world all by themselves. So why so much firepower for this adventure? Because they're going to need it!

Nova (Richard Rider), Hyperion, Beta Ray Bill, Captain Avalon (Brian Braddock) and Star-Lord (Peter Quill) are the default characters for this adventure. Star-Lord's profile can be found in the *Core Rulebook*; all of the others are in Chapter 8: Characters.

Alternatively, if the players wish, they can all be members of the Earth-56438 resistance who have come together to foil the plot they discover in the course of this adventure. In that case, they can each use any Rank 5 profile from this book or the *Core Rulebook* as the basis for their character. They should each take time to alter the details of the characters' backgrounds and codenames to differentiate themselves a bit from the standard version.

Original Heroes

If the players are creating original characters for the game, we suggest starting them at Rank 5 so they can be used with this adventure. If the characters don't have a rank cap, you could play through all of the adventures in this book to raise them all up to Rank 6.

Either way, this adventure is particularly high stakes and, as such, may not be the best introduction to the game. But if you and your table like a challenge, feel free to jump right in!

Adjusting the Difficulty

The players can, of course, use other established Marvel heroes for this adventure. If they are of a higher rank, the combat portions of the adventure might be too easy for them—depending on how much more powerful they are. It is not advisable to attempt this adventure with characters Rank 3 or lower, however.

See the first chapter of this book for some suggestions on how to adjust this adventure for them. Note, though, that you don't *have* to adjust this adventure at all, especially if this is not the first time that you and your players are going to be playing the game. While it may prove a significant challenge for lower-rank heroes, that's okay as long as everyone agrees to the challenge!

THE HOOK

The day was saved. Or was it?

By now, the heroes know that the denizens of Earth-56438 have been working hard to open a path to their home dimension, but it's time to find out why (as the people of Earth-56438 understand it):

They were running from something even worse.

The Crimson Surfer wasn't just a major force for Hydra, but much more importantly, he was the herald of Kang the Devourer. His mission was to search the Multiverse for timelines suitable for consumption. Having found Earth-56438, he struck a deal with the people there to stall his master, temporarily sparing Hydra Earth. During this time, the Crimson Surfer enjoyed his prominent status on Earth-56438 and looked for ways to betray his master.

Not content to be at the Crimson Surfer's mercy, Kang of Earth-56438 began looking for a way to save his timeline from Kang the Devourer, taking great steps to accrue power to himself and renaming himself Godking Kang. The Crimson Surfer knew of this and allowed the Supremacy to believe that Godking Kang was his master, when all he was really doing was hoping that Godking Kang would find a way to defeat Kang the Devourer and set him free.

Unfortunately, the failure of the Crimson Surfer has presented Godking Kang with a problem: Kang the Devourer is now on his way to consume Hydra Earth, and the heroes have thwarted the Godking's prospective escape route. However, no Kang who gives up easily can truly be called Kang. He has deduced that if the Devourer can be reasoned with, he can be *controlled*.

The Godking has used all the technological might at his disposal to create a machine that he hopes can allow him to control the Devourer and direct his power wherever Kang decides. If he succeeds, he could truly become the god he styles himself as and have ultimate control over his universe.

The remaining resistance on Hydra Earth knows Godking Kang is trying to elevate himself to actual godhood, but they don't know his true motivations or means. In any case, they're literally powerless to stop it. The Godking has moved his operation to the Inhumans' city of Attilan on the Moon, and even if the heroes could reach it, he's the master of time and space and can go anywhere, any time.

They have no choice but to ask for help. Electronics crackle, and the voice of Spider-Woman (Jessica Drew)—or another resistance member they previously made a meaningful connection with—comes through a radio calling on the heroes to save their world once again. Although they destroyed the dimension-hopping machine to stop the invasion of their Earth, the resistance has found a way to bring them back… if they're willing to help. It shouldn't be too difficult; all they have to do is confront a man who's conquered entire realities and wrest away the power to control a being who has consumed countless worlds. Just another day for our heroes, right?

FAQs

Players are always full of questions, and Spider-Woman tries to answer them as best she can. While we can't predict everything that the characters in your game might ask her, here are answers to the most common kinds of inquiries.

How do we know this isn't a trap? *You don't. This is exactly the kind of trap I'd set if I were in Kang's position. But whatever you think of Hydra, there are literally billions of innocent people here, and saving them has to be worth the risk.*

How do you know what Kang's planning? *One of Godking Kang's hideouts was commandeered, along with his communication technology from the future. That's how we were able to know what he's up to…and to get in touch with someone on the inside.*

How can we get back there? *After the Supremacy's defeat, the resistance were able to secure the portal technology from Egghead. Say the word, and we'll open a portal. Find a way to win, and it won't be a one-way trip.*

Does Hydra know about this? *Not sure, and I haven't asked. I'm not risking spending what's left of my life in a cell to find out!*

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Can't someone else handle this? *No. Everyone on this planet strong enough to fight back has already fled, been arrested or worse. You are our only hope.*

THE PLOT

The adventure takes place in roughly five parts.

1. The heroes discover that the threat from Hydra Earth is not over. Their resistance allies from that world reach out to them and reveal that the person behind the invasion they thwarted was the Kang of their universe, calling himself Godking Kang. Now that the Crimson Surfer has been defeated, it turns out that he was the only thing keeping Galactus (the people of Earth-56438 don't know he is Kang the Devourer) from devouring the planet. Now Godking Kang is trying to lure Galactus to Earth and control him for his own ends. The Hydra Earth turns to the heroes for help stopping him.
2. Godking Kang has set up a base in the city of Attilan on the Moon, utilizing the mind-controlled variants of the Inhumans as lieutenants. However, Lockjaw managed to get word to Spider-Woman that Black Bolt's screams are being used as a nearly inexhaustible power source for Kang's device to summon and control Galactus. Lockjaw teleports the heroes to Attilan, where they learn the device is also drawing chronal energy from ancient Egypt during Rama-Tut's reign, and they must deal with that before the device can be shut off. The heroes steal Kang's Time Chair to make the trip back in time.
3. The heroes arrive in the land of Egypt in the year 2950 BCE and quickly learn that Rama-Tut, as Kang was known then, has gone into the desert to search for someone named En Sabah Nur (better known as Apocalypse). This gives the heroes the opportunity to infiltrate his hidden ship underneath the Great Sphinx of Giza, find the Chronifact and deactivate it. The only thing standing between them is a small army of Rama-Tut's robotic guards, but even here in the far-flung past, they are not completely without allies.
4. With the chronal power supply severed, the heroes travel back to the present to confront Godking Kang and the Inhumans. Depending on whether or not they're able to free the Inhumans from their mind control, this could be a potentially lethal encounter!
5. Unfortunately, once the heroes defeat Godking Kang, he laughs at them and then curses them for fools. He's not the one they needed to stop. Galactus arrives, and he has Kang's face. He's been traveling from universe to universe, and Hydra Earth's time is up. Kang the Devourer plans not to simply consume the Earth but its entire time continuum.

No matter what the heroes choose to do, Kang the Devourer has his eyes set firmly on *their* world once he's done with this one, and he's coming soon. All they can do is escape home.

You can run these parts together as quickly as you like or space them out and toss in other scenes. It's entirely up to you and the pace at which your players want to keep things moving.

THE BEGINNING OF THE END

It's an absolutely perfect day.

The sun is shining, the birds are singing, your favorite song is playing and the pizza is piping hot.

Days like this help you remember why you choose to suit up and fight to protect people, because everyone everywhere should get to enjoy days like this.

You know all too well that not everyone gets to have peace…but you won't give up fighting the good fight—not today, not ever.

Distress Signal

The music begins to crackle with static, and a familiar voice comes through:

"Can you hear me? Is this thing even working? How are they able to respond, anyway? Hello?"

The voice of Spider-Woman—or another member of the resistance they previously connected with—echoes in the room. When they respond, she reveals that she's relieved this hairbrained scheme worked after all.

"I don't know how long this connection will hold, so I'll get to it. It's bad. As bad as it gets, in fact. You did us a favor taking out the Crimson Surfer, but he was a small stone plugging a very big dam…and it's about to break. We need you back here."

She explains that the Crimson Surfer was holding some sort of force at bay…one that she herself doesn't quite understand, but it's a destroyer of worlds. Kang the Conqueror—now calling himself Godking Kang—seems to be behind it all, but he has moved his operation to the Moon, out of reach for the remaining members of the resistance.

Art by John Byrne

"Even Hydra would probably try to stop him if they knew they were about to be destroyed!"

She answers all their questions to the best of her ability, but the truth is she doesn't know much. Something is coming, and only the heroes are strong enough to do anything about it. The key to stopping it is on the Moon.

"There's a whole city up there—did you know that? At least on our world, there's a group known as the Inhumans *who live up there. I thought they were a myth, but after seeing what you guys are capable of, anything is possible. We've got someone on the inside who can get you in and bring you up to speed once you get there. Don't bother packing a toothbrush—you'll either be back by morning or not at all."*

When the heroes say they're ready, a portal opens in the middle of the room…

An Alternate Beginning

If you have not played through Chapter 5: National Emergency, you can simply have Spider-Woman of Earth-56438 reach out to the heroes for help or begin your story as members of the resistance on Hydra Earth. If so, the story begins as follows…

On Earth-56438, Hydra reigns supreme. During the Cold War, they infiltrated S.H.I.E.L.D. and took it over from within. A later tragic super-hero battle over the Statue of Liberty let them complete their takeover of the U.S. government. Today, only a small resistance movement stands against Hydra's might.

For the first time in ages, as long as anyone can remember, there is hope. The Supremacy has disappeared. No one knows what happened—some nonsense about invaders from another dimension, a *big* explosion—and no one has seen them since.

Your squad leader, Spider-Woman, was quick to pounce on the opportunity to raid a newly abandoned Supremacy hideout, and what you find makes your heart sink.

A signal originating from the Moon was being sent into deep space toward something absolutely massive, and now it is headed straight toward Earth.

Spider-Woman's fingers float across the keyboard, scanning the Moon.

"There's some sort of settlement up there…an entire city? And I'm getting a response…but it makes no sense. Who…or what is a Kang?"

A moment later, her face goes pale.

"All right, this is bad. As bad as it gets, in fact. I don't understand everything I'm seeing here, but I need you to get up there and check it out and shut it down."

When you ask just *how* you're supposed to get up to the Moon of all places, a portal opens in the middle of the room…

WELCOME TO ATTILAN

Whatever their origin, when the heroes step through the portal, they are greeted by an astonishing sight: a gleaming city of crystal and metal, more sculpture than metropolis. Attilan—at least as a concept—has stood for fifty thousand years and looks like it could be from fifty thousand years in the future. You arrive behind a small guard building, but gleaming towers reach high overhead, drawing your eyes up to a black sky dotted with stars and the pale blue orb of Earth. Lush greenery extends in all directions off into the distance, ending at the bleak walls of the lunar crater that stretch up toward the sky. A lone tower stands off in the distance.

As you look around, you see people, but none like you've ever seen. They are all manner of colors and physical builds. If you didn't know any better, you'd think they were mutants.

How do the heroes respond to being on the Moon? In a hidden city, no less?

But before you can approach anyone, a rustling in the bushes gets your attention.

Meet Your Contact on the Inside: Lockjaw

Out of the bushes, a unique sight appears: an absolutely colossal brown bulldog. He stands 5 feet tall at the shoulder, nearly 7 feet in length and weighs over 1,200 pounds. Oddest of all, a metal tuning fork pokes out of his forehead, glowing with a faint energy.

You, as Narrator, have another decision to make: Canonically, Lockjaw has spoken before, but that has also been retconned multiple times. It is up to you if you wish to let him speak here—definitely the easier route—or if you prefer to pantomime what he's trying to tell the heroes. They can try all sorts of tactics to communicate with him. They can be kind to him, be gruff with him or even threaten him… which is generally ill-advised. When they're done playing that part out, have the player doing the talking make a Challenging check to see what happens. Lockjaw is familiar with communicating with his fellow Inhumans, but not with the players just yet.

If the heroes try to apply reason to the situation, this should be a Logic check. If they use their emotions to get a feel for what he means rather than the specifics, make it an Ego check. For a Rank 5 hero, the target number (TN) of a Challenging check is 15 or better.

On a success, they understand his meaning completely; on a failure, something is lost in translation…perhaps something *vital*. Whether or not he speaks or has another way to get his point across, Lockjaw has quite a story to share.

What Happened

Lockjaw is your contact here on the Moon.

If the heroes treat him like a simple dog, he plays along for a moment, accepting pats and chin scritches, but a look into his eyes reveals a keen intelligence. He is no simple pet, and his family is in trouble.

After a few moments, Lockjaw makes his way into the small building, revealing a bank of security monitors; this is some sort of guard station for the Inhuman Royal Guards, currently unoccupied. He noses and paws at a couple of large buttons, causing the displays to light up with recordings from all over Attilan.

A man calling himself Godking Kang arrived, seeking an audience with their king, Black Bolt, and his queen, Medusa. Kang claimed to hail from the 41st century and came bringing tidings of a crisis that would destroy the Inhumans…and he could prove it. He was escorted into the heart of the Palace of the Royal Family for an audience with the King and Queen, along with other members of the Royal Family: Crystal, Gorgon, Karnak and Lockjaw himself.

Kang told them of the impending arrival of a being known as Galactus, a devourer of worlds. He had been working on an escape plan to be able to safely transport the people of this Earth to another one in a different dimension, and he shows them holographic projections of another Earth: yours.

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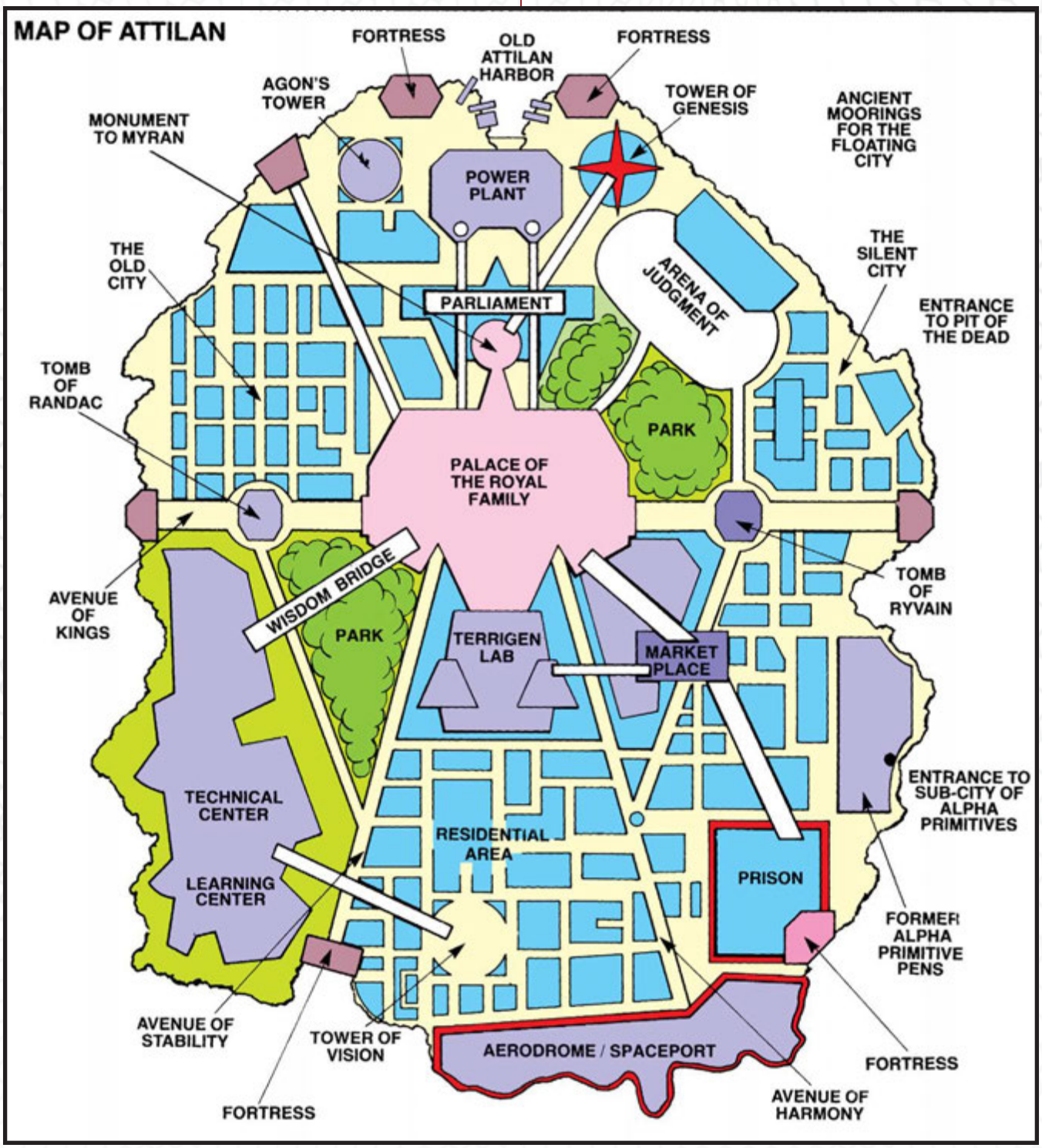
When that failed due to interference on the other side, Kang shifted tactics to stop the impending catastrophe. His ship was capable of traveling across both space and time, and in ancient Egypt, he used a device known as the Chronifact to supply him with the necessary power for his plan, but he needed one other thing: the Inhumans.

The King and Queen in their wisdom suspected treachery and asked Kang what proof he had of his claims. He produced a heavily modified piece of equipment from Doctor Doom's now abandoned lab: an odd helmet known as the Remembrancer. The moment Godking put on the helmet, a blinding flash of light lit up the room and dominated the minds of the Royal Family, putting them firmly under Kang's control.

Unfortunately, despite his vast genius, Kang had made a critical error: He mistook Lockjaw for a simple dog, unnecessary to control. When Lockjaw realized what was happening, he simply played along to find out Kang's plan.

And…he didn't understand it.

Kang began setting up some sort of chamber that he led their king, Black Bolt, into and had him do the unthinkable:



Art by Eliot R. Brown

Michael Syrell (Order - 53194700)

Art by Jim Cheung & Justin Ponsor

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-1700)

scream. Black Bolt's supreme might manifests through his voice; the smallest whisper is capable of destroying buildings, yet Kang began channeling this almost inexhaustible energy out into space, toward an unknown end. It was at this point that Lockjaw found the earliest opportunity to teleport away.

Lockjaw and the other Inhumans have long been aware of the resistance on Hydra Earth, and have even assisted them on occasion. He reached out to his contact Spider-Woman, who told him about you and your recent heroics. He hasn't alerted anyone else—yet—lest he give up the element of surprise to stop Kang's plan in its tracks.

The Inhumans

Lockjaw communicates openly and freely to the best of his ability, as described above.

If asked about Attilan or the Inhumans, he explains that fifty thousand years ago, Attilan, the Island of the Gods, was a technologically advanced city, located in the North Atlantic Ocean.

Across the sea of time, this city has been moved multiple times to avoid being found by the people of the world, ultimately ending up here on the Moon. The Luther Crater had been modified by alien technology to make it habitable, which suited the reclusive Inhumans just fine.

SO, NOW WHAT?

Lockjaw is a very intelligent bulldog, but he's no tactician; that's why he agreed to bring strangers into Attilan to help. He is, however, a national treasure and known fixture of the Royal Family. If the heroes decide to surveil the city or talk to any other Inhumans they come across, they gain an edge in any interactions with the locals while they have Lockjaw with them. Any interactions with the xenophobic Inhumans without Lockjaw give the heroes trouble instead. The people of Attilan are ignorant of what has happened to the Royal Family.

In broad strokes, the heroes have two potential options: the direct approach to head straight to take on Kang or attempting to disrupt his chronal power supply first.

Potential Encounters in Attilan

Whichever plan they decide on, here are a few random encounters the heroes might experience in Attilan, should you choose to bring the timeless city fully to life.

Inhuman Royal Guards

Someone in the Residential Area has called in a report that outsiders who look suspiciously like the heroes have been seen sneaking around. The guards are not initially hostile if Lockjaw is present, but they definitely have a lot of questions about who the heroes are and what they're doing in Attilan.

Terrigen Mist

Inhumans generally gain their powers by being exposed to a substance known as Terrigen Mist when they are young. The heroes come across a ceremony where a young pair of twins are exposed to the mist, developing light and darkness powers that the children immediately relish.

One child flies into the air, leaving a dazzling trail of colors behind to the amazement of all in attendance, while the other immediately plunges into a nearby shadow and reappears standing behind our heroes.

If the heroes are exposed to this mist, it can provide those with Inhuman genes new or stronger powers, which may be temporary or permanent as you, the Narrator, decides Terrigen Mist has a very pleasant scent, like cinnamon or other baked goods.

Alpha Primitives

A group of Alpha Primitives are at work repairing a damaged building. As they work clearing the rubble, the body of an odd green-skinned alien with a rough and bumpy chin is revealed—a Skrull…and it's not quite dead!

Alpha Primitives are the Inhumans' workforce, genderless beings who are reproduced by cloning, so they are all innately equal. They understand and respond to language similar to how a six-year-old human child would. The Alpha Primitives are not aggressive but defend themselves if attacked.

Debate!

A group of Inhumans are having a heated argument. They're aware of what's happening on Earth—half of them are sympathetic to Hydra, and the other half are sympathetic to the resistance. Surely the heroes can help settle the argument for them: *Does society need a firm hand or unchecked free will to achieve greatness?*

Wedding Procession

A wedding procession is marching through the streets on the way to their ceremony, but the bride and groom are the single most beautiful beings the heroes have ever seen…and the couple is looking at them. The procession grinds to a halt as one of the pair approaches and whispers, "*Help!*"

THE WATCHER

The tuning fork on Lockjaw's head glimmers, and the heroes pop from where they're standing to…somewhere else. They're high atop a much taller building, and Attilan stands off in the distance at the other end of the crater. Behind them, a 20-foot-tall bald man with piercing white eyes stands studying them all.

"Greetings. I am Uatu, the Watcher. You are not from this… universe. What are you doing here?"

The Watcher is a Rank X being (see page 305 in the *Core Rulebook*), having unquantifiable power. The Watcher is from a group of beings sworn to neutrality and observation. He means the heroes no harm and relies on diplomacy if attacked. If the heroes won't listen to reason, he simply teleports them back to Attilan. The Watcher is a vast storehouse of knowledge, limited only by his vow of noninterference. He is useful for gaining specific facts rather than advice on how to proceed. There's almost no limit to the help he can provide…if the heroes ask the right questions.

Who are you?
"I am Uatu, the Watcher. I see all things but never interfere."

Why don't you interfere?
"My people took a vow, countless millennia ago. It is the same with the Watcher of your world as well."

Why have you brought us here?
"Your appearance here, in this reality, will be a crucial turning point for this universe, however it ends. I wanted to know more about who you are and your motivations."

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Aren't you interfering right now? We've got to stop Kang!
"No. I will return you to the precise moment I removed you from. No time will have elapsed for the people of Attilan."

How do you know we're not from this universe?
"I have seen where you hail from. You have troubles, to be certain, but your people live with far more peace and freedom than the humans do below us."

If you know they're suffering, why don't you do something about it?
"Because it's not my role to intervene—simply to watch."

Will we defeat Kang?
"I have seen countless possibilities. Some where Kang is victorious, and others where he is not. What transpires here will be up to you."

And what of Galactus?
"The Devourer. A destroyer of worlds, more force of nature than simple being."

What can you tell us that might help?
"I do not wish to help—that is not my role. However…"

This is an excellent opportunity for you, the Narrator, to foreshadow whatever plot threads you like.

Once they are done speaking, Uatu delivers the heroes as promised back to the exact moment they departed from.

IT'S TIME TO SAVE THE WORLD

The Direct Approach

If the heroes decide to take Kang head-on, Lockjaw discovers he's unable to teleport back inside the palace for reasons he doesn't understand. If any of the heroes have powers that allow them to teleport as well, an unknown energy field around the Palace of the Royal Family prevents them from doing so. Instead, Lockjaw can guide the heroes as far as the Parliament building connected to the palace before running into any significant trouble.

Outside the building, eight Inhuman Royal Guards are stationed with strict orders not to admit anyone into the palace; not even Lockjaw is allowed re-entry. The guards are not initially hostile, but they are unwavering; it is an impossible task for characters to talk their way past the guard. The guards are all true believers who would lay down their lives in an instant, but with some luck, they can be persuaded or intimidated into allowing Lockjaw to enter alone with an Ego vs. TN 19 action check. If the heroes decide to fight their way past the guards, four more guards arrive every two rounds for the duration of the conflict.

The intent here is not to railroad your players into making the trip to ancient Egypt, so much as to show them the significant difficulties that lie ahead of them if they don't work to undermine Kang's machinations first. Should they persevere, allow them to enter the palace as planned.

Into the Palace

Inside the lower level of the palace, the heroes encounter Crystal, Gorgon and Karnak (for profiles, see Chapter 8: Characters), along with six more Inhuman Royal Guards. The Royals simply attack as soon as they detect the heroes—another indicator that their minds are not their own.

Two guards stand by each door leading farther into the Royal Palace. Crystal, Gorgon and Karnak are arrayed in the middle, directly in front of the heroes. Lockjaw fights alongside the heroes to the best of his ability, without harming his family too seriously.

In the fight, the Inhumans begin with a Level 3 Offensive Team Maneuver, which should make it clear to the heroes that they mean business! Karnak looks at them, his face unmoving. *"In time, all we rely on will shatter and fall. Only Godking Kang will remain. His will is unbreakable!"*

Gorgon flexes, his muscles bulging underneath his skin: *"I am Gorgon Petragon! I have crushed armies and gods! I have devoted my entire life to honing the warrior's craft. And I will use it to lay your broken bodies before the Godking!"*

Wind begins to swirl around Crystal as she extends her hands toward the heroes: *"You disrespect this palace with your presence. Now see what it means to anger an elemental!"* Crystal uses her Elemental Powers (Air) to target any heroes who can fly or are clearly very mobile. Gorgon uses his superhuman strength to charge right at the strongest-looking hero. Karnak uses his Exploit power to target whichever hero is the leader or whoever appears to be the most intelligent.

The guards are *not* brainwashed but are simply following the orders they received from the Royal Family to guard the doors at all costs. If any of the heroes is knocked unconscious—or, worse, killed—Lockjaw teleports the entire group out of there immediately.

If the heroes succeed in defeating the Inhumans and their guards, once they open the door, they are met with a bluish-white field of pure chronal energy. The force-field Kang has erected that is keeping Lockjaw from teleporting in is keeping them out as well. Nothing short of cutting the chronal power supply in ancient Egypt can bring down the field.

If the heroes flee—and they probably should—neither the Inhumans nor the guards give chase, but they do radio their description to all the other guards in the city. Travel through Attilan becomes much more complicated after that.

Should the heroes prove victorious in this truly difficult encounter, proceed to the final encounter with Godking Kang described later in the chapter. If, however, the fight proves too much or they decide not to take Kang head-on just yet, proceed with the other option to head to ancient Egypt first.

Kang's Time Chair

Whether they head there directly or flee from pursuers, the trip to the Aerodrome/Spaceport can be as quick or as difficult as the Narrator prefers. Outside of the Royal Palace, Lockjaw's teleportation abilities function normally, and he can easily teleport the heroes to their destination. Or you may prefer to have them squeak it out, carefully creeping across Attilan.

Lockjaw knows that Kang arrived here in a small, chair-shaped craft that he claimed travels through time, as well as space. He was not allowed to bring his Time Chair into the Royal Palace, so it remains parked at the Aerodrome under the watchful eye of the Inhuman Royal Guard. The guards are more preoccupied with keeping an eye on the vessel and the danger it might pose than with keeping visitors away from it. As such, they can be convinced to let the heroes access the vessel with an Ego vs. TN 15 action check. Once again, if Lockjaw is present, the heroes gain an edge on this check.

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Michael Syrell (Order: 53194700)

Art by Carlos Magno & Espen Grundetjern

Once they approach the chair, Lockjaw falls back. He has no intention of leaving his family at a time like this.

Activating the Time Chair is easy; perhaps Kang felt no one would dare try to interfere with it. And, even if they did, piloting it would be beyond their comprehension. With a push of a button, a log of Kang's recent comings and goings displays itself. All of his trips revolve around coming to or leaving from a specific point in space and time: a temple complex in the land of Egypt during the time of the pharaohs, 2950 BCE. Whatever Kang is doing there is channeling incredible amounts of chronal energy into the Royal Palace from a power supply located in ancient Egypt; if that power supply is shut off, Kang will be vulnerable.

However, while the heroes gain access to the chair, operating it is a different matter.

The mechanics behind operating the Time Chair are slightly different from other checks in the game. Any time they attempt to pilot the chair, call for an Ego vs. TN 15 action check. If the hero has any familiarity with Stark technology, give them an edge on this check since the Time Chair is based on 41st-century applications of 21st-century Stark technologies.

This is no longer a question of failure but exactly how successful they are in their attempt to pilot the craft. Wherever the characters end up, the Time Chair goes with them.

- **They succeed by 6 or more:** Total success! The heroes arrive exactly when and where they're supposed to, and bypass as many of the encounters detailed below as the Narrator sees fit.
- **They succeed by 4 or 5:** The heroes arrive exactly when and where they're supposed to in a safe enough location to be able to survey the area without being immediately detected.
- **They succeed by 1 to 3:** The heroes arrive exactly when and where they're supposed to in an area directly in the patrol route of four of Rama-Tut's human-sized robots. The heroes have an edge on their initiative checks against the robots.
- **They succeed with exactly 15:** The heroes successfully arrive in Egypt in the year 2950 BCE but may or may not arrive at their physical destination, as defined by the Narrator.
- **They fail by 1 to 3:** The heroes successfully arrive in Egypt in the year 2950 BCE in an area directly in the patrol route of four of Rama-Tut's robots. The robots are aware of their arrival and give the heroes trouble on their initiative checks.
- **They fail by 4 or 5:** The heroes successfully arrive in Egypt, but sometime other than the year 2950 BCE, or they arrive in 2950 BCE, but somewhere other than Egypt.
- **They fail by 6 or more:** Lost in space…and time! The heroes end up in a wholly unanticipated place and time, and will need to successfully use the Time Chair again to escape.

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This is a golden opportunity for you, as Narrator, to insert whatever time-traveling hijinks into your story that you would like. Kang's Time Chair can take the heroes anywhere and anytime in this universe, but it cannot travel interdimensionally. As of now, Lockjaw is their only way to get back to their Earth. Note: You can make the return trip back to Attilan as complicated as you'd like as well.

THE LAND OF THE PHARAOH

When the heroes arrive in the year 2950 BCE, they're greeted by a sight you won't find in any history book. It's all so… *green*. Gardens filled with flowers, trees and fountains dot the sandy landscape. The pyramids of Giza stand gleaming, covered in their original marble, and the Great Pyramid has its golden capstone. The Nile flows much closer by the Sphinx, which stands with its original jackal-like face, than it does in modern time. High above, technological airships wheel overhead, stylized like Bennu birds. Beautiful people clad in robes make their way through the streets, stopping to pay respects to the priests standing outside the various temples of the gods.

But one temple towers over the others.

Adjacent to the Sphinx, a massive temple stands with two 60-foot statues of Rama-Tut, looming over the people of this time. Rama-Tut is Kang at an earlier point in his life, having created an empire for himself in ancient Egypt. At the base of the statue is a small army of golden robots. They range in size from person-sized robots with faces that look almost human to upwards of 12-foot robots shaped to look like the various gods of Egypt. And two 25-foot robots that look exactly like giant mechanized versions of Rama-Tut surveying the passersby for sufficient penitence.

Along the Nile, a huge crowd is lined up on both sides of the river, waving goodbye to a grand procession of boats sailing toward Upper—A.K.A. the southern part of—Egypt. The boats are a mixture of lavish wooden barges, along with technology so advanced it's almost alien. Large cannons adorn the central vessel, which looks like it could lift off and fly at any moment, and on top is Pharaoh Rama-Tut himself, standing resplendent in the sun, leading his army out of the city and into the desert.

As he speaks, the mouths of all the robots in the city open and echo his voice, booming everywhere.

"My children. There is a cancer growing in the heart of our eternal kingdom. The rebel miscreant Baal and his traitorous Sandstormers think they can defy my will. NONE may defy Rama-Tut! I will crush *these blasphemous dogs and bring En Sabah Nur back here. As Horus glorified Osiris, I shall raise him properly to embrace his power and glorify me, your god!"*

The people begin cheering in unison—under the watchful eye of the robots, of course:

Oh Rama-Tut, You the King of Truth, the Lord of Eternity,

The Prince of Everlastingness,

You Sovereign of all Gods,

You God of Life, you Creator of Eternity,

You Maker of Heaven.

All the Gods rejoice at your rising!

The chanting continues as the fleet sails down the Nile, out of sight. The heroes have arrived at a fortuitous moment; their enemy has removed himself from their path.

Into the City

How the heroes are received by the city's robots and residents varies greatly based on their appearance and what lengths they go to disguise themselves. The larger of the golden robots remain in the vicinity of the temple of Rama-Tut, but the human-sized robots make routine patrols through the city. Their pattern is discernible with a Routine Logic check, since they want their presence known.

Whether the heroes intend to evade or attack the robots, an unusual scene unfolds before them:

A crash and a scream alert them to a commotion as a woman runs out of her house, clutching a young child.

"Please, please let him go! I am begging you… I am begging for Pharaoh Rama-Tut's mercy for my son!"

A moment later, two of the human-sized robots emerge from the house, one holding a teenage boy by the collar, as if he weighs nothing.

The young man shouts defiantly, *"The gods will topple this false king! Glory to Egypt!"*

The woman pleads as the robots ignore her completely, *"He is just young! He will learn to love and worship the Pharaoh as I have!"*

The robots' mouths open as a recording of Rama-Tut's voice plays. *"The punishment for blasphemy is* death!" The robots' eyes begin to glow red with crackling energy, preparing to reduce the boy to ashes…unless the heroes do something first!

The Fight

As the heroes engage the first two human-sized robots, two more immediately arrive on the scene. In the third round, two more appear. If combat continues into the fourth round, one of the airships arrives on the scene as well. These human-sized robots are actually prototype versions of Kang's Growing Man robots. Use the profile for the Growing Man in Chapter 8: Characters.

Rama-Tut's Airship

Vehicle or Equipment	Speed	Powers	Health
Rama-Tut's airship	10 spaces	Elemental Barrage (energy) Elemental Blast (energy) Elemental Burst (energy) Flight 2	150 Health

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Rama-Tut's airships are automated.

- If the vehicle/equipment takes 50% damage, it slows to half speed.
- Taking 100% damage renders the vehicle destroyed.
- All of the airship's action checks should use the base stats from the Hydra Officer profile found in Chapter 8: Characters.

In the fight, two of the robots face the heroes, with the woman, the small child and the teenager between them and the robots. The other two arrive from the left and right sides of the map. There are all manner of carts and tables that can potentially be used for cover, but the priority must be getting the family out of the line of fire.

Thankfully, as soon as the heroes engage, the robot holding the teenager drops him, and they are completely ignored until the greater threat posed by the heroes is dealt with. But by no means are they out of danger.

The robots attack, repeating in unison: *"The punishment for blasphemy is* death*!"*

The robots' threat-assessment skills are limited; they respond first to any aggression against themselves and second to any aggression being directed toward another unit. If there is no clear aggressor—or all targets are equally aggressive—they target the physically largest hero first. They feel no pain, fear or remorse and fight until incapacitated.

Should the heroes have technological abilities that allow them to hack the robots, call for a Logic vs. TN 19 check to connect with the advanced machine. If the hero has any familiarity with Stark technology or has previously operated the Time Chair, give them an edge on this check due to their familiarity with the Time Chair's 41st-century applications of 21st-century Stark tech. If they are successful, the robot may be able to be repurposed or utilized in ways limited only by the hero's imaginations and the mercy of the Narrator!

After the fight if they've rescued the family, the boy, Asim, pulls from his mother Khepri's grasp to rush up to the heroes. Her baby girl, Bahiti, smiles with a cheery-eyed, toothless grin at the heroes, completely undisturbed by the chaos.

"You strangers destroyed them! Are you gods from a foreign land?"

However, before the heroes respond, Khepri chimes in with a voice of reason, *"We should leave this place before more of those abominations appear!"* She doesn't wait for agreement; she grabs her son's hand and immediately rushes down a nearby alley. *"Come, come!"*

The heavy footfalls of more approaching robots should motivate the heroes to move along…quickly!

The Coming of Rama-Tut

Khepri leads the heroes quickly through the alleyways between buildings until she comes to what looks like an abandoned building. They squeeze their way through the boards over the doorway and motion for the heroes to follow.

Once they're inside, Asim moves quickly, pushing crates to block the door. Khepri puts the baby in a cradle and lights a small lamp.

"So. From what land do you wanderers hail?"

Whatever the heroes choose to share, Khepri and Asim believe it with minimum prompting. These heroes are but another thing on a very long list of incredible things they've seen in their mortal lives.

Asim leaps to his feet, wild-eyed. *"They are not gods…but have been sent by the gods to save us!"*

"You forget yourself, my son. That impulsiveness is what led those metal monstrosities to our door! Please, friends, allow us to tell you how our land has come into such a state.

*"This…*usurper *arrived when my son was but a boy. His ship crashed in the desert, leaving him blinded and injured; the stories say he is no god but just a man from the far, far future. What manner of god could be injured in such a fashion?*

"Sadly, he was found by a gentle healer named Baal and his band of Sandstormers who lived in the desert south of here. They rescued him from the ship and nursed the wounded man back to health. Although blinded in the crash, he rejected their hospitality and eventually fled into the desert, leaving behind devices that held information about the coming birth of the Chosen One, known as En Sabah Nur.

"He brought his army of robots and weapons from his hidden vessel and easily took over our kingdom of Egypt, renaming himself Rama-Tut. He even used our healing magics to restore his lost vision. Rama-Tut forced the people of Egypt to worship him and build massive statues in his honor and reject the old gods."

"The true *gods,"* Asim interjects.

"Just so," his mother agrees. *"Now he has led his army into the desert once again to crush the Sandstormers and recover this En Sabah Nur. I hope the gods hide his path from Rama-Tut for all time,"* she says, spitting on the ground for emphasis.

Khepri answers any of the heroes' questions to the best of her ability, but she doesn't know much beyond whispers and hearsay.

The Rise of the Resistance

Asim looks at them, his eyes pleading. *"There are many who wish this man gone and our old ways to return, but they are scattered. Frightened. The gods have sent you here for a reason; perhaps you could help us find a way to fight back…to* resist*!"*

The heroes have an important choice to make. On the one hand, they must do everything in their power to get back to Attilan as fast as possible to stop Godking Kang's machinations there. However, they literally have a time machine and could spend years here if they chose and still arrive at the same time back on Attilan. *But*, they don't know how long they have until the Rama-Tut of this time returns from his campaign.

Whether they choose to get hands on in the rallying of a resistance to the tyranny of Rama-Tut, simply encourage the people with a rousing speech or do nothing at all, you, the Narrator, should give out edges or even troubles as their actions dictate.

Should they attempt to rally fighters to their call, the mechanics behind this check are once again slightly different from normal ability checks. First, call for a Ego vs. TN 15 check. This is no longer a question of failure, but exactly how successful they are in their attempt to light the fires of rebellion in the hearts of these people.

- **They succeed by 6 or more:** Total success! Riots in the streets! People of all walks of life attack every robot in sight, clearing a path through all but the encounter with Logos and the final two robots guarding Kang's ship.

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- **They succeed by 4 or 5:** Pockets of unrest break out in strategic areas in the city, drawing out all of the aircraft and human-sized robots from the heroes' path to the temple.
- **They succeed by 2 or 3:** As word spreads about the heroes, whispers come back about a secret entrance into the temple if they can avoid detection in the approach.
- **They succeed with exactly 15:** A mass of people gather around the Temple of Rama-Tut, granting the characters an edge in the first combat they engage in with the robots.
- **They fail by 2 or 3:** The fear of Rama-Tut's wrath is simply too great, and only Khepri and Asim are willing to help.
- **They fail by 4 or 5:** Betrayal! Word of the heroes' plan reaches the wrong person, who swiftly informs Rama-Tut's forces. All adversaries they encounter inside the temple have one edge in the first round of combat.
- **They fail by 6 or more:** Catastrophe. Word reaches Logos of what the heroes are planning, souring him against them. He launches a surprise attack along with the Rank 5 robots from inside the temple on the heroes, aiming to make an example out of them and everyone foolish enough to assist them…starting with Asim and Khepri.

Whatever the result, the people fight bravely but not foolishly in the defense of their home.

To the Temple of Rama-Tut

If the heroes learn of the secret entrance, this encounter can be bypassed completely.

If the heroes prefer the direct approach, the outside of the temple is guarded by four human-sized robots and the two Rank 5 25-foot statues of Rama-Tut. Although the statues are physically the largest, they are not the most powerful in the Pharaoh's arsenal. (Use the Abomination profile in the *Core Rulebook* for these 25-foot statues.)

Use the Temple Entrance map. The two large statues flank each side of the entrance, and the four human-sized robots are arrayed directly in front of them, between the heroes and the entrance. There are trees and pillars available for cover.

As the heroes approach, the statues call out in Rama-Tut's voice:

"Bow down before your god, Pharaoh Rama-Tut!" The robots attack, shouting in unison the now-familiar refrain: *"The punishment for blasphemy is* death!"

In the fight, the robots use the same threat-assessment tactics as before, but they always prioritize targeting the heroes over any other citizen.

Art by Adam Pollina & Tim Townsend

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Into the Temple of Rama-Tut

Whether they fight their way in or gain access through the secret entrance, the heroes are confronted by an astonishing, lavish scene.

Five 12-foot golden robots shaped in the forms of the gods Ra, Set, Apep, Sobek and Serket worship before a 25-foot robot like the one outside. Although these statues are smaller, they are more powerful opponents with individual power sets:

The falcon-headed Ra robot has elemental fire powers. (Use the Human Torch profile from the *Core Rulebook*.)

The jackal-headed Set robot has Chaos magic powers. (Use the Scarlet Witch profile from the *Core Rulebook*.)

The Apep robot is a giant snake with growth-resize powers. (Use the Giant-Man [Raz Malhotra] profile from the *Core Rulebook*.)

The crocodile-headed Sobek robot has Tactics powers. (Use the Shuri profile from the *Core Rulebook*.)

The Serket robot is a giant scorpion with some insect-like powers. (Use the Doctor Octopus profile from the *Core Rulebook*.)

Use the interior temple map. These robots fight completely differently than those in the previous encounters. In every round, Sobek acts first using his Tactics powers to give his side the advantage. The heroes would be wise to eliminate him as fast as possible. Beyond this, they each pair off with one hero who their powers match up against most favorably. Hacking these robots represents an Absurd Logic check.

If you are playing this adventure with only four players, consider dropping the Sobek robot from the encounter, unless you want it to be especially difficult.

During the battle, the Rama-Tut robot doesn't fight. It simply monologues with painfully accurate jabs at the heroes for every mistake they make with taunts such as:

"Fools, you are unworthy of the true might of Rama-Tut!"

"It would dishonor me to bless you with my wrath!"

"I am the Pharaoh of all time and space, and you are but insects!"

"If you fools knew what is to come in the endless centuries ahead, you would bow down and embrace my will!"

The statues do not verbally respond to any provocation, but particularly blasphemous comments might result in their attention being redirected at the speaker.

If any of the heroes are knocked unconscious—or, worse, killed—a different voice speaks through the robots: that of Logos (see below). He promises medical treatment for the fallen hero in exchange for the heroes' commitment to peacefully negotiate with him in the inner chamber.

If the heroes agree, the fight is over. If not, it continues. The robots do not surrender under any circumstances.

An Audience With the Grand Vizier

Whether the heroes are triumphant in the previous battle or are forced to surrender, deep within the temple, they find a lone man: Logos, the Grand Vizier (whose profile can be found in Chapter 8: Characters). Logos is a slight Egyptian man wearing a tunic with no discernable weapons or armor. If the robots brought or pursued the heroes this far, he dismisses them.

"I am Logos, Grand Vizier of Egypt, and I am not your enemy, off-worlders. You are as alien to this time as my master, Rama-Tut. Tell me—who are you and why have you come?"

Logos' telepathic abilities make him difficult to lie to, and should they be caught in a deception, Logos takes no offense… at first. Even limited threats or attempts at coercion are met with diplomacy.

"I know I look feeble, but I assure you I am difficult to deceive. Please, offer me your honesty, and I shall offer you mine."

Logos is keenly curious about the heroes and their mission here, but his patience has limits. Should they insult or attack him, he activates the final two robots and uses every means at his disposal to escape. He leaves any fighting to the robots.

Should they talk with him, however, he both asks questions and answers them honestly to the best of his ability.

He asks questions such as:

"Do you know where En Sabah Nur is hiding?"

"Does Rama-Tut still rule in your time?"

"What is the ultimate fate of my world?"

"What is life like in the land and time you come from?"

He can answer questions such as:

Where did Rama-Tut come from?
"The far future. A time he calls the '41st century,' nearly 44,000 years from now. He claims to be a conqueror of worlds, but using power such as his against people such as us is like hurling boulders at anthills. If he is so great, why doesn't he fight ones like you?"

Where is the power supply?
"You must mean the Chronifact. Rama-Tut's Time Ship is where he keeps his technology. It is hidden underneath the sphinx. I can guide you to it, but even I cannot bypass the two mighty defenders guarding it."

Why are you helping us?
"However great a man Rama-Tut is, he's still just a man…and men are fallible and temporary. I wish to see for myself what other secrets are hiding in his vessel, and this is the first opportunity I've had to do so."

Then why are you helping *him*?
"In my capacity as Grand Vizier, I can help direct his boundless cruelty. And he gives me just enough access to his knowledge and technology to be able to advance my scientific work. I have accomplished more in the last ten years than I would have in fifty…but I feel no gratitude because I know he did not do this for me, he did it for himself."

Who is En Sabah Nur?
"He is something Rama-Tut calls a 'mutant,' apparently the first of what will one day become a mighty race."

What does Rama-Tut want with En Sabah Nur?
"He is the herald of some sort of apocalypse. Rama-Tut wishes to make him his heir so that the boy's power will be at his disposal."

Ultimately, unless hostilities have broken out, Logos helps them access Kang's Time Ship. Logos has his own reasons for wanting to access the vessel, and he needs the heroes to clear the way.

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Approaching the Ship

Logos guides the heroes deep underground through tunnels carved perfectly through solid rock, illuminated by glowing stones. Elaborate hieroglyphics cover the walls, depicting Rama-Tut's descent from heaven to rule over the lands of Egypt as their one true god and Pharaoh.

Once they have walked for what seems like an eternity, they reach a final room where Logos stops.

"I can go no farther. Directly ahead, you will find the answers you seek…and hopefully, so will I."

Ahead, inside the room, Kang's Time Ship sits. It is shaped like a black metal sphinx, with all manner of cables and hoses extending off it and into the walls and floors of the room, supplying power to the entire temple complex. In front of the ship, on the paws of the sphinx lay two slabs with human-sized robots on top of them, side by side. One looks like a green-skinned man wearing a pharaonic nemes headdress. The other looks like a beautiful woman made out of alabaster with a headdress with a sun disk between the horns of a cow. The profiles for the Isis and Osiris robots can be found in Chapter 8: Characters.

The moment the heroes cross the threshold into the room, the two robots hold hands and activate a Level 3 Defensive Team Maneuver. In this fight, these are especially ferocious opponents; Kang has trusted them to defend his Time Ship for a reason.

Tactically, they focus on a single target together until that hero is eliminated. They focus on the physically weakest hero first and then work their way up, leaving the most physically imposing enemy for last. Isis initially prioritizes dampening the heroes' powers until either Osiris or two of the heroes are incapacitated, then she shifts to power duplication. Osiris tries to incapacitate as many as possible with spells such as the Crimson Bands of Cyttorak before switching to offense. Hacking these robots is an impossible task.

This is a particularly difficult fight, especially if the heroes have had to fight their way to this point. If any of the heroes is knocked unconscious—or, worse, killed—Logos risks his life to rush in and drag them out to safety; the Isis and Osiris robots don't leave this room under any circumstances. If the entire party is defeated in this way, they awaken in Logos' lab attached to healing equipment with a chance to regroup.

Art by Carlos Magno & Espen Grundetjern

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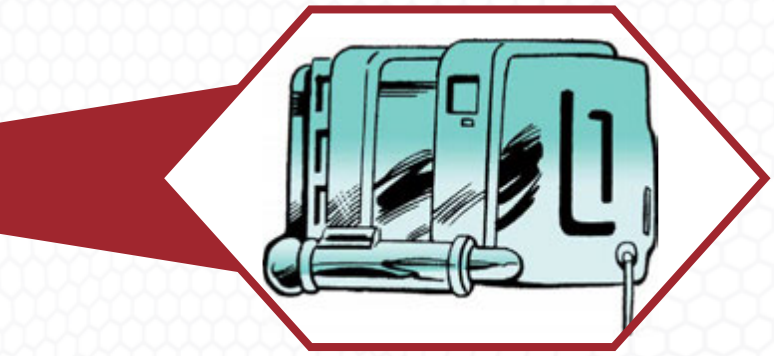
THE CHRONIFACT



Art by John Ross, Martin Griffiths & Gary Gravett

Entering the Time Ship

Once the sentries are dealt with, Kang's Time Ship lies undefended. When the heroes try to access it, call for a Logic vs. TN 19 check to connect with the advanced machine. If the hero has any familiarity with Stark technology or has previously operated the Time Chair, give them one edge on this check due to their familiarity with the Time Chair's 41st-century applications of 21st-century Stark tech. Simply using force against the advanced craft to batter the door open constitutes a Melee vs. TN 21 action check.

Once inside, the craft is a much larger, yet somehow less sophisticated version of the Time Chair, similar to how a computer from twenty years ago is a physically larger piece of hardware that has less processing power than a modern cell phone a tenth the size. Inside the ship, Kang has relics from across space and time: dinosaur skulls; a broken Iron Man helmet; half of Thor's hammer, Mjolnir, levitating in an antigravity container; a Skrull and a Kree floating in suspended animation; 41st-century datapads containing all manner of history, science and knowledge; and anything else the Narrator decides.

Most any question the heroes have about this world—and perhaps their own—can be answered here by Kang's technology. Further Logic checks are unnecessary unless you, the Narrator, decide to call for them; the ship views the heroes as its master Kang and hides nothing from them. If the heroes look up Kang's mind-control technology, give them an edge and reduce the target number by 1 when they try to free the Inhumans later.

In the center of the room sits a pillar that is clearly meant to hold something missing: Rama-Tut's lost Eye of Ages. Without it, this ship can't travel, leaving both it and Kang stuck here—at least for now. (Baal of the Sandstormers has the Eye of Ages at this time.)

The Chronifact is not difficult to locate inside the ship's engine room. It looks like a row of interconnected boxes, not unlike a high-tech radiator of a completely different make than the rest of Kang's technology. And yet it pulses and hums with chronal energy that warps and distorts the very fabric of time around it, giving you odd glimpses of Attilan and Godking Kang. Anyone attempting to approach it must make an Ego vs. TN 15 action check to be able to steel their resolve enough to approach it. If they reach out to touch or interact with the Chronifact in any way, Logos calls out:

"Wait, you're not from this time; if you get too close to it, your own ungrounded chronal energy will—"

Too late.

The Fury of Time Unleashed

Through the distortion, you see Godking Kang look in your direction and reach out as the Chronifact EXPLODES. The damage it inflicts is more temporal than physical, however.

This is another opportunity for you, as Narrator, to have a field day!

The heroes can see literally anything you decide, in whatever detail you decide. You can have them detour into entire other adventures or merely glimpse snapshots from previous adventures or the finale to this campaign. Some suggestions include:

- **The Blitz of London in World War II:** Remember, in this world, Hydra infiltrates S.H.I.E.L.D. from its infancy, so in many ways, this conflict was the beginning of the end for this world.
- **The Coming of Apocalypse:** En Sabah Nur eventually embraces his identity as the powerful mutant Apocalypse and overthrows Rama-Tut once and for all…but is it for better or worse?
- **Important character moments:** What was their variant's life like on Earth-56438? Perhaps they get a glimpse of what this other version of them became. How does it make them feel to witness this?
- Baron Zemo plotting the invasion of the heroes' Earth along with Madame Masque; this is an excellent opportunity to tie up any potential loose plot threads from the previous adventures.
- A formless void at the dawn of time with Doctor Doom, Thanos, Dormammu and Magneto facing off against… the heroes? That's a little hint for how the final adventure of this campaign concludes!

Whatever they see, however many places they visit and however long you choose to spend exploring this, eventually, the heroes return to the same place and time within Kang's Time Ship…but the Chronifact is shattered. The device has broken into pieces, of which only one remains and the others have all disappeared.

With the heroes having succeeded in their mission here, allow them to explore the ship and resolve any further business with Logos and the budding resistance before taking the Time Chair back to Attilan.

RETURN TO ATTILAN

Ahead of their return to Attilan, the players may have some questions or plans that require addressing.

What If We Contact Hydra?

Hydra is still the dominant power on Earth-56438 and, as such, has a vested interest in not seeing it destroyed. They are also fascist monsters who would sooner launch a full nuclear strike against Attilan than have an advanced race of aliens living above them. If the heroes choose to inform Hydra about Galactus' imminent arrival, they bring their full might to bear in the defense of Earth in whatever way you see fit.

What About Time-Travel Hijinks?

Time-travel stories can become especially twisty, with a lot of unintended consequences. If you aren't careful, the plot

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can quickly descend into nonsense like "We'll travel back in time to hide keys/weapons/the Avengers here to help us, so we should have it right now!" The simplest solution is to use the parameters given previously for piloting the Time Chair, so hijinks like that are statistically improbable to pull off.

But there is one particularly novel idea that your players may attempt: What if they go back in time to stop Kang the moment he arrives in Attilan?

Never punish creativity. Should the heroes think of this strategy—or any other clever one—allow it to play out as you see fit. However, Kang is a genius with a particular mastery of time travel. There is no guarantee he wouldn't see such an ambush coming and have a mighty contingency plan.

Also, for reasons that become clear at the end of this adventure, the Devourer still arrives. If the heroes succeed in ambushing Kang before he can even put his plan in motion, they may end up with a *very* false sense of security about the fate of this world.

Should they decide to stick with the original plan, the Time Chair will transport the heroes back to the Aerodrome.

Outside the Royal Palace

The heroes arrive back at the Aerodrome and are greeted with a very different Attilan than the one they left. The city is in total lockdown with a message playing on a loop echoing throughout the city:

"By order of King Black Bolt, all citizens are required to return to their homes—effective immediately."

Inhuman Royal Guards gently but firmly drive people out of the streets, using nonlethal but still violent means to "restore order."

A moment later, Lockjaw teleports to the heroes, happily licking their faces in a way that only a 1,200-pound bulldog can! With the destruction of the Chronifact, the force-field around the Royal Palace has dropped, allowing Lockjaw to teleport them in directly—assuming they don't want to do something about the guards first.

If the heroes intend to go straight to confront Kang, really twist the knife by emphasizing the terror in the streets as the guards are dispersing the people. Defeating Kang and freeing the Inhumans is definitely the greater good, but no one said being a hero is easy!

Inside the Royal Palace

Once Lockjaw teleports them inside the throne room, what would normally be a scene of dignity and resplendence is anything but. The room is covered by a crystal dome that gives an unobstructed view of the sky and, beyond it, Earth. Two large thrones sit in the center of the room, with adjacent chairs for the other members of the Royal Family, even Lockjaw. All the Inhumans are here—Black Bolt, Medusa, Crystal, Gorgon and Karnak—whether or not the heroes already faced off against some of them previously.

If the heroes come straight here, Lockjaw is here as well. All of the Inhumans sit on their thrones, staring silently ahead. In the center of the room stands the cell containing Black Bolt. He is leaning heavily on one side, clearly on the verge of collapse. But he continues to scream as the box channels the energy into a beam of light that is flying up into the sky to an unknown destination.

In the center of the room, Godking Kang (use the profile for Kang the Conqueror in Chapter 8: Characters) stands observing Black Bolt, his back to the heroes. If the heroes bring the Time Chair here, Kang raises a hand and commandeers it instantly, gaining access to its full capabilities—many of which the heroes have no idea of.

Art by Andre Lima Araujo & Frank D'Armata

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The Fury of the Godking

With or without his throne, Kang finally turns and addresses the heroes:

"Ah. So, that's what happened to the Chronifact. I was always curious about that. You interlopers have proven you have some skill and, by extension, some usefulness. Bow down and pledge your allegiance to me, Godking Kang, and I will spare your lives. Decide quickly; this world's time is nearly at an end."

Godking Kang exudes the height of arrogance. He answers any questions with condescension but honestly. He truly believes himself to be superior to the heroes and every other living thing. He also talks for as long as the heroes choose to talk; after all, if there is anything he has, it's time. *The heroes* don't, but he does. Even if they attack him, Godking Kang is unflappable. He continues talking calmly even as the battle rages.

Here are some answers Godking Kang might give to common questions:

What are you doing?

"It isn't possible to tame the wind and waves, but it is possible to adjust our sails. Without the Crimson Surfer, Galactus is unchecked. I am bringing him to heel."

Why are you doing this?

"Because I can. It is the Divine Right of Power. Because no one can stop me, my actions are, by definition, just."

What is this device you've constructed?

"Since my Eye of Ages was lost, I required a power supply, and King Black Bolt fit the bill. He will wear out and die soon, but not before he has served his purpose."

What did you do to those people back in Egypt?

"I ruled them. It was a glorious time when the common people got down on their knees in praise without prompting; perhaps I will return there to retire at the end of my days."

If you're so powerful, why did you allow Hydra to take over?

"They are but a bubble in the river of time, as are you. They are my world's caretakers for a generation, perhaps two. In a few centuries, they will be but memories and dust."

What did you do to the Inhumans? Let them go!

"Why? I made use of them. Perhaps you require a demonstration…" Kang promptly orders them to attack!

Use the map of the Royal Palace (page 127) for this fight. In the fight, Kang doesn't dirty his hands unless he must. The heroes are so far beneath him that he would not sully himself by dispatching them. He has people for that. At the first sign of aggression, Kang orders the Inhumans to attack.

The Inhumans begin with a Level 3 Offensive Team Maneuver, which should make it clear to the heroes that they mean business. Crystal uses her Elemental Powers (Air) to target any heroes who can fly or are clearly very mobile. Gorgon uses his superhuman strength to charge right at the strongest-looking hero. Karnak uses his Exploit power to target whichever hero is the leader or whoever appears to be the most intelligent. Medusa uses her hair to attack anyone trying to free Black Bolt first or attacking Kang second. As long as the Inhumans are under Kang's control, they are prepared to fight to the death.

Kang continues to ignore the heroes until all of the Inhumans have been defeated or freed from his control. He then uses the Time Chair to activate a temporal singularity to bring two more versions of himself (all using the same profile) to this present moment to fight alongside himself.

"Kang, what sort of a mess have you gotten us into this time?"

"I will explain later, Kang. First, we must dispatch these nuisances."

"In my time, I rule with a much firmer hand, Kang."

"Yes, but if I fall here, you fall there, Kang."

Once all three Kangs join the battle, they begin with a Level 3 Defensive Team Maneuver. Godking Kang is a tactical genius and directs all his fury toward the most dangerous opponent. If you wish to make him particularly evil, have him target Lockjaw. After all, that miserable mutt is what got him into this mess!

This is, potentially, a nearly impossible battle unless the heroes take steps to turn things around by freeing the Inhumans from their mind control, but doing so is difficult. Have the heroes make an Ego vs. TN 19 check for each Inhuman they seek to free. There are, however, several ways to make this more feasible.

- Lockjaw zeroes in on Crystal, trying to get the heroes to free her first. Because of the special bond between them, the check is lowered to TN 17.
- If the heroes looked up Kang's mind-control technology aboard the Time Ship, give them an edge and reduce the TN of each roll by 1.
- For each Inhuman freed, the heroes gain one edge when trying to free the next one. The strength of the Royal Family's connections with each other is the source of this potentially powerful boost.

The mind-controlled Inhumans fight to the finish against the heroes and their own family alike.

Black Bolt is unreachable inside his cell, and Kang fights like a lion to keep him inside. The heroes have to be ingenious in their plan to free him, since the moment the cell is opened, the devastating power of his voice is also unleashed!

Clever, possibly foolhardy, heroes may try to find a way to unleash Black Bolt's power *against* Kang. Should this happen, you, the Narrator, should delight in finding interesting ways to pay off this particularly high-stakes gambit.

This is the final battle of the penultimate adventure in this campaign, so it should be the stuff of legend. Kang is a great and terrible foe, possessed of nearly as much power as he has ego. Make sure he leaves his mark stamped deeply on the heroes'—and players'—memories.

THE END OF THE BEGINNING

When Kang crashes to the ground in defeat, the other two versions of him decide to cut their losses and depart. They teleport away with a parting jab:

"Mediocre, Kang."

"Your weakness has allowed our defeat."

Despite the truly super-heroic beating the heroes and their Inhuman allies have laid on him, Kang still struggles back to his feet, beaten and battered.

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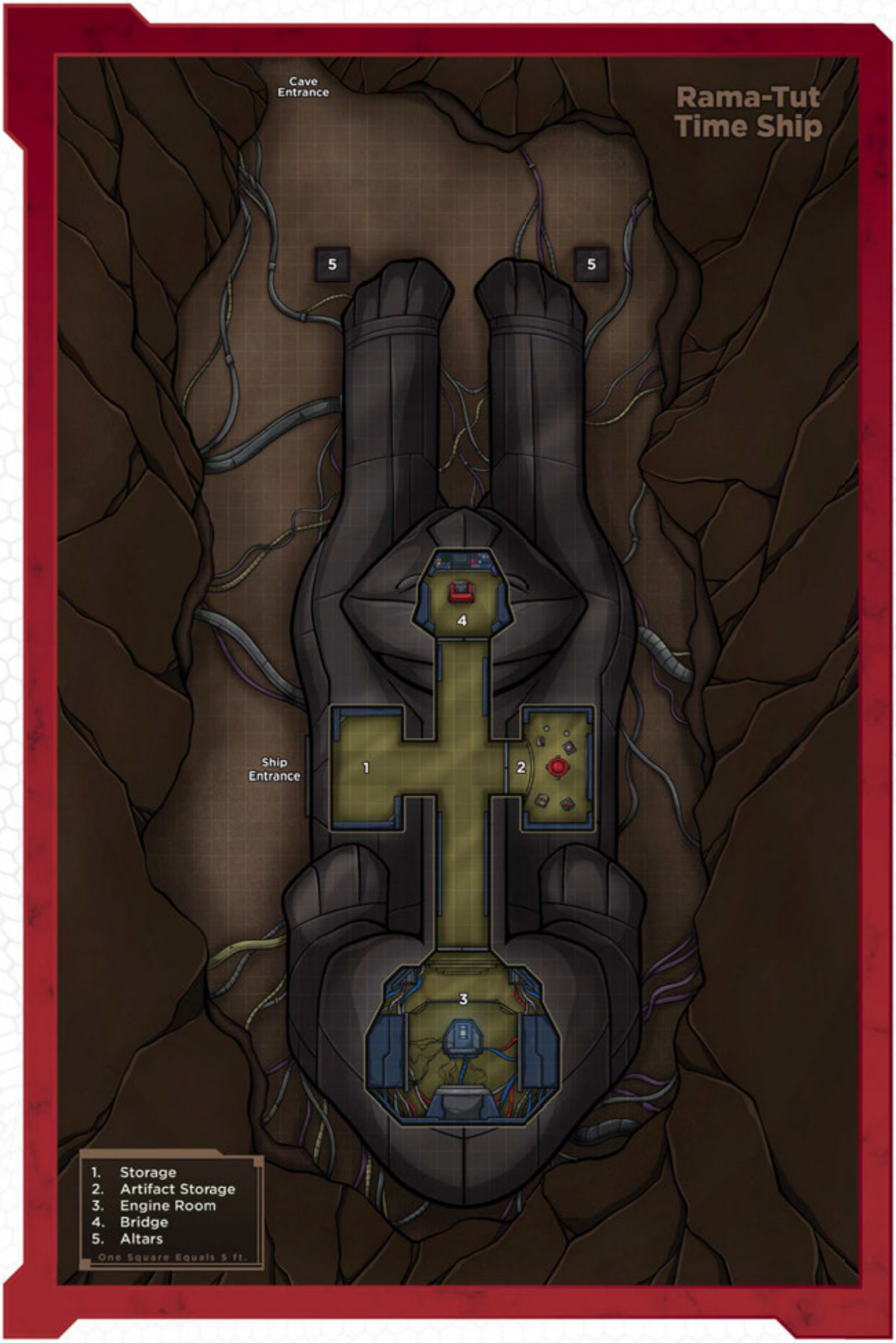

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Art by Jae Lee

Michael Symon (Order #53194700)

Black Bolt immediately stops screaming and collapses as Medusa rushes to her husband, ripping the cell door off its hinges.

"You will pay for this, interloper; I swear it as the Queen of Attilan!"

Kang limps over and sits on Black Bolt's throne, defeated.

"Yes, I will. We all will. It's too late. It was always too late."

Before the heroes can ask any follow-up questions, a voice booms from everywhere at once:

"Yes, it was always too late, 'Godking' Kang." The voice drips with sarcasm. *"You have played your part sufficiently, as only a lesser version of myself could."*

Out of the domed view overhead, a massive vessel appears, blotting out the sun. Galactus' worldship, the *Taa II*, floats above, casting a long shadow over the solar system. After a moment, a holographic image blinks into the middle of the room of Galactus…with Kang's face.

Kang the Devourer Is revealed!

"Greetings, mortals. I am Kang the Devourer. Your Godking *Kang believed he could steal the power of Galactus for himself and achieve true divinity. An excellent idea, of course, which is why I actually did that myself—in my own universe—centuries ago."*

The Inhumans are largely focused on aiding their fallen king, so the heroes are free to converse with Kang, either the Godking or the Devourer. Once again, Kang the Devourer answers all questions honestly and truthfully, since what point is there in lying to beings who are about to be eradicated?

The answers to some common questions might go like this:

Who are you?

"The sentients of this reality are especially slow. I told you, I am Kang the Devourer. I was once small like that one, but now I am everything he wished to become."

What is happening?

"Your Kang thought he could control me. One of many who has made such foolish attempts. All he—and you—have done is bring my attention to your timeline, which I will now consume."

You consume…worlds? Entire *timelines*?

"Yes. Just like you consume the plants and flesh of lesser beings to sustain yourself, I, too, consume lesser beings. And all beings are lesser than me."

How many times have you done this?

"I stopped counting past a certain point. How many times have you eaten what you need to survive? Or evolve? I am aware that it is difficult to fathom, but there are yet greater heights for even one such as myself to attain. This requires fuel."

When all the questions are done, Godking Kang stands up defiantly.

"I do not kneel. No Kang *kneels."*

The Devourer looks at him, nodding in approval.

"No. No Kang kneels. Which is why in every universe, every timeline, I ultimately encounter one of us. And every time, they must be destroyed."

The Devourer's eyes glow, and Black Bolt twists and wrenches on the ground, before sitting up and screaming with his dying breath at Godking Kang, who in his weakened state can mount no defense. The other Inhumans rush to restrain him, but it's no use—the crystal dome shatters, and the palace begins to collapse around the heroes. Godking Kang looks at you one last time and simply says "Avenge me" as he is reduced to atoms by Black Bolt's fury.

In the chaos, the Inhumans turn their eyes toward Kang the Devourer as their world shakes to its foundation. Medusa looks at you, as if seeing you for the first time.

"Thank you, heroes. You fought bravely for us, and that will never be forgotten. Lockjaw, send them home."

The tuning fork on Lockjaw's head lights up, even if the heroes protest. Kang the Devourer looks right at them as the portal swallows them up, his voice echoing in their ears.

"Flee, fools, to yet another Earth. I shall visit you soon enough."

And the heroes are gone.

DAMAGE CONTROL

Hopefully, the heroes manage to stick to at least the rough edges of the plot and triumph in the end. If they don't, there are all sorts of things that can go wrong.

Dead Heroes

With Rank 5 heroes, death is a bit harder to come by, but some of the encounters in this adventure are *very* difficult.

In the admittedly unlikely event this is your heroes' first adventure, Narrators should keep in mind the group's feelings about playing heroes who die. If it's a one-shot adventure using premade profiles rather than original characters, letting such unfortunate characters go might be all right. The players, after all, can just take on the roles of different characters in the next adventure.

If the players plan to continue with these characters after this adventure, though, don't let random chance end their plans. Give the other heroes a chance to save them. If necessary, you can rule that the villains wanted to capture the heroes rather than—or at least before—killing them, so the last bit of damage the hero takes is nonlethal.

However, if the *players* are looking for a heroic end for their characters, risking or even giving their lives to save a planet or an entire universe full of innocents makes for a fitting end. As long as the players consent to their characters' death, then you, the Narrator, should make that moment as great and gloriously climactic as possible, especially if these are characters who have risen up from the lowest ranks.

Also, if comic books have taught us anything, it's that death is *rarely* permanent. There's no limit to the creative ways a hero can make their way back to the land of the living.

The Villains Win

Although it's not likely, it's entirely possible for the villains to triumph over the heroes in this adventure. If that happens, it's (hopefully) not the end of the world.

Should your heroes be defeated before Black Bolt can be liberated, Lockjaw can teleport them away to regroup.

Should they be defeated after Black Bolt's liberation, you can have the heroes wake up in Godking Kang's or Kang the Devourer's custody and pick up the story at whatever section of Chapter 7: Galaxy of Hurt you prefer.

THE EPILOGUE

The heroes find themselves back at their headquarters, mere hours after they left. Yet now the weight of their universe hangs on their shoulders. The sun seems a bit darker, the

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birds sing a little quieter and their world seems balanced on a knife's edge.

How do they pick up and carry on after what they experienced? An entire *universe* of sentients is at risk of being consumed by Kang the Devourer…and what if he turns his attention here next?

Not *what if? When?*

What do the heroes do?

What can they do?

Notifying Nick Fury Jr., Tony Stark, Dr. Strange, Reed Richards or some other genius is probably a good place to start, and securing the safety and cooperation of Black Bolt and the Inhumans might be worthwhile too. One way or another, the heroes haven't seen the last of Kang the Devourer, not just the destroyer of worlds or even universes, but entire *timelines.*

AN ALTERNATE ENDING

If the heroes were originally from Hydra Earth, they reappear back home with the *Taa II* blotting out the sun. Their situation is *far* more dire because Kang the Devourer is already here. Spider-Woman comes to collect them and moves them to a new safe house where she thoroughly debriefs them. So, what do they do?

What can they do?

Call Hydra

Anyone on Earth-56438 with eyes is soon aware of the giant spaceship in the sky, but they may not know who it is or what it represents. The heroes could remedy that.

Deciding to inform Hydra what's happening is an extremely high-stakes gambit, as it is an excellent way to end up in a deep, dark cell, pressed into Hydra's service or both. Spider-Woman has the connections to send the information anonymously, but that makes it more likely to be ignored.

If Hydra is tipped off, they respond as you would expect: first with a nuclear strike against Attilan and then by mobilizing their vast resources toward mounting a counteroffensive.

Time Travel

Although the heroes lost access to the Time Chair, they now know that time travel is possible. Didn't someone mention something about an abandoned lab Doctor Doom left behind?

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Maybe he left some clues, and if not in Castle Doom, he must have had more than one lab…

Appeal to Ego

Godking Kang isn't the only massive ego on this planet. Perhaps there are other global-level super villains who could be mobilized in the defense of their world. After all, if Kang the Devourer plans to consume all of time, then literally every being in existence has a vested interest in defeating him!

Ranking Up

Whether or not it's time to have the heroes rise from Rank 5 to Rank 6 depends on your plans for the game. If you want to roll straight into the final adventure in this book, then you should go ahead and let the heroes rank up right away.

However, if you have other adventures that you want the heroes to engage in first, there's no need to rush. If the adventures you have in mind are suitable for Rank 5 heroes, then feel free to delay ranking the characters up until the time is right. You can put this off all the way until right before starting in on the final adventure in this book.

If your players would like to rank their characters up sooner than later, there's likely little harm in that. Just make sure that you adjust your adventures to be challenging for their heroes at their new ranks. Adventures are most fun when they make the triumphs they offer meaningful, and Rank 6 heroes are as powerful as they get.

If the heroes gained new or additional powers during this adventure, it's probably better to put off ranking up for a little bit if you can manage it. Let the players test out the characters' new powers for a while before they have to press on.

The Next Adventure

In the final adventure in *The Cataclysm of Kang*, the heroes learn that Kang the Devourer is coming for their universe. They must do something to stop him before it's too late, but how do you put an end to the greatest danger in time and space, especially when so many other universes have already fallen to his unabated hunger?

It's all led up to this. The final battle is upon them, and countless lives in at least *two* universes hang in the balance!

SIDETRACKS

While this adventure is complete, you and your players might not be ready to plunge straight into the adventure in the next chapter. Here are some suggestions for other things that your group can explore and have fun with in the meantime.

The Inhumans

If the heroes can find a way to the Blue Area of the Moon, Attilan is present, but the situation is *vastly* different than that of Earth-56438. The heroes have quite a story to tell but no real way to *prove* it. How do they convince the Inhumans about what happened in that other universe and may well happen again here?

Rally Earth's Mightiest Heroes

The heroes may not have returned with any physical proof, but there are plenty of other ways to prove it to people with super-powers. And having Nick Fury Jr. vouching for you certainly doesn't hurt. Armed with this, the heroes should be able to gain an audience with pretty much anyone they wish to track down. How those people respond to the heroes and the threat they've possibly led to Earth is a different matter entirely, though.

Spinning Plates

The heroes have been so busy closing portals and traveling between universes that they've left their standard rogues' gallery unattended. This is an excellent opportunity to have wholly unrelated super villains turn up to antagonize the heroes!

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Art by Paco Medina & Jesus Aburtov

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7

GALAXY OF HURT

In this age of heroes, it often seems like there's always some sort of imminent disaster about to strike the Earth. Over the years, this bright jewel of a planet has seen a seemingly infinite variety of threats: alien invasions, attacks from Hell, Hydra takeovers, killer robots and more.

Fortunately, the super heroes of Earth have always managed to rise to the occasion and stem the tide of destruction, doing everything they can to save the planet. Perhaps they haven't been able to save *everyone*, but without their efforts, the whole planet would have been doomed several times over.

This time, though, the threat is more dire than to the world itself—or even the entire universe.

It's to the entire history of the whole Marvel Multiverse.

THE BRIEFING

Galaxy of Hurt is a full-length adventure for four or five Rank 6 characters. It should take approximately two or three sessions to complete.

The Villains

In the course of this adventure, the heroes should encounter a number of different villains. Primary among these is Kang the Devourer, a Kang from an alternate universe who has taken the powers of Galactus and is using them to consume entire timelines. Profiles for him and other adversaries in this adventure can be found in Chapter 8: Characters.

Note, however, that the Devourer is a Rank X character—placing him beyond the standard system—so his profile differs as well.

The Locations

This adventure starts on the Moon, but it soon winds up in the center of the universe at the end of time, where Kang the Devourer travels to consume the universe of Earth-56438 and all its possible futures. To fix things, the heroes must travel to the dawn of time in that universe to put a stop to the Devourer's destruction.

The Plot

After the events in Chapter 6, the heroes learn that Kang the Devourer is coming for their universe. They must do something to stop him before it's too late, but how do you put an end to the greatest danger in time and space, especially when so many other universes have already fallen to his unabated hunger?

THE HEROES

This adventure assumes that the heroes are all Rank 6. However, you should feel free to tailor it to fit the needs of your group. If the heroes aren't of a high enough rank, you can give them the opportunity to set themselves up with equipment or other assistance that can give them enough power to step up to the challenges they are bound to face.

Marvel Heroes

Only the most powerful characters in the Marvel Multiverse are Rank 6. In the *Core Rulebook*, this includes Blue Marvel, Captain Marvel (Carol Danvers), Clea, Doctor Strange, Dormammu, Gorr the God Butcher, Hela, Hulk (Bruce Banner), Magneto, Professor X and Thanos.

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In Chapter 8: Characters, you can find profiles for Adam Warlock, Phoenix (Maya Lopez), Silver Surfer and Quasar (Wendell Vaughn), who are the default characters for this adventure. The players can use them or swap them out for any of the other Rank 6 heroes from the *Core Rulebook*, as they prefer.

Original Heroes

If the players have created original characters, they shouldn't attempt to tackle this adventure with those heroes until they are Rank 6. If the characters have a rank cap that's lower than Rank 6, though, you can adjust the adventure to fit them better—or give them enough resources to balance out the difference.

Either way, this adventure serves as the high-stakes culmination of the series of adventures in this book. The fate of an entire universe is at stake—and the rest of the Multiverse could fall prey to this threat soon after.

Adjusting the Difficulty

The players can, of course, use other established Marvel heroes for this adventure, beyond the default ones. If they are of a lower rank, the combat portions of the adventure might be too much of a challenge for them—depending on how much less powerful they are. If the characters are Rank 5, it's not that much of an adjustment, but it would be hard to tamp the challenges in this adventure down enough that they wouldn't absolutely demolish Rank 1 heroes.

See the first chapter of this book for some suggestions on how to adjust this adventure for your players' chosen heroes. Note, though, that you don't *have* to adjust this adventure at all. You could just use this as an exercise to show the heroes the kind of ultimate threats that await out there in the Marvel Multiverse.

If they fail—as they are likely to—they can send a record of their attempt to save their universe to the next universe on Kang the Devourer's menu. Then they can create or pick a new roster of heroes to rise to the challenge in that universe. They can even use new versions of their current heroes but try different strategies that hopefully have a better chance of success.

Failure can make for a hard way to learn lessons, but—in this game at least—it doesn't have to be the end.

THE HOOK

How the heroes become involved in the story depends on whether they played through Chapter 6: World of Trouble. If the heroes have been playing through all of the adventures in this book in order, they should already have a decent idea about what's going on. Otherwise, they're going to need someone to fill them in.

Playing as a Graphic Novel

There's a version of Kang the Conqueror—called Kang the Devourer—out there who took the place of Galactus in another universe. Since then, he has been traveling from universe to universe, eating not just the planets but their entire timelines. The heroes narrowly escaped that fate in Chapter 6: World of Trouble, but before they left, they got a look at the face of their actual foe.

In recent times—as much as such a thing can be said about a creature who consumes timelines—Kang the Devourer took a herald known as the Crimson Surfer and sent him ahead to scout for timelines worthy of the Devourer's attention. The Crimson Surfer served up untold numbers of timelines for the Devourer's ravenous appetite, but the herald was recently defeated.

Bereft of his favored servant, Kang the Devourer has begun a rampage through the Multiverse, stuffing continuum after continuum into his ravenous gullet.

After the end of the last adventure, the heroes may believe that they've escaped Kang the Devourer's wrath. After all, there are a nearly infinite number of universes out there that he could attack. It could be a long time until he gets to theirs—if he's picking them at random.

Unfortunately, Nick Fury Sr. has detected signs that the Devourer's arrival is imminent. If the heroes don't do something fast, their entire universe is doomed. Kang the Devourer will make it so that their timeline never even happened at all.

How does Fury know? Because Kang the Conqueror—of this universe—has informed him.

Kang has laid down the gauntlet before the heroes, using the elder Fury as his messenger. If they want to save their universe—something Kang is deeply invested in—then he needs their help.

Playing as a Single Issue

If the players have not played through the previous adventures, that's okay. They can jump right to the ending and get straight to the kind of high-stakes epics that Rank 6 adventures promise.

Assume that while the players might not have played the first five adventures, some other characters have still been through all those experiences. Better yet, they succeeded at what they set out to do. Those heroes, though, are perhaps not up to rising to this most demanding occasion—at least in the estimation of Kang the Conqueror. He needs a team made up of the most powerful heroes available if they're to have any prayer of saving the Multiverse. Otherwise, they're all doomed.

That's where the players' heroes come in.

FAQs

This adventure is a bit looser than some of the earlier adventures, so the players might have all sorts of questions. Here are a few that are most likely to come up, along with some answers.

Who can we get to help us?

With a problem as massive and potentially apocalyptic as this, the heroes might want to call in some help. That makes good sense—but it's less fun. The players need to be actively involved to feel like the fate of the Multiverse is up to them. Other people who might be able to lend direct aid are generally busy with different problems. The heroes need to handle this one on their own.

That said, they can ask people for information and for other kinds of help, as you can see in various parts of the adventure. This help, however, shouldn't come in the form of direct action. The players take on the role of their heroes

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because those are the people most critical to the story. Be sure not to let them get pushed aside—even if that's what they think they want.

What about this universe's Galactus?
He was dead—but he got better. He recently played a part in the Reckoning War and was restored to full health. However, he no longer hungers for the energy of planets, and he and the Silver Surfer now explore the outer edges of the universe together. No one has seen either of them since they left.

THE GRAND FINALE

Before you start, you should think about the end.

If you've been playing through the previous adventures in this book—or really, any series of adventures that have led the heroes to this point—this can be a great place to end your campaign. This adventure provides a natural stopping point.

After the heroes save the Multiverse, what else is left for them to do? What can top that?

End This Team's Journey

After playing a massive, high-stakes adventure like this, it's a challenge to concoct a new adventure that's even more dangerous with somehow even more at stake. At a certain point, the players may become weary of being placed under such incredible pressure to succeed.

That doesn't mean the players have to stop playing the game, though. Maybe they just need to try something different with new characters instead.

It's hard being some of the most powerful heroes in the universe. Maybe it's time to give being a friendly neighborhood hero a chance for a bit instead. At least when a hero blows something at that level, the worst that usually happens is that the villains get away.

The easy solution is to have the players pick or create heroes of a lower rank for your next adventure. Captain Marvel is a bit overpowered for patrolling Hell's Kitchen, but that's a fine thing for Daredevil to focus on, for instance.

That doesn't mean that the players can't go back to their Rank 6 heroes at some point, but if they need a break for a bit, go ahead and give them that. They can always return to playing those incredibly powerful heroes when something else threatens the world again later.

End the Game

Sometimes it's not that the players need a break from the heroes so much as they need to press pause on the game for a bit. That's fine too. After saving the Multiverse, they might need a moment.

You can always come back to play again. Just have that breather first so that when you return, you're all fresh and ready for even more adventures. When you do, you can decide if you want to pick up with the same characters again or start with something new.

Some players might want to return to their current characters, while others might want to start fresh. That's fine as well. Super-hero teams like the Avengers and the X-Men change their rosters up all the time, and your players' team of heroes can do the same by shuffling their membership around.

Or Keep Going!

Alternatively, you can forget all that "taking a break" stuff and press ahead! There's no wrong answer here. You and your players get to do whatever you want with your game.

That said, it's a good idea to take your foot off the pedal for a session or two after this one. Let the heroes go back home to their lives after this. Have them reconnect with their family and friends. Give them a chance to bask in the praise of a grateful universe—or, alternatively, wonder why no one ever thanks them for doing vitally important things that have few, if any, witnesses.

Look toward the end of this chapter for some ideas about where you can take your game from here. Just like in the comics, good heroes never go away.

Not for long, anyhow.

THE PLOT

The adventure takes place in roughly five parts.

1. Nick Fury Sr. contacts the heroes and warns them that while Godking Kang may have been thwarted (see Chapter 6: World of Trouble), there's still the much larger threat of Kang the Devourer to deal with, preferably before he destroys Earth-56438.
2. The Devourer's standard method is to show up in a universe at the end of time and start to consume the entire timeline. The heroes need a time machine to get there. Under Fury's guidance, they travel to Latveria to beg/borrow/steal Doctor Doom's time platform.
3. The heroes also need the Ultimate Nullifier to stop the Devourer and must figure out how to get their hands on it.
4. The heroes arrive at the end of time in Earth-56438, ready to fight. They fail, but before they can be killed, Kang from their world shows up to rescue them. He explains that Kang the Devourer is too powerful for them at that point in time.
5. With Kang's help, the heroes return to the dawn of Earth-56438's timeline and battle the Devourer. It turns out that the Devourer has rallied some help to protect himself from them. They must defeat his team and use the Ultimate Nullifier against him, perhaps at the cost of their own lives.

You can run these parts together as quickly as you like or space them out and toss in other scenes of your own—perhaps involving things that are more personally important to the various heroes—to space things out a bit. It's entirely up to you and the pace at which you and your players like to keep things moving.

WHEN FURY CALLS

A summons goes out to the heroes from Nick Fury Sr. from his station in the Blue Area of the Moon, where the Watcher (Uatu) placed him—and from which he recently embarked on a mission to take an active hand in helping out as many universes in the Multiverse as he can.

His son, Nick Fury Jr., has been monitoring the events from the entire string of adventures and relaying the information to the elder Fury. While the senior Fury is impressed with all that's been done to stop the invasion from Earth-56438,

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he knows that the danger posed by Kang the Devourer is far from over.

There are two problems as Fury sees it.

1. Kang the Devourer is about to destroy the universe of Earth-56438, including its entire timeline.
2. Once the Devourer is done with Earth-56438, he's going to be on the hunt for a new universe to destroy.

In Fury's mind, the time to act is now, before it's far too late.

Feeling Blue

Nick Fury Sr. has a long and storied history, from his time with the Howling Commandos in World War II to his legendary stint as the director of the preeminent espionage organization in the world, S.H.I.E.L.D. In recent years, though, his fate has taken several sharp turns, starting with his murder of Uatu the Watcher, who monitors—but never (well, rarely) interferes with—the fate of the Earth.

Since then, Uatu has returned from the dead and become the sole super-powered Watcher of the entire universe. As a means of penance for his horrible crime, Fury has taken over Uatu's old post in the Blue Area of the Moon, from which he watches over the Earth, monitoring it for existential threats.

Recently, Uatu permitted the father to turn over that responsibility as "the man on the wall" to the son. Apparently, Nick Fury Sr. grew weary of seeing so many threats plaguing so much of the Multiverse and being unable to do anything to help. He embarked on a long-term mission to make things better in as many worlds as possible.

As part of that, Fury Sr. became aware of the threat of Kang the Devourer. By the time his son reached out to warn him about it, he was already trying to figure out a way to put a stop to this existential danger who had already consumed countless timelines. With the heroes' home universe having found its way on to the Devourer's menu, Fury Sr. knew that he had run out of time to prepare. The inevitable was going to happen soon.

The father returned to the Blue Area of the Moon and set up shop there once again so that he could coordinate the effort against Kang the Devourer. He's been working with his son on this project since the adventure in Chapter 2: Origin Story.

The Blue Area of the Moon was created in the Luther Crater roughly a million years ago. Despite its location on the side of the Moon facing the Earth, the Blue Area features gravity and atmosphere akin to that of the Earth. The Watcher lived there for untold years, and the X-Men have an outpost there too, known as the Summer House, from which they like to kick back and watch the Earth.

While the Watchers were forbidden from interfering with the fate of the worlds they monitored, the Fury family labors under no such restriction. Fury Sr. doesn't have the personal power to stand up to tremendous troubles, but he has many friends that do. That's where the heroes come in.

How the heroes get to the Moon is up to them, but Fury can arrange transport if they are unable to manage it on their own. If the heroes are part of a team, he summons them all together at once. If they don't normally work together, he can contact each of them individually and be the catalyst that unites them.

For transport, Fury Sr. uses a teleportation device in the Watcher's citadel to bring the heroes to him. He can also use it to send them anywhere else they need to be—as long as the destination is in the same universe.

He can move into other universes in the Multiverse on his own, and if the need is dire, he might be able to bring the heroes with him to other universes. He's loath to do this unless it's absolutely necessary, though. He's already worried about attracting too much attention with his own travels, and moving a group of top-ranked super heroes from one dimension to another might make things worse.

In other words, he prefers the heroes find their own way to Earth-56438 if at all possible. If not, he sucks it up and takes the risk. It's not like he's going to leave them hanging and jeopardize the whole mission because of a nagging worry.

The Impending Apocalypse

If the heroes took part in the earlier adventures in this book, they should already be aware of the problem that both their world and Earth-56438 face, but they likely don't know what to do about it. The kind of threat that Kang the Devourer represents is beyond the capability of any single hero to stop. Even the full force of a team like the Avengers or the Fantastic Four might not be enough.

Fury Sr., however, has a plan.

Once the heroes have gathered in the Watcher's citadel, Fury Sr. presents the problem to them, along with his idea for a solution. From what he has learned from his intelligence efforts (in other words, multiversal spying), Kang the Devourer might have already shown up on Earth-56438 to threaten the heroes and revel in their terror, but that's not important. It's horrible, sure, but there's little they can likely do about that.

When the Devourer starts to feed on a timeline, he goes to the end of that universe's time to begin his feast. Otherwise, he would struggle to feed on the countless possible futures branching off from each earlier moment in time. Moving backward, he can consume a single, already completed timeline.

To stop the Devourer, the heroes need to find a way to get to Earth-56438 and to the end of its time. For most heroes, there aren't a lot of options for doing so, and Fury Sr. doesn't have the power to send them there on his own. Instead, he suggests they beg, borrow or steal Doctor Doom's time platform, find a way to get to Earth-56438, hustle to the end of that timeline and take down the Devourer any way they can.

As far as Fury Sr. knows, there's only one weapon that any Galactus has ever feared: the Ultimate Nullifier. The heroes should find one to use against him. If they can't find one in this universe, perhaps they can track down one in another.

Options

The heroes may have all sorts of questions and probably also have a few ideas of their own about how to handle the situation.

Do we have to save Earth-56438?

Technically, no. It's a world still ruled by Hydra, after all, so Fury Sr. can see why some people might want to write it off. Few people have fought against Hydra for as long as him. However, there are plenty of innocents who still reside on the planet—not to mention the rest of that universe—and in his mind, they're worth saving, even if it means leaving Hydra

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in charge for now. If the heroes want to topple Hydra there, they can see about tackling that particular problem later.

If the heroes are dead set against saving Earth-56438, don't force them. (However, it could have an effect on their standing as heroes and could cause any of them who have the Heroic tag to lose it.) You can just skip over the part where they try to defeat Kang the Devourer at the end of time and have Kang the Conqueror track them down once the destruction of Earth-56438 is already underway.

Is there another way to travel through time?
Probably? Maybe? But the one that Fury Sr. knows about and has some trust in is Doctor Doom's time platform. The Kang of their world could probably manage it too, but he's not easy to find or reach. (He is bound to show up eventually, but he wants the heroes to know how much they need his help first.)

Is there another way to kill Kang the Devourer?
Probably, but it's rare to find such powerful weapons ready to be used. Thor did kill Galactus not long ago, but Thor had been imbued with the Power Cosmic at that point, something he no longer has. A Cosmic Cube or even some of the Infinity Stones might be able to manage it. However, Adam Warlock recently gave each of the stones a soul of their own, and they took off and have not been seen since.

In other words, none of these other methods will be easier than finding an Ultimate Nullifier, and none of them has ever been proven to work, either. The heroes can certainly try those things if they like, but both of the Furys counsel strongly against it.

This sounds like too much work.
The heroes don't have to save the Multiverse. If they don't, though, they're doomed, along with everyone else they know and care about. Other heroes might step up and try to plug the gap, but there are few who have the powers, experience and abilities to make it work.

If the players honestly aren't up for the challenge, go do something else for a while. There's nothing that says that Kang the Devourer is heading straight to their world after destroying Earth-56438. He might need some time to digest his latest meal. He might have a few other universes that come first on his menu before theirs. Let the heroes stew on it for a while, and spring it on them again later.

When the Devourer is knocking on their world's door, they are likely to change their minds. Of course, if it gets to that point, it may be too late for that world. Perhaps the best the heroes could hope for would be to destroy the Devourer and flee to another universe—if they can.

Failure Is an Option

If the heroes don't rise to the occasion—or somehow manage to mess everything up at any point in this adventure—that's it. They're done, and sooner or later, Kang the Devourer eats their universe.

While that might not be a terribly satisfying ending, it's still an ending. Go ahead and give it to them.

Describe to them how the universe ends. From their point of view, it seems like everything is fine, right up until it's not. Then—as the Devourer consumes their timeline—they see their history rewind before them, everything moving backward throughout their lives right up to the moment of their births. There's nothing they can do to stop it. By the time they see it happening, it's already too late.

Once they're all gone, the history of the universe continues rewinding without them, spiraling all the way back to its very beginning. Then, when the Big Bang reverses and turns the universe into a single point in space, that point disappears into Kang the Devourer's ravenous maw, and not only does everything end—it never happened in the first place.

While the heroes have failed here, that doesn't mean the heroes of another universe are fated to do the same. Your players can start over in another world—either with all-new heroes or variants of the ones they played before—and see if they can save that universe instead.

Maybe this time, they can succeed where so many others have failed.

DOOM TIME

Assuming the heroes don't have a better idea—or at least haven't been able to get that idea to work—they should follow Fury Sr.'s suggestion and try to acquire Doctor Doom's time platform. Doctor Doom's profile can be found in the *Core Rulebook* and can be used whenever called for.

Doom's lookalike robot servants, Doombots, also will be used throughout this adventure. A Doombot profile can be found in Chapter 8: Characters.

If the heroes do figure out another way to reach the end of time, feel free to skip over this section and move on to the next one.

Asking Permission

The heroes have two main options when it comes to obtaining Doctor Doom's time platform. They can ask for it, or they can take it.

Getting a hold of Doom is a challenge in the first place. He is likely to take calls from only a handful of people. They include Mister Fantastic and the Invisible Woman, who are the core of the Fantastic Four, his oldest rivals. They can reach him at any reasonable time, assuming he's available.

The Thing and the Human Torch (Johnny Storm) might also be able to get Doom to take their call, but it takes them a bit more shouting at underlings before Doom will respond. He doesn't have the respect for them that he has for the others.

Doom often responds to the rulers of other nations, whom he considers to be his equals—at least in that regard. This includes the Sub-Mariner (Namor) and Black Panther (T'Challa). Whether they are actually in charge of a nation at the time or not does not matter when it comes to those two. Doom has a long history with them that transcends such details.

Playing Doom

Victor von Doom is perhaps the most conceited and arrogant person on the planet. He considers everyone else to be beneath him, and he has the power—both technological and magical—to back up such arguments. There are exceedingly few people who could be considered to be on the same level as him in either field, much less both of them.

Despite that fact, he has a fragile ego, and his ego is particularly threatened by those who he secretly considers his equals or—worse yet—his betters. He heaps scorn upon them at every chance, daring them to do their best to measure up to him, an effort he personally guarantees is bound to fail.

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Art By Alex Ross

Doom frequently refers to himself in the third person, especially when he's angry, which is often. He sometimes refers to himself as *I*, but he rarely uses *me*. To his ears, this clearly makes him sound more important than those around him.

For instance, when the heroes first contact him, he says, "Who dares disturb Doom? Speak quickly! An audience with Doom is a rare and precious thing of which you should not waste a second!"

He also generally refers to others by their last name and does not respect their honorifics. He calls Mister Fantastic "Richards" and Doctor Strange "Strange." If that gets confusing for others when there is more than one person from the family in the room, that would be their problem for not being smart enough to follow along, not Doom's.

Despite all his villainy, Doom sometimes does things that are for the greater good—especially if that good falls to his favor. He is a patriot of his homeland of Latveria, for example, and he often works to make things better there. The trouble is that, in Doom's mind, no one is better qualified to rule Latveria—or the world—than he is, so things that help make that happen are "good." Not just for him, but for the world as a whole.

Convincing Doom

If the heroes contact Doom and ask him if they can use the time platform, he turns them down flat. First, he is not interested in handing over his amazing machine to anyone, ever. Second, he's not inclined to believe in the threat of this so-called Kang the Devourer from some other universe.

Still, the heroes may give it a try, and some of them might somehow manage to be convincing.

If the heroes appeal to Doom's emotions, they must make an Ego check against his Ego defense of 17. If they appeal to his intelligence, they must make a Logic check against his Logic defense of 16.

If the heroes have no evidence for their claims, they have trouble on the check. If they have some evidence—but it's something that the ever-suspicious Doom could

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possibly think they faked—it's a regular check. If they have overwhelming evidence of Kang the Devourer's plans, they gain an edge on the check instead.

Give the heroes an edge if they role-play the conversation with Doom well and are respectful to him throughout, in the way he feels he deserves. If they lose their temper with him and berate him or—even worse—threaten him, they should have trouble instead.

There are no circumstances, though, under which Doom is willing to simply hand over his time platform to someone else—even someone as disgustingly trustworthy as his longtime rival, Mister Fantastic.

If the heroes need the time platform, Doom insists on coming with them and operating it himself. This, of course, is a nonnegotiable point for many heroes. Any of them with any experience dealing with Doctor Doom are unlikely to accept this condition. Despite that, they may not have any other options.

If the heroes decide to bring Doom along on their adventure, they cannot count on him to help them out in any way other than providing transportation. They must also work under the constant threat of his betrayal. Doom is a man of his word, but because of that, he does not make promises lightly. He absolutely refuses to make any deals with the heroes unless they give him no other choice.

Note that Doom refuses to accept that anyone has any authority over him. He would not see being blackmailed into a promise as him then making such a promise under duress, as that would involve admitting that the choice was not his to start with. He wouldn't let anyone else off the hook that easily, and he certainly never allows such mercies for himself.

Despite his protestations, Doom believes the heroes' story about the threat they face. He might not have the resources of the Furys when it comes to monitoring multiversal threats, but he does take pains to keep track of such issues. He's seen the reports of the attempted Hydra invasion from another world, and he's done his research. He doesn't want his world to end any more than the heroes do. He just doesn't trust them not to blow it.

Stealing Time

If the heroes don't want to negotiate with Doctor Doom over the use of his time platform, they can try to take it from him instead. That's no simple task, though, even for some of the most powerful people on Earth. Doom knows that his time platform is one of the most valuable devices in the world, and he keeps it under strict lock and key.

The time platform is guarded around the clock not only by a stunningly effective security system but also by a platoon of Doombots. More importantly, it's in a fortified room in the depths of Castle Doom, which would be a terrifying place to enter even if you were invited to do so.

That doesn't mean it's impossible to get to, but even the bravest and most powerful thieves would consider it a challenge. Further, those thieves would likely go to great lengths to keep their identities a secret if they attempted to steal the time platform, as anyone with a shred of sense would know that Doom would immediately hunt them down and exact retribution from them in the most direct and painful way.

For most heroes, attempting to take something from Doom would be unwise if not absolutely insane. If the heroes feel cornered, though, they might give it a shot anyhow.

Let them.

Doom understands that people would try to steal the time platform from him only in the direst of circumstances. Anyone that desperate—who has both the ability and the will to make it deep into his fortress in the capital of his tiny mountain nation of Latveria—is welcome to have it.

The catch is that just because the time platform can be stolen does not mean there are no strings attached, not all of which are visible. Doom has set it up so that he can monitor it and the people using it constantly, letting him know where and when it goes. He can also shut it down or summon it back to himself remotely. He's willing to grant the thieves enough grace so that he can figure out what they are up to—and whether or not he wishes to quietly support their efforts.

Robbing Doom

Just because Doom is willing to let desperate people steal the time platform doesn't mean that he's going to make it easy on them. They must *prove* that they're desperate enough to go after it and powerful enough to make good use of it. To do that, they have to find a way into the vault underneath Castle Doom, take down the Doombots guarding it and then escape.

Fury Sr. knows the location of the vault and can brief the heroes on the mission. Doom uses a combination of advanced magic and technology stolen from the future to protect the place against ingress of all sorts. It's impossible to teleport into the vault, phase through its walls or otherwise sneak straight into it.

However, that means that Doom can't get into the vault any of those ways either and must approach it from the entrance chamber that sits outside its door. That's also the heroes' way in.

The heroes have several options for reaching the entrance chamber. The obvious way is to parachute/fly into Castle Doom and fight their way through the entirety of Latveria's armed forces. This is next to impossible—and also a good way to start an international incident that could lead to war.

Fury Sr. counsels strongly against this. While the heroes might want to save a whole other universe, there's no reason to plunge this one into a major international conflict to make it happen. He once learned this lesson himself the hard way.

If the heroes can't figure out a better way to get into the entrance chamber on their own, he offers to teleport them straight into the chamber, using the teleportation device in the Watcher's citadel. He'd rather they used means of their own, as that would give them a better chance to escape if and when everything goes perpendicular, but he's ready to serve as their backup way in—and out, if he can manage it.

Doom, of course, is prepared for people to try to rob him this way. This is all part of the test he's prepared for them. He's happy to take those who fail into custody and parade them through the streets of Doomstadt as proof of his superiority.

When the heroes arrive in the entrance chamber, they find themselves in a massive room carved from the living rock of Latveria's mountains. The place is filled with dramatic lighting and lined with a wide carpet. The place smells well-ventilated, but the room is as cold and unheated as a natural cave.

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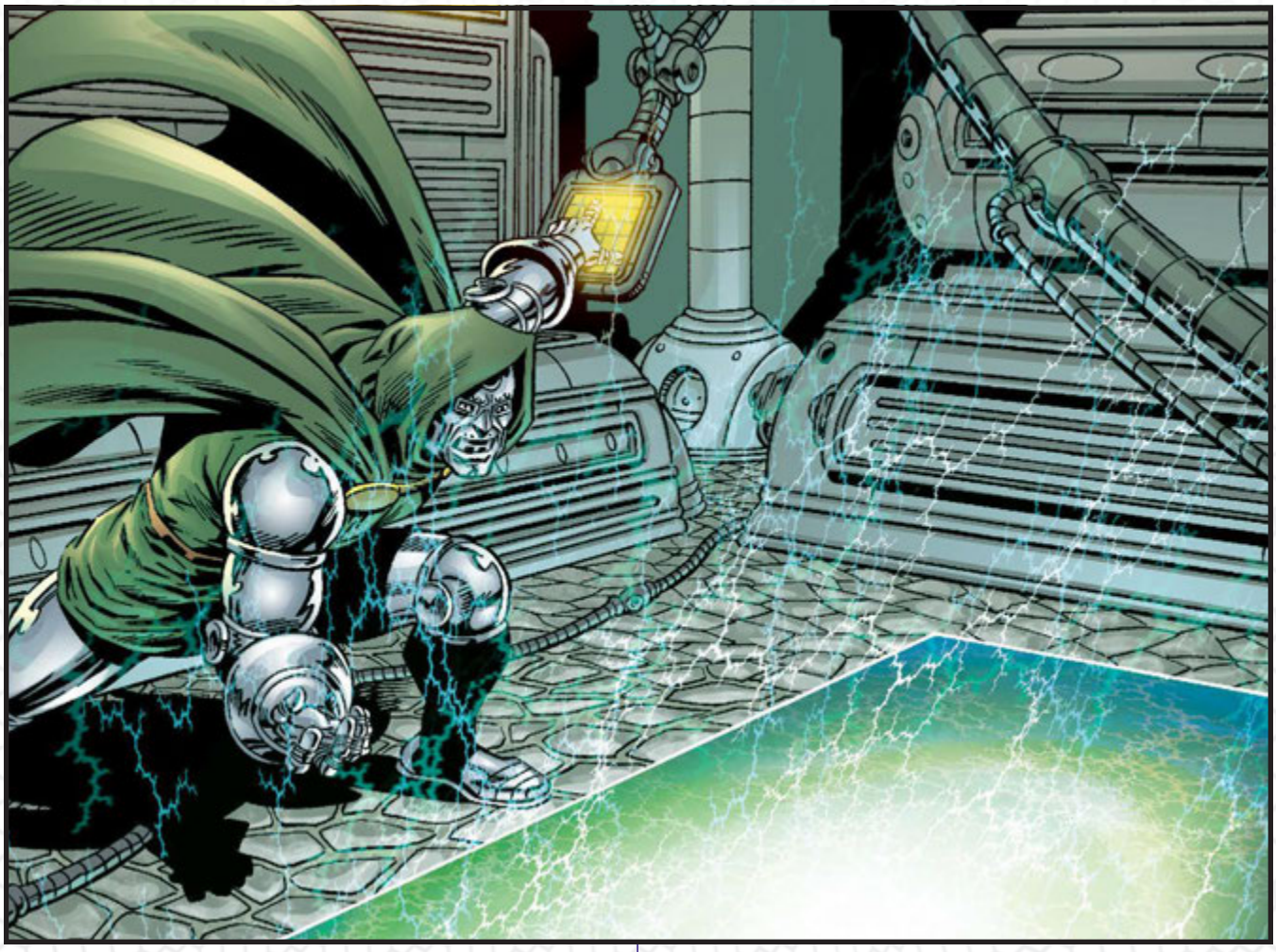
Art by Jim Starlin, Al Milgrom & Christie Scheele



On top of all that, the walls of the chamber are lined with multiple life-sized statues of Doom, all dressed in his signature armor and green cloak. These statues are actually Doombots, placed there to guard the chamber.

The Doombots are not active yet. Instead, they stand there amidst the statues, identical to them and all frozen in different heroic poses. They and the statues all feature plaques beneath them that honor various triumphs in Doctor Doom's life. They include:

- Doom Ascends to the Latverian Throne
- Doom Becomes Rightful Emperor of Earth
- Doom Rules over Counter-Earth
- Doom Returns from Hell
- Doom Welcomes Atlantean Refugees
- Doom Conquers Symkaria
- Doom Rules the Multiverse

Not all of them might make sense to the heroes, and some of them could appear to be aspirational rather than historical.

The last statue—the one at the south end of the chamber, right in front of the vault's door—shows Doom sitting on a throne and wearing white robes instead of green. This is meant to memorialize his time as God Emperor Doom, when he ruled over Battleworld at the end of the Seventh Cosmos. Most people—even those who survived the rebirth of the Seventh Cosmos into the Eighth—don't have any memory of that time, though, so the statue may confuse them. They would probably see it as a goal Doom has set for himself.

People who do remember that time include the Human Torch (Johnny Storm), the Invisible Woman, Mister Fantastic, the Molecule Man, Franklin Richards, Valeria Richards and the Thing. They could try to relate the story to others, but it's extremely complicated and mostly unprovable.

Doom remembers those days all too well.

There may be others who have an inkling of it—like Blue Marvel, who spent time investigating the rebirth of the cosmos—but few truly understand it.

The entrance to the vault—which sits behind the statue of God Emperor Doom—is hidden by a well-made false wall boosted by a hologram. Detecting it requires a Logic vs. TN 18 action check.

The heroes can also find it by trying and failing to move through the fake wall, which should trigger their suspicions, or by doing 20 points of damage to the fake wall. The heroes could do this by bashing the walls until they find the vault's door, or the fake wall could be damaged accidentally in a battle. Wanton destruction to simply find the vault automatically activates the Doombots, as described below.

Otherwise, the Doombots don't attack intruders immediately. Instead, they wait and watch what the heroes do. If a Doombot is attacked, it retaliates, but the others maintain the façade of simply being statues.

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The Battle of the Doombots

What looks to be a time platform sits in the center of the room, seemingly unprotected. It's actually a fake, but it's a good one. This requires a Logic vs. TN 18 action check to figure out. Characters that have used a time platform before get an edge on the check.

If the heroes try to take or turn on the time platform, one of the Doombots attacks immediately, crying out, "Who dares violate the vault of Doom? Doom rules supreme!"

At the start of each round, an additional Doombot activates. All of the active ones say "Doom rules supreme!" at the start of each round. If you run out of Doombots in the room, more teleport in from elsewhere in Castle Doom at the same rate.

As soon as there are three or more active Doombots in the chamber, they activate a Level 3 Offensive Team Maneuver.

The heroes can try to defeat all the Doombots, but there's a never-ending stream of them. They should eventually try to locate the vault's door, even while the fight continues. If the heroes haven't managed this by the time they've defeated one Doombot for each one of the heroes, the next Doombot attack that misses a hero hits the fake wall instead and destroys it.

Once the door is exposed, the heroes must get past it. It is proofed against all powers that might allow someone to move through it. It is protected by a force-field that can be shattered by dealing 100 points of damage to it in a single round. The door itself requires another 100 points of damage to destroy.

The heroes can also try to unlock it. The door has a retinal scanner and a voice scanner, and these each require a Logic vs. TN 20 action check to defeat.

Alternatively, the heroes can use one of the Doombots to unlock both of these by holding its head against the retinal and voice scanners and waiting for it to say "Doom rules supreme!"

Note that the Doombots aren't meant to be a serious threat to a group of Rank 6 heroes. They're simply there to keep out the riffraff and to give the heroes the idea that Doom isn't leaving one of his most precious possessions entirely unguarded. Clever heroes might be able to reason out why that is, but that doesn't change anything. If accused of the truth, Doom forcefully denies it.

The Vault of Doom

Once the door is opened, the heroes can move into the vault. It's filled with all sorts of things, but most of them are mementoes that would mean something only to Doom. The rest are facsimiles meant to slow down greedy intruders. They include things like:

- Doom's first suit of armor
- The suit of Iron Man armor Doom wore while replacing Tony Stark
- Several ancient books of spells, which don't contain anything all that useful
- An Ultimate Nullifier
- An Infinity Gauntlet
- A Cosmic Cube
- A statue of Doom's mother

Of the amazing devices in the vault, only the time platform actually works.

Operating the time platform is not meant to be complicated—at least for Doom. It only requires someone to place a gauntlet from Doom's armor on a readily visible hand scanner. The gauntlet of a Doombot serves the same purpose, and the heroes should have a ready supply of these by now. If not, they should know where to find one.

THE DOOM OF EARTH-56438

The heroes might realize that there may be another option for them in terms of time platforms. If the Doctor Doom of their world has a time platform, there's a good chance that the Doctor Doom of Earth-56438 has one too.

And they are right.

If the heroes approach the Doom of Earth-56438 about his time platform, he is willing to just give it to them. He knows what has to happen to stop Kang the Devourer from destroying his universe—and also that he cannot manage this on his own. In fact, he realizes that it may already be too late.

As part of the takeover of Earth-56438, Hydra went to great pains to isolate, imprison, depower or outright assassinate any heroes with the power to stop them. Because of this, there are no heroes on Earth-56438 who are powerful enough to stop Kang the Devourer—and perhaps not enough powerful villains either, even if someone could somehow unite them.

Doom doesn't believe the Supremacy can manage it, and he's right, as the heroes should eventually see.

A Reasonable Doom

The Doom of Earth-56438 readily hands over the time platform to anyone who seems like they might have a real shot at stopping Kang the Devourer. With the Devourer's recent arrival in this universe, he knows that time is literally growing short, and he is becoming desperate. If there's any way for him to help with the heroes' plan—outside of actually risking his own life—he's willing to do it.

Doom-56438 would prefer to accompany the heroes to stop the Devourer. In fact, he insists on it at first, as part of allowing them to use his time platform. If the heroes refuse, though, he says, *"Bah! Fine! Take my marvelous invention—which is beyond your talents and skills to devise—and do your best to destroy this so-called Devourer. Doom shall walk alone!"*

Doom-56438 then sets about finding a way out of this universe before the Devourer consumes it. While he may hope that the heroes can stop that from happening, he's not about to be destroyed along with his universe if they fail. If he cannot rule this universe, then another one must do, even if that means starting over.

In the meantime, though, if Doom-56438 doesn't accompany the heroes, he monitors their progress via the time platform. If they look like they might fail, Doom-56438 is not above recalling the time platform via remote and without notice—assuming he hasn't already departed at that point.

If he can't figure out another way, Doom-56438 plans to rework his time platform for multiversal travel and then use it to escape this universe for one the Devourer hasn't gotten to yet. But that's his backup plan. Doom always prepares for as many contingencies as he can manage.

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REACHING EARTH-56438

While Doctor Doom's time platform (the one from the heroes' universe) can move back and forth through time, it can't get the heroes to Earth-56438, as that's not a possible future for their timeline but a different universe altogether. In other words, their timelines diverged sometime in the past, and the time platform isn't capable of jumping over to that universe on its own.

Thankfully, there are more options for moving between universes than through time.

The heroes can use any of the following methods to reach Earth-56438, and if they don't already have a time platform (or other time-traveling options), they can look into approaching Doom-56438 about that, as suggested above.

Powers

One or more of the heroes may have Omniversal Travel powers. With the appropriate ones, they can move to Earth-56438 and then journey up and down the timeline as they please. Such powers are rare, but they're not impossible to find.

If one hero doesn't have all of the necessary powers, the heroes can team up to get where they need to be instead. For instance, America Chavez—who can travel between universes—can get the heroes to Earth-56438. From there, they would need a means of traveling in time. That could be Doom's time platform or some other method.

Ticket to the Multiverse

Ghost-Spider has a device called the Ticket to the Multiverse that allows her to travel between universes. She could be persuaded to loan it out to the right people for the right reason. These would, of course, have to be people she trusts—or at least people that someone she trusts can vouch for.

Ghost-Spider uses the Ticket to the Multiverse regularly to commute from her home in Earth-65 to attend classes at Empire State University in Earth-616, where her identity is a secret, and she can be out in public anonymously. Because of that, she is going to want the Ticket back soon.

She might even be persuaded to serve as a multiversal taxi service, taking the heroes wherever they need to be. She's not of a high enough rank to deal directly with the challenges in this adventure, but if one of the players wants to take on her role, let them. That's a great example of how heroes of wildly different ranks can work together toward a common goal: by using their special skills or powers to deal with issues that others in the group aren't able to.

The M'kraan Crystal

The M'kraan Crystal is a rose-colored gem the size of a small house. It serves as a nexus of all realities, and those who touch it can transport themselves to any point in time or space in the whole Multiverse. Even shards of the crystal can grant this power, and several of them are usually floating around at any given time. (There is likely one inside of Ghost-Spider's Ticket to the Multiverse.)

The M'kraan Crystal exists in all universes at once. Destroying it in any one of them could theoretically wind up destroying the entire Multiverse. Because of that, it's likely the most protected item in any universe.

In the heroes' universe, the world on which the crystal sits is located somewhere in the Shi'ar Galaxy, under the guardianship of the Shi'ar Empire. Two incredibly powerful creatures are known to guard it at all times in all realities: Jahf and Modt. They are unlikely to listen to any claims that someone needs to get close to it.

Jahf is an extremely formidable guardian. Despite being the size of a child, he nearly stopped the X-Men single-handedly. Modt appeared after Jahf's defeat, claiming to be a thousand times as powerful as Jahf. He claimed that if he was defeated, a third guardian—one with a thousand times his own power—would replace him, and that this progression would continue until all attackers were defeated.

The heroes are not likely to have to engage with the M'kraan Crystal at any point, but if they get desperate, they might use it—or a shard of it—to travel between universes.

The Tallus

Several dimension-hopping teams of heroes known as the Exiles (or sometimes as Weapon X) often use a device called the Tallus to move between realities. This device works off a shard of the M'kraan Crystal encased in a circular container, and it is worn on the wrist like a watch. It can also be used to communicate with the Timebroker, the morphable personification of the Panoptichron, a pocket dimension outside of time and space.

Those who use the Tallus can move to different universes and dimensions. However, they cannot travel through time with it.

Otherworld

The pocket reality known as Otherworld serves as a nexus for the Multiverse as well. The many Captains Britain that hail from across the Multiverse can travel there, and from Otherworld they can move to universes that are not their own.

There are other methods for reaching Otherworld besides catching a ride with a Captain Britain or even Captain Avalon. These are mostly situated in places of magical power, and they are fairly easy to use. However, those who arrive in Otherworld without a guide are likely to encounter trouble. Also, they would struggle to find a way to travel from there to a universe other than their own.

Saturnyne is the current ruler of Otherworld. She could grant the heroes access to Earth-56438, but she rarely does favors for anyone without expecting something in return. Saturnyne is the current Omniversal Majestrix of the Dimensional Development Court, the person in charge of watching over every universe of any kind. However, the potential loss of a single universe would not be enough to sway her to action. To her mind, universes appear and disappear all the time, and she doesn't care much about them—unless they happen to contain some of her favorite people.

If the heroes point out that Kang the Devourer has already destroyed several universes and is likely to keep doing so until stopped, Saturnyne relents and agrees to help them. However, she still wants something for it: a single favor from the hero she finds most intriguing. How this might come back to become a problem for the heroes is a plot thread you can leave dangling until another time.

In any case, she refuses to take a direct hand in helping save what she considers a "run-down, backwater universe." If and when the conflict reaches the heroes' universe, she might become more interested, but she's not one to worry about such troubles until they actually land on her doorstep.

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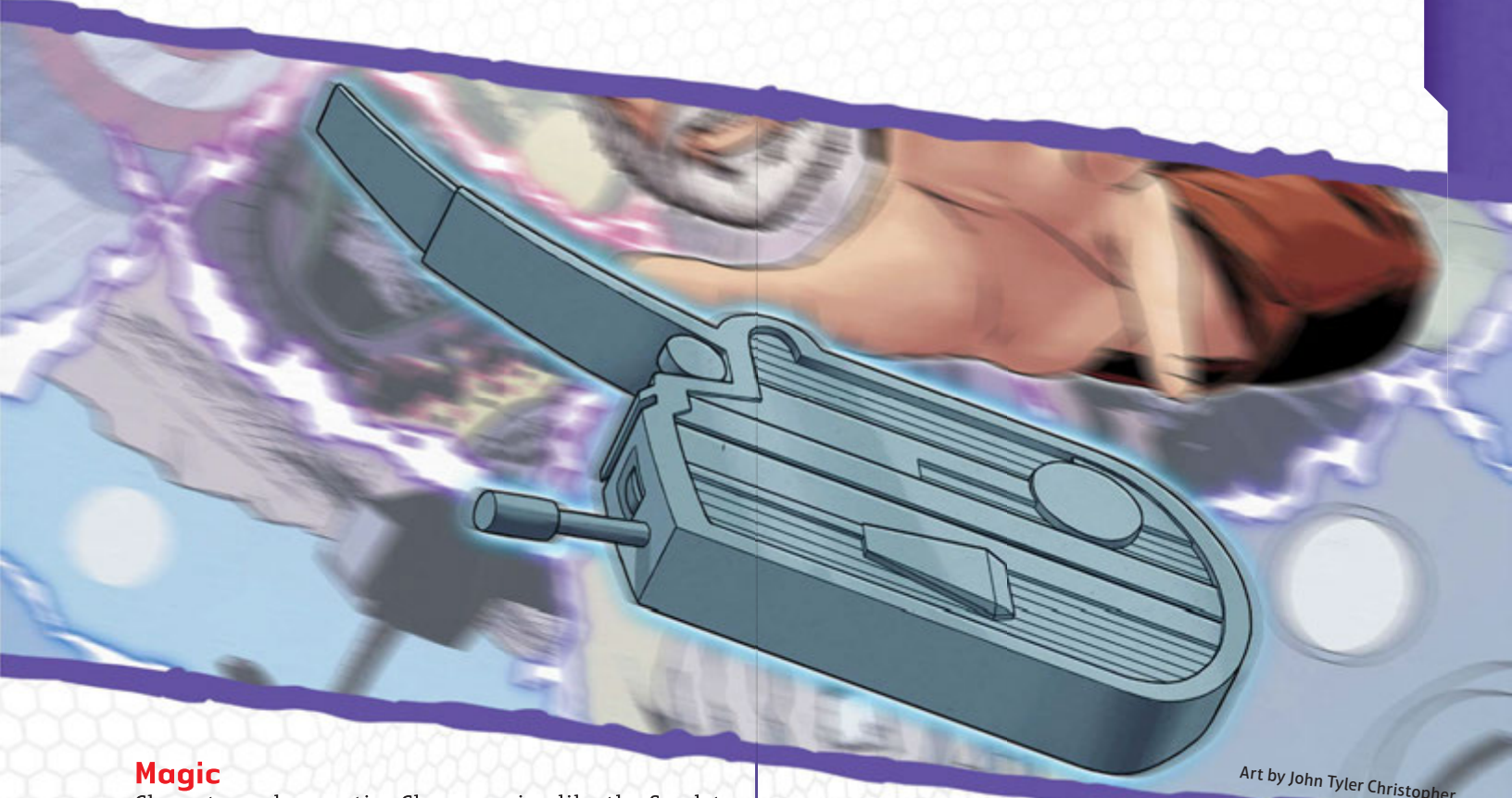

Art by John Tyler Christopher

Magic

Characters who practice Chaos magic—like the Scarlet Witch—may have access to the Powerful Hex power. They could use this to replicate powers from the Omniversal Travel set and use those to travel to Earth-56438 and even through time. Many such sorcerers are wary of using their powers in these ways, though, as they know all too well how easily the best intentions can lead to catastrophic ends.

Characters with the Summon Portal power can use it to travel between universes and dimensions. Note, though, that this does not move the affected characters through time. The heroes need something else to help them with that.

THE ULTIMATE NULLIFIER

Once the heroes procure a time platform, they still have to figure out a way to defeat Kang the Devourer. Simply showing up at the end of time to confront him without a proper weapon is a sure means toward a swift death.

As Fury Sr. notes, the only weapon to ever strike fear in Galactus has been the Ultimate Nullifier. Not even nuclear missiles have had any effect on Galactus before. Countless worlds have thrown everything they had at him to no avail.

As powerful as it is, the Ultimate Nullifier is a relatively small device that can be held in one hand and pointed at a target, just like a pistol. It instantly, entirely and completely eradicates its target.

However, unless the wielder is powerful enough—like Galactus himself—using the weapon also slays the one using it. The one time that it was actually used in the distant past of the heroes' universe—by the Watcher Emnu, who created it—it made ninety percent of the universe hostile to life. The Watchers sealed that area behind an impenetrable barrier, keeping the rest of the universe safe from the region now known as the Barrens.

Finding the Nullifier

After Galactus was resurrected at the end of the Reckoning War, he and the Silver Surfer embarked on a mission of exploration to discover what might be happening in the Barrens since it was cut off from their portion of the universe countless millennia ago. The Barrens might now be safe to enter, but there was no telling what happened in that part of reality in the intervening time.

Neither Galactus nor the Silver Surfer have been seen since their departure on that mission, which could literally take them untold decades. If the Ultimate Nullifier is anywhere, though, it's probably secured on Galactus' worldship, *Taa II*, where it belongs.

If the heroes don't know this already—as it's not widely public knowledge—Fury Sr. can inform them. Any member of the Fantastic Four would be aware of it, of course, as well as the many people who helped them, including their children, She-Hulk, Jack of Hearts, Thor, members of the Guardians of the Galaxy, Uatu and Doctor Doom.

Additionally, Iron Man (Tony Stark) likely has learned all this from the people in charge of the Howard and Maria Stark Center for Galactic Research, a facility that he set up at Empire State University to learn about galactic history and the Earth's place in it. (See Marvel.com/rpg for more details about the center, which first appeared in the *Playtest Rulebook*.)

Finding Galactus

Just because the heroes know where the Ultimate Nullifier might be, though, doesn't mean they can get their hands on it. Galactus is hard to reach in the best of times, and even if they manage to contact him out in the Barrens, he might not care to respond.

The heroes' best bet is to contact the Silver Surfer instead. If one of the players is playing the Silver Surfer, this is simple enough. However, there are other means the heroes can employ too.

Mister Fantastic likely has a way to contact the Silver Surfer, and he would be happy to use it. A powerful telepath

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like Jean Grey or Professor X might also be able to reach out to the Surfer with their mind. Doctor Strange might also be able to contact him via magical means.

Once the Silver Surfer knows of the situation, he may hesitate to retrieve the Ultimate Nullifier from Galactus' worldship. After all, that is not a weapon to be toyed with. If someone he trusts implicitly—like any of the Fantastic Four—vouches for the heroes' tale, though, he believes them. At the very least, Nick Fury Sr. can confirm the details for the Surfer and echo the heroes' request.

If one of the players is playing the Silver Surfer, they can go and retrieve the Ultimate Nullifier. However, you should have them take the other characters with them so they can help explain to Galactus what it is they need—and why.

This is a Logic vs. TN 10 action check. Each hero can make it separately if they like, or they can give edges to the speaker by helping out. Give them multiple chances to present their case if needed, but they should come up with new arguments for their request each time.

If the heroes succeed, Galactus grants their request, although feel free to make the heroes sweat it out for a bit. He mentions the fact that they can discuss such things openly shows how his relationship with the Silver Surfer has improved over the years. This brings a hint of a smile to his gigantic face.

Obtaining the Nullifier

Even so, if the Silver Surfer is not part of the team, he is reluctant to simply hand over the Ultimate Nullifier. While he may trust the people who have asked him for it, he cannot risk it falling into the wrong hands. If there is no one on the team who he can fully trust with it—as in, someone he's known for years, like a member of the Fantastic Four—he insists on accompanying the heroes on their mission and carrying the Ultimate Nullifier himself.

Again, if the Silver Surfer is already part of the team, that's easy enough to handle. Otherwise, you—as part of your duties as the Narrator—should play the character. Alternatively, this would be a great chance to introduce a new player to the game in the role of the Silver Surfer, even temporarily.

If the Silver Surfer needs someone to vouch for the heroes, Fury Sr. is willing to do just that. The two of them know each other reasonably well, and the heroes have Fury's full backing. After all, he called them together to help save the universe. If he didn't trust them to do the right thing, he never would have contacted them in the first place.

What About Galactus?

While the Silver Surfer is ready to travel with the heroes to stop Kang the Devourer, the Galactus of their universe is loath to do so. He is tied directly to his own universe and prefers not to depart from it. If Kang the Devourer dares to appear in the heroes' universe, Galactus may be moved to confront his variant, if only out of a sense of self-preservation. Meanwhile, he remains unconvinced that him attacking the Devourer directly would do more good than harm.

If the heroes press Galactus to fight alongside them, the Silver Surfer intervenes. He points out that the Devourer has already stolen the power of one Galactus. He also has consumed countless timelines already, some of which likely featured a Galactus of some sort in them as well. There's no reason to risk this Galactus for now.

In short, the Ultimate Nullifier is the heroes' best bet against Kang the Devourer, and any of them can fire the weapon. As that's something that Galactus does not wish to do himself, they are better off without him.

TO THE END OF TIME

Once the heroes secure a proper weapon and a means of traveling through time—no matter how fundamentally undependable it might be—they need to travel to the end of the universe to confront Kang the Devourer and put a stop to his plans.

It doesn't matter how the heroes get there, whether under their own power, via a time platform or by some other means. It's entirely up to them—with a little help from their Narrator, if necessary, of course.

The end of time happens in the center of the universe, right where the Big Bang started everything off untold millennia ago. This universe is contracting in a Big Crunch. Perhaps it would restart again after that with a new Big Bang, but if the Devourer has his way, it isn't likely to get that chance. To the heroes, it appears that a gigantic black hole in the center of the universe is pulling everything into it, growing bigger and bigger as planets, stars—even entire galaxies—are drawn faster and faster past its event horizon, feeding its limitless maw.

When the heroes arrive, they find that Kang the Devourer is already there—in his worldship, the *Taa II*—and he has set up his machinery to feed the energy of the entire timeline to him.

There's not much time left till the end.

If the heroes arrive via a time platform, they can stand on that, and it protects them from any flying debris and the effects of the black hole—as long as they don't get too close. When they arrive in this universe, they can materialize either inside or outside the *Taa II*, as they wish, but being inside the ship is far safer.

If the heroes arrive by other means, they should materialize within the shelter of the *Taa II*. Otherwise, without any other protection, they risk immediate destruction from the black hole or the astronomical bodies being drawn into it.

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Art by Will Sliney

The Supremacy's Final Failure

The Devourer has been waiting for someone to try to interrupt him. It seems most universes try to mount an assault like this to save themselves, and there's no reason for him to believe this place is any different in that regard.

In fact, one such effort has already been launched and thwarted. When the heroes arrive, they find a number of bodies scattered about the inside of the *Taa II*. They include many members of the Supremacy, as seen in previous chapters.

Only things inside the worldship's area of influence are immune to the destruction of the timeline that's already happening outside of its environs. If there were other people who came here to attempt to put an end to the Devourer's plans, they have already disappeared along with the time at which they arrived.

This should signal to the heroes that they are in for their biggest challenge ever. The most powerful people of Earth-56438 confronted Kang the Devourer and paid for their foolhardiness with their lives. None of them survived. Anyone the heroes think they should see there but don't was probably defeated outside the confines of *Taa II* and eradicated entirely.

Still, this is where the heroes need to make their stand—or at least when and where Fury Sr. convinced them that they should give it their best shot. Let them have at it.

Versus Rank X

Kang the Devourer is a Rank X character. His power is simply not on the same scale as that of regular people, not even the most powerful super heroes. That means his profile differs from the standard variety, as he's essentially impervious to any damage the heroes might try to do to him.

That doesn't mean that the Devourer can't be beaten or that he doesn't have particular things he can do, including types of attacks. However, those things are described narratively rather than via numbers and stats. This includes the following abilities:

- Each turn, the Devourer can fire twin blasts from his eyes against a single foe. Avoiding these requires an Agility vs. TN 18 action check. Anyone struck by them is instantly destroyed.
- He can instantly travel backward and forward to any moment in time in the universe in which he is in.
- He can travel to other universes, although this takes him more time. Part of that is because he prefers to emerge at times and places in which his most-feared foes—primarily variants of Kang, the Watcher (Uatu) and Galactus—are at their weakest. Doing so requires research, which is why he decided to take on the Crimson Surfer as his herald.
- He can devour time. This forces it backward and eliminates potential futures in which he does not triumph.

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Art by John Romita Jr., Klaus Janson & Dean White

The Fight

Kang the Devourer doesn't pay much attention to anything that happens around him as he feeds. He treats most people as if they are little more than gnats: minor annoyances that can't even sting him through his armor. Having set up his machinery, the Devourer stands at the bridge of the *Taa II* and consumes the timestream.

If the heroes don't attack the Devourer or attempt to enter his worldship, they can do whatever they want without fear of intervention. There's no one else at the end of time for them to even run into—which is why they eventually should feel like they have no other choice but to do something that might garner the Devourer's attention.

Just as with the regular Galactus, the *Taa II* helps convert the energy the Devourer demands into something that's easier for him to digest. The Devourer doesn't technically require such machinery to make that happen, but he prefers it. It's akin to sitting down for a meal with glasses, silverware and plates. That might be how you like to eat, but you can make do without such trappings if need be.

Despite that, the heroes might attack the worldship in the hopes of hampering the Devourer's efforts to gobble up the timestream. The entirety of the ship is surrounded by a force-field that requires 100 points of damage in a single attack to shatter. If broken, it returns at full force one round later.

It is possible to teleport into the ship's interior normally. The time platform can manage this by setting its destination within the ship on any leap through time. The simplest place to appear is on the floor of the bridge, next to the Devourer. From there, the heroes can attack him directly.

Even from inside the worldship, there's little the heroes can do to destroy the ship. It's so large that attempting to break it is like trying to destroy the Earth by punching the ground beneath your feet.

Still, there are visible power cells and controls on the bridge, and the heroes might want to attack those. As with the ship's exterior, these are each surrounded by a force-field that requires 100 points of damage from a single attack to shatter. Any shattered force-field returns at full strength one round later.

Each of the power cells has a Health of 100. If one is destroyed, it detonates, causing 100 points of Health damage to everyone within 10 spaces—with the exception of the Devourer, who is unharmed. Even if they are all destroyed, though, there are plenty of other power cells on the ship that the Devourer can divert to continue his work.

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However, such attacks do attract the Devourer's attention the moment they start. Successful attacks would be annoying, and he would prefer to end them. He stops devouring the timeline for the moment and focuses on destroying the heroes directly instead.

The heroes can also get the Devourer's attention by trying to attack him directly. Unless they're using the Ultimate Nullifier, there's little chance they can hurt him, but he does respond to such assaults, more out of indignation than any sense of being threatened.

Helping Hands

It's entirely possible that Doctor Doom or the Silver Surfer might be on hand to help the heroes. Perhaps even both of them. If you're controlling them as the Narrator, you should take care not to get in the other players' way unless absolutely necessary.

Although both of those characters are powerful people with no lack of initiative, let the heroes take the lead whenever possible. The Silver Surfer looks to them for guidance, as they got him involved in this. He follows their suggestions whenever reasonable.

Doctor Doom, on the other hand, is no one's inferior. He refuses to take orders from anyone. Instead, he stands back and observes, allowing the heroes to test out various theories on how to proceed. If they fail, they can suffer the consequences. If they succeed, he stands ready to swoop in and scoop up any spoils.

However, there's a limit to Doctor Doom's patience. If the heroes can't seem to come to a decision about what to do, he advocates for whatever strategy seems the most likely to succeed. If you like, you can use this to goad the heroes into attempting things they have yet to consider.

If the heroes freeze up entirely, Doom eventually shouts at them in frustration and takes action on his own. "Bah! How did I allow myself to be surrounded by such cowards masquerading as heroes? Doom waits *on* and *for* no one!"

He then attacks the power cells. The moment the Devourer intervenes, though, he backs off and lets the heroes absorb the brunt of the retaliation so that he can observe the Devourer's strategies and learn from them.

Playing the Devourer

Kang the Conqueror is as narcissistic as anyone in the universe. He believes that no one is superior to him and that he is destined to eventually conquer the entire universe. If this sounds a bit like Doctor Doom, the two are remarkably similar in that regard.

Records about Kang's ancestry are muddled, but some of them indicate that he's descended from Doctor Doom—and possibly from Mister Fantastic as well. To an extent, Kang models himself after Doom. In fact, after meeting Doom for the first time, Kang decided to abandon his original Rama-Tut identity and took up as the armored Scarlet Centurion for a while instead.

While Kang doesn't refer to himself in the third person as much as Doom does, he's known to indulge in that habit sometimes. He otherwise speaks in a similarly arrogant manner, looking down on those around him and seeing few equals to challenge him. He's a bit more open about his frustrations with those who thwart his plans, verbally raging against them.

The Devourer has many of these same traits, but he is so rarely frustrated any longer that he's actually amused when it happens—at least at first. Unlike Galactus—who consumed worlds because he had no other way to survive—the Devourer actually relishes his meals.

The Devourer speaks in a deep, booming voice like that of Galactus, either unable or unwilling to modulate it for those around him. He speaks more slowly than Kang, as if he has all the time in the world. He is literally stuffing himself with time as he dines, after all.

If anyone actually thwarts the Devourer, his rage should be awful to behold. He curses those who foil him and swears that some version of him is bound to have his revenge. But the heroes have a long way yet to get to that point.

Death or Something Like It

Although the heroes may not know it, their efforts are doomed from the start. Once the fight begins, Kang the Devourer should be able to make quick work of them, taking out one of them each round until they are all dead—including Doctor Doom and the Silver Surfer if they are involved. There's little any of them can do to stop him.

If the heroes threaten the Devourer with the Ultimate Nullifier, he stops his attacks and laughs out loud at them. He marvels at the fact that they seem to think no one has ever tried to use such a weapon against him before. To the contrary, it happens almost every time, but once he's begun the process of devouring the timestream, it's doomed to fail.

The heroes might realize this on their own when their dead or destroyed bodies come back to life, fully healed, at the start of each new round. A side effect of the destruction of the timeline is that things that happen are soon undone, including their own deaths.

The heroes are unlikely to take the Devourer's word for it, though. If they fire the Ultimate Nullifier, it works as advertised. It destroys the Devourer entirely, along with the person who fired it.

Roughly a minute later, though, the whole incident is undone. The Devourer and his worldship are restored, as are the heroes, and the Ultimate Nullifier reverts to being unfired.

If the heroes like, they can repeat the attempt. They can fire the Ultimate Nullifier at Kang the Devourer again and again and again. Each time, everything reverts to the way it was before—only a little bit earlier.

Time Runs Out

Eventually, time reverts to a point before which the heroes arrived in this universe. When that happens, they are booted back to their own universe to the moment at which they departed. In effect, they never left.

This eventually happens to the dead members of the Supremacy too. However, they arrived well before the heroes and set up to research the situation for a while before they attacked. It's going to take more time for them to be kicked back from the end of their universe's timeline.

Since the Supremacy hails from this timeline, though, that doesn't put them out of harm's way. Those characters can be kicked back to their past, but they're still stuck in their same timeline. Eventually, the Devourer is bound

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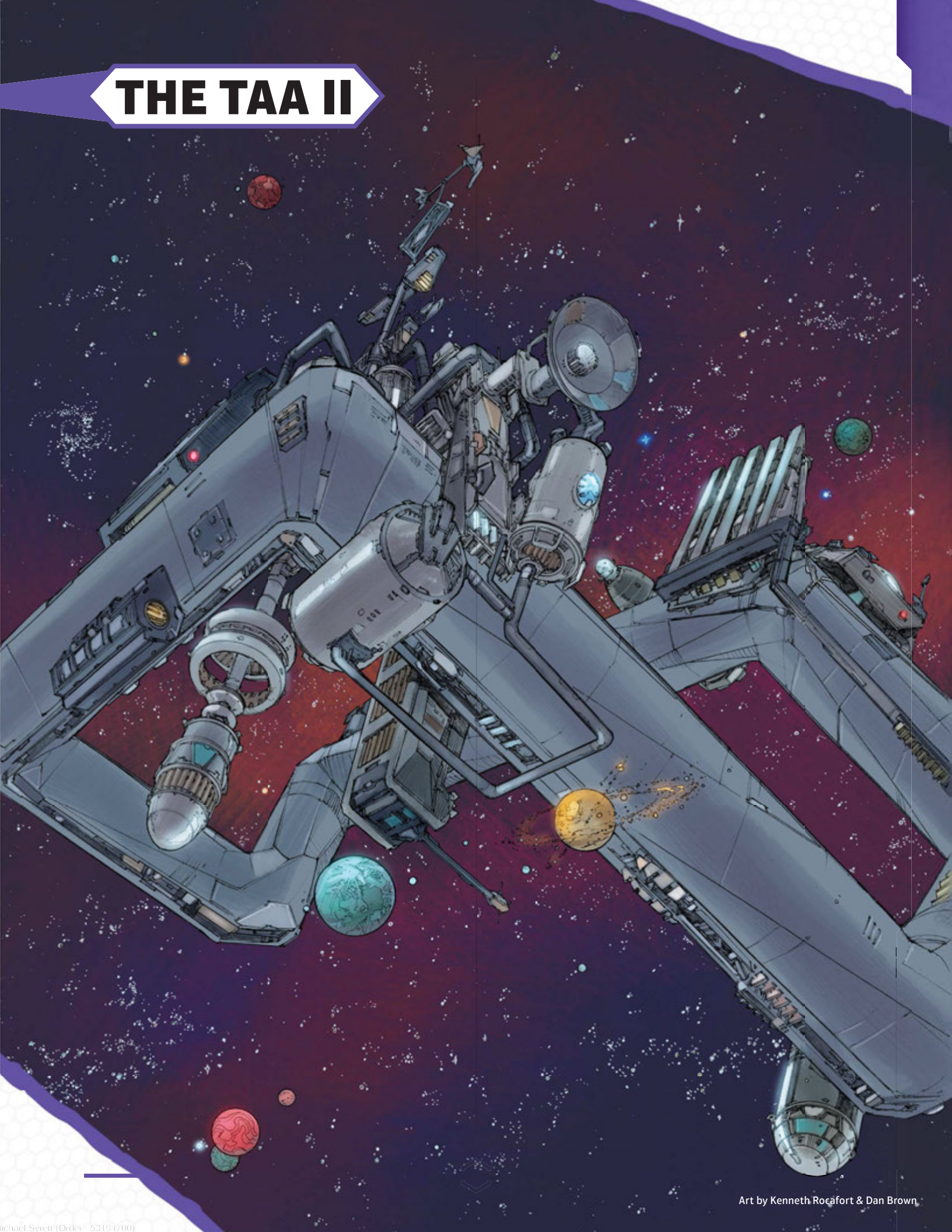
THE TAA II



Art by Kenneth Rocafort & Dan Brown

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to work his way back to that point in time and destroy them there as well. Without outside intervention, they are all doomed.

That might not cause many heroes to shed a tear, but the destruction of the timeline dooms not just the Supremacy but everyone who ever lived or will live in that universe. This is a disaster of apocalyptic proportions.

Doom Departs

If Doctor Doom is not with the heroes and it looks like they are about to be defeated and are not attempting to use the time platform to flee, Doom summons it back to its regular place in his castle. He is not about to allow his device to be destroyed, and if the heroes won't be able to use it any longer, he's not going to leave it to the Devourer's mercy.

If Doom is with the heroes and operating the time platform personally, he does the same thing. He can see when the tide turns against the heroes, and he refuses to be swept away along with them.

Doom's disappearance might justifiably horrify the heroes. Not only is the battle not going well for them, but they've lost their only means of escape. This effectively strands them at the end of time, facing an angry Devourer.

Doom recognizes this but does not care. If the fools can't make good use of his time platform, then perhaps he should find someone else who can. The Doom of Earth-56438 will return to his present at Castle Doom and start making other plans. If the heroes were accompanied by the Doom from their Earth, he also returns to the past and finds means to get back to his reality. He might even reach out to Fury Sr. and offer to loan him the time platform if he can come up with a more competent team this time around.

Of course, if this happens, the heroes eventually get booted back to the moment they used the time platform to head to the end of time. The time platform then disappears an instant later.

KANG TO THE RESCUE

When it seems like the players have had enough—when they've given up on just about every avenue open to them—let them wallow in their frustration for a bit. Then spring the big surprise on them.

Wherever and whenever they are, Kang the Conqueror from their own universe is there too. He's been monitoring their progress the entire time, waiting for them to exhaust their other options. Now—when they're at their lowest—is the moment he feels they might be most willing to listen to him, a man many of them surely consider a villain. And maybe he is.

But he also has a plan to save the universe. The one he and the heroes are from, at least.

Timing Issues

Kang explains to the heroes that the real problem they're facing is that they don't understand the nature of time—at least not as well as he does. They're fools to think they can stop Kang the Devourer by shooting him with a weapon that eradicates him at the end of time.

The issue is that—by that point—Kang the Devourer has already started to consume the timeline. When that timeline gets cut down to a time before the heroes attacked the Devourer, he returns, because the time in which they shot him no longer exists. Or at least it seems that way to their minds.

The other issue is that it's not enough to remove Kang the Devourer from a timeline. If you do that, another timeline pops into existence in which he wasn't removed, and you find yourself right back in the same situation again. The Devourer just keeps eating the timeline like nothing happened to him.

The Devourer survives by consuming such possibilities, but the branching nature of the Multiverse also makes him invulnerable to such attacks—depending on when they are carried out. If you want to truly destroy him, you have to do so when he has no means of escape.

Objections

The heroes may object to Kang's reasoning. It might not make any sense to them at all.

That's fine. Most of the people in the Marvel Multiverse don't understand the true nature of time and how time travel works within it, but no one gets it better than Kang.

This is why Kang doesn't just go around in time, changing everything to favor him. He knows that making drastic changes simply pushes the traveler into an alternate timeline, and he's not interested in such cheap and hollow victories. He wants to conquer the timeline he's in, not create new ones.

He's gotten better at this as he's grown to understand the nature of time more and more. This is why he knows how to defeat the Devourer in a way that not even Kangs from other universes might be able to comprehend.

The One Way

The heroes were on the right path. Using the Ultimate Nullifier is essentially the only way to destroy Kang the Devourer. But as they've seen, just shooting him with it is not enough.

To truly destroy the Devourer, they need to fire the Ultimate Nullifier at him at the beginning of a timeline, not the end. That's the moment when he's consumed all the possibilities from a universe and there is no more space for the timeline to rewind in.

That means that the heroes must travel to the dawn of Earth-56438's timeline and attack the Devourer there, even if that entails letting him consume the entire dimension first. That's the only moment at which harming the Devourer can take permanent hold.

The heroes might ask if they can go find another universe the Devourer was in before this and destroy him before he travels to Earth-56438. Maybe they could even find the universe he hailed from originally and stop him there before he becomes the Devourer at all.

Kang laughs at this. It won't work, and he knows it.

For one, there's the challenge of figuring out what universe the Devourer originally hailed from.

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Art by Alan Davis, Mark Farmer & Javier Rodriguez

Tracking him backward through the countless timelines he's destroyed—which no longer exist—would be impossible. Even if he and the heroes could somehow manage that, the Devourer likely already destroyed his original timeline entirely, so there would be nowhere—or when—for them to go.

On top of that, destroying the Devourer at a point in his past would only cause a new timeline to form in which the Devourer was stopped. It wouldn't do anything to the one in which he'd survived, since he already managed that.

The heroes must go to a moment that is in both their personal futures and the Devourer's personal future, plus a moment at which he has no means of escape. That's the best time at which they have any hope of stopping him.

Is There Another Way?

One of the brilliant things about tabletop role-playing games is that the players can come up with all sorts of ideas—things that no one could have possibly thought about ahead of time—and they can present them to the Narrator to see what happens.

In other words, your players might come up with an entirely different way to save the world than what Kang presents to them. Let them run with it. It might even work!

Whether or not it *actually* works, of course, is entirely up to you. If it looks like there's a chance, let them have a go at it. Just keep in mind the limitations and parameters that Kang outlines so that they don't spend too much time working on something that's bound to fail, likely because they don't understand the nature of time travel that well.

It's all right for the heroes to get frustrated, but you don't want the players to feel like the challenge you present them with is entirely hopeless. That's no fun for anyone.

If they run out of other options, remind them that there's always Kang's plan to fall back on.

BACK TO THE BEGINNING

In the universe of Earth-56438, the beginning of time happens at the same physical location as the end of time that the heroes already visited. But instead of the black hole that they found at the end of time, they discover a supermassive white hole that's constantly blasting stellar matter out into the newly formed universe. This looks like glowing stardust gushing out in every direction. Someday it surely starts to coalesce into nebulas and stars and even planets and the seeds of life, but not for billions of years yet.

As long as the heroes are inside the *Taa II* or within 100 spaces of it, they are protected from the blasting stardust. Otherwise, they take 100 points of Health damage every round until they are incinerated. Damage reduction and other protective powers work normally against this.

When the heroes arrive at the dawn of that universe, they discover that things are just as Kang the Conqueror had predicted. Kang the Devourer floats there—along with his worldship and the unlimbered eating machinery—finishing his feast on the timeline.

The Devourer is, in fact, using the last minutes in this universe to dismantle the machinery that his worldship

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uses to help him consume the timeline. It's difficult to travel between universes with the machinery unlimbered like this, and the remnants of the timeline are so small now that he does not need any mechanical assistance absorbing them.

There are two major complications the heroes must deal with.

First, the most powerful villains of Earth-56438 are here with Kang the Devourer, and they stand ready to defend him. They call themselves the Final Supremacy.

Second, while it only takes a single person to fire the Ultimate Nullifier, Kang the Conqueror refuses to do it. The heroes have to choose one of their own. They may have already gone through this selection process at the end of time, but here, it's bound to be permanent.

The Final Supremacy

The moment the heroes arrive at the dawn of time, the Final Supremacy attacks them. Members of the Final Supremacy include Hela, Thanos, Dormammu and Magneto.

There is one member of the Final Supremacy present for each of the heroes. If you have fewer than four heroes in your game, pick the villains you feel make the best matches for your players' heroes. The others never show up.

Note that Kang the Devourer usually takes out other time travelers quickly when he arrives in a timeline. At the very least, he would never trust them not to betray him at the first opportunity, so variants of both Kang the Conqueror and Doctor Doom would never be allowed to join this group.

If there are four or more heroes on the team, just stick with the four listed members of the Final Supremacy. That lineup of villains should be enough to present a challenge to just about any group of heroes.

As Kang the Devourer worked his way backward in time, he faced challenges from several of these villains, but none of them could defeat him. He offered each of them the chance to live if they would serve him by defending him at the dawn of time. (The Devourer has done this many times and knows to expect resistance.) He promised that those who proved themselves by surviving the final battle there could fight it out to see which of them would become his new herald, replacing the Crimson Surfer.

Battle at the Dawn of Time

Despite facing such a terrifying lineup, the heroes have a few elements on their side that give them a chance to emerge victorious.

First, the villains are not willing to support each other. Each of them is used to being the master of their own destiny and has no reason to trust any of the others. They are not a team and cannot use team maneuvers.

Second, the villains are all looking for opportunities for treachery. If they can figure out how to turn everything against the Devourer, they leap at any decent chance.

Short of that, any of them would be happy to sacrifice their compatriots to further their own ends. After all, the fewer villains who survive the battle, the less competition the survivors have for becoming the Devourer's next herald.

However, the Devourer fears that the heroes will use an Ultimate Nullifier against him. While he didn't worry about that possibility at the end of time, he is aware of how vulnerable he is at the current moment.

The only reason he assembled the Final Supremacy to help him was to keep the heroes busy while he finds the Ultimate Nullifier and either takes it from them or destroys it. The opportunity to replace his herald is merely a bonus.

Time for Treachery

The villains of the Supremacy are no fools. They know that the Devourer must be worried about something the heroes have, or he wouldn't have brought them along to begin with. If they can figure out what the heroes' advantage might be, they can steal it for themselves.

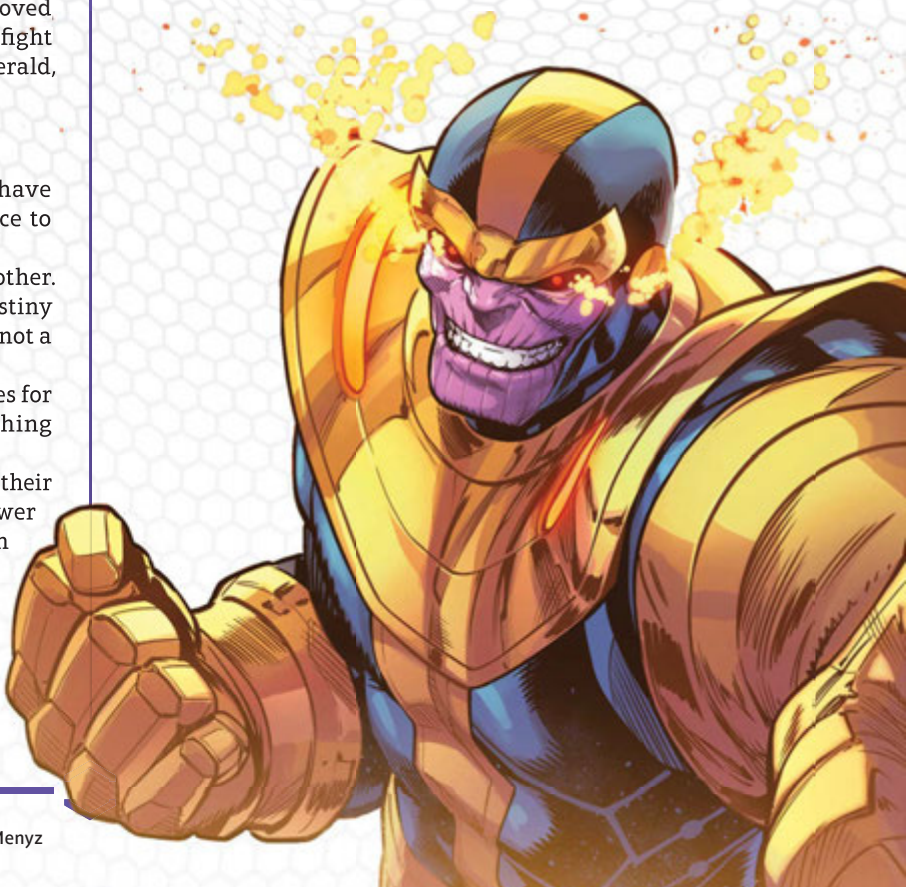
If any of the villains manages to snatch away the Ultimate Nullifier, they turn and point it at the Devourer to threaten him with it. Few people have actually seen this device in action, so they likely don't recognize it for what it is. However, they know a weapon when they see it, and they are ready to use it.

Those who do recognize the Ultimate Nullifier would not wish to use the weapon, as they know that doing so would kill them—but they also wouldn't want to lose an opportunity to have the Devourer at their mercy. Of them all, only Magneto would be willing to sacrifice himself to save the Multiverse. He may be a villain here, but he's not as far gone as the others.

The Devourer points out to any such traitors that firing the weapon would kill both him and them, and he doesn't think any of them are that selfless. He might be wrong when it comes to Magneto, but that's an accurate assessment of the others.

If the villain with the Ultimate Nullifier is willing to negotiate, the Devourer offers to make them his new herald on the spot. If they agree, he makes good on his end of the bargain. The transformed villain insists on keeping the weapon, though, as they need some way to ensure that the Devourer won't renege on their deal immediately.

The Devourer agrees to this. But once they leave this universe behind and he starts to devour another



Art by Sean Izaakse & Marcio Menyz

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timeline—making him invulnerable to the Ultimate Nullifier's effects—he plans to renegotiate with his new herald. The herald likely doesn't know about that loophole, though, unless the heroes inform them.

With the Ultimate Nullifier out of play, the heroes are in deep trouble, as they no longer have a way to stop the Devourer. See later in this chapter for ideas about how to handle such issues.

Kang the Rescuer

Don't forget that the heroes may have Kang the Conqueror from their universe on their side. He likely had to explain to them what they needed to do to defeat the Devourer. If so, he would insist on accompanying them, to make sure that they don't blow their best chance at defeating this existential threat to their entire timeline.

If the heroes refuse to let Kang come with them, that doesn't mean that he will respect their wishes. If they need his help to travel through time, they are stuck with him. If they have their own means of reaching the dawn of time, he follows along after them, monitoring the situation from a safe distance.

If the heroes are about to do something spectacularly fatal—or if the villains are about to turn the tables on them and the Devourer—Kang the Conqueror can step in to stop it. Whether or not he does is entirely up to you, but Kang doesn't want to see the heroes fail. If they do, he knows that his own universe could well be the Devourer's next target, and he's not interested in taking that risk.

Kang is also not interested in becoming a new Devourer. Even if he could figure out a way to assume the Devourer's power, he wouldn't do it. He sees the Devourer as a tragic figure, a version of himself that couldn't see the inevitable results of his ambitions.

The Devourer no longer has any choice about how to live. He cannot enjoy his rightful position as a conqueror. Instead, he has become a hostage to his insatiable hunger. Kang the Conqueror would prefer to avoid that fate.

THE ULTIMATE SACRIFICE

If the heroes attempt to use the Ultimate Nullifier, they should know that the price of doing so is the life of the person firing the weapon. If one of them is willing to make this sacrifice—and no one else interferes with them—they can go ahead and do it.

This is an opportunity for the players to engage in some dramatic role-playing over who—if anyone—should be the one to fire the weapon. It's for the greater good, no doubt, but the price is terribly high.

Will all of them attempt to step up, or at least more than one? If so, how do the heroes determine which one of them pulls the trigger? There's no need for more than one of them to die.

Or will they all refuse, hoping to find another way? If so, they risk all of them being destroyed, along with whatever universes Kang the Devourer decides to feast on next. For how long are they willing to take that chance before they take decisive action?

Calling Their Bluff

If the heroes threaten the Devourer with the Ultimate Nullifier rather than simply using it on him, he asks them what they want. He doesn't believe that any of them can actually go through with it. He tells them that he's run into variants of them before, and they always balk at the critical moment. They rant on and on about how they refuse to believe in a no-win situation, right up until it's too late.

As evidence, he offers up the fact that he's still there, consuming one timeline after another. No one has managed to stop him yet.

If the heroes aren't willing to kill him, the Devourer asks them for their wishes. He insists on finishing off Earth-56438's timeline, which is almost entirely gone anyhow. If the heroes demand that he stops destroying universes, he says it's too late for that. He depends on such energies to survive, so pledging to give that up would only offer him a slow, lingering death from starvation rather than the instant demise they're threatening him with.

The Devourer would be willing to leave the heroes' timeline—and any branches off it—for the last item on his menu. He knows that the heroes have little reason to trust him, but he has a bargain in mind. He offers them a deal similar to the one that Galactus offered Norrin Radd that changed Radd into the Silver Surfer.

If one of the heroes agrees to become the Devourer's new herald, that hero can guide him to universes that have few if any intelligent forms of life in them. The Devourer can sustain himself on such energies for a long time, and it would delay if not outright save countless timelines.

If anyone takes the Devourer up on his offer, he is true to his word. He imbues his new herald with the Power Cosmic and bids the other heroes goodbye. They don't want to be there when Earth-56438's timeline ends.

Alternatives

If none of the heroes is up for the job, they might be able to find someone else to fire the weapon. Perhaps Kang can snatch someone for the job from their own universe—or maybe from another point in time. Someone who is about to die anyhow might be willing to make their last act one that saves the remaining Multiverse.

The heroes might try to convince one of the members of the Final Supremacy to fire the weapon and thus have their revenge on Kang the Devourer for destroying their entire universe. After all, even if the Devourer triumphs over the heroes, those villains have nothing to go back to. Everyone and everything they ever knew is gone. The best they can hope for is to face off against any other Final Supremacy survivors for the chance to become the Devourer's new herald—and few people so powerful are ever content to serve.

That would, of course, mean that the heroes have to trust that villain not to betray them by handing the Ultimate Nullifier over to the Devourer or cutting some other kind of deal with the Devourer now that they finally have leverage over him. It's possible, though, that the heroes can convince one of them to act without hesitation and finish the job before the Devourer can hope to respond.

Few heroes, however, will want to hunt down someone and ask them to sacrifice themselves for the greater good, especially if they're not willing to do it themselves. That person would likely have to demand the chance—or, if that doesn't work, beg for it—and there probably aren't any such martyrs at hand.

The only exception is the Silver Surfer, if none of the players are controlling him. He could have accompanied them all the way to this point to keep watch over the Ultimate Nullifier. If they ask him to, he accepts the duty without

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complaint. He was willing to threaten the Galactus from his universe with the weapon, and he does not hesitate to do so again to save even more people than were in danger back then.

The Damage Done

Once used, the Ultimate Nullifier works as advertised. It obliterates Kang the Devourer and kills the person who fires it. It also destroys about 90 percent of the universe—which isn't all that large at that point in time, just after the Big Bang.

Fortunately, the Ultimate Nullifier is designed to leave anyone within the user's region of space unharmed—other than the user and the target, of course. This early in the universe's development, there are no other living things, so no one else is destroyed.

Unfortunately, without the chronal energies that the Devourer consumed, the universe of Earth-56438 cannot move forward on its own. It is doomed to remain a truncated stub like this for all time.

DEALING WITH THE SUPREMACY

In the end, Kang the Devourer must be dealt with one way or another. However, the heroes have other options with the members of the Final Supremacy who face off against them. It's entirely possible—perhaps even likely—that some or all of those villains may survive the adventure.

But what should the heroes do with the last survivors of Earth-56438 if their timeline has been devoured?

The villains might hope that the timeline will re-form naturally now that the Devourer is no longer consuming it, and they might attempt to return home. This does not work, as the energy the Devourer consumed is the energy that time—and life in this universe—needs to move forward. It disappeared along with him.

The heroes have a few options for the members of the Final Supremacy, and none of them are great.

Kill Them

The simplest solution is to kill the few survivors of Earth-56438. Most of them are unrepentantly evil and would certainly do the same to the heroes if their situations were reversed.

However, most heroes—especially those with the Heroic tag—should find this difficult to stomach. They are unlikely to be willing to outright murder defeated foes in cold blood.

Those foes, however, could give the heroes a reasonable excuse to do just that. If they haven't been defeated or disabled, they can attack the heroes in an effort to force them to transport the villains to another universe, one in which they can start anew. To that end, they are willing to fight to the death.

If the villains force the heroes' hands, the heroes might be more comfortable about reluctantly handing them a fatal ending. It's up to you if you want to give them that moral escape route instead of leaving them to hang on the horns of this dilemma.

Leave Them

The heroes could simply depart Earth-56438's universe and leave the villains to their own devices. This might feel like killing the villains through neglect, but it's not necessarily so. Some of them might have a way to escape the cold and unforgiving remnant of their universe.

However, the Devourer surely stripped his recruited villains of any means of omniversal travel so that they wouldn't simply escape the moment he turned his back on them. If the villains are left in this dimension, the most likely scenario is that they perish soon after.

Such powerful people are stubborn about survival, though. If the heroes don't take the Devourer's worldship with them—or somehow destroy it—the villains might be able to live on it indefinitely. Given enough time, they might even be able to figure out how the Devourer used it to move between universes. If so, they could then depart and terrorize other places—and perhaps even hunt down the heroes to take their revenge upon them.

Imprison Them

If the heroes subdue the villains—or if the villains surrender—they could choose to bring them back to their own universe for imprisonment, just like the heroes would do for almost any other villain. It might be difficult to keep some of these villains locked up, but with outside help, the heroes might be able to devise a means of keeping their universe safe from such powerful threats.

This means, of course, that the prisoners might later find a way to break out and threaten the heroes once again, perhaps even in partnership with their alternate versions from that universe. But at least it means the heroes aren't murdering the villains or leaving them to die.

Help Them

The Final Supremacy villains might ask to be brought to a parallel universe that closely matches their own. Of course, the alternate versions of themselves in those worlds might not tolerate that, but that's the kind of problem the heroes might not feel bad about inflicting on such people.

This solution keeps the heroes from having to harm helpless prisoners, and it turns the villains into someone else's problem. That doesn't mean that this act can't come back to haunt the heroes later. The heroes might have earned the villains' gratitude, but the people the villains plague after this might want to track down and have revenge on the folks who inflicted such horrors upon them. And if the villains team up with their counterparts rather than fight them, the heroes could be causing innocent people all sorts of misery.

On the other hand, the villains might have been traumatized enough by the destruction of their universe that they decide to put their past sins behind them and work to help people in whatever universe the heroes deposit them. Or at least stop trying to destroy innocents. How it turns out is entirely up to you and your plans for your game.

OTHER ULTIMATE NULLIFIER OPTIONS

Few players like being confronted with a no-win situation, and they often work hard to come up with other options that don't involve anyone dying. When it comes to the Ultimate Nullifier, they may have a few such paths to pursue.

Learning the Details

Very few people in the Multiverse truly understand how the Ultimate Nullifier is supposed to work. Even fewer have

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actually fired one. It's a weapon of last resort for the most powerful beings in existence.

Because of that, figuring out how the weapon works is a challenge. You can't exactly go out into the woods and test-fire it, and there are no manuals for it.

At the moment, the people who know the weapon best are Mister Fantastic, Galactus, the Watcher (Uatu) and another Watcher by the name of Emnu. Of the four of them, only Emnu and Mister Fantastic have fired it.

Emnu actually created the Ultimate Nullifier himself in an act of desperation. Despite the terrible damage that he knew would ensue, he used it to stop an aggressive alien race known as the Prosilicans from using Watcher technology to conquer the universe. Firing it ruined nine-tenths of the universe, and Emnu hid his actions from the vast majority of his fellow Watchers for the rest of time.

Mister Fantastic used the weapon much more recently, as a means of putting an end to the Reckoning War. He survived the experience, but only by a wild set of circumstances that neither he nor anyone else could likely reproduce. He would not be able to fire it again without paying for that choice with his life.

Working the Nullifier

The Ultimate Nullifier works differently depending on who fires it. If any of the heroes fire the weapon, it simply kills them. However, if someone powerful and intelligent enough uses it—someone of Rank X, in effect—they can eliminate the target from ever having existed. They can then rework the universes the target has touched so that those timelines are disrupted in the least possible ways by the target's removal. This includes the universe the firer is in at the moment.

This effectively means that the shooter can survive using the weapon by reworking reality so that they remain after the target's disappearance. A sufficiently powerful being could destroy the entire Multiverse and then reassemble it as they wished.

At the moment, there are only two such creatures in the heroes' universe or Earth-56438 who could manage such a thing: Galactus and Uatu.

The other Watchers might have been able to manage it once, but most of them were depowered during the Reckoning War. The only ones who escaped that fate were Uatu and Emnu, and Emnu was imprisoned inside the M'kraan Crystal, along with the instigators of the Reckoning War.

So, if the heroes can find Galactus or Uatu and get them to use the Ultimate Nullifier to destroy Kang the Devourer, they could theoretically restore all of the timelines in all of the universes that the Devourer has destroyed to that point.

Doing this is not impossible, but it's a huge challenge. Galactus, as mentioned previously, is roaming the outer edges of the universe in a newly opened frontier. The Silver Surfer might track him down, though, and ask him to join the fight.

The trick would be to convince Galactus that he should get involved. Traditionally, as someone who devours entire planets, saving the Multiverse has not been something that concerned him. In fact, he might sympathize with Kang the Devourer, who is

Art by J. Scott Campbell & Sabine Rich

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Art by Brett Booth, Adelso Corona & Guru-eFX

only feeding in a way similar to how Galactus had been sustaining himself—albeit only a planet at a time—for countless millennia.

As for Uatu, he recently became the only Watcher empowered to watch over his universe and—from his vantage point—the rest of the Multiverse as well. As such, he has renewed his pledge of noninterference, the one by which all Watchers are supposed to abide.

That said, unlike most of the other Watchers, Uatu has broken that pledge repeatedly in the past. In fact, the first time he did so was to help the Fantastic Four find the Ultimate Nullifier so they could use it to dissuade Galactus from devouring the Earth. He might well be sympathetic toward doing something similar when the fate of so many universes is at stake.

Finding Uatu is a challenge, as he no longer lives in his citadel on the Moon. However, he is aware of all that transpires in the universe, so it's not a stretch to think that he would be monitoring the heroes' efforts against Kang the Devourer. When they need him most, he might step in to help.

Or he might let one of them pay the price of firing the Ultimate Nullifier instead, believing that this is the way that events are supposed to transpire.

What he does is up to you.

Alternate Universe Solutions

What about the Uatu and Galactus of Earth-56438? They're already dead. The first thing that Kang the Devourer does when he enters a new universe is take out the biggest threats to himself. That includes both of those notable figures.

It's possible that the heroes could figure out a way to pluck either of those figures from an earlier point in the timeline of Earth-56438, but the Devourer is careful about such things when it comes to universes that know he's coming. If he can get away without alerting them, he prefers to simply consume them with the rest of a timeline. However, in such cases, he takes pains to destroy both the Watcher and Galactus at points in their timelines when they are too young to be a threat to him.

Still, the heroes might go hunting for a universe in which Uatu or Galactus are unharmed and perhaps not as attached to their own lives. It's a big Multiverse out there, with all sorts of possibilities, but such a find would be extremely rare.

DAMAGE CONTROL

Hopefully, the heroes manage to stick to at least the rough edges of the plot and triumph in the end. If they don't, there are all sorts of things that can go wrong. Here are some tips on how to handle the game in those cases.

Dead Heroes

It's possible for the heroes to get killed (or otherwise incapacitated) at many points in the adventure. If that happens, the game doesn't have to end there.

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For one, death is rarely permanent when it comes to Marvel heroes. If there's a way for them to come back to life, now would be the time to explore that, especially in an adventure with such high stakes.

While the heroes shouldn't be encouraged to waste time—lest the Devourer start in on consuming another universe, perhaps even the heroes' own—one of the benefits of time travel is that there's always a bit of wiggle room when it comes to how much time the heroes have. Even if they have to take off in the middle of the final battle to deal with the death of one of their own, they could theoretically return an instant later with a resurrected friend—and perhaps some additional help—to save the day.

Alternatively, if a hero dies, their player can (as suggested in the *Core Rulebook*) let that character rest for a while and start playing a new one instead. Just as in the comics, when one hero falls, there are often others who can be called upon to take their place. If the Silver Surfer has been working alongside them under the Narrator's control, this would be an excellent time to hand that character over to an eager, empty-handed player.

Captured Heroes

If the villains capture the heroes at any point in the adventure, that can put a real crimp in their plan to save the day. If all the heroes are captured, you should present them with opportunities to escape.

Those opportunities can vary according to your taste. Maybe only some of the heroes can get away. Maybe just one.

Those who are free might be able to figure out a way to rescue the others. Or they might need help. If so, you could have the players of the captured heroes take on the roles of some of the rescuers.

In this case, since the captor in question isn't as powerful as the Devourer, you might consider letting the players become lower-rank heroes, ones who would find it a challenge to face off against whoever the captor might be. Once the original heroes are free, the players can switch back to playing them and let their rescuers return to whatever they were doing.

Alternatively, if it seems like the original heroes could use some help—perhaps indicated by the fact that they were captured—the heroes could bring the rescuers along on their mission. However, what those extra heroes do is entirely up to you as the Narrator.

Handling that many extra characters can become a lot to juggle. If you prefer, you can offload some of that on to the players by asking them to take control of not only their original characters but the rescuers too. As Narrator, you have veto power over the actions of the secondary heroes—if only to make sure that the players don't favor the interests of their main heroes too strongly—but that's often not an issue you need to worry about.

Note that the Devourer isn't the sort to take prisoners. If he has the chance, he is sure to kill the heroes instead. However, members of the Final Supremacy might not be so vicious about such decisions, especially if they think they can turn a hero's capture to their favor. That's not something they're likely to be able to use against the Devourer—who doesn't care if the heroes die—but they might be able to leverage the situation against the other heroes.

Tactical Retreat

It's not common, but sometimes heroes balk at facing down such overwhelming foes as Kang the Devourer. Trying to stand up to someone powerful enough to consume not just worlds but entire universes requires a great deal of bravery, especially when the odds seem far from in the heroes' favor.

They might decide that the problems facing Earth-56438 are not something they need to concern themselves with. Trying to save the Final Supremacy and the Earth they rule over might gall them a bit. However, by the final section of the adventure, it's too late to do much for that world anyhow.

Instead, it's the rest of the Multiverse that's at stake. Eventually, the existential threat that the Devourer presents is bound to make its way to the heroes' own universe, and they may soon run out of places to which they can escape. It's better to stand up to the Devourer sooner than later, when there's not nearly as much left to save.

If you need a mouthpiece to make this argument, the Silver Surfer would excel at it. He's well known for being willing to sacrifice to save others, and he can encourage the heroes to do the same.

If the heroes can't find it in themselves to make a stand, it may be time to have a chat with the players and see how they would like to proceed. Is the adventure just too much for them to handle? Would they like to try it with different heroes instead?

Don't try to force people to play an adventure they're not up for. It won't be fun for anyone.

It's possible, after all, that the heroes could die of old age before the Devourer gravitates toward consuming their universe. Then it's a problem the next generation of heroes must deal with instead.

You don't have to let the heroes off the hook entirely, though. If you keep playing an ongoing series, you can have refugees from other universes the Devourer is consuming make their way to the heroes' world with tales of horror and woe. You can imply that the danger comes closer to the heroes' home with every passing day. Sooner or later, they're going to have to figure out how to do something about it.

The Villains Win

If all the heroes die, the villains win, right?

Technically, sure, but that's a rotten way to end a game. The heroes might give their lives in their attempt to stop the Devourer's plans, but that doesn't mean the game has to end. You still have a couple of options.

Maybe this is simply a minor setback. If the heroes have ways to be brought back from the dead, they can go through that process and give it another shot. Hopefully this time, they have better luck—or perhaps enter the battle better prepared.

Alternatively, you can treat this as a major setback in which the heroes are all dead and not likely to come back anytime soon. If so, it's time for a new group of heroes to step up to the challenge and hopefully do better than the last group managed. In such a case, do what you can to hook the new heroes in and make them feel like they're part of the original team's effort.

Maybe the dead heroes asked the new heroes for help already, but the new heroes couldn't get there in time to

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save their friends' lives. And now they're fighting not just to save the Multiverse but to avenge the fallen heroes' deaths.

If need be, you can do this as many times as it takes the heroes to win. That's especially true if they can come back from the dead easily.

If the players must come up with a new group of heroes each time, though, the repeated effort can become dark pretty quickly. Have Nick Fury arrange for more help for them. Maybe this time they actually do get hold of Uatu and bring him into the fight. Or they decide that they can't manage this without the aid of their universe's Galactus, so they put their best efforts into recruiting him instead.

This isn't just a matter of stopping a mugging. If the heroes fail here, ultimately, the entire Multiverse could be destroyed. There's no walking away from this. At least not forever…

If things grow desperate, Kang the Conqueror may take the chance to slip away and recruit a new and hopefully more fortunate group of heroes to put an end to the Devourer's threat. The heroes that he started with might fail or give up or even run away, but the Conqueror's never been one to give up. Not even against the Devourer.

THE AFTERMATH

Once the Devourer is defeated, it's time for the heroes to return to their own time and place. Assuming Kang the Conqueror has survived to this point, if the heroes have any questions about what happened and what the ramifications to the Multiverse might be, he can try to answer them.

If the heroes get confused, Kang gives up trying to explain such things to them. Time travel is a complicated business, and it only becomes more so when dealing with alternate universes. Suffice it to say that they saved the Multiverse, and for that, they have Kang's gratitude—for all that may be worth.

Going Home

If Kang has survived, he is happy to take the heroes back to their own universe and deposit them at the proper moment in their timeline. It can be as if they never left.

If Kang is dead or otherwise incapacitated and the heroes have no other way to return home, they may be in serious trouble. However, they discover that Doctor Doom hasn't entirely abandoned them. Soon after they find themselves trapped at the dawn of time without any way back, he uses Summon Portal to rescue them.

This is not, perhaps, the sort of thing Doom usually does, but he likes the idea of such a powerful group of heroes owing him a favor—even if they did just save him and the rest of the Multiverse.

If Doom has been with the heroes throughout much of the adventure, he brings them back home—wherever that might be for them—and departs. He grudgingly admires what they've managed to accomplish, even if their motives are rooted in foolish altruism rather than self-interest.

If the heroes have a means to get back to their Earth and somehow still have Doom's time platform but Doom is not with them, they can use it to get back to their own time. The moment it brings them to a safe place in that era, it immediately disappears, recalled back to Doctor Doom remotely. While he may have been willing to loan out his powerful device to the heroes in dire straits, he still wants it back straightaway.

Heroes who are interested in maintaining respectful if not cordial relations with Doom might consider voluntarily returning the time platform to him directly rather than waiting for him to take it back. This is the kind of thing that earns Doom's respect, and if the heroes do this and treat him and his belongings well, he grants them leave to depart from Latveria immediately, without fear of attack. Those who insist on lingering may discover that Doom's mercy is a fragile and short-lived thing.

Exploring Time

After returning to their own universe, heroes who have access to Doctor Doom's time platform—without Doom operating it for them—might decide that they don't want to go straight back to where they belong. After all, they can return to the same point at which they started whenever they want, so what's the harm with doing a little sightseeing on their way?

Kang counsels them against such foolishness. It's easy to disrupt the timeline without intending to, and he doesn't want to have to come in to clean up after their mistakes. If they just go ahead and leave, though, he can't stop them.

The moment the heroes try to abscond with the time platform, however, they wind up right back in Castle Doom, not long after when they departed from there originally. Doom might have been willing to give them a long leash while they tried to put an end to the Devourer's threat, but now that they're done, he's taking his time platform back, whether they like it or not.

On the other hand, if you have plans of your own that involve the heroes roaming through time, feel free to have Doom be content to watch the heroes muck about. He can always recall the time platform whenever he likes—perhaps at what the heroes would consider the absolute worst time.

On top of that, Doom doesn't have to bring the heroes with the time platform when he recalls it. If they're not near it when he takes it, they might not even notice that it's missing—and that they're now stranded—for a good while.

Returning the Ultimate Nullifier

If the Silver Surfer is with the heroes at this point, he reclaims the Ultimate Nullifier and returns it to Galactus' worldship, where it belongs. If anyone argues with him about this, he insists to the point of fighting them over it.

If someone is foolish enough that they threaten the Silver Surfer with the weapon, he relents. He curses them for their greed—or whatever other motivation they might express—and then returns to Galactus as soon as he can. Once he does, Galactus summons the Ultimate Nullifier back to the *Taa II*, and it immediately appears there, right where it belongs. This can happen only if the weapon isn't in someone's hand at the moment, but it's unlikely the heroes can manage to keep wielding it forever.

The Homecoming

Nick Fury Sr. would like to debrief the heroes in the Watcher's citadel. He thanks them all for their service, not just to their own universe but to the entire Multiverse. Without them, Kang the Devourer would have eventually consumed it all.

He also helps them mourn for anyone who died or was lost in the course of the adventure, whether because they

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fired the Ultimate Nullifier or for some other reason. While the world at large may never know of—or at least properly appreciate—their sacrifice, he knows and the Watcher knows, which must count for something.

Once Fury Sr. answers any questions that he can, he sends the heroes on their way, returning them to their homes or headquarters. As they leave, he thanks them again for everything they've done and hopes out loud that he never has to call them together to face a threat like this again.

At least not for a while.

Ranking Up

If any heroes involved aren't already at Rank 6 or at their rank cap, this is a great time to give them a chance to bump up a rank. Let the players choose how they want to manage the inherent increases from that boost while their heroes recover from what may well be the biggest adventure they've ever had.

The Next Adventure

There are no more adventures! That's it! You're done! You reached the end!

Well, the end of this book, at least. As more than 80 years of Marvel Comics stories tell us, there are always more adventures ahead, more things for heroes to do and more universes that need saving. See the section below for suggestions about where you might take things from here.

WHERE TO GO FROM HERE

Now that the heroes have saved the entire Multiverse, they might like a change of pace. You can certainly put them through the wringer again later, but take it a little easier on them in whatever you do next. Those little breathers let you ease the tension down so that later you can ratchet it back up again.

Prequel Time

If you haven't already played through the other adventures in this book, it's okay to go back and give them a shot in whatever order you like. While they're designed to be run in order, there's nothing that says you can't go backward instead. In that case, each of the earlier adventures can help the players fill in the gaps in the story that they already know. By the time they complete them all, they should have an excellent grasp on everything.

Other Adventures

While *The Cataclysm of Kang* is the first graphic novel-length series of adventures for the *Marvel Multiverse Role-Playing Game*, there are others in the works. Be sure to check with your local retailer or one of our electronic partners for what's available now.

As always, you can visit www.Marvel.com/rpg for the latest details and updates for the game.

Your Own Adventures

Of course, there's nothing stopping you from coming up with all-new adventures of your own, tailored especially for the players in your group and their amazing heroes. Here are a few suggestions.

- While Earth-56438 may be destroyed, there's certainly a universe out there just like it that Kang the Devourer never reached. The heroes might take it upon themselves to explore that twisted but familiar world and see what kind of good they can do there. Maybe they can help the resistance there to finally defeat the Supremacy and overthrow Hydra.
- It's also possible that people from that alternate universe might come to visit the heroes' world instead. Perhaps the Supremacy is running out of foes to scare their people with in their own world and wants to start an interdimensional invasion, so they give their forces a new common foe—and can thus keep their stranglehold upon their citizens.
- The heroes could help rebuild the parts of their world that were damaged by the attempted invasion from Earth-56438. As they do, they might discover that they didn't entirely rid the world of a number of Hydra agents from Earth-56438—and perhaps even some members of the Supremacy. Stranded in this world and cut off from any outside support, those villains are sure to reach out to Hydra on this world for assistance, perhaps with disastrous results.
- Maybe some other super-powered people from Earth-56438 escaped before the Devourer destroyed their timeline. This might even include variants of some of the players' heroes. How do they deal with these multiversal refugees? Do they try to integrate them into their world, or do they seek out a new home for them in another world that somehow has more room for such folks?

THE EPILOGUE

After the final session is over, congratulate the players for completing the adventure—or the whole series of them, if they made it through them all—and thank them for playing with you. Then—as mentioned at the start of this chapter—when the time is right, broach the subject of what you all might be interested in playing next.

Your ideas about what you want to do might have changed over the course of completing the adventure. If so, don't feel obligated to go through with your original plans, whatever they might have been. One of the great things about a tabletop role-playing game is that your imagination is the only limit. You can always change your mind.

Either way, you may want to give it a day or two to all sink in before you make any big decisions. The players and you are likely to have had a wild ride.

Congratulations!

When thanking the players, they might think to thank you as well—as you certainly deserve—but either way, we want to thank you too. This game is only words in a book until someone like you picks it up and becomes a Narrator.

While a massive amount of work went into this book to give you all the tools you need to run an incredible game, you—as a Narrator—are the one who actually puts all those words and ideas into practice with your players.

So, thanks for playing! This adventure literally wouldn't be complete without you!

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Art by Ruairí Coleman & Jesus Aburtov

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8

CHARACTERS

Character profiles, both heroes and villains, for use in *The Cataclysm of Kang* can found in the following pages.

ORGANIZATION

The profiles are listed in alphabetical order, so you can find them quickly, whether you're using them in one of the adventures in this game or for one of your own.

It might seem easier to group the characters by the adventures in which they appear, but some appear in multiple adventures, and it didn't make sense to repeat profiles. Also, we didn't want to offer the players any spoilers by grouping the suggested heroes with the foes that they might wind up fighting.

Keeping Track

In the middle of a game, you don't want to have to go flipping through the book to find the profiles for various characters. You can keep that from happening with a little advance preparation.

One way is to print copies so you have them on hand at all times. Another way is to mark the pages you might need to refer to so that you can find them instantly. You can do this with something as simple as a bookmark or even scrap paper. Alternatively, you can use sticky notes or color-coded sticky tabs to flag those important pages.

PICKING HEROES

Before you get too far along with planning to use any particular adventure, you should make sure you know which heroes your players are planning to play. If they already have characters of their own that they've created—and they fit the rank recommendations for that adventure—you're all set.

Either way, you should offer them the opportunity to play the recommended heroes for each adventure. It's okay for them to play their own heroes for one adventure and to use the recommended heroes in another.

For instance, if their heroes are already Rank 3, they might prefer to play the recommended heroes for the first two adventures. After that, they can switch back to playing their own original heroes.

Providing Heroes

If the players want to use the recommended heroes, you should copy the information for those heroes on to a character sheet for them. If you'd rather they take the time to do that—during which they can familiarize themselves with the character—you may want to photocopy the pertinent pages (or send the players photos of them) rather than have them accidentally stumble upon any spoilers in this book.

MULTIVERSAL PROFILES

The profiles in this book are generally for the Earth-616 versions of the characters. When you need to use a version from another universe, like Earth-56438, the biographies might differ—as described in the adventures—but the rest of the profile should be the same.

The exceptions to this are the brand-new characters that were created for this book, like the Crimson Surfer.

For example, Spider-Woman (Jessica Drew) led a very different life on Earth-56438 than her Earth-616 version did, but her powers, abilities and so on are identical.

However, if something doesn't ring true to you for an Earth-56438 variant, go ahead and alter things as you wish.

Michael Syrett (Order #53194700)

AGENT SUM

Art by Adriana Melo, Mariah Benes & Chris Sotomayor

RANK	KARMA
1	1

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
10	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +0

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	1	11	+1
AGILITY	2	12	+2
RESILIENCE	1	11	+1
VIGILANCE	0	10	+0
EGO	0	10	+0
LOGIC	1	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Expert
- **Connections:** Espionage
- Leverage

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Mysterious
- Secret Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Pistol

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Hui Lin
Height: 6'1" **Weight:** 207 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Facial scar
Occupation: Spy
Origin: Unknown
Teams: S.H.I.E.L.D.
Base: Mobile

History
Born to a family of Chinese peasants in the mid-fourteenth century, Hui Lin grew up with no prospects in life. At the ripe age of forty, he took a fall off a horse and cracked his head wide open.

The fall should have killed Hui, but within minutes, his head had fully healed, leaving nothing but a small scar behind. Horrified and confused, he fled his little village into the countryside.

From that day forward, Hui stopped aging. He spent the next several centuries living the quiet life, only emerging into the world on the rare occasions that he found a cause worth fighting for.

Going by the name of David Sum, Hui joined S.H.I.E.L.D. sometime in the late twentieth century. He's been a top-ranking member of the organization ever since, maintaining ties with S.H.I.E.L.D. leadership even after its dissolution.

Personality
As a veteran of numerous wars, Agent Sum is a bit self-serious, if not outright world-weary. He has too often found himself as the lone survivor of a devastating attack.

POWERS

Basic
- Healing Factor

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Suppressive Fire

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

ALPHA PRIMITIVE

Art by Pablo Raimondi, Andrew Hennessy & Adriano Lucas

RANK	KARMA
1	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
40	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+0E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
3 MELEE	13	+4
2 AGILITY	12	+2
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
0 VIGILANCE	10	+0
0 EGO	10	+0
-2 LOGIC	8	-2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY		
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY		
EGO	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY		
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	−	2 ABILITY		

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- **Connections:** Military (Inhuman Royal Guard)
- Enhanced Physique
- Situational Awareness
- Weird

Tags
- Backup
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Varies
Height: Varies, typically around 5½ feet
Weight: Varies **Gender:** Mostly male
Eyes: Varies **Hair:** Bald **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Military
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: Servants and defenders of the Inhuman Royal Family
Base: Mobile

History
Thousands of years ago, a brilliant but cruel geneticist appeared before the ruling council of Inhuman society. This geneticist argued that to turn their society into a true paradise, the Inhumans of the future would need docile, unintelligent attendants who could take care of their every physical want. To that end, he claimed he could breed a genetically perfect servant.

The ruling council approved the geneticist's request. Within a few years, hundreds of his creations—which he dubbed Alpha Primitives—had joined Inhuman society.

At first, the Alpha Primitives were everything the geneticist had promised: unintelligent, physically strong and largely obedient. Even after the fall of the old Inhuman society and the rise of the Royal Family, the Alpha Primitives continued to provide their labor freely and without complaint.

However, deep down, beneath all their societal and genetic programming, some part of each Alpha Primitive yearns to be free. Across the last several decades, bloody Alpha Primitive rebellions have wracked the foundations of Inhuman society. With the recent collapse of New Attilan, most of the remaining Alpha Primitives have scattered to the winds.

Personality
Most Alpha Primitives are kind, but they have the vocabulary of a young child. They can speak in simple sentences and follow simple instructions, but they would be lost if asked to assemble anything more complex than a cardboard box.

However, when pushed to the breaking point, Alpha Primitives have been known to exhibit sudden flashes of incredible intelligence. Their rebellions have been organized and swift.

POWERS

Basic
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 1

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber

ichael Syrett (Order : 53194700)

ARNIM ZOLA

Art by Dan Mora & Edgar Delgado

RANK	KARMA
3	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	-2

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	1	11	+1
AGILITY	1	11	+1
RESILIENCE	3	13	+3
VIGILANCE	2	12	+2
EGO	2	12	+2
LOGIC	6	16	+9

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Abrasive
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Extra Occupation
- Font of Information
- Inventor
- Scientific Expertise
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- A.I.
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance
- Lab Access
- Public Identity
- Streetwise
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Arnim Zola
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 200 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: None **Hair:** None **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Humanoid robot with a screen for a face in his chest
Occupation: Criminal, Scientist
Origin: High Tech: Android
Teams: Hydra
Base: Mobile

History
Arnim Zola was once a brilliant Nazi scientist who, in order to protect himself from the dangers of his own creations, transferred his mind into a robotic body he made. Atop this body he mounted an experimental "ESP Box"—a device designed to amplify his own brain waves.

The ESP Box worked better than Zola ever could have expected, granting him a slew of telepathic powers. His renown in fascist circles skyrocketed, and after the fall of the Third Reich, Zola joined with the Red Skull and several other fanatical fascists to form the latest incarnation of the terrorist group Hydra.

In the years since, Zola has always been a top-ranking member of Hydra High Command. He forms the backbone of the evil organization's scientific efforts, and has been personally responsible for the creation of many of their most powerful villains. Doughboy, Man-Fish, Primus and the Black Knights (A.K.A. the Fenris Twins) all owe their existence to the dastardly inventions of Zola.

Zola is not a skilled fighter, but his ESP Box allows him to hold his own in battles against the likes of Captain America and the Falcon.

Personality
Like most of Hydra's leaders, Arnim Zola is a committed fascist and megalomaniac. His complete disregard for the lives of others has been made apparent by his many horrific and torturous experiments. Zola is single-mindedly determined to continue his terrible research, and he will let no one stand in his way.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 3
- Uncanny 2

Elemental Control (Electricity)
- Elemental Burst

Telepathy
- Command
- ESP
- Information Upload
- Machine Telepathy
- Telepathic Blast
- Telepathic Link
- Telepathic Network

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

BETA RAY BILL

Art by Andrea Di Vito & Laura Villari

RANK **5**

KARMA **5**

HEALTH **240**

DAMAGE REDUCTION **-2**

FOCUS **90**

DAMAGE REDUCTION **—**

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 6

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+2**

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
8 MELEE	17	+12
3 AGILITY	12	+4
8 RESILIENCE	18	+8
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
4 EGO	14	+6
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 10 MULTIPLIER	+	8 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 7 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 8 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Big (reach 2)
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- **Connections:** Outsiders
- Enhanced Physique
- Extra Occupation
- Extraordinary Origin (2)
- Fearless
- Fresh Eyes
- God Heritage (via Twilight Sword)
- Stranger
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- Alien Heritage
- Alternate Form (regular Korbinite form)
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- Supernatural
- Worshipped (as Thor)

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Beta Ray Bill
Height: 6'7" **Weight:** 480 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: No irises **Hair:** None **Size:** Big
Distinguishing Features: Bright orange skin, horse-like head
Occupation: Adventurer, Outsider
Origin: Alien, High Tech: Cybernetics, Mythic: Asgardian
Teams: Annihilators, Guardians of the Galaxy
Base: Mobile

History
Years ago, the demonic Surtur of Muspelheim unleashed his minions upon the planet of Korbin. Korbinite civilization was annihilated, and the few who survived fled across the cosmos.

Korbinite scientists performed torturous experiments upon their own people, hoping to create a champion capable of fighting the demons. Only one subject named Bill survived the transformation, but even his newfound powers were not enough to hold back the demons.

All hope was lost until a chance encounter with Thor Odinson led Bill into an alliance with Asgard. Impressed by Bill's strength, Odin himself granted the Korbinite a hammer with a set of powers to match Thor's own. Together, Bill and Thor pushed the demons back into Muspelheim.

Much later, Bill invaded Muspelheim and defeated Surtur once and for all. He abandoned Odin's gifts and claimed Surtur's Twilight Sword as his own. Although he is still revered in Asgard, Bill now focuses most of his energies on caring for his people.

Personality
Beta Ray Bill's noble and serious demeanor matches well with those of the gods of Asgard. The Asgardians accept him as one of their own—more so than his fellow Korbinites, who are largely frightened by his monstrous form. Bill can use his sword to disguise himself as a regular Korbinite, and he tends to stay in this disguise when among his own.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Discipline 2
- **Iconic Weapon:** Twilight Sword [Adds elemental fire effect to melee attacks.]
- Inspiration
- Mighty 4
- Sturdy 2

Melee Weapons
- Exploit
- Fast Attacks
- Focused Fury
- Vicious Attack
- Whirling Frenzy

Super-Strength
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Jump 1
- Ground Shaking Stomp
- Immovable
- Quick Toss
- Smash

Michael Syrett (Order # 53194700)

BLACK KNIGHTS/FENRIS TWINS

Art by Sean Damien Hill, Victor Nava & Espen Grundetjern

RANK **3**

KARMA —

HEALTH **60**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS **90**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 15

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+2E**

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+2
4 AGILITY	14	+5
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
4 EGO	14	+5
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Abrasive
- Battle Ready
- **Connections:** Military (Hydra)
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Situational Awareness
- Weird

Tags
- Hounded
- Krakoan
- Public Identity
- Villainous
- X-Gene

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Andrea and Andreas von Strucker
Height: 5'9" (both)
Weight: 110 lbs. (Andrea), 165 lbs. (Andreas)
Gender: Female (Andrea), Male (Andreas)
Eyes: Blue (both) **Hair:** Blond (both)
Size: Average (both)
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Military
Origin: Mutant, Weird Science
Teams: Hellfire Trading Company, Hydra
Base: Krakoa

History

Decades ago, fascist leader Baron von Strucker forced his pregnant wife to undergo experimental treatments developed by the brilliant but evil Dr. Arnim Zola. The genomes of the twin embryos were modified to include a number of unusual genes, including the X-Gene of mutant fame.

Andrea and Andreas von Strucker displayed few symptoms of this meddling at birth, but as young adults their powers began to emerge. The twins could fly, perform incredible feats of acrobatics, and shoot blasts of energy from their fists—but only while in direct contact with each other.

Under the codename Fenris, the twins went into business for themselves as super-powered mercenaries. They have spent most of their adult lives menacing the rest of mutantkind, attacking super heroes for profit and pleasure.

Although the Fenris Twins were granted permission to live on Krakoa—despite the artificial nature of their mutant status—most other mutants do not regard them with respect. As the Black Knights of the Hellfire Club, they act as personal bodyguards for the villainous Sebastian Shaw.

Personality

The Fenris Twins are almost comically spoiled. They grew up in the lap of luxury, their every whim attended to by a squadron of servants. From a young age, they were taught to understand that they were better than other people and to violently oppose any who gainsaid that idea.

Like their father, both of the Fenris Twins are committed fascists and white supremacists. However, their first and greatest loyalty is to money. They do terrible things not out of a commitment to an ideology but out of a desire to maintain their opulent lifestyle.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Discipline 1
- Flight 1 (adjacent)

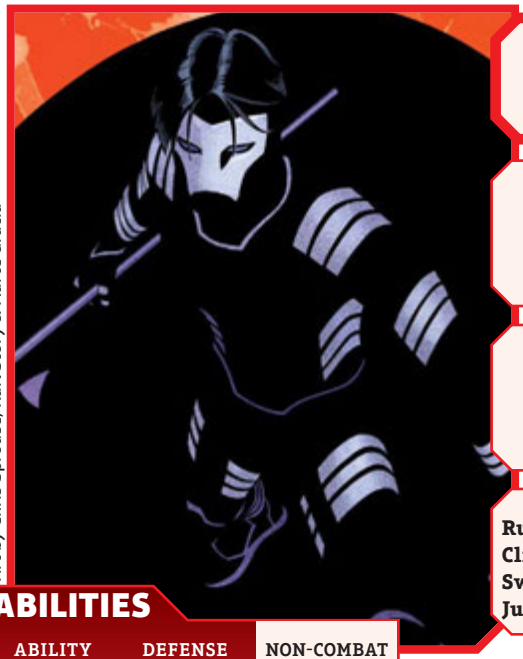
Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Blast (adjacent)
- Elemental Burst (adjacent)
- Elemental Push (adjacent)
- Elemental Ricochet (adjacent)

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Point-Blank Parry
- Return Fire
- Snap Shooting
- Stopping Power
- Suppressive Fire

Note: The Fenris Twins are two mechanically identical characters. They can move separately, but several of their abilities work only when the twins are close enough to touch. These powers bear the label "(adjacent)."

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

BLINDSPOT (SAM CHUNG)



Art by Chris Sprouse, Karl Story & Marte Gracia

RANK	KARMA
2	2

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+2
3 AGILITY	13	+3
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
2 VIGILANCE	12	+3
0 EGO	10	+0
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Inventor
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance
- Heroic
- Hunted
- **Mentor:** Daredevil (Matt Murdock)
- Secret Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Steel pole (club)

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Samuel "Sam" Chung
Height: 5'11" **Weight:** 175 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Black eyes with glowing blue irises
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: High-Tech, Special Training
Teams: The Hand
Base: NYC

History
When Sam Chung was just a boy, he and his family emigrated from China to the United States. With a prodigious mind and a strong admiration for the super heroes of New York City, Chung spent much of his childhood working on designs for an invisibility suit.

As soon as he was able, Chung built his suit and began to fight crime on the streets of New York's Chinatown under the codename Blindspot. Later, the super villain Muse tore out his eyes. They were eventually replaced with mystic counterparts, but his new glowing eyes have made maintaining his secret identity difficult.

Personality
Chung is a bit of a loner and a cynic. His mentor, Daredevil, is one of the few people on Earth he genuinely admires.

As an undocumented immigrant, Chung displays trepidation around law-enforcement officers.

POWERS

Illusion
- Invisibility

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Counterstrike Technique
- Defense Stance
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes

Melee Weapons
- Exploit
- Vicious Attack

Michael Syrett (Order : 53194700)

BULLDOZER (WRECKING CREW)

Art by Carlo Pagulayan, Jeffrey Huet & Justin Ponsor

RANK 3

KARMA —

HEALTH 90

DAMAGE REDUCTION -3

FOCUS 90

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +2E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
4 MELEE	14	+6
4 AGILITY	14	+4
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
1 EGO	11	+1
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 5 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Berserker
- **Connections:** Military
- Determination
- **Signature Attack:** Ram
- Situational Awareness

Tags
- Public Identity
- Supernatural
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Henry Camp
Height: 6'4" **Weight:** 325 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Military
Origin: Magic
Teams: Wrecking Crew
Base: Mobile

History

Abandoned on a trash heap when he was just 2 days old, Henry Camp grew up in an orphanage. Following a dishonorable discharge from the U.S. Army, he turned to a life of crime. After being picked up on burglary charges multiple times, he was sentenced to an extended stay on Ryker's Island.

In prison, Camp met Dirk Garthwaite, A.K.A. the villainous Wrecker. Along with a couple of other inmates, Camp helped Garthwaite escape from Ryker's. In exchange, Garthwaite granted Camp and his compatriots a portion of his own super-powers. Together, they formed the super-villain group known as the Wrecking Crew, and they've been in each other's orbits ever since.

At times when Henry Camp is not available, his daughter, Marci Camp, takes his place in the Wrecking Crew as the new Bulldozer.

Personality

Henry Camp's outwardly cool and tough demeanor conceals an inner bitterness. He harbors a burning resentment toward the government, society and the world at large, stemming from how they all failed him his entire life. It is this resentment that drives him forward in his criminal activities.

POWERS

Basic
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 3

Martial Arts
- Defense Stance

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Ground-Shaking Stomp
- Immovable
- Quick Toss
- Smash

Michael Syrett (Order #5319470)

CAPTAIN AMERICA (SAM WILSON)

Art by Taurin Clarke

RANK	KARMA
4	4

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-4

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	—

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 24

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +3

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
5 MELEE	15	+6
5 AGILITY	15	+5
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
2 EGO	12	+2
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Combat Expert
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Tech Reliance
- Weird

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- Streetwise

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Samuel Thomas "Sam" Wilson
Height: 6'2" **Weight:** 240 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: High Tech, Weird Science
Teams: Avengers, S.H.I.E.L.D.
Base: NYC

History
Sam Wilson grew up as an orphan in Harlem. As an adult, he was determined to give back to the community that raised him. He was helping out as a social worker when a fateful encounter with the Red Skull and a Cosmic Cube granted him super-strength and the ability to communicate with birds.

Shortly thereafter, Wilson ran into Steve Rogers—the original Captain America. Wilson and Rogers became fast friends, and together, they defeated the Red Skull. Subsequently, Rogers and Wilson became crimefighting partners: Captain America and the Falcon.

Wilson gradually developed a prowess in battle to rival Rogers' own. At times when Rogers has been unwilling or unable to take up the mantle of Captain America, Wilson has taken his place. Nowadays, both Wilson and Rogers go by the codename of Captain America.

Personality
Even more so than Rogers, Wilson's defining trait is his love for the downtrodden. His one goal in life is to use his powers for the protection of the weak and the oppressed.

Although Wilson is generally a serious man, he has a soft spot for those closest to him, particularly his avian companion Redwing.

POWERS

Basic
- **Iconic Weapon:** Captain America's shield [+1 damage multiplier. Grants the user one extra level of the power Shield, up to Shield 4.]
- Inspiration
- Flight 2
- Mighty 1

Shield Bearer
- Brace for Impact
- Do This All Day
- Hurled Shield Bash
- Hurled Shield Block
- Hurled Shield Deflection
- Rico-Shield
- Shield 3
- Shield Bash
- Shield Deflection

Telepathy
- Animal Bond (Redwing)
- Animal Communication (birds)

ichael Syrett (Order : 53194700)

CAPTAIN AVALON (BRIAN BRADDOCK)

Art by Vasco Georgiev & Erick Arciniega

RANK	KARMA
5	5

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
180	-3

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 25

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +4

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
8 MELEE	18	+12
3 AGILITY	13	+3
6 RESILIENCE	16	+6
4 VIGILANCE	14	+4
2 EGO	12	+2
2 LOGIC	12	+3

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 9 MULTIPLIER	+	8 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 5 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 5 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 6 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extra Occupation
- Fearless
- Glibness
- Inventor
- Leverage
- Scientific Expertise

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Lab Access
- Public Identity
- Sorcerous
- Supernatural

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Brian Braddock
Height: 6'6" **Weight:** 257 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Blond **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer, Scientist
Origin: Magic: Sorcery
Teams: Excalibur, S.H.I.E.L.D.
Base: Krakoa

History

Brian Braddock was once just a promising young physicist working out of an obscure facility in England. Then came the day the villainous mercenary Reaver attacked his workplace and slaughtered all of his co-workers. Braddock himself was on the verge of death when the specter of the wizard Merlin suddenly appeared before him.

Merlin offered Braddock one of two powerful gifts: a sword or an amulet. Out of a desire not to harm others, Braddock chose the amulet.

Instantly filled with power, he transformed into Captain Britain. As the one true defender of the British Isles, Braddock spent years defending both the United Kingdom and the mystical Otherworld of Arthurian legend, from which he drew his incredible powers.

Eventually, he learned of other ways to draw power from the Otherworld and granted possession of his amulet to his sister, Betsy Braddock. Today, Betsy fights under the title of Captain Britain, while Brian acts as Captain Avalon.

When he's not adventuring, Brian spends most of his time at home with his wife—Meggan Puceanu (codename Gloriana)— and their daughter Maggie.

Personality

Although he holds a doctorate in physics, Braddock is hardly a stuffy old professor. His friends know him as a kind and caring father with a good sense of humor. His enemies know him as a fearsome and determined opponent.

Braddock's natural confidence and charisma serve as the source of his mystic powers, which can be channeled only by those who believe in themselves. When he is feeling self-assured, Captain Avalon is nearly impossible to defeat.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 1
- Environmental Protection
- Flight 2
- Inspiration
- Mighty 4
- Sturdy 3

Magic (Sorcery Set)
- Shield of the Seraphim (20 points to shatter)

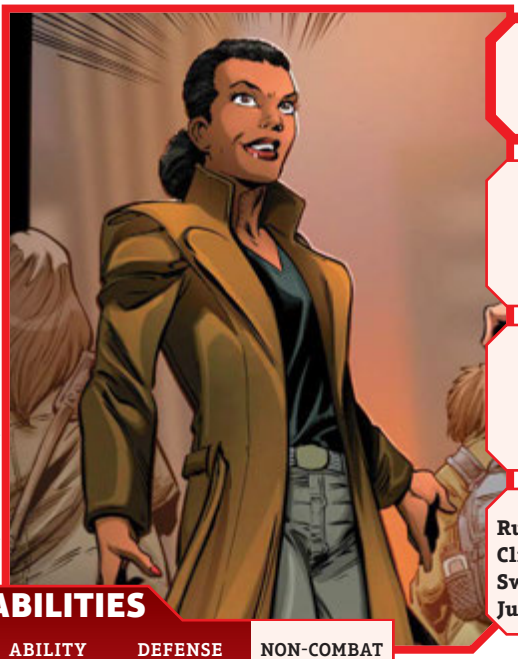
Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Immovable
- Quick Toss
- Smash

Tactics
- Hit the Dirt
- Keep Moving
- On Your Feet

Note: Captain Avalon's powers are based on his confidence. If he fails an Ego check, he has trouble on all power-based checks until he succeeds at a subsequent Ego check.

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

CLAIRE DIXON



Art by Mark Bagley, Scott Hanna & Dono Sánchez-Almara

RANK	KARMA
1	1

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +1

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
3 MELEE	13	+4
0 AGILITY	10	+0
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
0 EGO	10	+0
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Enduring Constitution
- Interrogation
- Investigation
- Weird

Tags
- Authority
- Backup
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Pistol

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Claire Dixon
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 133 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Law Enforcer
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: F.B.I.
Base: Mobile

History
Claire Dixon was the head of the F.B.I.'s Anti-Symbiote Task Force, until the day she was forcibly bonded to a symbiote of her own. Under the influence of the dark creature, she wrought chaos against her former allies. As the super villain Raze, she slaughtered members of her own unit. Eventually, Venom himself intervened to separate her from the alien slime.

Following the separation, Claire discovered that she had retained a portion of the symbiote's power. Vowing to make up for the evils she committed as Raze, Claire took a leave of absence from the F.B.I. and set out to become a super hero.

Personality
Claire takes her job as a government agent very seriously, and she has a strong sense of justice. Although she used to harbor an almost fanatical hatred of all things alien, her interactions with Venom have led her to soften her stance on symbiotes.

POWERS

Basic
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 1

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber

Michael Syrett (Order : 53194700)

CLOAK

Art by Takeshi Miyazawa

RANK	KARMA
3	3

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+4E

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	5	15	+5
AGILITY	2	12	+2
RESILIENCE	2	12	+2
VIGILANCE	4	14	+4
EGO	1	11	+1
LOGIC	1	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Sneaky
- Situational Awareness
- **Surprising Power:** Teleport Other
- Weird

Tags

- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Hounded
- Krakoan
- Secret Identity
- X-Gene

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Tyrone Johnson
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 155 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Mutant, Weird Science
Teams: Savage Avengers, X-Men
Base: Mobile

History

Tyrone Johnson grew up in a poor neighborhood in south Boston where, despite a significant stutter, he excelled in school. As a well-respected member of his community, he had no intention of leaving his hometown—until the day he watched his best friend get gunned down in the street by a trigger-happy cop.

Terrified and racked with guilt over his inability to prevent his friend's death, Johnson fled for New York. At a bus station in Manhattan, he and fellow runaway Tandy Bowen were kidnapped by Maggia goons.

The Maggia injected Johnson, Bowen and a number of other teenagers with an experimental narcotic. While this drug killed most of the runaways, it reacted with something lying dormant in Johnson and Bowen. Johnson gained a metaphysical connection to a dimension of darkness, while Bowen tapped into the power of light.

Under the codenames of Cloak and Dagger, Johnson and Bowen took their revenge on the Maggia. Since then, they have worked to protect young people across the world. They frequently fight with Mister Negative, a super villain created by the same narcotic that empowered them.

Personality

Years of adventuring have softened Cloak's naturally anxious personality. He spends most of his time in the form of his heroic alter ego, scouring the world for people to protect. Serious and soft-spoken, Cloak no longer stutters—except on the few occasions he returns to his old identity and becomes fully tangible.

POWERS

Basic

- **Iconic Weapon:** The Cloak (Can imprison grabbed opponents in the Darkforce dimension, during which time Cloak automatically makes a free Ego attack against them on his turn each round. To escape, imprisoned creatures must succeed on an Ego check against Cloak's Ego defense.)

Phasing

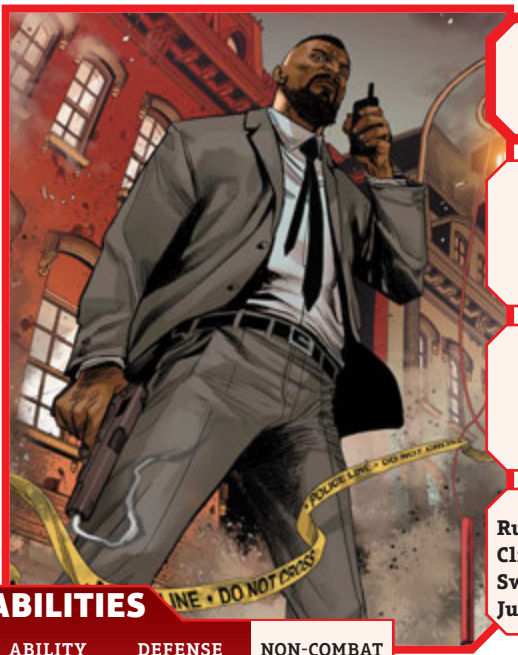
- Partial Phase
- Phase Self
- Quick Phase

Teleportation

- Blink
- Teleport 2
- Teleport Blind
- Teleport Object
- Teleport Other
- Teleport Together

Michael Syrett (Order #5319470)

COLE NORTH



Art by Marco Checchetto & Sunny Gho

RANK	KARMA
2	0

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+3
2 AGILITY	12	+2
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
1 EGO	11	+1
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Determination
- Fearless
- Interrogation
- Investigation
- Presence

Tags
- Authority
- Backup
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Cole North
Height: 6'3" **Weight:** 225 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Law Enforcer
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Fist, NYPD
Base: NYC

History
Cole North was once a revered detective in the Chicago Police Department. Then, for reasons unknown, he took a transfer to the New York Police Department. His first task in New York was to investigate a murder supposedly committed by Daredevil (Matt Murdock).

North took to that case the same way he does with all his cases: with dogged determination. In a matter of days, he tracked Daredevil down, beat him up and arrested him. Unfortunately, North's incredible and public defeat of Daredevil only made the hero's subsequent escape from custody all the more humiliating for the NYPD.

For a while after that, North harbored a grudge against all costumed super heroes. However, recent events have begun to push him into closer cooperation with the hero he once called an enemy.

Personality
North is a serious, by-the-book cop. He has trouble understanding why his fellow officers would willingly allow costumed vigilantes to act freely within their city.

Although he would typically prefer to avoid violence, North is more than capable of it. He is a highly trained boxer and a serious bodybuilder. North's status as the most muscular cop in New York has granted him a level of respect within the NYPD typically reserved for much older officers.

POWERS

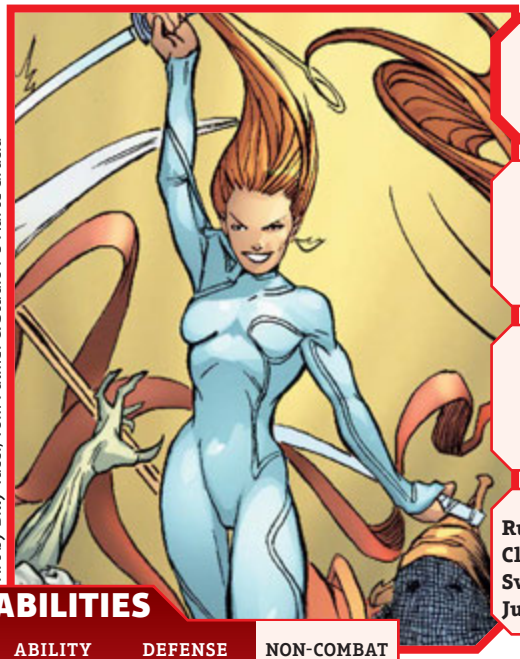
Basic
- Inspiration
- Mighty 1

Martial Arts
- Chain Strikes
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Snap Shooting
- Suppressive Fire

Michael Syrell (Order # 53194700)

COLLEEN WING



Art by Billy Tucci, Tom Palmer & Studio F's Marte Gracia

RANK	KARMA
2	2

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+2
2 AGILITY	12	+2
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
1 EGO	11	+1
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Beguiling
- **Connections:** Police
- Determination
- Fearless
- Interrogation
- Investigation

Tags
- **Headquarters:** Nightwing Restorations Ltd.
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Sword

POWERS

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Defense Stance
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes
- Leg Sweep

Melee Weapons
- Exploit
- Fast Attacks
- Vicious Attack

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Colleen Wing
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 135 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Red **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Investigator
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Heroes for Hire, Nightwing Restorations Ltd. (sometimes A.K.A. Daughters of the Dragon)
Base: NYC

History
With her mother dead and her father busy, Colleen Wing grew up in the custody of her grandfather: Kenji Ozawa, the head of the Japanese Secret Service. As a combat veteran, Ozawa was eager to tutor Wing in the art of sword fighting, training her to be a world-class expert with the katana.

As an adult, Wing moved to New York City, where she met Misty Knight, who soon became her best friend and her partner in their private investigation business, Nightwing Restorations Ltd. They often join Luke Cage and Iron Fist (Danny Rand) to round out their team, known as the Heroes for Hire.

Wing later learned that her mother had been the leader of the Nail, a faction of the ninja clan called the Hand. For a short while, she led a new incarnation of the Nail, but later betrayed them when she couldn't stomach their harsh methods.

Personality
Wing is a bit more socially reserved than Misty Knight, but the women have more in common than not. Both are thrill-seeking daredevils with a cool head for combat.

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

CRIMSON SURFER

Art by Ruairí Coleman & Jesus Aburtov

RANK	KARMA
6	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	-2

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 6 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Flight:** 36	+4

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	5	15	+7
AGILITY	6	16	+8
RESILIENCE	5	15	+5
VIGILANCE	4	14	+4
EGO	7	17	+9
LOGIC	3	13	+3

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 8	MULTIPLIER	+	5	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 8	MULTIPLIER	+	6	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 8	MULTIPLIER	+	7	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 6	MULTIPLIER	+	3	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Expert
- Combat Reflexes
- Determination
- Enduring Constitution
- Extraordinary Origin
- Inventor
- Presence
- Public Speaking
- Weird

Tags
- Authority
- Backup
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance
- Hunted
- Powerful
- Public Identity
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Johann Shmidt
Height: 6'5" **Weight:** 189 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** None **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Body covered in nigh-indestructible crimson material
Occupation: Leader
Origin: Special Training, Weird Science
Teams: Hydra
Base: Mobile

History

The Crimson Surfer started out the same way as Earth-616's Red Skull. Adolf Hitler—declaring that he could turn anyone into the ideal Nazi soldier—selected a random bellboy by the name of Johann Shmidt to be his next secret agent. After World War II, the crimson-headed Shmidt carried the mad führer's dream of a worldwide Nazi government into the modern age. This is where his fate and that of his Earth-616 counterpart diverge, as he successfully led Hydra to take over the world.

At some point, Kang the Devourer targeted the timeline of this Red Skull for destruction. Much like Norrin Radd made a deal with Galactus in the universe of Earth-616 to save his people, the Red Skull presented himself to the Devourer and offered to become his herald. He did it only to save his own skin, though, and for the Devourer to grant him a portion of his Power Cosmic. This gave him powers comparable to those of Earth-616's Silver Surfer and transformed him into the Crimson Surfer—after which, he helped oversee the destruction of his own universe's timeline.

Personality

Shmidt is a fascist zealot, a madman and a master propagandist who deftly recruits crowds of bigots. Gaining the Power Cosmic has only heightened Shmidt's megalomania. If he did not have to serve Kang the Devourer, the Crimson Surfer would already be scouring the universe, forcing as many worlds under his boot as he possibly could. He constantly looks for ways to betray the Devourer and take the rest of his power too.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 2
- Discipline 2
- Environmental Protection
- **Iconic Weapon:** Crimson surfboard [Summonable by Crimson Surfer. Grants Flight 2.]
- Inspiration
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 2

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrage
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Infusion
- Elemental Protection 2 (20 points to shatter)
- Elemental Reinforcement

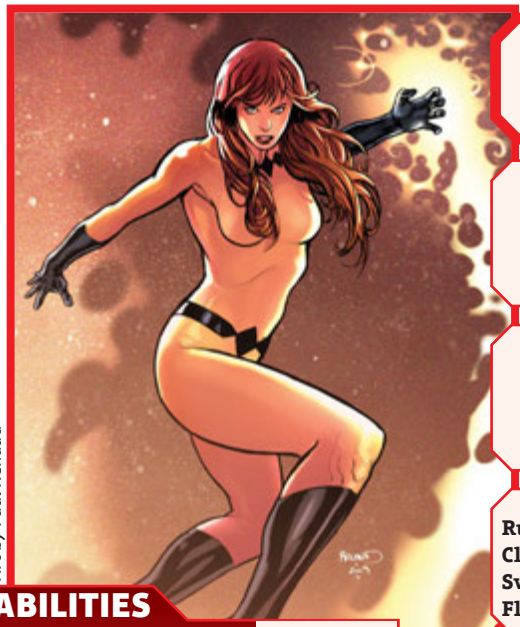
Ranged Weapons
- Covering Fire
- Double Tap
- Return Fire
- Snap Shooting
- Stopping Power
- Suppressive Fire

Tactics
- Keep Moving
- On Your Feet

Note: The Crimson Surfer's powers are not identical to those of the Silver Surfer and are, in fact, weaker. This is because Kang the Devourer does not trust Shmidt with that much power and so gave him less of it.

ichael Syrell (Order : 53194700)

CRYSTAL



Art by Paul Renaud

RANK	KARMA
4	4

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-2

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 6 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Flight:** 24	+3

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+2
5 AGILITY	15	+5
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
6 EGO	16	+9
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 7 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Beguiling
- Combat Expert
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Dealmaker
- Determination
- Fearless

Tags

- Black Market Access
- Inhuman Genes
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Crystalia Amaquelin
Height: 5'6" **Weight:** 110 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Blue-green **Hair:** Red **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Inhuman
Teams: Fantastic Four, House of Agon, Universal Inhumans
Base: Mobile

History

Crystal was born in the Inhuman city of Attilan into a family of royal nutritionists. Just like her older sister, Medusa, Crystal was exposed to the Terrigen Mist as a baby. Subsequently, she gained the power to control the four classical elements: earth, air, fire and water.

As young girls, Crystal and Medusa were inseparable. Sadly, war and chaos conspired to tear them apart when Crystal was just eight years old. Crystal spent her youth traveling the world, searching for Medusa. By the time they finally reunited, Crystal had grown into a young woman.

Crystal accompanied her sister back to Attilan, and in time, both became prominent members of the royal court. Medusa became queen of the Inhumans, while Crystal became an important ambassador and royal advisor.

Even after the bulk of Inhuman society was destroyed by Black Bolt, Crystal remained close to the Royal Family, providing whatever help she could to assist her sister in rebuilding their kingdom.

Personality

Having spent her youth traveling the world, Crystal is far more outgoing and personable than most Inhumans. She's the only member of the Inhuman royal court to have had a number of significant romantic relationships outside of Inhuman society. She dated the Human Torch (Johnny Storm) and was even briefly married to Quicksilver. Together, they had one child, a girl named Luna.

Even more than Medusa, Crystal is headstrong. She relishes adventure and never hesitates to rush into the most dangerous situations.

POWERS

Basic

- Discipline 3
- Flight 1
- Sturdy 2

Elemental Control (Air/Earth/Fire/Ice/Water)

- Elemental Barrage
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Grab
- Elemental Prison
- Elemental Protection 3 (30 points to shatter)
- Elemental Push
- Elemental Reinforcement
- Elemental Sphere
- Elemental Suffocation

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

DAGGER

Art by Mike Choi

RANK	KARMA
3	3

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 6 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	2	12	+2
AGILITY	5	15	+7
RESILIENCE	3	13	+3
VIGILANCE	2	12	+2
EGO	2	12	+2
LOGIC	1	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 5	MULTIPLIER	+	5	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+	1	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Presence
- Weird

Tags

- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Hounded
- Krakoan
- Secret Identity
- X-Gene

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Tandy Bowen
Height: 5'5" **Weight:** 115 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Blond **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Crescent moon mark on face
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Mutant, Weird Science
Teams: Savage Avengers, X-Men
Base: Mobile

History

Tandy Bowen was born into a cold and distant family of wealthy socialites. As a teenager, she became fed up with her affluent but unloving life in Ohio and ran away from home.

At a bus station in Manhattan, she ran into another teenage runaway: a penniless boy named Tyrone Johnson. She and Tyrone had only just begun commiserating over their mutual homelessness when they were kidnapped by Maggia goons.

The Maggia injected Bowen, Johnson and other teenagers with an experimental narcotic. While this drug killed most of the runaways, it reacted with something lying dormant in Johnson and Bowen. Johnson gained a metaphysical connection to a dimension of darkness, while Bowen tapped into the power of light.

Under the codenames Cloak and Dagger, Johnson and Bowen took their revenge on the Maggia. Since then, they have worked to protect young people across the world. They frequently fight with Mister Negative, a super villain created by the same narcotic that empowered them.

Personality

Dagger's personality contrasts sharply with that of her partner. While Cloak is serious, demure and soft-spoken, Dagger is friendly and outgoing. Cloak prefers to fight evasively, while Dagger attacks head-on.

Despite their differences, Dagger is connected to Cloak by their powers and their mutual desire to protect the young and innocent. Dagger is one of the few people who can enter Cloak's Darkforce dimension unharmed.

POWERS

Basic

- Accuracy 2
- **Iconic Weapon:** Light daggers [act as regular ranged weapons, but inflict Focus damage rather than Health damage]
- Slow-Motion Dodge

Ranged Weapons

- Double Tap
- Fast Hands
- Point-Blank Parry
- Return Fire
- Slow-Motion Shoot-Dodge
- Snap Shooting
- Sniping
- Stopping Power
- Suppressive Fire
- Weapons Blazing

Michael Syrell (Order # 53194700)

DAKOTA NORTH

Art by Michael Lark, Stefano Gaudiano & Chris Eliopoulos

RANK	KARMA
1	1

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+1

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
0 MELEE	10	+0
2 AGILITY	12	+3
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
0 EGO	10	+0
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- **Connections:** Police
- Determination
- Interrogation
- Investigation
- Skeptical

Tags
- **Headquarters:** Dakota North Investigations
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- Rich
- Streetwise
- **Signature Weapon:** Pistol

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Dakota North
Height: 5'7" **Weight:** 130 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Red **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Investigator
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Dakota North Investigations
Base: Dakota North Investigations

History
As the daughter of a cold and distant C.I.A. agent, Dakota North grew up hearing only whispers of her father's world-spanning escapades. Despite her father's protests, Dakota became determined to understand what his work was really all about. She became a world-famous child model, but from her teen years onward, she spent every day training, preparing for the day when she would enter the world of adventuring herself.

On the day of her eighteenth birthday, Dakota founded Dakota North Investigations—a private detective agency based out of New York City. Using her connections in the fashion industry, the business quickly took off. Over the course of the next few years, she opened three more branches of the investigative company in major cities across the United States.

In her time as a P.I., Dakota North has solved serial murders, thwarted terrorist attacks and assisted several other investigative super heroes in their escapades. Few other P.I.s in the world are as respected as Dakota North.

Personality
Dakota North is a no-nonsense woman of action. She would not hesitate for a moment to jump through a window or to take a bullet for a client.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1

Martial Arts
- Defense Stance

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Suppressive Fire

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

DEMOLISHER (WRECKING CREW)

Art by Mario Del Pennino, Arianna Florean & Pete Pantazis

RANK	KARMA
2	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+3E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
3 MELEE	13	+4
1 AGILITY	11	+1
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
1 EGO	11	+1
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Determination
- Situational Awareness

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Public Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Ball and chain (throwable club)
- Streetwise
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Laura Lopez
Height: 6'2" **Weight:** 240 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Criminal
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Wrecking Crew
Base: Mobile

History
Unlike the core four members of the Wrecking Crew, Laura Lopez joined the criminal organization long after its initial formation. She had been training to be muscle for Wilson Fisk, but the Kingpin believed that her incredible talents could be made better use of elsewhere. He introduced her to the Wrecker, and she's been part of the crew ever since.

Little is known about the Demolisher's early life. She presumably has some history in the professional bodybuilding scene because—unlike the other members of Wrecking Crew—she does not rely on the Wrecker's magic. Instead, her strength arises from years of hard work and training.

Personality
Lopez is the youngest member of the Wrecking Crew, and as such, she is less hardheaded and jaded than her compatriots. She truly enjoys the thrill of battle and isn't above cracking a joke in the midst of a life-or-death situation. She's also the only woman on the team, which she is always aware of.

POWERS

Basic
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 1

Martial Arts
- Defense Stance

Melee Weapons
- Exploit
- Fast Attacks
- Hit & Run
- Vicious Attack
- Whirling Frenzy

Michael Syrell (Order - 53194700)

DOOMBOT

Art by Ron Lim, Scott Koblish & Rob Ro

RANK **3**

KARMA **—**

HEALTH **90**

DAMAGE REDUCTION **-2**

FOCUS **120**

DAMAGE REDUCTION **-1**

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 15

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+3E**

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	2	12	+3
AGILITY	2	12	+2
RESILIENCE	3	13	+3
VIGILANCE	3	13	+3
EGO	3	13	+4
LOGIC	3	13	+4

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+ 2	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+ 2	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+ 3	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+ 3	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Combat Expert
- **Connections:** Military (Doombot army)
- Font of Information
- Presence
- Situational Awareness
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- A.I.
- Extreme Appearance
- **Linguist:** English, German, Hungarian, Latverian, Romani
- Public Identity
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Varies
Height: Varies, typically around 6'6"
Weight: Varies, typically around 500 lbs.
Gender: Male **Eyes:** Varies, usually brown
Hair: None **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Robotic body, usually hidden by armor
Occupation: Military
Origin: High Tech: Android
Teams: Allies of Doctor Doom
Base: Latveria

History
Victor von Doom is an ambitious and intelligent man with more enemies than he can count. By the end of his college years, Doom realized that, if he wanted to survive the coming decades, he would need trained body doubles.

Unwilling to settle for using regular men, Doom began prototyping robots that could act in his place. The first of these Doombots were impressive but flimsy, barely able to fight for themselves. Ever undeterred by defeat, Doom continued to rebuild and rework his bots until they became a force to be reckoned with.

The modern Doombots are among the toughest and most fearsome androids on the planet Earth. A single Doombot can contend with the likes of Spider-Man, and Doom's enemies are rarely lucky enough to be faced with just a single bot. Doom has been known to deploy entire armies of Doombots to deal with his archrivals in the Fantastic Four, or to put down peasant uprisings in his home country of Latveria.

Personality
The A.I. that runs the Doombots is both sophisticated and limited. When Doom himself is not available, they are capable of emulating his personality almost exactly, to the point where they begin to believe that they themselves are the real Doom.

However, when Doom is present, the Doombots shift into a mode more resembling that of mindless zombies. They follow Doom's orders to the letter, with no comments or complaints.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 1
- Discipline 1
- Flight 1
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 2
- Uncanny 1

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Defense Stance

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

EGGHEAD

Art by Brent Schoonover & Jordan Boyd

RANK	KARMA
2	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+1

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	0	10	+0
AGILITY	2	12	+3
RESILIENCE	1	11	+1
VIGILANCE	1	11	+1
EGO	2	12	+3
LOGIC	4	14	+6

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+ 0	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+ 2	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+ 2	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+ 4	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Abrasive
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Extra Occupation
- Inventor
- Scientific Expertise
- Tech Reliance

Tags

- Black Market Access
- Lab Access
- Public Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Egg bombs (frag grenades)
- Streetwise
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Elihas Starr
Height: 5'7" **Weight:** 320 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** None **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Unusually large, conical head
Occupation: Criminal, Scientist
Origin: High Tech
Teams: Masters of Evil
Base: NYC

History

For attempting to smuggle atomic secrets out of his own government-backed laboratory, Elihas Starr was fired from his job and became a pariah in the scientific community. Unfortunately for humanity, this served only to drive Starr further down the criminal path.

Shortly after Starr was fired, a group of upper-class criminals contacted him. Impressed by his supposed intellect, they hired Starr to defeat the scientist/crimefighter Ant-Man (Hank Pym).

Starr's initial attempts at this were, by and large, catastrophic failures, but that did not matter to him. He had gotten a taste for the thrill of super-villainy, and he was never going back.

Despite repeatedly being beaten, locked in jail and—on at least one occasion—killed outright, Starr has continued to menace the scientific world. Under the codename Egghead, he plots the destruction of all legitimate scientists, particularly Hank Pym and his heroic proteges.

Personality

Egghead is a delusional egomaniac who believes he is the smartest man in the world. In reality, he is nothing more than a mediocre scientist with a decent head for on-the-fly inventions. He can be reasoned with, but only insofar as he can be flattered.

Though Egghead may make an exception for the right price, he prefers criminal assignments that allow him to face off against important scientists like Hank Pym and Tony Stark. He wants nothing more than to prove himself in a battle of wits with those whom he believes are his intellectual rivals. He never succeeds.

POWERS

Basic

- Accuracy 1
- Brilliance 2
- Discipline 1
- Inspiration

Elemental Control (Energy)

- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst

Tactics

- Battle Plan

Michael Syrett (Order : 53194700)

FROG-MAN

Art by Mike McKone & Jeromy Cox

RANK	KARMA
1	1

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
10	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 5

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +0

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
1 MELEE	11	+1
2 AGILITY	12	+2
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
0 VIGILANCE	10	+0
1 EGO	11	+1
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Fearless
- Honest
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance (in suit)
- Heroic
- Poor
- Secret Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Eugene Paul Patilio
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 185 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Red **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: High Tech: Battle Suit
Teams: Action Pack, Space Friends
Base: NYC

History

Vincent Patilio was a penniless inventor who thought he could make a quick buck by building a super-suit that would allow him to make a quick escape from any heist. Donning a frog-themed costume, Vincent Patilio made his debut upon the world stage as the villain Leap-Frog.

He was almost immediately arrested by Daredevil.

From then on, Vincent's life only got worse. Despite having sworn off crime, the public continued to see him as little more than a petty menace. He and his son Eugene fell further and further into poverty.

Eventually, Eugene became sick of people bad-mouthing his father. He dug up his dad's old suit and vowed to clear the name of frog-themed adventurers everywhere. Under the title of Frog-Man, he wages a one-amphibian war on crime.

Personality

Eugene has a good heart, but his own bumbling and awkward nature has kept him from achieving his dreams. Despite having been an adventurer for a few years, he has yet to make much of a name for himself. He often falls back on his old job as a busboy to make rent.

POWERS

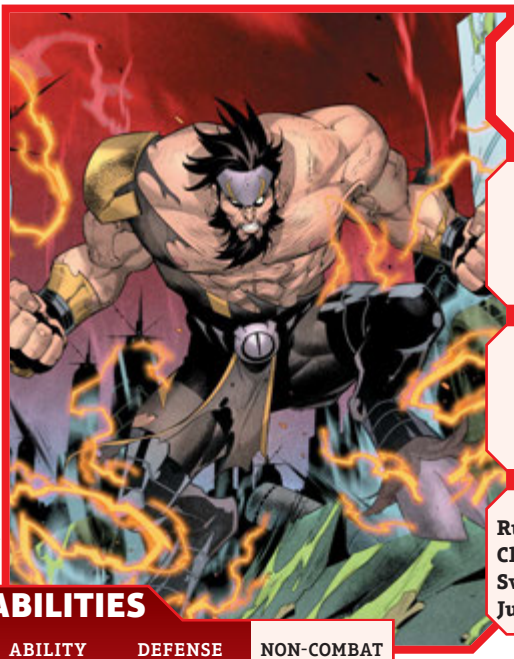
Basic
- Sturdy 1

Melee Weapons
- Hit & Run

Spider-Powers
- Jump 1
- Spider-Dodge

Michael Syrett (Order #5319470)

GORGON



Art by Marc Deering & Jose Villarrubia

RANK	KARMA
4	4

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	-3

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 6

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +2E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
7 MELEE	16	+10
3 AGILITY	16	+3
5 RESILIENCE	15	+5
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
1 EGO	11	+1
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 7 MULTIPLIER	+	7 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Big (reach 2)
- Combat Expert
- **Connections:** Military (Inhuman Royal Guard)
- Determination
- Fearless
- Situational Awareness

Tags
- Extreme Appearance
- Inhuman Genes
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Gorgon Petragon
Height: 6'8" **Weight:** 485 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown **Size:** Big
Distinguishing Features: Hooved feet
Occupation: Military
Origin: Inhuman
Teams: House of Agon, Inhuman Royal Guard
Base: Mobile

History
Born into an offshoot of the royal House of Agon, Gorgon Petragon was taught from a young age to revere and respect Inhuman royalty. As a young man, he befriended the future Inhuman king, Black Bolt, pledging his loyalty to the young prince. In the years since, Gorgon has never strayed far from Black Bolt or his queen, Medusa.

As the head of the Inhuman Royal Guard and the personal bodyguard of the royals themselves, Gorgon has been entrusted with the protection and preservation of the House of Agon. This is a job he takes with deadly seriousness, one he continued to perform even after Black Bolt was forced to kill the bulk of the Inhuman population.

If he can be convinced that doing so would be in the Royal Family's best interests, Gorgon has sometimes been known to work against the royals' wishes. On multiple occasions, the Inhuman villain Maximus has used this fact to manipulate Gorgon into attacking those he was sworn to protect.

Personality
Gorgon's unflinching loyalty to the House of Agon is both his greatest strength and his greatest weakness. He stops at nothing to ensure the safety of the Inhuman Royal Family. In times of relative unity, this dedication has been an immense boon for the royals. In times of division and confusion, Gorgon can be as much a danger as an asset.

POWERS

Basic
- Brawling
- Inspiration
- Mighty 3
- Sturdy 3

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Ground-Shaking Stomp
- Immovable
- Jump 1
- Quick Toss
- Smash
- Unrelenting Smash

Tactics
- Battle Plan

Michael Syrett (Order - 53194700)

GORGON (TOMI SHISHIDO)

Art by Stefano Caselli & Daniele Rudoni

RANK	KARMA
4	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+4E

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	6	16	+7
AGILITY	2	16	+2
RESILIENCE	3	13	+3
VIGILANCE	4	14	+4
EGO	1	11	+1
LOGIC	4	14	+6

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 5 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 6 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Expert
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Font of Information
- **Signature Attack:** Focused Fury
- Situational Awareness

Tags
- Hounded
- Krakoan
- Public Identity
- Streetwise
- Villainous
- X-Gene

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Tomi Shishido
Height: 6'4" **Weight:** 215 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Yellow **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Glowing yellow eyes, pale-gray undead skin
Occupation: Assassin
Origin: Mutant
Teams: Great Captains of Krakoa, the Hand, Hydra
Base: Mobile

History

Unlike most mutants, Tomi Shishido's powers began to manifest almost immediately after his birth. As a mere toddler, Shishido had the skills to rival the world's greatest artists. His intelligence advanced so quickly and erratically that by the time he was a teenager, something fundamental within his psyche could no longer bear the strain. He became increasingly despondent and, eventually, violent.

At the age of eighteen, Shishido killed his entire family. Shortly thereafter, he took control of the Hand and merged the ninja organization's already considerable resources with those of Hydra. As the mighty Gorgon—high commander of both Hydra and the Hand—Shishido committed himself to sowing death and destruction across the globe.

For the good of mutantkind, the founders of Krakoa convinced Shishido to put aside his evil ways. However, few doubt that he could return to his old patterns under different circumstances.

As a man who cares deeply about the well-being of Japan, Wolverine (Logan) keeps tabs on Shishido. He has already foiled Gorgon's plots for world domination several times, and if and when the time comes, he will be prepared to do so again.

Personality

Unlike most members of Hydra, Gorgon is not a fascist. Rather, he is an extreme nihilist. He sees the world as only a cruel joke played by an unloving god. In his heart, he desires nothing more than to wipe the slate clean and destroy all of creation. Hydra and the Hand are simply means to that end.

Rumors hold that—like the monster of Greek myth from which he takes his name—Gorgon can turn a person to stone with a single glance. However, no one has witnessed this happen for a long time, and it may be that Gorgon himself is the source of these rumors.

POWERS

Basic
- Brawling
- Brilliance 2
- Healing Factor
- Mighty 1

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes
- Leg Sweep

Melee Weapons
- Exploit
- Fast Attacks
- Focused Fury
- Riposte
- Vicious Attack

Telepathy
- Borrow Senses
- ESP
- Telepathic Link

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

GROWING MAN

Art by Gabriel Hardman & Elizabeth Dismang Breitweiser

RANK **4**

KARMA —

HEALTH **150**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS **60**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 4
Climb: 2
Swim: 2
Jump: 4

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+2**

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
6 MELEE	17	+9
2 AGILITY	13	+2
5 RESILIENCE	15	+5
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
4 EGO	14	+4
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 7 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Outsiders
- Determination
- Fearless
- Fresh Eyes
- Small
- Stranger
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- A.I.
- Extreme Appearance
- Public Identity
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Varies
Height: Varies **Weight:** Varies **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Varies **Hair:** None
Size: Varies, small by default
Distinguishing Features: Robotic humanoid with bright orange skin
Occupation: Outsider
Origin: High Tech: Android
Teams: Ally to Kang the Conqueror, Hydra
Base: Mobile

History

As part of his usual plans to cement himself as ruler of the known multiverse, Kang the Conqueror created the world's first stimuloid: an artificial human with the ability to absorb kinetic energy and turn it into mass. Kang proudly named his creation the Growing Man, and he buried it in Earth's ancient past for safekeeping.

In the early twenty-first century, a group of archaeologists working out of Manhattan inadvertently uncovered this stimuloid, awakening it much earlier than Kang had wished. Without the guidance of his creator, the Growing Man embarked on a wild rampage that drew Kang to that period of time. In the end, it took Thor himself to stop both the Growing Man and Kang himself.

Kang has rebuilt the Growing Man several times, only to see the stimuloid defeated again and again. He long ago abandoned any hope that the Growing Man would be his ultimate weapon, and these days he mostly uses the android as a bodyguard.

Personality

The Growing Man is intelligent, but only at the level of a toddler. Though he does not really understand why, he has an instinctive loyalty to his creator. Nothing bothers him more than the idea that Kang may have betrayed or otherwise abandoned him.

The Growing Man's control over his own powers is limited, and a slow and steady beating can force him into a spiral of uncontrollable growth. Whenever the Growing Man is in the field, Kang carries a "De-Energizer" gun capable of instantly reverting the stimuloid to his default size of small.

POWERS

Basic
- Energy Absorption
- Mighty 3

Resize
- Grow 4
- Growing Attack
- Macrodimensional Travel

Super-Strength
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Ground-Shaking Stomp
- Immovable
- Jump 1
- Quick Toss
- Smash
- Unrelenting Smash

Note: Whenever possible, the Growing Man uses the Energy Absorption power as a reaction. Every time he successfully uses this power, he automatically grows one size. He cannot willingly return to his default size.

Michael Syrett (Order - 53194700)

HAWKEYE (KATE BISHOP)

Art by Julian Totino Tedesco

RANK	KARMA
2	2

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
1 MELEE	11	+1
3 AGILITY	13	+5
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
0 EGO	10	+0
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Police
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extra Occupation
- Fearless
- Interrogation
- Investigation

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- **Mentor:** Hawkeye (Clint Barton)
- Public Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Bow and arrow

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Katherine Elizabeth "Kate" Bishop
Height: 5'5" **Weight:** 120 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer, Investigator
Origin: Special Training
Teams: West Coast Avengers, Young Avengers
Base: Mobile

History
When Kate Bishop was a young girl, she was kidnapped by a super villain named El Matador. After being rescued by the Avengers, she developed an abiding admiration for the team, especially Hawkeye (Clint Barton), who fought for justice despite his lack of super-powers.

Bishop decided to follow in Hawkeye's footsteps. As a teenager, she adopted Hawkeye's codename and began fighting crime as a member of the Young Avengers, with whom she has had numerous adventures. In the years since taking on the codename Hawkeye, she has worked several times with the original Hawkeye, who has made her his official protege, and she even took over ownership of his dog, Lucky. She recently started her own detective agency: Hawkeye Investigations.

Personality
Despite her outwardly casual and sometimes flighty attitude, Bishop has a strong and determined sense of justice. She wouldn't hesitate to put herself in harm's way to save another, even if it risked certain death.

POWERS

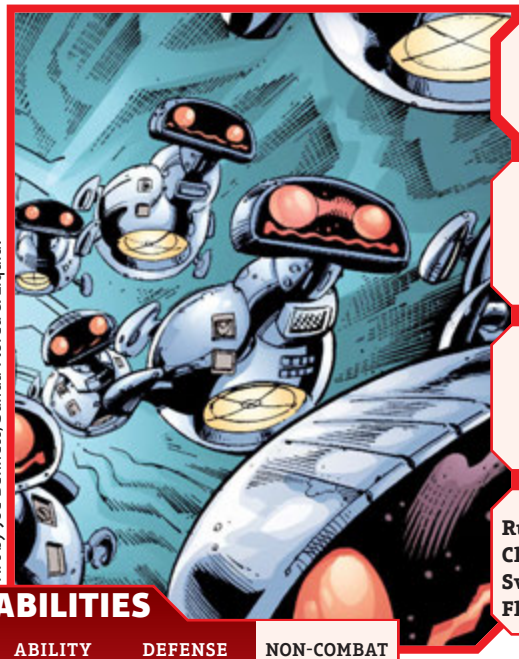
Basic
- Accuracy 2

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Defense Stance

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Snap Shooting
- Stopping Power
- Suppressive Fire

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

H.E.R.B.I.E. (SECURITY UNIT)



Art by Joe Bennett, Sandu Florea & Liquid!

RANK	KARMA
2	2

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED
Run: 4
Climb: 2
Swim: 2
Flight: 8

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +1

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
0 MELEE	11	+0
3 AGILITY	14	+4
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
0 EGO	10	+0
3 LOGIC	13	+3

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- **Connections:** Community
- Extra Occupation
- Font of Information
- Inventor
- Presence
- Scientific Expertise
- Small
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- A.I.
- Extreme Appearance
- Heroic
- Lab Access
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Humanoid Experimental Robot, B-type, Integrated Electronics
Height: Varies, usually 2'
Weight: Varies, usually 70 lbs.
Gender: Male **Eyes:** Yellow
Hair: None **Size:** Small
Distinguishing Features: Child-sized metallic robot with screen for a face
Occupation: Educator, Scientist
Origin: High-Tech: Android
Teams: Fantastic Four
Base: NYC

History
The first prototype H.E.R.B.I.E. was created by Mister Fantastic (Reed Richards) of the Fantastic Four to aid in the search for Galactus and to act as his personal laboratory assistant. HERBIE was designed to be smart, helpful and generally cheerful. Incredibly, he actually turned out to be all those things.

In fact, the H.E.R.B.I.E. project was such a success that Richards slowly began to produce more H.E.R.B.I.E.s. Within a few years, H.E.R.B.I.E. units were running almost all of the day-to-day activities at the Fantastic Four's headquarters.

H.E.R.B.I.E. units sometimes accompany the Fantastic Four on their adventures across time and space. However, the average H.E.R.B.I.E.'s duties are far more pedestrian. For example, a specialized H.E.R.B.I.E. unit often acts as the personal caretaker to Richards' two children, Franklin and Valeria.

Personality
For the most part, H.E.R.B.I.E. units are thoughtful and chipper. Built with a heroic spirit, they are quick to offer a hand in assistance to any who need one.

Some H.E.R.B.I.E.s, particularly those assigned to menial and boring tasks, harbor some resentment for their creator, but they rarely let it show. Only a select few H.E.R.B.I.E. units have ever chosen to leave the Fantastic Four behind.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Flight 1
- **Iconic Weapon:** Opti-Blaster (works like a regular pistol, but blinds the target on a Fantastic success)
- Sturdy 1

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Return Fire
- Snap Shooting
- Sniping
- Suppressive Fire

Note: Not all H.E.R.B.I.E. units are equipped with weapons. Such non-security units can fly but are otherwise no more powerful than an average civilian (see that profile in the *Core Rulebook*).

ichael Syrett (Order # 53194700)

HIVE

Art by Stefano Caselli & Sunny Gho

RANK **3**

KARMA —

HEALTH **120**

DAMAGE REDUCTION **-2**

FOCUS **90**

DAMAGE REDUCTION **-1**

SPEED
Run: 10
Climb: 6
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+2E**

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
3 MELEE	13	+5
1 AGILITY	11	+1
4 RESILIENCE	14	+4
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
2 EGO	12	+2
3 LOGIC	13	+3

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- **Connections:** Military (Hydra)
- Enduring Constitution
- Fresh Eyes
- Monster
- Situational Awareness
- Weird

Tags
- Extreme Appearance
- Mute (can only speak in eldritch gibberish)
- Public Identity
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Hive
Height: Varies, typically around 7'
Weight: Varies, typically around 340 lbs.
Gender: Male **Eyes:** White
Hair: None **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Humanoid hive of parasitic organisms
Occupation: Military
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: Hydra
Base: Mobile

History
The Hive is a living bioweapon, the result of experiments performed by Hydra researchers on some of the world's deadliest creatures. These maniacal scientists sought to create a living monster that was also a physical representation of everything Hydra stands for. In the many-tentacled Hive, they found their champion.

Just like Hydra, the Hive is conniving, amoral and parasitic. It can survive only by regularly bonding with a host—that it takes over entirely—and feeding upon innocent people. If left isolated for an extended period, the Hive dissolves back down into its original form: a pathetic and squirming pile of prehensile appendages.

The Hive's innate loyalty to Hydra as an organization is the only thing that keeps it in check. For high-ranking members of Hydra, the Hive has been known to sacrifice pieces of itself, merging with its allies in order to extend their lifespans.

Personality
Although the Hive is thought to be intelligent, it cannot speak any known human language. It can understand English, but its own speech consists of a garbled mess of undersea squeals and eldritch burbling. A few select members of Hydra have learned to decipher this language, and they serve as the Hive's handlers.

The Hive needs to feed on a new human only once every few years, but it prefers to feast on a daily basis. It can bond with persons of any gender, but it tends to present as male.

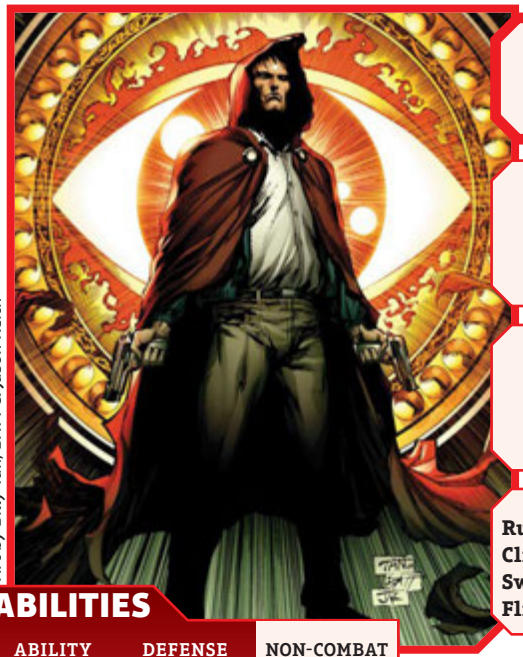
POWERS

Basic
- Additional Limbs
- Mighty 2
- Uncanny 1

Plasticity
- Bounce Back
- Coiling Crush
- Extended Reach 2
- Flexible Bones 2
- Reverse Punch
- Rubberneck
- Slip Free
- Stilt Steps

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

HOOD



Art by Billy Tan, BATT & Jason Keith

RANK	KARMA
2	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Flight:** 10	+3E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
1 MELEE	11	+1
3 AGILITY	13	+4
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
2 EGO	12	+2
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- **Connections:** Criminal
- Glibness
- Situational Awareness

Tags

- Black Market Access
- Secret Identity
- Sorcerous
- Streetwise
- Supernatural
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Parker Davis Robbins
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 165 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Criminal
Origin: Magic: Sorcery
Teams: Illuminati
Base: Mobile

History

With a pregnant wife at home and an ailing mother in the hospital, Parker Robbins turned to a life of crime to make ends meet. Off a tip from his cousin, Robbins broke into a warehouse that was supposed to contain a large shipment of valuable foreign goods.

Robbins found no such riches. What he discovered instead was a summoning circle and a terrifying cloaked demon spawned from the depths of hell.

More out of panic than malice, Robbins riddled the demon with bullets. In a frenzy, he stole the creature's clothes and made off into the night.

Only after the fact did Robbins realize that the garments had special powers. Using them, he could turn invisible, walk on air and even shoot bolts of lightning from his hands.

Under the codename of the Hood, Robbins set out to turn his newly found powers toward the pursuit of personal profit. He found that he had a talent for villainy and, after a few rocky capers, his crimes began to pay for themselves. Today, the Hood oversees a crime syndicate worthy of the Kingpin himself.

Personality

Despite his many crimes, Robbins still sees himself as basically a good person, a misunderstood man of the people. He rarely flaunts his wealth, stowing most of it away for the future benefit of an infant son he hardly ever sees.

Largely estranged from his family, Robbins spends most of his time drinking heavily and skulking around his own gambling dens.

POWERS

Basic

- Accuracy 1
- Flight 1

Illusion

- Invisibility

Magic (Sorcery Set)

- Bolts of Balthakk

Ranged Weapons

- Double Tap
- Snap Shooting
- Stopping Power
- Weapons Blazing

Note: The night he got his powers, Parker Robbins was approached in an alleyway by a recruiter for Hydra. On Earth-616, Robbins beat this recruiter senseless. On Earth-56438, he accepted the offer.

Michael Syrell (Order # 53194700)

HYDRA OFFICER

Art by Stefano Caselli & Daniele Rudoni

RANK **2**

KARMA —

HEALTH **60**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS **90**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+2E**

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+2
2 AGILITY	12	+2
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
2 EGO	12	+2
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 2 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Combat Expert
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Military (Hydra)
- Determination
- Situational Awareness

Tags
- Secret Identity
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Varies
Height: Varies **Weight:** Varies **Gender:** Varies
Eyes: Varies **Hair:** Varies **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: The green-and-yellow Hydra uniform
Occupation: Military
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Hydra
Base: Secret

History
Hydra tends to treat its lowest-level recruits (Hydra Agents) as cannon fodder, foot soldiers who can be spent or lost without hesitation. After all, there never seems to be a lack of disaffected people looking to join up with the fascist organization to do their part for world domination. As the Hydra oath goes, "Cut off a limb and two more shall take its place!"

Those agents who survive long enough—or are ambitious enough—find themselves promoted to positions of leadership within their hierarchical organization. Often they're the leaders of independent cells sequestered from the rest of Hydra for operational security, and the fact that they've survived to that point means (at least to them) that they must be doing something right.

Personality
While Hydra agents like to follow orders, Hydra officers have developed a taste for giving them. They like to shout at their underlings and boss them around, and many of them harbor aspirations of one day becoming the Supreme Hydra themselves. They tend to be mean and merciless—to outsiders, to their subordinates and most especially to those they see as rivals. Many of them see the fact that they've risen in the ranks as the proof of their superiority, and because of this, they tend to be cocky as well.

POWERS

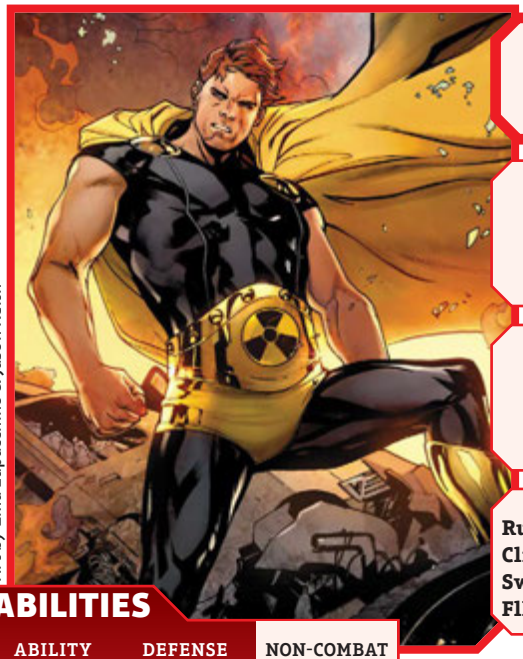
Basic
- Combat Trickery
- Inspiration

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Snap Shooting
- Suppressive Fire
- Weapons Blazing

Tactics
- Battle Plan
- Keep Moving

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

HYPERION



Art by Ema Lupacchino & Jason Keith

RANK	KARMA
5	5

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
180	-3

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Fllight: 30

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +3E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
6 MELEE	15	+9
2 AGILITY	11	+3
6 RESILIENCE	16	+6
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
5 EGO	15	+7
3 LOGIC	13	+4

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 8 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 7 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Beguiling
- Big (reach 2)
- Combat Expert
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Fearless
- Font of Information
- Situational Awareness

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Eternally Immortal
- Heroic
- Mahd Wy'ry
- Secret Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Marcus "Marc" Milton
Height: 6'4" **Weight:** 460 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Auburn **Size:** Big
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Eternal
Teams: Alpha Flight, Avengers, Squadron Supreme
Base: Mobile

History
Marcus Milton was born in an alternate universe—Earth-13034—as the sole survivor of a dying world of Eternals. His people sent him to Earth, where he was raised by a humble family of ordinary people.

Under the codename Hyperion, Milton worked to make that Earth into a utopia. Sadly, his home, his family and every other member of his universe were destroyed by the incursion of another reality, leaving him—once again—the sole survivor.

Hyperion was pulled from the void of his dead universe to Earth-616 by a group of A.I.M. scientists experimenting with multiversal travel. The Avengers freed Hyperion from A.I.M. containment, and for a while, he traveled with them on their adventures. However, he eventually tired of hero work, abandoned his identity as Hyperion and took up a job as a trucker, hoping to learn more about his new home.

Events outside of his control have occasionally forced Milton to return to his super-hero identity, but he continues to spend most of his time living on the road.

Personality
Milton struggles with his identity. He is not even the first version of himself to be pulled from another universe into Earth-616. The original Hyperion—Mark Milton of Earth-712—died shortly after this Milton's arrival.

Having survived so much death and destruction, Milton sometimes feels like fighting for justice may be a futile effort when, at any second, his whole world could be destroyed or reset. Still, he can't help but answer the call to action when he sees a person in need.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Brilliance 1
- Discipline 2
- Environmental Protection
- Flight 2
- Mighty 3
- Sturdy 3

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrage
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Ground-Shaking Stomp
- Immovable
- Quick Toss
- Smash

ichael Syrett (Order # 53194700)

INHUMAN ROYAL GUARD

Art by Stefano Landini & Matt Milla

RANK **2**

KARMA **0**

HEALTH **60**

DAMAGE REDUCTION **-1**

FOCUS **120**

DAMAGE REDUCTION **—**

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+3E**

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	1	11	+2
AGILITY	1	11	+2
RESILIENCE	2	12	+2
VIGILANCE	3	13	+3
EGO	2	12	+3
LOGIC	1	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- **Connections:** Military (Inhumans)
- First Aid
- Situational Awareness
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- Inhuman Genes
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Varies
Height: Varies **Weight:** Varies **Gender:** Varies
Eyes: Varies **Hair:** Varies
Size: Varies, usually average
Distinguishing Features: Varies
Occupation: Military
Origin: Inhuman
Teams: Inhuman Royal Guard
Base: New Attilan

History

The Inhuman Royal Guard has existed in one form or another since the dawn of the Inhuman monarchy itself. For thousands of years, they have been charged with the protection and preservation of the Royal Family. It is a duty that most of its members treat with deadly importance.

The Royal Guard has always been led by offshoots of the Royal Family itself. The most recent commander of the guard was Gorgon Petragon, cousin to both the king and the queen. The few who have obtained significant ranks within the Royal Guard have earned the privilege of direct proximity to ultimate power. Inhuman children grow up dreaming of gaining so much as a temporary position within the guard's lowliest ranks.

Early incarnations of the guard wielded spears and swords, and on ceremonial occasions the modern guard has been known to return to these implements. However, when out and about on duty, members of the current guard carry energy pistols and wear suits of gray cyber-armor. They are crack shots who shoot first and ask questions later.

Personality

While the leaders of the Royal Guard have distinct and boisterous personalities, the rank-and-file members of the institution are often indistinguishable from normal humans. Some of them have undergone Terrigenesis and acquired low-level super-powers, but many others have chosen to forgo the mists and strengthen themselves in more traditional ways.

When in the presence of royalty, members of the guard are expected to maintain complete and reverent silence. Much of a guard's regular duties can be summed up in a single sentence: stand still and look intimidating.

POWERS

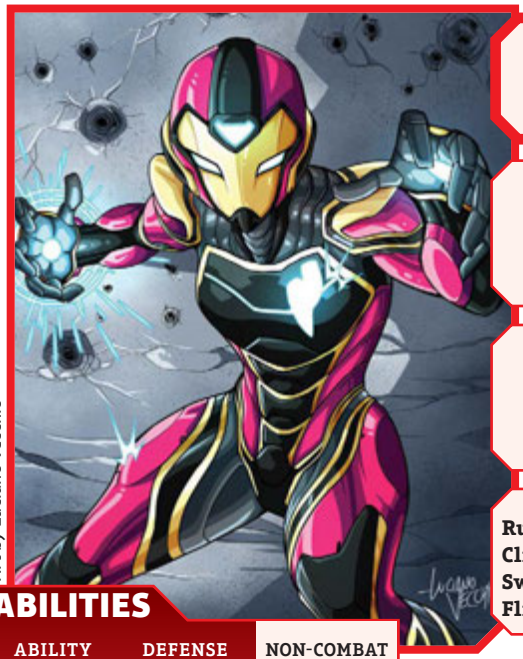
Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Discipline 1
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 1

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst

Ranged Weapons
- Snap Shooting
- Suppressive Fire

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

IRONHEART (RIRI WILLIAMS)



Art by Luciano Vecchio

RANK	KARMA
3	3

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-2

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 15

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +2E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
1 MELEE	11	+2
3 AGILITY	13	+4
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
2 EGO	12	+3
4 LOGIC	14	+6

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Determination
- Gearhead
- Inventor
- Quick Learner
- Situational Awareness
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- Extreme Appearance (in battle suit)
- Heroic
- Lab Access
- **Mentor:** Tony Stark
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Riri Williams
Height: 5'2" **Weight:** 100 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Engineer
Origin: High Tech: Battle Suit
Teams: Champions, Underground
Base: Mobile

History

As a shy kid from the south side of Chicago, Riri Williams had few prospects and even fewer friends. However, as a certified child genius, Williams earned a full ride to M.I.T. at the age of 11. Lacking the skills to make friends there—and surrounded by students twice her age—her first two years at the institute passed uneventfully. She withdrew into her studies, rarely speaking to anyone save for her parents and her childhood friend Natalie Washington.

In the summer of her sophomore year, Williams' social circle shrank even further when both her stepfather and Natalie were killed in a senseless drive-by shooting. Determined to avenge the deaths of her loved ones, Williams built a battle suit in the style of Iron Man (Tony Stark). Her escapades in this initial prototype drew the attention and admiration of Stark himself, who offered Williams the mentorship and resources she needed to build a new suit and become a full-fledged super hero.

As Ironheart, Williams has everything she ever wanted, including the opportunities to make friends. She often fights as part of the Champions, a team of young super heroes ready to help save the world.

Personality

As a young girl, Williams could not have been any more timid and awkward, but as she matured into a young adult, she learned how to speak her mind with confidence. As such, she's made friends both within the super hero community and without. What little free time she has she spends listening to hip-hop and poring over circuit diagrams.

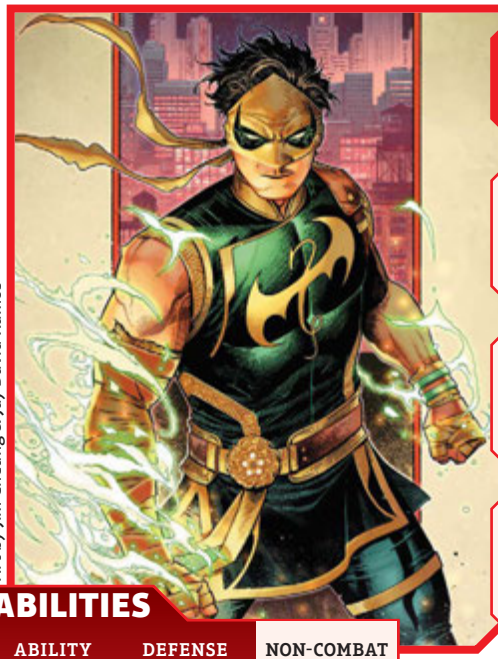
POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Brilliance 2
- Discipline 1
- Environmental Protection
- Flight 2
- Might 1
- Sturdy 2

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Push

Michael Syrett (Order # 53194700)

IRON FIST (LIN LIE)



Art by Jim Cheung & Jay David Ramos

RANK	KARMA
3	3

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +3

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	4	14	+6
AGILITY	3	13	+3
RESILIENCE	2	12	+2
VIGILANCE	3	13	+3
EGO	2	12	+2
LOGIC	1	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+ 4 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+ 3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+ 2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+ 1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- **Signature Attack:** Focused Strike

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- **Mentor:** Iron Fist (Danny Rand)
- **Mentor:** Shang-Chi
- Public Identity
- Supernatural
- Young

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Lin Lie
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 175 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Dragon insignia on right arm
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Magic, Special Training
Teams: Agents of Atlas
Base: Mobile

History

One year after Lin Lie's father and brother mysteriously disappeared, Lie was attacked at his home in Shanghai by a deliveryman—who turned out to be one of the demons who had kidnapped his missing kin. In a last-ditch effort to ward off the hellish creature, Lie took hold of his father's old sword and lashed out. To his surprise, the demon disappeared.

The blade once belonged to Fu Xi, one of China's three legendary sovereigns, and as Xi's descendant, Lie was one of a select few who could wield it against demons. Determined to save his family, Lie took on the codename of Sword Master and embarked on a global demon-killing spree.

After months of adventures, Lie finally encountered a demon he could not defeat. This fearsome creature shattered the legendary blade, embedding the shards within Lie's body. He would have perished had it not been for the intervention of the dragon spirit Shou-Lao. The serpent imbued Lie with chi power, transforming him into the latest incarnation of Iron Fist.

Lie's search for his family continues, but now he must juggle that quest with the responsibility of being the new Iron Fist.

Personality

In his heart, Lin Lie is still just a kid from Shanghai. He is young and insecure and constantly questions whether he deserves the power he has been given. Only with the constant support of those around him has Lie been able to build and maintain the confidence to carry on.

POWERS

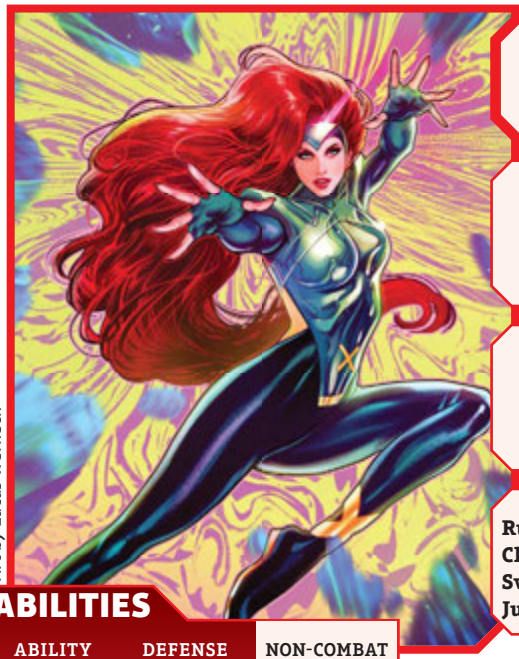
Basic
- Mighty 2

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Chain Strikes
- Counterstrike Technique
- Defense Stance
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes
- Focused Strike
- Leg Sweep
- Reverse-Momentum Throw

Melee Weapons
- Exploit
- Vicious Attack

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

JEAN GREY



Art by Lucas Werneck

RANK	KARMA
6	6

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
240	-2

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+7E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
1 MELEE	11	+1
3 AGILITY	13	+3
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
7 VIGILANCE	17	+7
8 EGO	18	+8
8 LOGIC	18	+10

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	8 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 8 MULTIPLIER	+	8 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Combat Expert
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Enduring Constitution
- Fearless
- Iron Will
- Situational Awareness

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Hounded
- Krakoan
- Public Identity
- X-Gene

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Jean Grey-Summers
Height: 5'6" **Weight:** 130 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Green **Hair:** Red **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Mutant
Teams: X-Force, X-Men
Base: Mobile

History
Jean Grey's mutant psychic abilities awakened when she was just 10 years old, after she witnessed her best friend die in a hit-and-run. With Jean traumatized and unable to control her nascent powers, her parents did the only thing they could think of. They entered her into the care of psychic professor Charles Xavier, better known as Professor X.

Not long thereafter, Xavier formed the original X-Men and installed Grey as a founding member, under the codename Marvel Girl. In the years since, Grey has become one of the most famous and powerful mutants—if not heroes—in existence. Along with the rest of the X-Men, she has fought against existential threats to the universe itself.

Additionally, Grey has hosted the Phoenix Force, an ineffable entity of light and fire older than the cosmos. Although the Phoenix Force has currently bound itself to another, Grey remains extremely powerful.

Two of Grey's future children that she has yet to have with Cyclops (Scott Summers)—who she is in a long-term relationship with—have become X-Men on their own: Rachel Summers and X-Man (Nate Grey).

Personality
Grey's powers are limited by her ability to control her mental state. She has rarely been completely stable on a psychic level, and repeatedly acting as the host of the sentient Phoenix Force has only served to further damage her. When she is stable, though, Grey is known for her kind and caring nature. Grey's teammates have long been a driving force in helping her to maintain her sanity, particularly Cyclops.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 2
- Uncanny 2

Telekinesis
- Levitation
- Telekinetic Attack
- Telekinetic Barrier
- Telekinetic Grab
- Telekinetic Manipulation
- Telekinetic Protection 2 (20 points to shatter)
- Telekinetic Reinforcement
- Telekinetic Sphere

Telepathy
- Astral Form
- Cloak
- Cloak Group
- Command
- Domination
- Edit Memory
- Memory Blip
- Mental Shelter
- Mind Interrogation
- Mind Reading
- Orders
- Telepathic Blast
- Telepathic Link
- Telepathic Network
- Telepathic Possession

Michael Syrett (Order - 53194700)

J. JONAH JAMESON

Art by Terry Dodson, Rachel Dodson & Ian Hannin

RANK **1**

KARMA **1**

HEALTH **10**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS **30**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+1**

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	1	11	+1
AGILITY	0	10	+0
RESILIENCE	0	10	+0
VIGILANCE	1	11	+1
EGO	2	12	+2
LOGIC	1	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Abrasive
- Audience
- **Connections:** Sources
- Determination
- Public Speaking
- Pundit
- Skeptical

Tags
- Heroic
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: John Jonah Jameson Jr.
Height: 5'11" **Weight:** 181 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Black with gray temples
Size: Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Journalist
Origin: Special Training
Teams: The *Daily Bugle*, TNM
Base: NYC

History

Determined to make the world a better place, J. Jonah Jameson spent his childhood studying the art of journalism. As a mere high school student, he wriggled his way into a position as a junior reporter with the *Daily Bugle*. Jameson's stellar reporting on civil rights issues, alongside his thrilling exposés on organized crime, rocketed him to the top of the paper's lineup.

Eventually, Jameson found the resources to buy the *Daily Bugle* and install himself as the editor in chief. Practically overnight, Jameson turned the *Bugle* from a failing local rag into an internationally respected news organization.

More than anything, Jameson is renowned for his editorial stance against costumed super heroes. As a man dedicated to the truth, he despises anyone whom he believes has something to hide. He has a particular sore spot for Spider-Man, who operates in the *Bugle's* direct vicinity.

Jameson lost control of the *Daily Bugle* and was forced to get a job as a regular reporter again. He even became mayor of New York City for a while. He has since returned to his first love: the news.

Personality

While he can come off as charming on camera, Jameson's employees know him as the gruff and abrasive man he really is. Although he retains the strong sense of justice he had in his youth, years of dangerous reporting work have turned Jameson into an angry cynic. He spends his days alternately shouting at his reporters to work harder and brooding in his office, scheming ways to keep his latest venture in the black.

Jameson has a soft spot for his son, John Jameson (A.K.A. Man-Wolf), whose heroics as an astronaut earned him worldwide recognition.

POWERS

Basic
- Inspiration

Martial Arts
- Banging Heads

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

KANG THE CONQUEROR

Art by Patrick Gleason & Alejandro Sánchez

RANK	KARMA
5	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-2

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
210	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+6

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	2	12	+4
AGILITY	3	13	+3
RESILIENCE	3	13	+3
VIGILANCE	6	16	+6
EGO	5	15	+7
LOGIC	6	16	+8

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 7	MULTIPLIER	+ 2	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 5	MULTIPLIER	+ 3	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 7	MULTIPLIER	+ 5	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 7	MULTIPLIER	+ 6	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Combat Expert
- Combat Reflexes
- Font of Information
- Presence
- Public Speaking
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- Authority
- Powerful
- Secret Identity
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Nathaniel Richards
Height: 6'3" **Weight:** 230 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Leader
Origin: High Tech
Teams: Anachronauts, Council of Kangs
Base: Mobile

History
Nathaniel Richards grew up in the near-utopian environment of the 30th century of Earth-6311. As an adult, he became sick of luxury and became determined to live a life of adventure in a more interesting era.

Disguising himself as the Pharaoh Rama-Tut, he built a time machine and set about conquering ancient Egypt. The Avengers put a quick end to his reign, but Richards remained undeterred. He conquered the war-torn 40th century and returned to the Avengers' era equipped with the greatest weaponry the future could offer.

As Kang the Conqueror, Richards has attempted many times to take down Earth's mightiest heroes. He has faced many defeats, but his powers over time have always allowed him to return and try again.

Kang is not above meddling in anyone's timeline, even his own. As a result, his early life has become shrouded in mystery and divergence, including other identities like those of Iron Lad and the Scarlet Centurion. Several alternate Kangs from across the Multiverse have had adventuring careers to rival his own. His future timeline is just as convoluted, often due to him trying to avoid becoming the more peaceful Immortus.

Personality
Kang is a megalomaniac and a narcissist of the highest order. He believes he's the most important being in existence, and he goes to great lengths to prove it. He often speaks in the style of ancient Greco-Roman conquerors.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 2
- Discipline 2
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 2

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrage
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Protection 2 (20 points to shatter)

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Defense Stance
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes

Omniversal Travel (Time)
- Time Portal
- Time Travel
- Time Travel Other
- Time Travel Together

Michael Syrett (Order: 53194700)

KARNAK

Art by Jim Cheung & Justin Ponsor

RANK	KARMA
4	4

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-2

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 6 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+4

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
5 MELEE	15	+7
5 AGILITY	15	+5
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
4 VIGILANCE	14	+4
2 EGO	12	+2
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 6 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Community
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extra Occupation
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Font of Information
- Presence
- **Signature Attack:** Exploit

Tags

- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance
- Inhuman Genes
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Karnak Mander-Azur
Height: 5'7" **Weight:** 150 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: No irises **Hair:** Shaved **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Numerous face tattoos
Occupation: Adventurer, Educator
Origin: Inhuman, Special Training
Teams: House of Agon, Universal Inhumans
Base: Mobile

History

Karnak was born into a prominent family of Inhuman geneticists, an offshoot of the royal House of Agon. When Karnak was just a boy, his brother Triton was exposed to the Terrigen Mist and mutated into a fishlike creature incapable of surviving on dry land. Subsequently, Karnak's parents forbade him from ever touching the mists.

Unwilling to be left behind by the other members of the Royal Family, Karnak embarked on a course of specialized and mysterious training. With the help of his strong Inhuman genes, Karnak quickly became an expert in combat. He can break most barriers and defeat most opponents in a single punch, given a chance to analyze their weaknesses.

Karnak's skill in combat makes him an invaluable asset to Black Bolt and the rest of the Inhuman Royal Family, though he's not as attached to the royals as many of the other members of their court. In recent years, he has dedicated much of his time to educating the next generation of warriors.

Personality

More so than any of the other Inhuman royals, Karnak is ruthless in combat. He does not hesitate to kill an opponent, especially one he considers inferior.

Outside of combat, he is equally single-minded. He spends much of his free time meditating on the nature of existence. He cares for the other members of the House of Agon, but only in a distant, brooding manner.

POWERS

Basic

- **Iconic Weapon:** Karnak's hands (act as melee weapons)
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 2

Martial Arts

- Attack Stance
- Brace for Impact
- Counterstrike Technique
- Defense Stance
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes
- Leg Sweep
- Regain Focus
- Unflappable Poise
- Untouchable Position

Melee Weapons

- Exploit
- Focused Fury
- Vicious Attack

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

LOCKJAW

Art by Ed McGuinness & Matthew Wilson

RANK	KARMA
3	3

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 6 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+3E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
5 MELEE	14	+6
2 AGILITY	11	+2
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
1 EGO	11	+1
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Big (reach 2)
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Situational Awareness
- Weird

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance
- Inhuman Genes
- Mute (can only bark)
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Lockjaw
Height: 5' **Weight:** 1,240 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown **Size:** Big
Distinguishing Features: Giant bulldog with small tuning-fork-like antennae
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Inhuman, Weird Science
Teams: House of Agon, Pet Avengers
Base: Mobile

History
Lockjaw is the final result of a series of experiments on animals performed by Inhuman geneticists. He was implanted with Inhuman genes and exposed to the Terrigen Mist while still in the womb. As a result, he later grew to an immense size and gained the ability to teleport nearly unlimited distances.

The data from the experiments on Lockjaw was used to give the future Inhuman king Black Bolt his own powers. Mere days after Black Bolt was born, the young prince developed an attachment to the dog who had been mutated in the same manner as himself. Soon enough, Lockjaw had become the official pet of the Inhuman Royal Family.

Lockjaw accompanies the royals on nearly all of their adventures. Although his combat abilities are limited, his powers of teleportation make him an indispensable teammate. In the rare event that the Inhuman royals are outmatched by an opponent, they can always cling to Lockjaw and teleport away.

Personality
Although more intelligent and observant than an average bulldog, Lockjaw is still an animal. He whines, barks, begs and behaves like any other dog.

Lockjaw can be rambunctious, and he has been known to run off on his own adventures from time to time. However, he is, above all else, loyal to Black Bolt. Any who make themselves an enemy of the Inhuman king must also contend with his dog.

POWERS

Basic
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 1

Omniversal Travel (Dimensional)
- Dimensional Travel
- Dimensional Travel Together

Omniversal Travel (Multiversal)
- Multiversal Travel
- Multiversal Travel Together

Teleportation
- Blink
- Teleport 2
- Teleport Blind
- Teleport Object
- Teleport Together

Michael Syrell (Order - 53194700)

LOGOS (OF EARTH-56438)

Art by Adam Pollina, Mark Morales & Christian Lichtner

RANK 2

KARMA 0

HEALTH 30

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS 60

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +2

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	1	11	+1
AGILITY	1	11	+1
RESILIENCE	1	11	+1
VIGILANCE	2	12	+2
EGO	1	11	+1
LOGIC	4	14	+5

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+ 1	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+ 1	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+ 1	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+ 4	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Dealmaker
- Legal Eagle
- Presence

Tags
- Authority
- Hounded (outside ancient Egypt)
- Krakoan
- Powerful (within ancient Egypt)
- Public Identity
- X-Gene

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Logos
Height: 5'0" **Weight:** 125 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Bald **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Leader
Origin: Mutant
Teams: Personal advisor to Rama-Tut Kang
Base: Ancient Egypt

History
Having been born into a wealthy Egyptian family, Logos was raised from birth to act as an advisor within the pharaoh's royal court. His brilliant mind and his preternatural ability to sense what others are thinking brought Logos prestige and renown. However, he obtained the status of grand vizier only after Kang's arrival.

When Kang first arrived in Egypt, he slaughtered most of the last pharaoh's court. Logos is one of the few who Kang chose to spare.

Although he does not know it himself, Logos is a mutant, one of the earliest. He is a brilliant advisor, but Logos' mutant status is the main reason Kang kept him around. Kang has been on the lookout for Apocalypse since the moment he set foot on Egyptian soil. Some part of him believes that by retaining control over one mutant, he can somehow draw in another.

Personality
Logos was raised to have unquestioning loyalty to the pharaoh. However, Kang's brutality has shaken his resolve. Logos remains committed to Kang's service, and he treats any threats to the pharaoh's well-being with deadly seriousness. However, he would be willing to assist an investigation into Kang's true origins.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 1
- Combat Trickery
- Inspiration

Martial Arts
- Fast Strikes

Telepathy
- ESP
- Mind Interrogation
- Mind Reading
- Telepathic Link

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

MADAME MASQUE

Art by Salvador Larroca & Frank D'Armata

RANK	KARMA
2	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
1 MELEE	11	+1
3 AGILITY	13	+5
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
2 EGO	12	+2
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+	1	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+	3	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+	0	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Beguiling
- **Connections:** Criminal
- **Connections:** Espionage
- Determination
- Extra Occupation
- Leverage

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Secret Identity
- Streetwise
- **Weapon:** Sub-machine gun

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Giuletta Kristina Nefaria
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 130 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Gray **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Scarred face beneath mask
Occupation: Criminal, Spy
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Maggia
Base: Mobile

History
As a baby, Giuletta Nefaria was discarded by her father Count Nefaria—the one-time leader of the Maggia. She spent her youth believing she was the daughter of a pair of wealthy Wall Street financiers. It was only after the death of her adoptive parents that Luchino re-entered Giuletta's life.

Sensing potential in the young woman, Luchino coerced his daughter into joining the Maggia. He gave her special training in combat and forced her to act as a Maggia spy under the codename of Madame Masque. Although she eventually separated herself from her toxic father, Giuletta has continued to work as a Maggia agent.

Personality
Unlike a lot of mafiosos, Madame Masque is not driven primarily by greed. She works for the Maggia because it's the only way she knows to make a sound living. A well-conceived moral argument could convince her to compromise her criminal ways.

POWERS

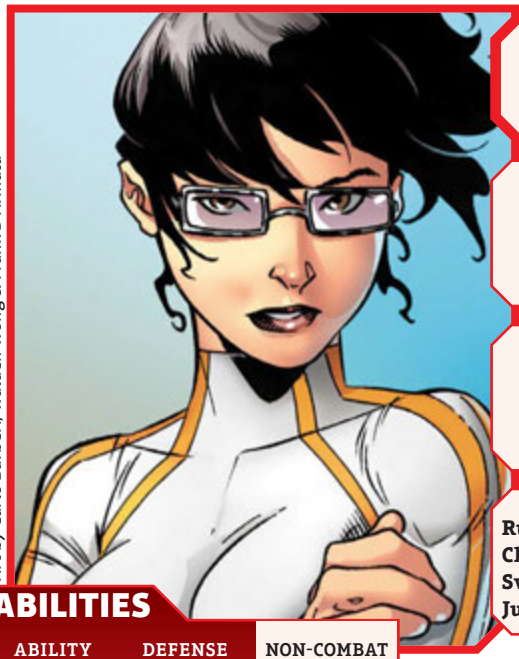
Basic
- Accuracy 2

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Counterstrike Technique
- Fast Strikes

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Point-Blank Parry
- Snap Shooting

Michael Syrett (Order : 53194700)

MADDY CHO



Art by Carlo Barberi, Walden Wong & Frank D'Armata

RANK	KARMA
1	1

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
10	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +1

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
0 MELEE	10	+0
1 AGILITY	11	+1
0 RESILIENCE	10	+0
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
0 EGO	10	+0
3 LOGIC	13	+4

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Determination
- Font of Information
- Inventor
- Scientific Expertise

Tags
- Heroic
- Lab Access
- Public Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Pistol

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Madame Curie "Maddy" Cho
Height: 5'7" **Weight:** 118 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Scientist
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Olympus Group
Base: Mobile

History
Despite having an intellect to rival the world's top scientists, Maddy Cho spends most of her time acting as a caretaker for her younger brother Amadeus—the boy better known as Brawn. Maddy is one of the few people in the world who Amadeus truly respects. Her calm maturity helps to temper her brother's fiery and often unstable personality.

Maddy is, ostensibly, a student, but her vast intellect makes school a minimal concern. She spends most of her time either looking after her brother or working on some self-driven scientific project. She jumps at any opportunity to study mysterious scientific phenomena.

Personality
Although she's just a teenager herself, Maddy has a very serious personality. Since the death of their parents, she's had to act more and more as a mother to her younger brother. Only on the rare occasions that she's separated from Amadeus does Maddy relax her typically stern demeanor.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 1
- Inspiration

Ranged Weapons
- Suppressive Fire

Tactics
- Keep Moving

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

MAGGIA TOUGH

Art by Marco Martin & Javier Rodriguez

RANK **1**

KARMA —

HEALTH **10**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS **30**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+1**

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
1 MELEE	11	+1
1 AGILITY	11	+1
0 RESILIENCE	10	+0
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
2 EGO	12	+2
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Abrasive
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Determination

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Public Identity
- Streetwise
- **Signature Weapons:** Pistols or clubs

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Varies
Height: Varies **Weight:** Varies **Gender:** Varies
Eyes: Varies **Hair:** Varies **Size:** Varies
Distinguishing Features: Any
Occupation: Criminal
Origin: Special Training
Teams: None
Base: Varies

History
Born out of European crime syndicates that date back centuries, the modern Maggia are less a singular entity and more a group of criminal families who occasionally aid one another. They have no hidden bases or Helicarriers. They're a bunch of racketeers who scratch each other's backs.

Unlike Hydra or other fanatical criminal organizations, Maggia toughs are motivated primarily by profit, not political ideology. Their pursuit of money often leads them to commit heinous crimes and even bankroll super villains, but they can be persuaded down more righteous paths—for the right price.

Personality
Many members of the Maggia are suit-wearing wiseguys. Most high-ranking members gain their status by being born into one crime family or another. Regular toughs, on the other hand, come from all sorts of places. New recruits tend to be poor youths with few scruples, folks happy to join up with a well-established criminal outfit.

POWERS

Melee Weapons
- Fast Attacks
- Vicious Attack

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Suppressive Fire

Michael Syrell (Order - 53194700)

MARIA HILL

Art by Marco Checchetto & Andres Mossa

RANK	KARMA
2	2

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
1 MELEE	11	+1
3 AGILITY	13	+4
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
1 EGO	11	+1
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Expert
- Determination
- Interrogation
- Investigation
- Presence

Tags
- Authority
- Backup
- Heroic
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Maria Hill
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 135 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Law Enforcer
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Force Works, S.H.I.E.L.D.
Base: Mobile

History

Having gotten a taste of action on a tour of duty with the US Marine Corps, a young Maria Hill joined up with S.H.I.E.L.D. the moment she was able. Her determination to succeed and her natural ability to make hard decisions propelled her through the ranks of the organization. Within a few years, she became the right hand of S.H.I.E.L.D. director Nick Fury Sr. Soon after, she replaced Fury.

Although supported by her subordinates, many of Hill's actions as director of S.H.I.E.L.D. remain controversial. The foundation of Pleasant Hill—an artificial-town prison designed to reform super villains through brainwashing—caused an international outcry. For her role in overseeing that project, Hill was booted from S.H.I.E.L.D. The organization itself dissolved shortly thereafter.

Despite her notoriety, Hill has found a second life as an agent for the CIA. She is wholly committed to the cause of making the world a safer place for regular people.

Personality

Hill's ability to make tough calls makes her a strong leader, but it's also her greatest flaw. Like many members of S.H.I.E.L.D., her knack for working within ethical gray areas gets her in trouble as often as it helps her succeed. If she can be convinced that doing so is for the greater good, Hill can steel herself to commit atrocious deeds.

Despite her headstrong and driven nature, Hill is not above cracking the occasional joke. Her social circle consists almost entirely of former S.H.I.E.L.D. agents.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Inspiration

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Snap Shooting
- Sniping

Tactics
- Battle Plan
- Change of Plans
- Keep Moving

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

MAY PARKER

Art by Joe Quinones

RANK	KARMA
1	1

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
10	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
0 MELEE	10	+0
0 AGILITY	10	+0
0 RESILIENCE	10	+0
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
1 EGO	11	+1
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 1 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Fearless
- Glibness
- Honest
- Investigation
- Out of Shape

Tags
- Heroic
- Public Identity

POWERS

Basic
- Inspiration

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Maybelle "May" Parker-Jameson
Height: 5'5" **Weight:** 110 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Gray **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: None
Origin: None
Teams: Howard T. Duck Private Investigations, Uncle Ben Foundation
Base: NYC

History

May Parker's early life was, for the most part, unremarkable. She was born into a poor and religious family that placed a high value on decency and responsibility. As an adult, she began dating a carnival barker named Ben Parker.

Ben was just as poor as May, if not more so, but he was kind and thoughtful. May valued that more than any riches in the world. Unable to have children themselves, Ben and May devoted their energies toward helping out with their nephew, Peter Parker.

After Peter's parents died in a tragic plane crash, he came to live with his aunt and uncle full-time. Ben and May treated Peter like their own son, which only made it all the more difficult for the boy when, a few short years later, Ben was gunned down in a robbery.

Ben's tragic death inspired Peter to become the world-renowned super hero Spider-Man. For many years Peter hid this fact from his aunt, but May eventually discovered her nephew's secret identity. Although she was wary at first, May has come to accept who Peter is and even appreciate his heroics.

At one point, she married J. Jonah Jameson's father, Jay, but he has since passed away.

Personality

Although she's getting up there in years, May Parker believes she can still take care of herself. She is a proud woman, and she resents the idea that she would need help with basic tasks. However, her increasingly ailing state has forced her, bit by bit, to accept more and more assistance.

May's greatest fear is that she will become a burden on Peter, the one person on Earth who she cares the most about.

Michael Syrett (Order : 53194700)

MEDUSA

Art by Jim Cheung & Justin Ponsor

RANK	KARMA
4	4

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-3

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 6 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 6	+3E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
5 MELEE	15	+8
6 AGILITY	16	+6
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
2 EGO	12	+2
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 7 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 4 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Reflexes
- Iron Will
- Presence
- Public Speaking
- Situational Awareness

Tags
- Authority
- Inhuman Genes
- Powerful
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Medusalith Amaquelin-Boltagon
Height: 5'11" **Weight:** 130 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Green **Hair:** Red **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Long, freely controllable hair
Occupation: Leader
Origin: Inhuman
Teams: Frightful Four, House of Agon, Universal Inhumans
Base: Mobile

History
Medusalith Amaquelin was born in the Inhuman city of Attilan into a family of royal nutritionists. As an infant, she was exposed to the Terrigen Mist and subsequently gained the power to control strands of her hair as if they were superstrong tendrils emerging from her head.

At a young age, Medusa developed close friendships with core members of the Inhuman Royal Family, particularly her second cousin, the Inhuman prince Black Bolt. Medusa later helped Black Bolt overthrow the cruel rulers of Attilan and establish himself as the king of all Inhumans.

As the years drew on, Medusa and Black Bolt grew closer and were married. Together, they've had one child, a boy named Ahura.

Following the tragic events wherein Black Bolt was forced to kill the bulk of the Inhuman population, Medusa and her husband began to grow apart. Although they remain close friends, they have functionally separated.

Personality
Medusa has exactly the personality one would expect of a powerful queen. She is headstrong, righteously vindictive and often a bit pompous. Her self-confidence makes her an effective ruler and team leader, though in more interpersonal settings it can cause troubles.

Even more than Black Bolt, Medusa takes her role as an Inhuman leader with deadly seriousness. She is determined to live up to the title of queen, no matter the personal cost.

POWERS

Basic
- Additional Limbs
- Inspiration
- Mighty 3
- Sturdy 3

Plasticity
- Extended Reach 1

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Jump 1
- Quick Toss

Tactics
- Change of Plans
- Keep Moving
- On Your Feet

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

MOCKINGBIRD (BOBBI MORSE)

Art by Kirbi Fagan

RANK **2**

KARMA **2**

HEALTH **60**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS **60**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+2**

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+3
2 AGILITY	12	+3
2 RESILIENCE	12	+2
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
0 EGO	10	+0
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+	0	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Extra Occupation
- Fearless
- Inventor
- Scientific Expertise
- Weird

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Lab Access
- Public Identity
- **Signature Weapon:** Fighting batons (clubs)

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Barbara "Bobbi" Morse
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 135 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Blond **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer, Scientist
Origin: Special Training, Weird Science
Teams: Avengers, S.H.I.E.L.D., West Coast Avengers
Base: Mobile

History
As a young but up-and-coming name in the world of biological science, Bobbi Morse was recruited by S.H.I.E.L.D. to act both as an agent and an on-staff scientist. Under the codename Mockingbird, she fought to keep the world safe from all manners of nefarious threats.

Morse eventually left S.H.I.E.L.D. to become an independent adventurer. In the years since, she has been an invaluable member of countless super-hero teams. Most famously, she has been a regular partner to the hero Hawkeye, to whom she was briefly married.

For a long while, she was thought to be dead, killed by Mephisto while she was on a mission with the West Coast Avengers. It turned out that she had been kidnapped and replaced with a Skrull impersonator who had died in her place.

Personality
Much like her ex-husband, Hawkeye (Clint Barton), years of adventuring have tempered Morse's attitude toward danger. Threats that would have terrified her in her early days now elicit little more than an eye roll or a pained groan from her. Her years terrorizing the Skrulls as the Robed Witch—while temporarily escaped on their home planet—contributed to that.

POWERS

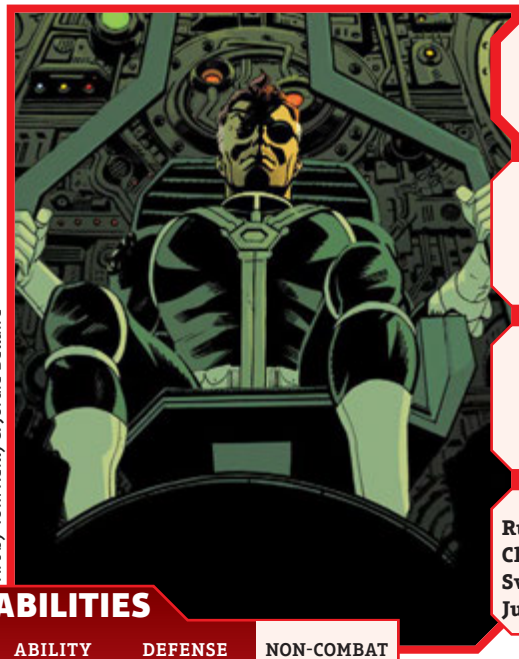
Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Mighty 1

Martial Arts
- Chain Strikes
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes

Melee Weapons
- Exploit
- Fast Attacks
- Vicious Attack

Michael Syrell (Order # 53194700)

NICK FURY SR.



Art by Tom Reilly & Jordie Bellaire

RANK **3**

KARMA **3**

HEALTH **60**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS **90**

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER **+3**

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	2	12	+2
AGILITY	4	14	+5
RESILIENCE	2	12	+2
VIGILANCE	3	13	+3
EGO	3	13	+3
LOGIC	1	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+ 2	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+ 4	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+ 3	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+ 1	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extra Occupation
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Glibness
- Interrogation
- Investigation
- Weird

Tags
- Authority
- Backup
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Nicholas Joseph "Nick" Fury Sr.
Height: 6'1" **Weight:** 221 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Bald, formerly brown
Size: Average
Distinguishing Features: Eye patch, various scars
Occupation: Adventurer, Law Enforcer
Origin: Special Training, Weird Science
Teams: C.I.A, S.H.I.E.L.D., Howling Commandos
Base: Mobile

History
As a stringent anti-fascist, Fury was among the first in his neighborhood to join the fight against the Axis Powers during World War II. He soon became a sergeant and was eventually appointed to lead a covert attack squadron of "Howling Commandos" through the European theater.

Late in the war, Fury took a stray piece of shrapnel to the face. The injury permanently blinded him in one eye and left him on the edge of death. To save his life, government scientists injected him with the experimental Infinity Formula. Miraculously, Fury made a quick recovery and finished out the war in style.

Shortly thereafter, Fury was tapped to lead the newly established UN peacekeeping force S.H.I.E.L.D. His run as the organization's director remains legendary.

Fury later left S.H.I.E.L.D. but continued working on his own to keep the world safe, no matter the costs. He recently took over for the Watcher (Uatu) as the one keeping watch over the Earth, but he's since moved on to helping protect the entirety of the Multiverse.

Personality
The serum in Nick Fury's blood slows his aging to a crawl. This has allowed him to act as a hero across several decades, but it has not kept him from being stuck in the past.

Nick Fury is, by most modern standards, a conservative old grump. He left Earth behind, in large part, because he was looking for new challenges.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Inspiration
- Slow-Motion Dodge

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Fast Strikes

Ranged Weapons
- Double Tap
- Slow-Motion Shoot-Dodge
- Snap Shooting
- Sniping
- Weapons Blazing

Tactics
- Change of Plans
- Keep Moving

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

NIGHTHAWK (KYLE RICHMOND)

Art by Leinil Francis Yu & Sunny Gho

RANK	KARMA
3	3

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 15

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +3

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
4 MELEE	14	+6
1 AGILITY	14	+1
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
1 EGO	11	+1
3 LOGIC	13	+4

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY	
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY	
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY	

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Celebrities
- Extraordinary Origin
- Famous
- Tech Reliance
- **Weakness:** Sunlight (Nighthawk loses his damage reduction during the day)
- Weird

Tags
- Heroic
- Lab Access
- Rich
- Secret Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Kyle Richmond
Height: 5'11" **Weight:** 180 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Auburn **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Tycoon
Origin: High Tech, Weird Science
Teams: Avengers, Defenders, Squadron Sinister
Base: NYC

History
Kyle Richmond was once just a scrawny, spoiled college kid who believed that his family's wealth could get him out of any jam. Then he got into a drunk driving accident that left him badly injured and—worse yet—confined his girlfriend to a wheelchair. Racked with guilt, Richmond dropped out of school and spent the next few years wandering around the United States, looking for something that could bring meaning back into his life.

An interdimensional being known as the Grandmaster took note of Richmond's plight. In exchange for Richmond helping found a team of super villains, the Grandmaster offered him a serum that made him superhumanly powerful whenever the moon shone.

Richmond accepted the serum, but his conscience eventually got the better of him. Within a few months, he turned against his own super-villain team. In the years since, Richmond has done his best to earn the trust of the super-hero community and has served as a member of both the Avengers and the Defenders.

Personality
Kyle Richmond's childhood as a lonely rich kid led him to a life of excessive thrill-seeking. However, years of adventuring have shaped his youthful hotheadedness into a more balanced vigilance. The missteps of his past weigh heavily upon his mind.

Nighthawk's ability to fly comes not from his innate superhuman strength, but from a custom jetpack he designed.

POWERS

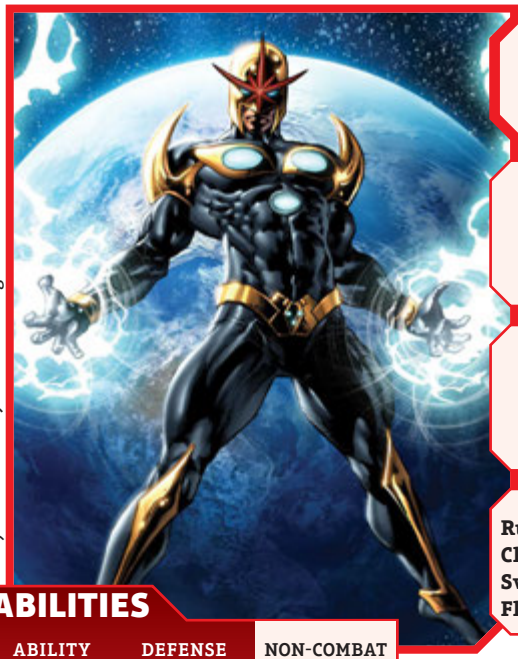
Basic
- Brawling
- Brilliance 1
- Flight 2
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 1

Melee Weapons
- Fast Attacks
- Hit & Run
- Vicious Attack
- Whirling Frenzy

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber

ichael Syrett (Order # 53194700)

NOVA (RICH RIDER)



Art by Mike Deodato Jr. & Bruno Hang

RANK	KARMA
5	5

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	-4

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	—

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 30

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +3E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
6 MELEE	16	+9
5 AGILITY	15	+5
4 RESILIENCE	14	+4
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
7 EGO	17	+11
0 LOGIC	17	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 8 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 9 MULTIPLIER	+	7 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Enduring Constitution
- Fearless
- Presence
- Situational Awareness
- Weird

Tags
- Alternate Form (Nova form)
- Authority
- Backup
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Powerful
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Richard "Rich" Rider
Height: 6'1" **Weight:** 190 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: Guardians of the Galaxy, Nova Corps
Base: Mobile

History

Many years ago, on the planet Xandar, a group of scientists tapped into a mysterious source of incredible power. They dubbed it the Nova Force and decided to imbue their most brilliant citizens with it. These brave explorers dedicated themselves to the betterment of the galaxy, forming the first Nova Corps.

Then came the day Zorr the Conqueror arrived on Xandar and slaughtered nearly the entire planet. Only a single, mortally wounded Nova Centurion escaped.

This dying warrior used the last of his power to send the entirety of the Nova Force to Earth, where it inhabited a scrawny teenager named Richard Rider.

Under the codename Nova, Rider has defeated countless cosmic threats, some on the level of Thanos himself. As he matured, he became more of a leader, even heading up the Guardians of the Galaxy for a while and—on a couple occasions—rebuilding the entire Nova Corps from scratch.

Personality

In his early adventures, Nova was a bit of a jokester, imitating the likes of other teenage heroes. Only after years of battle did he start to develop an identity for himself.

Today, Nova isn't humorless, but he is experienced enough to project a level of gravitas that was unavailable to him in his youth. He takes his role as a protector of the innocent seriously and is haunted by those he could not save.

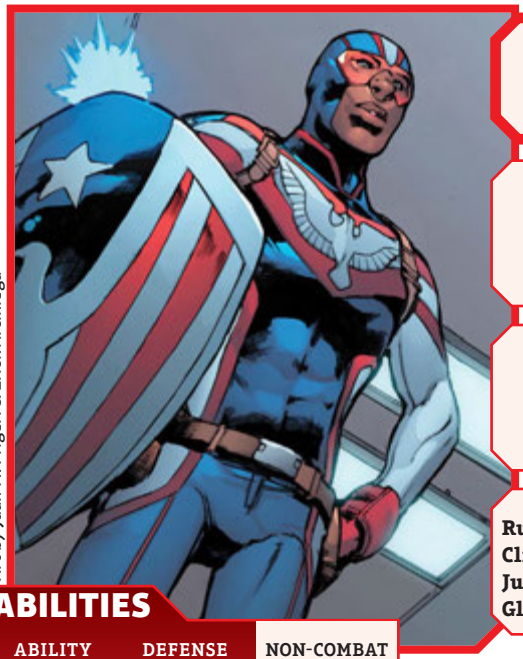
POWERS

Basic
- Discipline 4
- Environmental Protection
- Flight 2
- Mighty 3
- Sturdy 4
- Wisdom

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrage
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Form
- Elemental Protection 2 (20 points to shatter)
- Elemental Reinforcement
- Supernova

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

PATRIOT (RAYSHAUN LUCAS)



Art by Juan M. Frigeri & Erick Arciniega

RANK	KARMA
2	2

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	-2

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb/Swim: 3
Jump: 3
Glide: 10

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +3

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
2 MELEE	12	+2
2 AGILITY	12	+2
1 RESILIENCE	11	+1
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
1 EGO	11	+1
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY		
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY		
EGO	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY		
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY		

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Honest
- Quick Learner
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- Heroic
- **Mentor:** Falcon (Sam Wilson)
- **Obligation:** School
- Secret Identity
- Young

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Rayshaun "Shaun" Lucas
Height: 6'1" **Weight:** 200 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Student
Origin: High Tech, Special Training
Teams: Champions
Base: NYC

History
As a young teenager, Rayshaun Lucas was an active participant in the protests that followed the wrongful arrest of the super hero Rage. The connections he made during those protests led him further into the world of super heroes, and during the rise of Hydra's plot to take over the USA with the help of a twisted version of Captain America (Steve Rogers), he helped provide vital intel to the resistance.

The leaders of the resistance later rewarded Lucas for his noble efforts. Iron Man built him a high-tech shield based on Lucas' own designs, and the Falcon (Sam Wilson) took him on as a super-hero-in-training. Ever since, Lucas has fought crime and injustice—often alongside the Champions—under the codename Patriot.

Lucas is the latest hero by the name Patriot. The original was Jeffrey Mace, who became a replacement Captain America in the late 1940s. More recently was Elijah Bradley, a member of the Young Avengers, who has since given up the codename.

Personality
Lucas is young and inexperienced in battle, but he has an unflinching sense of justice that transcends the law. He refuses to let any authority stand between him and doing the right thing.

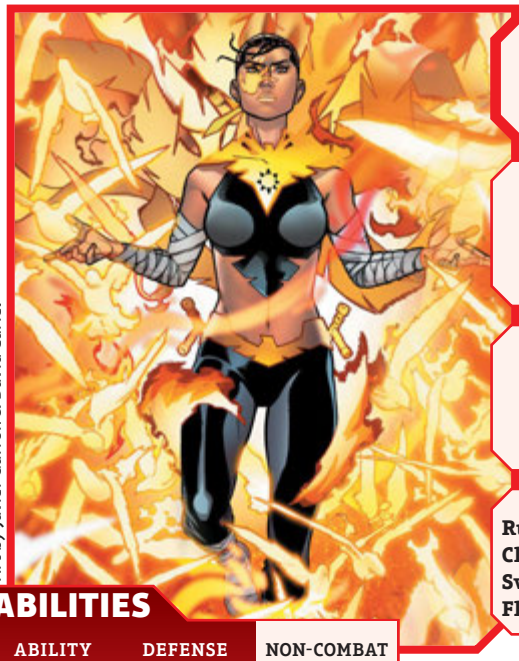
POWERS

Basic
- **Iconic Weapon:** Patriot's Shield. Grants Glide Speed equal to double his Run Speed. Also acts as a drone that can move within his line of sight and fire energy blasts with a range of 10.

Shield Bearer
- Brace for Impact
- Do This All Day
- Hurled Shield Bash
- Immovable
- Shield 2
- Shield Bash
- Shield Deflection

Michael Syrell (Order # 53194700)

PHOENIX



Art by Javier Garrón & David Curiel

RANK	KARMA
6	6

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	-3

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	—

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 36

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +4

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
6 MELEE	16	+8
5 AGILITY	15	+6
5 RESILIENCE	15	+5
4 VIGILANCE	14	+4
8 EGO	18	+10
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 8 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 7 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 8 MULTIPLIER	+	8 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Berserker
- Combat Reflexes
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Famous
- Fearless
- Free Running
- Presence
- Public Speaking

Tags
- Auditory Issues
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- Supernatural

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Maya Lopez
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 125 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: White handprint makeup on face
Occupation: Entertainer
Origin: Mythic, Special Training
Teams: Avengers, Daughters of Liberty
Base: Mobile

History

When Maya Lopez was a child, her father was gunned down by his own boss: the Kingpin (Wilson Fisk). Seeing the young girl's potential, Fisk took her in, giving her special training and eventually tricking her into believing that Daredevil had killed her father.

Eventually, Lopez discovered the Kingpin's deception and turned on him. Her quest for vengeance resolved, she became a tireless fighter for justice around the world. Under the codename Echo, she fought to keep the streets of Hell's Kitchen safe.

Recently, Echo took part in a contest held by the Phoenix Force, a primordial entity of fire and instability older than the universe itself. The Phoenix Force gathered heroes from around the globe and pitted them against each other to determine who would best serve as a host for its unfathomable power.

Echo lost her bout to the Sub-Mariner (Namor). However, the Phoenix Force admired Echo's unflinching determination in battle and decided to take her as its host anyway. With the power of the Phoenix Force within her, Maya Lopez has quickly advanced from a neighborhood vigilante to a defender of entire worlds.

Personality

As a deaf woman and a member of the Cheyenne Nation, Lopez's life has been full of struggles. Despite it all, she generally manages to stay upbeat. She has a particular love for the theatrical arts, having become a concert pianist and an expert dancer.

The Phoenix Force has, at times, threatened to turn Lopez into an unstoppable berserker. However, her strong sense of right and wrong helps her keep the primordial entity under control.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Combat Trickery
- Discipline 2
- Environmental Protection
- Flight 2
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 3

Elemental Control (Fire)
- Elemental Barrage
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Protection 2
- Elemental Reinforcement
- Supernova

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Chain Strikes
- Counterstrike Technique
- Defense Stance
- Fast Strikes
- Leg Sweep

Power Control
- Clone Moves

Michael Syrett (Order #5319-4700)

PILEDRIVER (WRECKING CREW)

Art by Carlo Pagulayan, Jeffrey Huet & Justin Ponsor

RANK	KARMA
3	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 5	+2

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	6	16	+8
AGILITY	3	16	+3
RESILIENCE	3	13	+3
VIGILANCE	2	12	+2
EGO	1	11	+1
LOGIC	0	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Fearless

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance
- Public Identity
- Streetwise
- Supernatural
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Brian Phillip Calusky
Height: 6'4" **Weight:** 310 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Blond **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Giant hands
Occupation: Criminal
Origin: Magic
Teams: Wrecking Crew
Base: Mobile

History

As a teenager in the countryside, Brian Calusky turned to a life of crime more out of boredom than anything else. Calusky's initial infractions were minor, but over the course of a decade, he managed to build himself a solid rap sheet. Eventually, he was sentenced to an extended stay in the maximum-security prison on Ryker's Island.

It was at Ryker's that Calusky met the super villain Wrecker. Along with a couple other inmates, Calusky helped the Wrecker escape from Ryker's. Out of gratitude, the Wrecker granted his allies a portion of his own powers, and together, they formed the Wrecking Crew.

Calusky has been with the super-villain group ever since. At one point, he mentored his son, Rick Calusky, who become the criminal known as Excavator.

Personality

Outside of the Wrecker himself, Piledriver might be the most unhinged member of the Wrecking Crew. He can be utterly reckless, both in a battle and outside of it. Unlike his allies, Piledriver prefers to fight without weapons or armor, smashing his opponents with his giant bare fists.

POWERS

Basic
- Brawling
- Inspiration
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 1
- Wisecracker

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Immovable
- Jump 1
- Quick Toss
- Smash

Michael Syrell (Order # 53194700)

QUASAR

Art by Daniel Acuña

RANK	KARMA
6	6

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	-3

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
210	—

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 30

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +6E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
7 MELEE	17	+10
4 AGILITY	14	+4
4 RESILIENCE	14	+4
6 VIGILANCE	16	+6
8 EGO	18	+11
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 9 MULTIPLIER	+	7 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 9 MULTIPLIER	+	8 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Combat Expert
- **Connections:** Military
- Determination
- Enduring Constitution
- Fearless
- Glibness
- Iron Will
- Situational Awareness

Tags
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- Sorcerous
- Supernatural

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Wendell Elvis Vaughn
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 180 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Blond **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Military
Origin: Magic
Teams: Guardians of the Galaxy, S.H.I.E.L.D.
Base: Mobile

History

As a young man, Wendell Vaughn successfully completed the special-agent training course at S.H.I.E.L.D. Academy only to be rejected for field duty by higher-ups who believed he was too kind and caring to be a serious agent. Instead, Vaughn was assigned to guard duty outside the containment chamber of the legendary Quantum Bands, mystic artifacts designed to protect life throughout the universe. These bands contain such incredible power that they annihilated most people who attempted to wield them.

Vaughn performed his duties diligently until the day an A.I.M. attack overran the base where he was stationed. Desperate to escape the slaughter, Vaughn took a chance and donned the Quantum Bands. Incredibly, the kindness in his heart soothed the cosmic energies within the bands and transformed him into Quasar, Protector of the Universe.

As Quasar, Vaughn has achieved things beyond his wildest dreams and gone places S.H.I.E.L.D. could never have taken him. He has helped to end galaxy-spanning wars and fought with evil creatures the size of planets. Today, he numbers among the most powerful heroes in existence.

Personality

Quasar wields phenomenal power, but he prefers to solve his problems peacefully whenever possible. He treats defeated enemies gracefully, with an eye toward reform. On at least one occasion, Quasar has faked his own death to peacefully satisfy a vengeful opponent.

If Quasar has a flaw, it is his tendency to defer to established authority. He has assisted in many of S.H.I.E.L.D.'s operations, not all of them strictly ethical.

POWERS

Basic
- Environmental Protection
- Discipline 3
- Flight 2
- Mighty 3
- Sturdy 3

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrage
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Form
- Elemental Grab
- Elemental Prison
- Elemental Protection 2 (20 points to shatter)
- Elemental Push
- Elemental Reinforcement
- Elemental Sphere
- Supernova

Teleportation
- Blink
- Teleport 2

Michael Syrett (Order #5319470)

RAMA-TUT

Art by Mike del Mundo

RANK	KARMA
4	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+4

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	2	12	+3
AGILITY	2	12	+2
RESILIENCE	3	13	+3
VIGILANCE	4	14	+4
EGO	4	14	+6
LOGIC	5	15	+6

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	4 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Combat Reflexes
- Font of Information
- Presence
- Public Speaking
- Tech Reliance

Tags
- Authority
- Powerful
- Secret Identity
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Nathaniel Richards
Height: 6'3" **Weight:** 230 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Brown **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Leader
Origin: High Tech
Teams: Anachronauts, Council of Kangs
Base: Ancient Egypt

History
Nathaniel Richards grew up in the near-utopian environment of the thirtieth century (Earth-6311). As an adult he became sick of his luxurious existence and decided to live a life of adventure in a more interesting era.

Disguising himself as the Pharaoh Rama-Tut, Richards built a time machine and set about conquering ancient Egypt. As the supreme ruler of Egyptian civilization, Richards sought to secure his reign over all the Earth. As such, he is constantly on the lookout for any who may have the power to oppose him, particularly the mutant conqueror known as Apocalypse.

He does not yet know it, but Apocalypse will be the least of his worries. He later takes on a number of other identities, the most famous of which is Kang the Conqueror.

Personality
Richards is a megalomaniac and a narcissist of the highest order. He believes himself to be the most important being in existence, and he will go to any length to prove his own importance. He often speaks in the style of the old Greco-Roman conquerors.

Richards is not above meddling in anyone's timeline, even his own. As a result, his early life has become shrouded in mystery and divergence. A number of alternate versions of him from across the Multiverse have had adventuring careers to rival Richards' own.

POWERS

Basic
- Brilliance 1
- Discipline 2
- Disguise
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 1

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Protection 1 (10 points to shatter)

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Defense Stance
- Fast Strikes

Omniversal Travel (Time)
- Time Portal
- Time Travel
- Time Travel Other
- Time Travel Together

Michael Syrell (Order # 53194700)

SILVER SURFER

Art by SKAN

RANK	KARMA
6	6

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
180	-4

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
210	—

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 36

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +6E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
3 MELEE	13	+5
5 AGILITY	15	+7
6 RESILIENCE	16	+6
6 VIGILANCE	16	+6
8 EGO	18	+12
3 LOGIC	13	+3

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 8 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 8 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 10 MULTIPLIER	+	8 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 6 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Outsiders
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Enduring Constitution
- Extra Occupation
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Fresh Eyes
- Situational Awareness
- Stranger
- Weird

Tags
- Alien Heritage
- Black Market Access
- Chaotic
- Extreme Appearance
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Norrin Radd
Height: 6'4" **Weight:** 225 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Silver **Hair:** None **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Body covered in nigh-indestructible silvery metal
Occupation: Adventurer, Outsider
Origin: Alien, Weird Science
Teams: Annihilators, Defenders
Base: Mobile

History

Norrin Radd was an ordinary man born on the utopian planet of Zenn-La. Fascinated by the opportunities provided by space, Radd endeavored to explore the cosmos. He was well on his way to achieving his dream when Galactus arrived on his planet.

Despite the best efforts of Zenn-La's leaders, none of their weapons could drive Galactus away. In a last-ditch effort to save his people, Radd boarded a spaceship and made a deal with the planet-eater. In exchange for sparing Zenn-La, Radd became Galactus' herald, imbued with a portion of Galactus' Power Cosmic, which transformed him into the Silver Surfer.

The Silver Surfer served Galactus faithfully until the day he arrived on Earth. Radd took pity on the people of Earth and fought Galactus on their behalf. Galactus ultimately spared the planet and stripped Radd of his position.

As a free agent, Radd has spent most of his subsequent years wandering the cosmos. His adventures have taken him across the universe and made him central in the fate of countless worlds.

Personality

The Silver Surfer regrets his time serving Galactus, and he often misses the people of Zenn-La he left behind. In addition, he is racked with guilt for all those he couldn't save.

The Silver Surfer does his best to act as a hero, but decades of tragic escapades have worn him down. The primary thing that keeps him going is his love for life itself.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 2
- Discipline 4
- Environmental Protection
- Healing Factor
- Heightened Senses 2
- **Iconic Weapon:** Cosmic Surfboard [Summonable by Silver Surfer. Grants Flight 2]
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 4

Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Form
- Elemental Protection 4 (40 points to shatter)
- Elemental Reinforcement

Magic (Chaos Set)
- Powerful Hex (represents his Power Cosmic)

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-1700)

SPIDER-WOMAN (JESSICA DREW)

Art by Frank Cho

RANK	KARMA
4	4

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED
Run/Climb: 6
Swim: 3
Jump: 6
Glide: 12

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +3E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
5 MELEE	19	+6
7 AGILITY	19	+8
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
3 VIGILANCE	13	+3
2 EGO	12	+2
2 LOGIC	12	+2

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	7 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 4 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Espionage
- **Connections:** Police
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Extra Occupation (2)
- Fearless
- Free Running
- Interrogation
- Investigation
- Leverage
- Weird

Tags
- Black Market Access
- **Dependents:** Gerry Drew
- Heroic
- Public Identity

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Jessica Miriam "Jess" Drew
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 130 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Green **Hair:** Blond, usually dyed black
Size: Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer, Investigator, Spy
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: Daughters of Liberty, New Avengers, S.H.I.E.L.D.
Base: NYC

History

When Jessica Drew was just a child, she contracted an acute case of radiation poisoning. Her father—a top geneticist and nuclear researcher—searched desperately for a cure to his daughter's condition. Hoping to grant her the increased radiation immunity enjoyed by many insects, he injected her with an irradiated form of spider DNA.

The treatment saved Drew's life but forced her into a coma that lasted more than a decade. By the time she awoke, her parents were long gone.

Lost and alone, Drew briefly stumbled into the care of Hydra agents who attempted to make her into a spider-themed superspy named Spider-Woman. Drew quickly turned on her handlers, but she kept the Spider-Woman costume.

As Spider-Woman, Drew spent the next several years traveling across Europe and the United States, occasionally allying herself with S.H.I.E.L.D. and other heroic organizations. Eventually, she settled down in NYC and decided to start a family on her own. When she's not adventuring, she spends much of her time caring for her son, Gerry.

Personality

Spider-Woman's early days as an adventurer were rocky. Having spent most of her life in a coma, her brain was deeply undeveloped. She often fled from conflict, fighting more out of necessity than a desire to enact justice.

The Spider-Woman of today hardly resembles her younger self. Years of experience have molded her into a confident and capable crimefighter. Drew is an expert in the arts of both espionage and investigation, and she suffers nonsense from no one.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Combat Trickery
- Evasion
- Inspiration
- Mighty 1

Spider-Powers
- Jump 1
- Spider-Dodge
- Spider-Sense
- Venom Blast
- Wallcrawling
- Webcasting
- Webgliding

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Chain Strikes
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes

Note: The profile of Spider-Woman of Earth-56438 matches this one, except Spider-Woman of Earth-56438 has the Villainous tag rather than Heroic. The two characters' histories are similar, but after Spider-Woman of Earth-56438 joined Hydra, she never left.

ichael Syrett (Order # 53194700)

STICK

Art by Paco Medina, Juan Vlasco & David Curiel

RANK 2

KARMA 2

HEALTH 30

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

FOCUS 60

DAMAGE REDUCTION —

SPEED
Run: 5
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Jump: 3

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +2

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	3	13	+4
AGILITY	2	12	+2
RESILIENCE	1	11	+1
VIGILANCE	2	12	+2
EGO	1	11	+1
LOGIC	1	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel × 3 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel × 2 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel × 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel × 2 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Abrasive
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- Supernatural
- Vision Issues

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Unknown
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 135 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** White **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Magic, Special Training
Teams: Chaste, Fist
Base: NYC

History
Born both blind and penniless, Stick took up martial arts at a young age to survive. He found that he had a natural talent for fighting, and soon enough he had drawn the attention and mentorship of the mystic martial arts master Yao (A.K.A. the Ancient One). The next several decades of Stick's life were spent in the shadows, during which he became the leader of the Chaste, an elite organization of ninjas created to counter the insidious clan of the Hand.

Stick's life was full of thrills and adventures, but as he got older, life in the shadows started to wear on him. He took a young blind boy named Matt Murdock under his wing to train as his heir. He taught the boy to fight and to develop his radar-like senses, which compensated for his blindness. Within a few years, Murdock's abilities began to rival Stick's.

As the super hero Daredevil, Murdock uses the training Stick gave him for the betterment of humanity. Stick died years ago, saving Daredevil and Black Widow from the Hand. He has returned to life occasionally since.

Personality
Stick is a gruff and disagreeable old man whose training methods often verge upon outright cruelty. He is hard on everyone, but none more than Matt Murdock.

Stick cares deeply for Murdock but that care often translates to harsh treatment. Stick's life has been hard, and he had to become hard to get through it. He fears that his star pupil lacks that same hardness, and that it may one day get him killed.

POWERS

Basic
- Heightened Senses 2
- Mighty 1

Martial Arts
- Attack Stance
- Chain Strikes
- Defense Stance
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes
- Leg Sweep

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

THUNDERBALL (WRECKING CREW)

Art by Chris Sprouse, Karl Story, Walden Wong, Matt Milla & Chris Sotomayor

RANK	KARMA
3	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
120	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	4	14	+5
AGILITY	1	11	+2
RESILIENCE	4	14	+4
VIGILANCE	2	12	+2
EGO	0	10	+0
LOGIC	4	14	+6

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+	4	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 4	MULTIPLIER	+	1	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3	MULTIPLIER	+	0	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 5	MULTIPLIER	+	4	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Fearless
- Font of Information
- Inventor
- Scientific Expertise
- Skeptical

Tags
- Lab Access
- Public Identity
- Supernatural
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Eliot Augustus Franklin
Height: 6'6" **Weight:** 325 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Brown **Hair:** Black **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Scientist
Origin: Magic
Teams: Illuminati (the Hood's), Wrecking Crew
Base: Mobile

History
Eliot Franklin was a world-renowned physicist who seemed to be living the dream—until the day he invented a miniature gamma bomb. The bomb's design was brilliant, but as his reward, Franklin's employers fired him and patented the bomb in their own names instead of his.

Franklin tried to steal back his invention but was caught and sent to prison, where he wound up alongside Dirk Garthwaite, the super villain known as the Wrecker. Franklin and a couple of his fellow inmates helped break Garthwaite out of prison, and in exchange, Garthwaite granted them each a portion of his own powers. Together, these escapees formed the Wrecking Crew.

For most of his criminal career, Franklin has worked with the Wrecking Crew, but he did join the Hood's version of the Illuminati for a while too.

Personality
Thunderball is known for being smarter and more restrained than the rest of the Wrecking Crew and has occasionally contested the Wrecker for the group's leadership. He has stayed with the crew largely so that he can continue to fund his research into gamma radiation. If any member of the crew can be reasoned with, it's Thunderball.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 1
- Brilliance 2
- **Iconic Weapon:** Thunderball and chain [Throwable club. Automatically returns to thrower.]
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 1

Melee Weapons
- Fast Attacks
- Vicious Attack
- Whirling Frenzy

Super-Strength
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Immovable
- Quick Toss

Michael Syrett (Order - 53194700)

TIGRA

Art by Mike Mayhew

RANK	KARMA
3	3

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
60	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 6 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 6	+2

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
3 MELEE	15	+5
5 AGILITY	15	+5
3 RESILIENCE	13	+3
2 VIGILANCE	12	+2
1 EGO	11	+1
1 LOGIC	11	+1

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	3 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Combat Reflexes
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Extraordinary Origin
- Fearless
- Weird

Tags

- Alternate Form (Tigra form)
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance (in alternate form)
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- Supernatural

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Greer Grant Nelson
Height: 5'10" **Weight:** 180 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Green **Hair:** Orange **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: Body covered with orange-and-black striped fur. Eyes have vertical slits like a cat's. Also has claws, fangs and a tail.
Occupation: Adventurer
Origin: Mythic, Weird Science
Teams: Defenders, West Coast Avengers
Base: Mobile

History

As a newly widowed woman in need of a steady income, Greer Nelson took a job working as a laboratory assistant for the kind but mysterious Dr. Joanne Tumolo, who was researching cats as a means of developing physical conditioning treatments for eccentric health club owner Malcolm Donalbain. However, when Tumolo discovered that Donalbain planned on using her treatments for evil, she abandoned her bizarre benefactor and made Nelson her primary test subject.

The experimental treatments gave Nelson catlike reflexes and agility. Under the codename the Cat, Nelson embarked on a short stint as a costumed crimefighter, using her abilities to defeat Donalbain once and for all.

After sustaining a critical injury in a fight with Hydra, Nelson discovered Tumolo's true identity. Her beloved boss was not merely a professor with an interest in feline physiology but part of an ancient and underground race of super-powered cat-people.

To save her assistant's life, Tumolo was forced to transform Nelson into a full-fledged cat-person too. Nelson quickly came to appreciate her new form, and she returned to her crimefighting career under the new codename Tigra.

Personality

Tigra makes the most of her powers with her fierce determination. She fights with a ferocity bordering on savagery when forced to it.

Although she has been part of both the Avengers and the Defenders, Tigra is often not shown the same level of respect as her peers in the superhero community. A part of her resents the lack of recognition, but she never lets that stop her.

POWERS

Basic

- Brawling
- Heightened Senses 2
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 1

Melee Weapons

- Exploit
- Fast Attacks
- Furious Attacks
- Hit & Run
- Vicious Attack
- Whirling Frenzy

Super-Strength

- Jump 1

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-4700)

VIPER

Art by David Finch, Danny Miki & Frank D'Armata

RANK	KARMA
2	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	-1

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
90	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+2E

ABILITIES

	ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
MELEE	2	12	+2
AGILITY	3	13	+3
RESILIENCE	1	11	+1
VIGILANCE	2	12	+2
EGO	2	12	+2
LOGIC	0	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+	3	ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+	2	ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 2	MULTIPLIER	+	0	ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits

- Battle Ready
- Beguiling
- **Connections:** Espionage
- **Connections:** Military (Hydra)
- Determination
- Extra Occupation
- Leverage
- Situational Awareness

Tags

- Black Market Access
- Secret Identity
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Ophelia Sarkissian
Height: 5'9" **Weight:** 140 lbs. **Gender:** Female
Eyes: Green **Hair:** Black, often dyed green
Size: Average
Distinguishing Features: Artificial fangs
Occupation: Military, Spy
Origin: Special Training
Teams: Hellfire Club, Hydra, Serpent Squad
Base: Mobile

History

Orphaned or abandoned shortly after birth, Ophelia Sarkissian was taken in by the terrorist group Hydra when she was just an infant. She took to the organization's training, and by the time she was in her preteens, she developed an unusual aptitude for combat. Before her twentieth birthday, she earned her way into Hydra's inner circle. Under the codename of Viper, she took charge of the organization's most insidious and clandestine operations.

Renowned for her ruthlessness in combat, Viper has gone toe to toe with the likes of Captain America (Steve Rogers) and Wolverine (Logan). Although she occasionally works as a private mercenary, she is rarely far from Hydra. The organization is the closest thing she has to a family, and it is the one place in the world where she is respected and loved unconditionally. Her unflinching loyalty to Hydra is emotional as much as it is ideological.

Sarkissian is a woman of many aliases and identities. Viper may be the codename she uses the most, but at other times she has been known as Madame Hydra, Madame Viper, the White Warrior Princess, or simply Ms. Sarkissian.

Personality

Above all, Sarkissian is cold and conniving, and as a leader she makes for an extremely harsh mistress. She cares for interpersonal relationships only insofar as she can use them to advance her own interests. She once clawed her way into a sham marriage with Wolverine (Logan)—a man she personally hated—solely so that she could obtain a favorable political position within a foreign court.

POWERS

Basic

- Combat Trickery
- Sturdy 1

Martial Arts

- Attack Stance
- Chain Strikes
- Counterstrike Technique
- Defense Stance
- Do This All Day
- Fast Strikes
- Reverse-Momentum Throw

ichael Syrett (Order : 53194700)

WARLOCK

Art by Ron Lim & Israel Silva

RANK	KARMA
6	6

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	-3

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	-1

SPEED
Run: 6
Climb: 3
Swim: 3
Flight: 36

INITIATIVE MODIFIER +4E

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
5 MELEE	15	+6
5 AGILITY	15	+7
5 RESILIENCE	15	+5
4 VIGILANCE	14	+4
9 EGO	19	+12
2 LOGIC	19	+3

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 7 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 8 MULTIPLIER	+	5 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 9 MULTIPLIER	+	9 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 7 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Battle Ready
- **Connections:** Outsiders
- **Connections:** Super Heroes
- Determination
- Enduring Constitution
- Extra Occupation
- Fearless
- Fresh Eyes
- Iron Will
- Situational Awareness
- Stranger
- Weird

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Extreme Appearance
- Heroic
- Public Identity
- Sorcerous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Adam Warlock
Height: 6'2" **Weight:** 240 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: No irises **Hair:** Blond **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: White eyes and bright golden skin
Occupation: Adventurer, Outsider
Origin: Weird Science
Teams: Guardians of the Galaxy, Infinity Watch
Base: Mobile

History
Adam Warlock was created by a group of evil geneticists known only as the Enclave. This shadowy organization sought to create the perfect human being—an all-powerful creature they could use to control the world. They succeeded in creating a very powerful creature, just not one that they could control.

Adam Warlock emerged from his biomechanical cocoon a fully grown adult. He instantly sensed the evil in the hearts of his creators and destroyed them. Then he set off across the cosmos to find his purpose.

In the years since his birth, Warlock has been at the center of several galaxy-spanning conflicts. He has contended with forces that threatened to consume all of existence, including the mad titan Thanos and the insatiable Hunger. Warlock has, on several occasions, died fighting for justice only to rise again, stronger than before.

Warlock's already considerable powers are frequently augmented by the Soul Stone, one of the six Infinity Gems. Although Warlock currently lacks a fully powered Soul Stone, he is still regarded as one of the toughest beings in the known universe.

Personality
Warlock's early days were filled with anger and confusion. He had incredible power but only the most basic grasp of right and wrong. Years passed before he could form a coherent identity for himself. Only then was he ready to become the hero the world knows today.

The modern Warlock is a humble and determined warrior. He seeks to preserve life across the universe and to defeat evil wherever it may be.

POWERS

Basic
- Accuracy 2
- Brilliance 1
- Discipline 3
- Environmental Protection
- Flight 2
- Mighty 1
- Sturdy 3
- Uncanny 1
- Wisdom

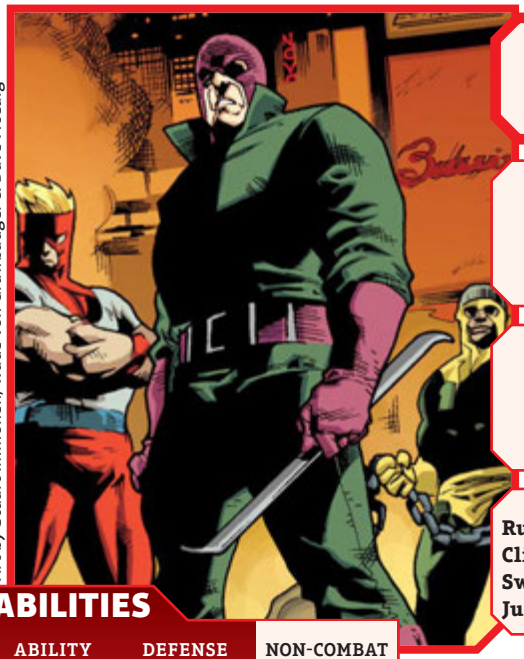
Elemental Control (Energy)
- Elemental Barrage
- Elemental Barrier
- Elemental Blast
- Elemental Burst
- Elemental Grab
- Supernova

Magic
- Astral Form
- Sense Supernatural

Magic (Sorcery)
- Bolts of Balthakk
- Images of Ikonn
- Shield of the Seraphim (20 points to shatter)
- Summon Portal

Michael Syrett (Order #5319470)

WRECKER (WRECKING CREW)



Art by Stuart Immonen, Wade von Grawbadger & Dave McCaig

RANK	KARMA
3	—

HEALTH	DAMAGE REDUCTION
150	-2

FOCUS	DAMAGE REDUCTION
30	—

SPEED	INITIATIVE MODIFIER
Run: 5 **Climb:** 3 **Swim:** 3 **Jump:** 3	+1

ABILITIES

ABILITY SCORE	DEFENSE SCORE	NON-COMBAT CHECKS
6 MELEE	16	+8
2 AGILITY	12	+2
5 RESILIENCE	15	+5
1 VIGILANCE	11	+1
1 EGO	11	+1
0 LOGIC	10	+0

DAMAGE

MELEE	dMarvel	× 5 MULTIPLIER	+	6 ABILITY
AGILITY	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	2 ABILITY
EGO	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	1 ABILITY
LOGIC	dMarvel	× 3 MULTIPLIER	+	0 ABILITY

TRAITS & TAGS

Traits
- Abrasive
- Berserker
- **Connections:** Criminal
- Gullible

Tags
- Black Market Access
- Public Identity
- Streetwise
- Supernatural
- Villainous

BIOGRAPHY

Real Name: Dirk Garthwaite
Height: 6'3" **Weight:** 320 lbs. **Gender:** Male
Eyes: Blue **Hair:** Brown **Size:** Average
Distinguishing Features: None
Occupation: Criminal
Origin: Magic
Teams: Wrecking Crew
Base: Mobile

History
Dirk Garthwaite was just a small-time thief with a crowbar until the day he was accidentally granted magical powers originally meant for Loki. As the Wrecker, Garthwaite used his new powers to embark on a one-man crime spree across New York City, and it took the intervention of Thor to end his villainous rampage.

Garthwaite wound up serving time in Ryker's Island. He eventually escaped, but only with the help of a few of his fellow inmates. Out of gratitude, he granted a portion of his own power to each of them, and they formed the nefarious Wrecking Crew.

Under the Wrecker's leadership, the Wrecking Crew has committed countless crimes, often in the employ of smarter, more ambitious or more powerful villains.

Personality
Even before he had powers, Garthwaite was prone to fits of anger and violence. Most people consider him an impulsive man in need of some serious psychiatric help. He is admired by the other members of his crew—if by no one else.

POWERS

Basic
- **Iconic Weapon:** Magic crowbar [Throwable club. Automatically returns to thrower.]
- Mighty 2
- Sturdy 2

Melee Weapons
- Fast Attacks
- Vicious Attack
- Whirling Frenzy

Super-Strength
- Banging Heads
- Clobber
- Crushing Grip
- Immovable
- Smash

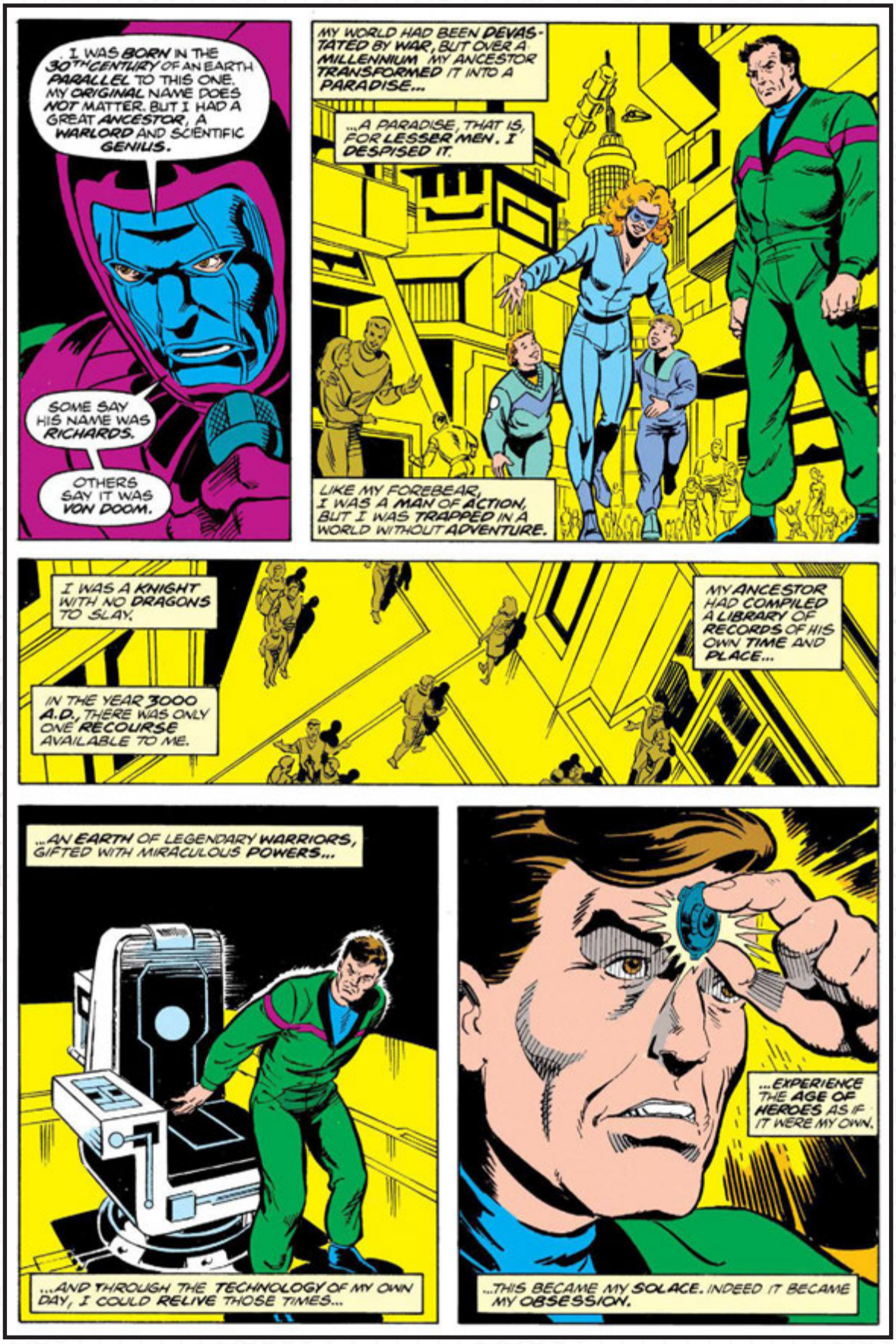
Michael Syrett (Order : 53194700)

BIRTH OF A WARLORD

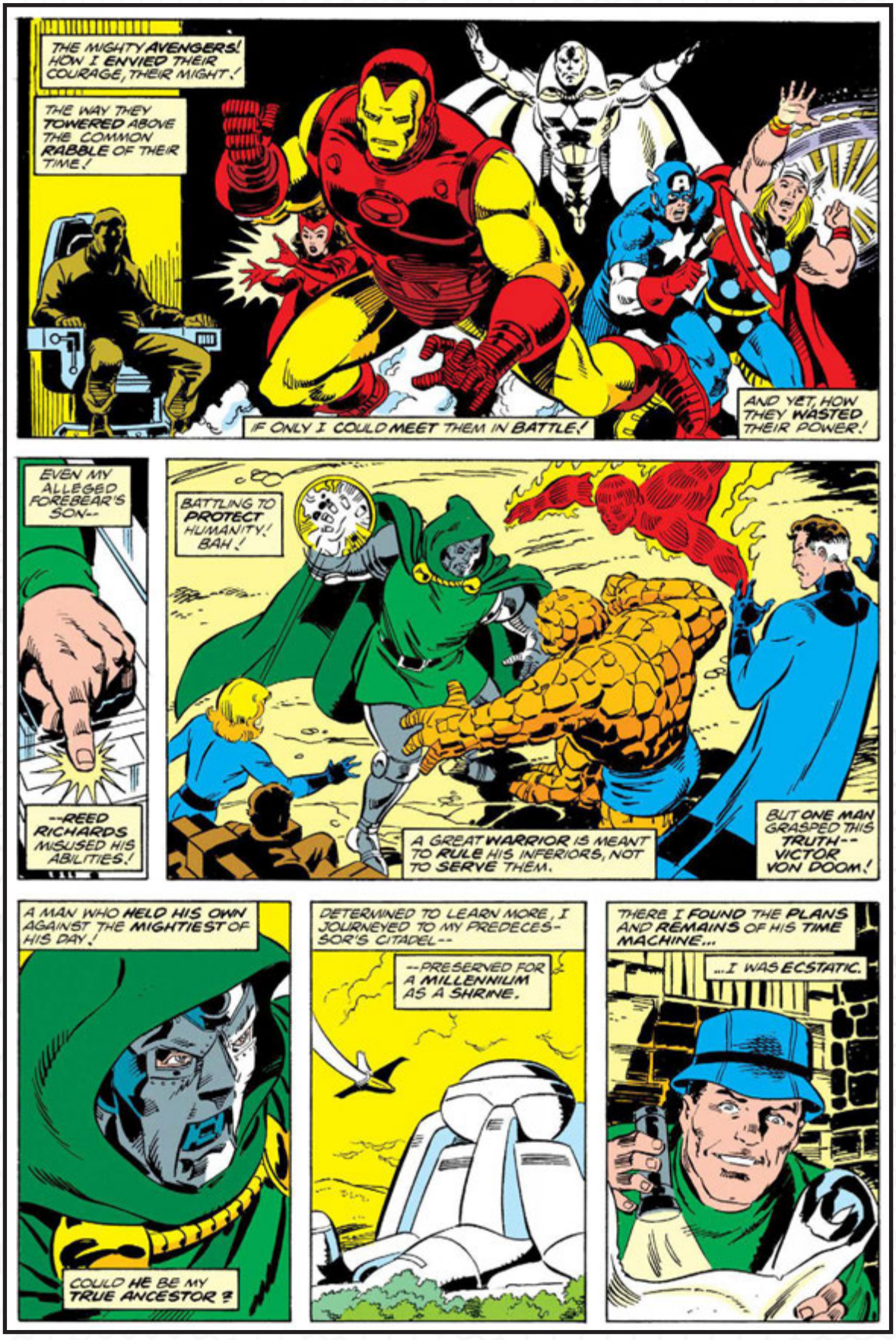
Included here is a special bonus! "Birth of a Warlord" written by Peter Sanderson, penciled by Rich Yanizesky, inked by Fred Fredericks, lettered by Dave Sharpe and colored by Max Scheele. This story first appeared in *Captain America Annual #11* (1992).

The comic tells the origin of Kang from his earliest days through his time as Rama-Tut to his first encounter with the Avengers. It should give some insight into Kang's legacy for anyone who is encountering him for the first time.

Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-1700)



Michael Sytch (Order: 53194700)



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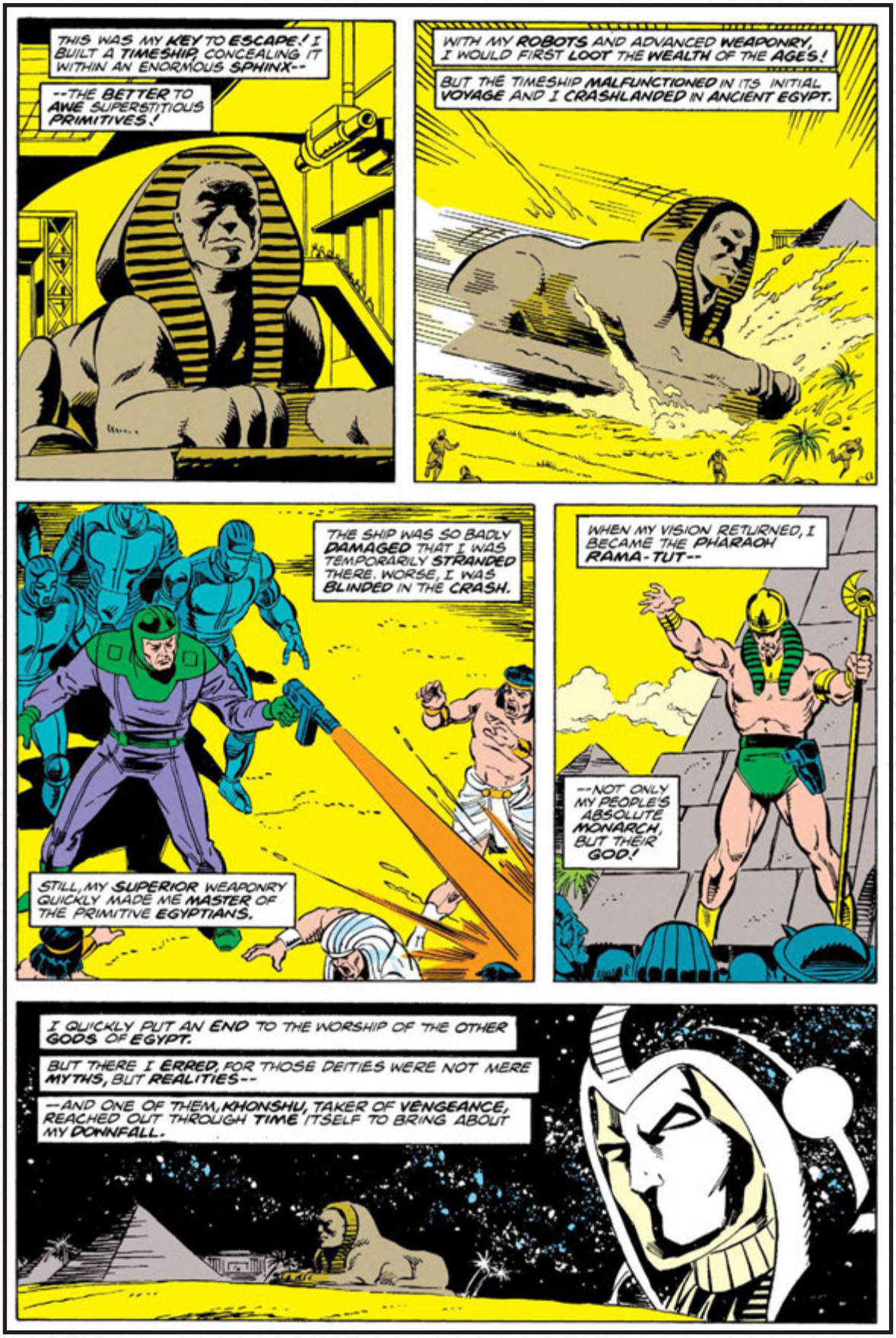
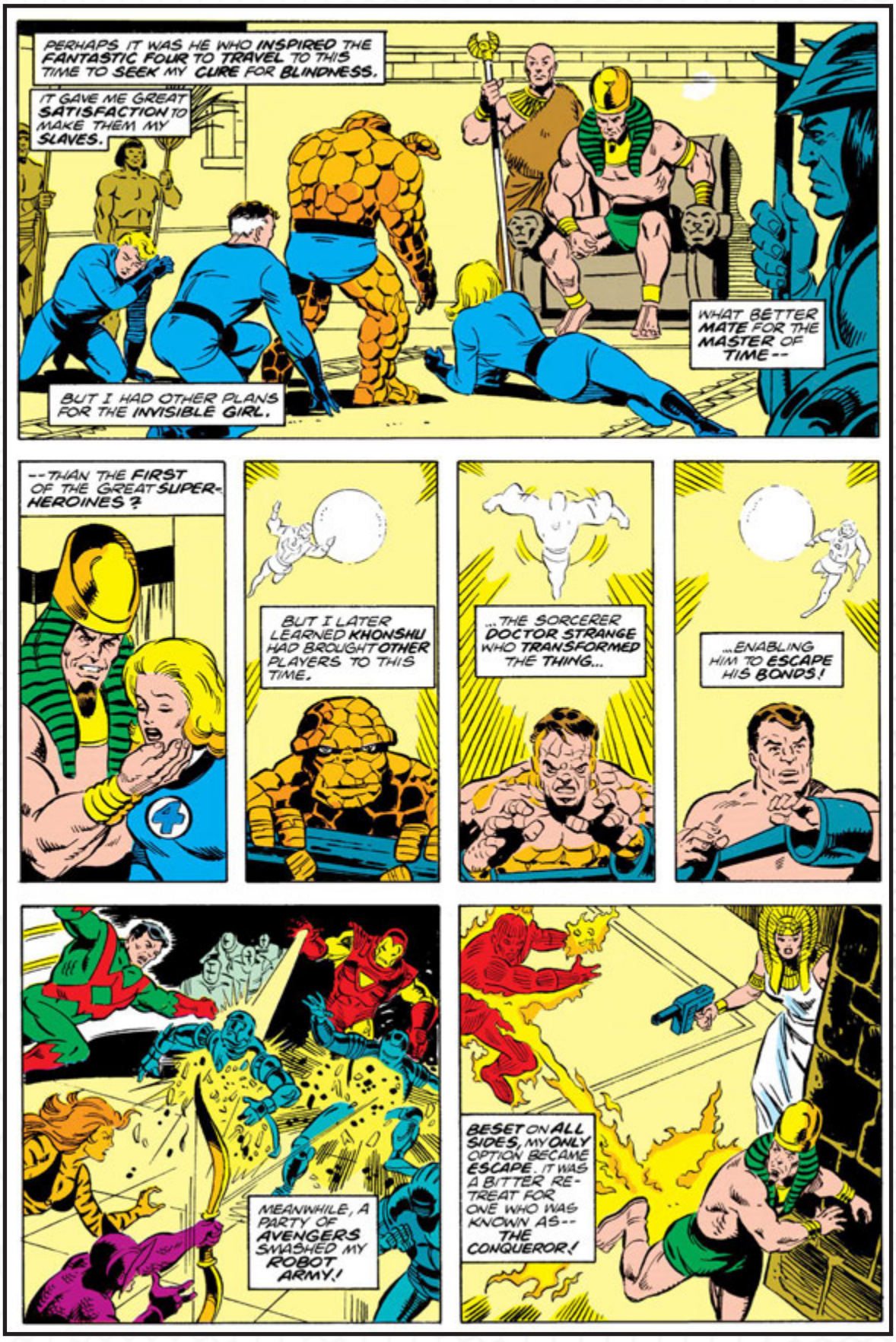


Michael Syrell (Order: 53194700)



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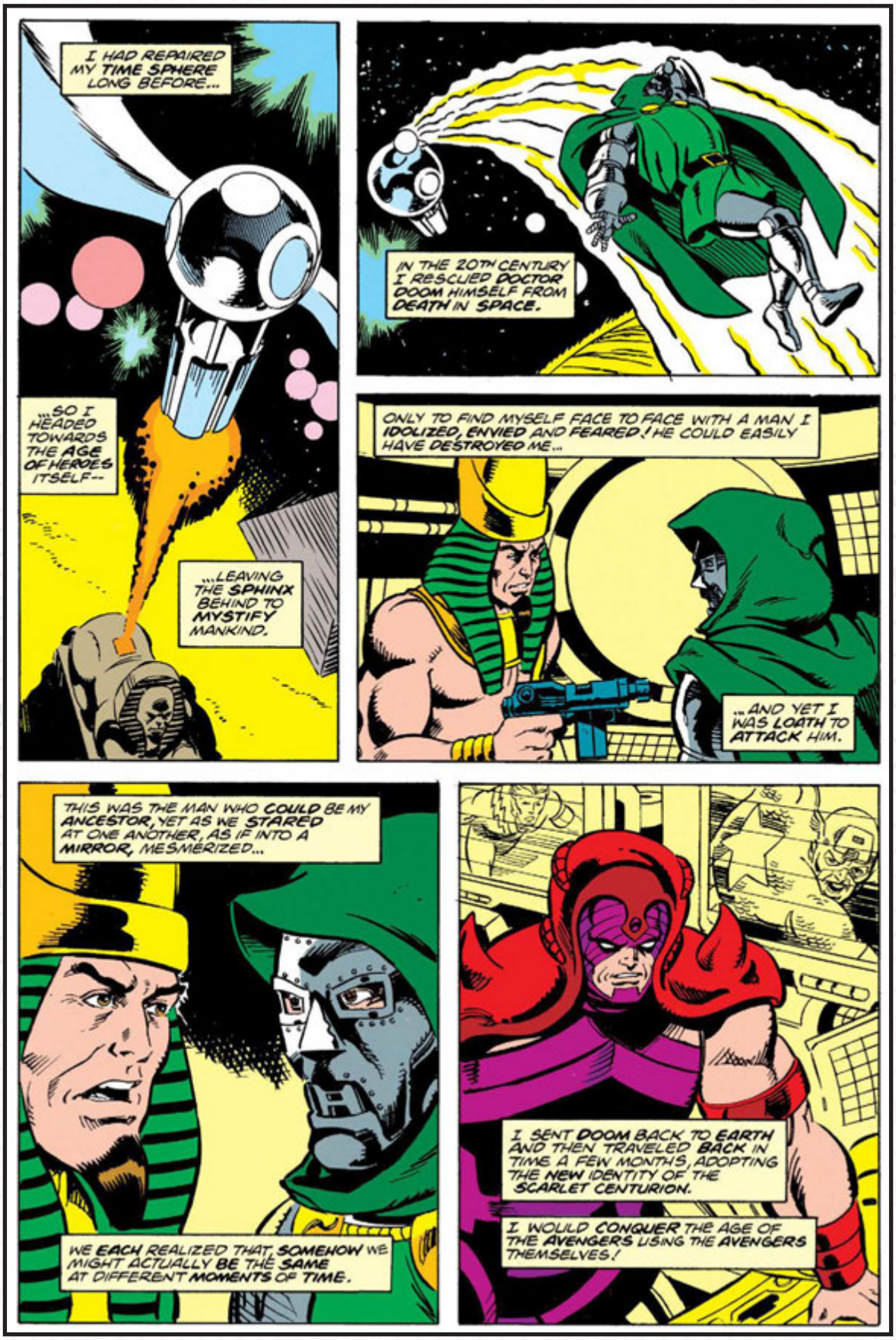

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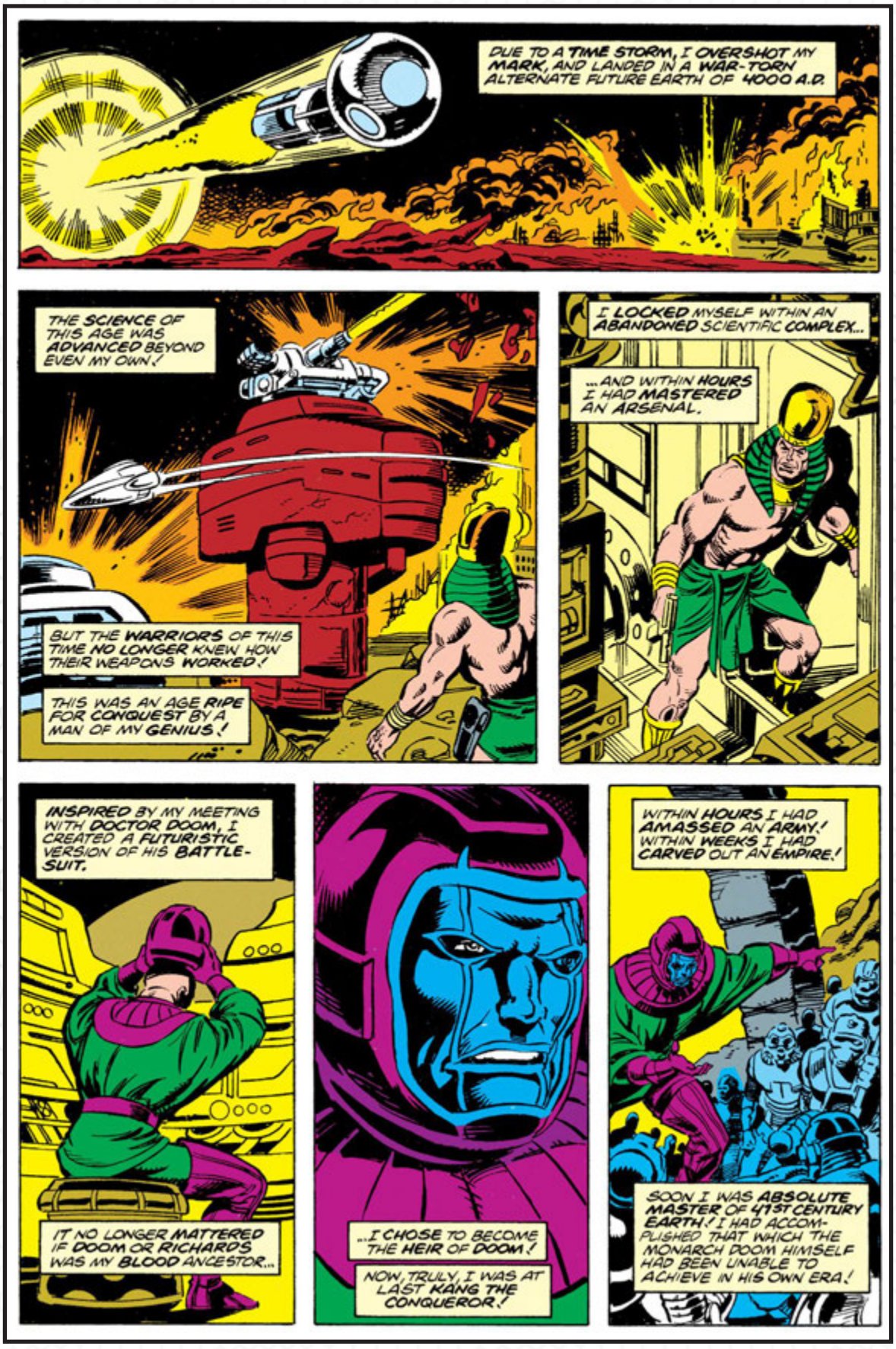

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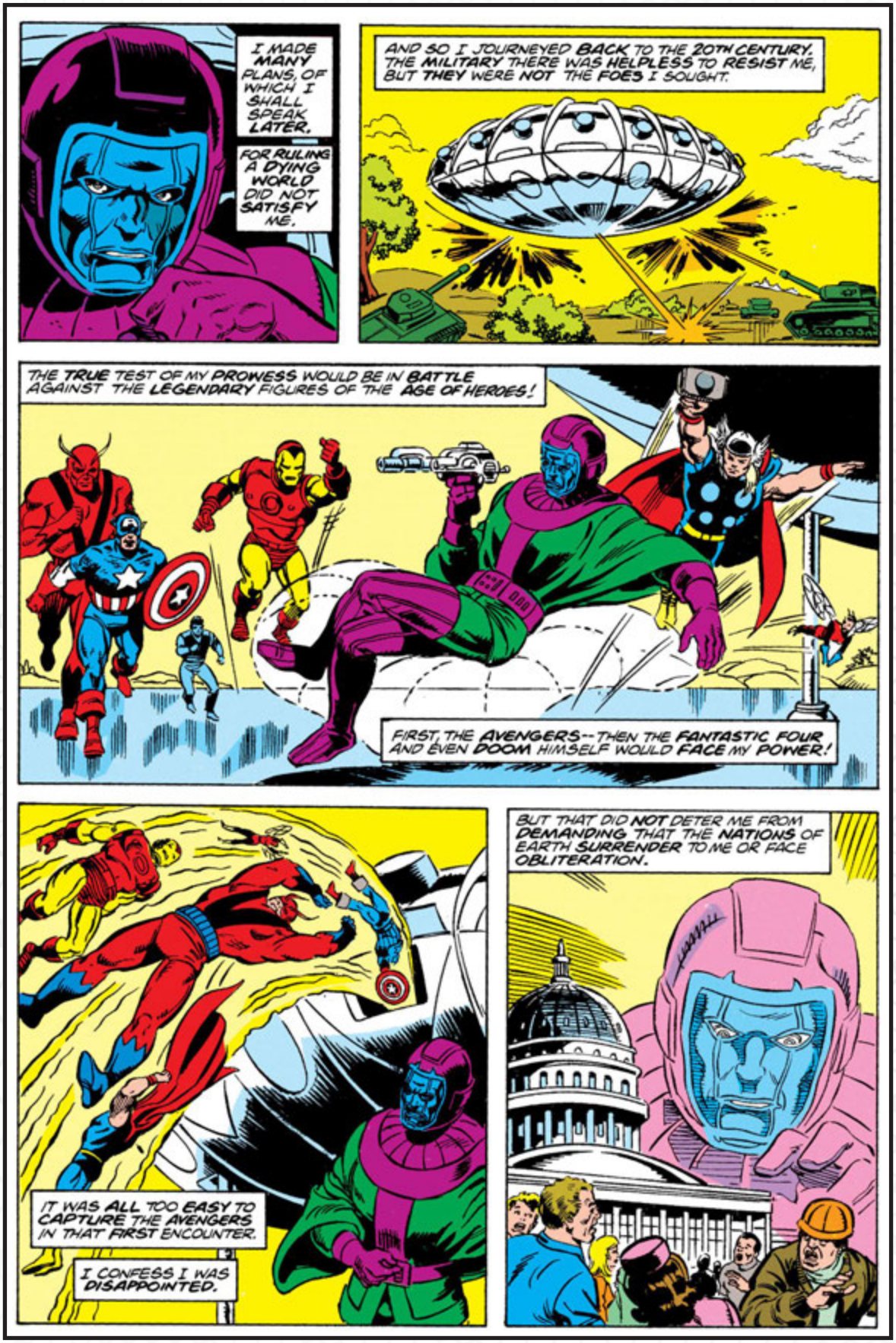
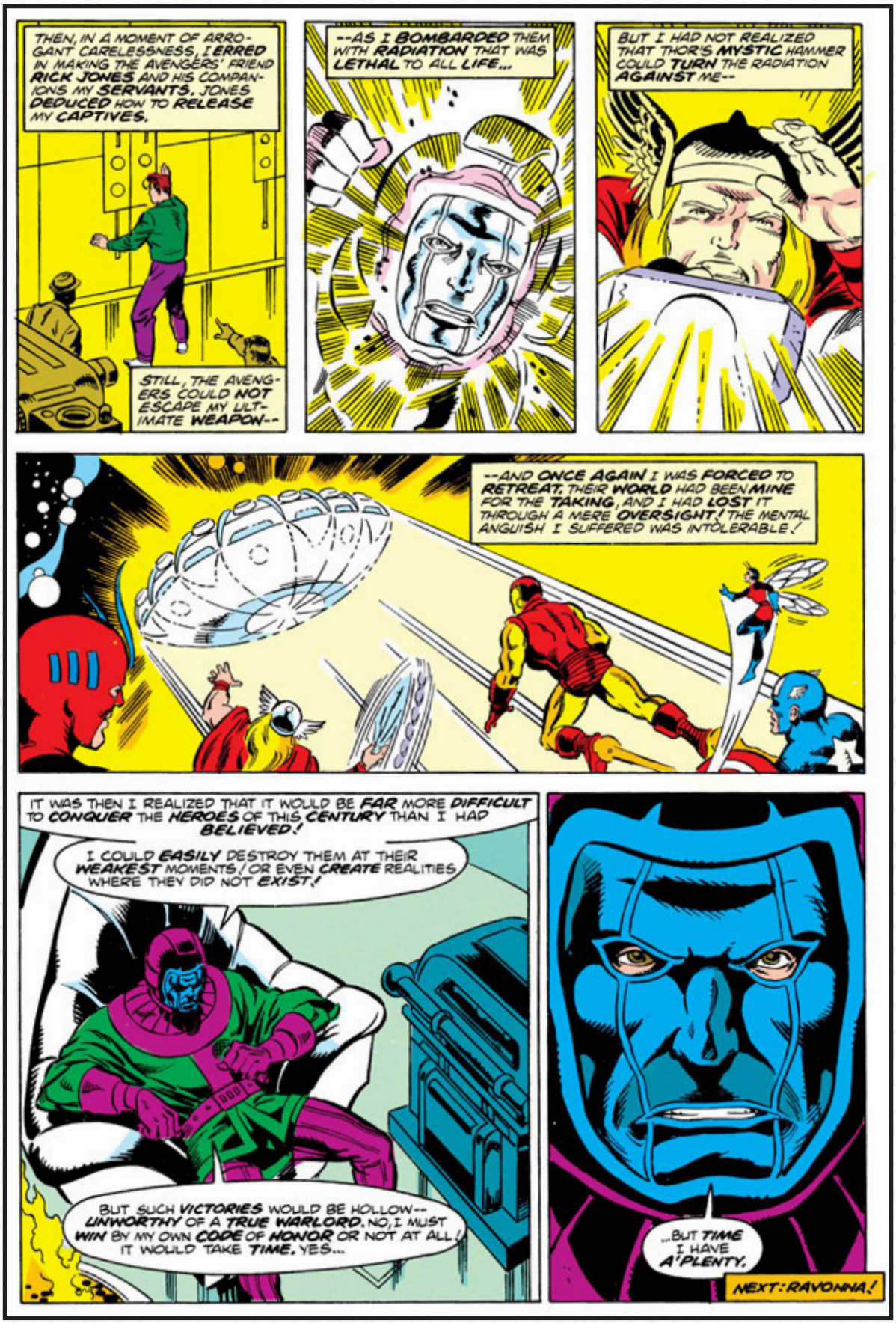


Michael Syrett (Order - 5319-1700)



Michael Syrett (Order: 53194700)

Art by Ruairí Coleman & Jesus Aburtov

Michael Syrett (Order #53194700)

The entries on these pages focus on new concepts, characters and items that appear in this book. If you can't find something you're looking for here, be sure to consult the Glossary/Index in the back of the *Core Rulebook* as well.

Note: Only the most important page numbers are listed with each entry, rather than an exhaustive list. Page numbers for profiles are listed in **BOLD**. If the profile is in the *Core Rulebook* rather than this book, those are also marked with **AN ASTERISK***.

A

Abomination 75, **134***
On the heroes' world, Emil Blonsky is a spy who became a super villain after exposure to gamma radiation transformed him into a massive, green-skinned monster. On Earth-56438, Rick Jones is the Abomination instead, and he serves Hydra. *First appearance (Emil Blonsky): Tales to Astonish #90 (January 1967); first appearance (Rick Jones): Incredible Hulk #1 (March 1962)*

Adhesive X 56
A chemical adhesive created by Baron Heinrich Zemo. It can bond to anything and is nearly impossible to dissolve. The Trapster created a chemical paste to remove Adhesive X, but no other methods are known. *First appearance: Avengers #6 (July 1964)*

Advanced Idea Mechanics (A.I.M.) 76
An offshoot of Hydra, A.I.M. is a group of brilliant scientists who seek to take over the world via their technological advances. On Earth-56438, A.I.M. remains a cooperative part of Hydra. *First appearance (as Them): Tales of Suspense #78 (June 1966)*

A.I.M. Mech-Suit 70, 75, 79
A suit of powered armor used by Hydra forces from Earth-56438, fitted with energy blasters and a shield bearing the Hydra symbol.

Alpha Primitives 125, **175**
A group of genetically engineered clones created four millennia ago to serve the Inhumans, which they did until modern times, despite the occasional rebellion. They are all identical, cannot reproduce and die in their early forties. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #47 (November 1965)*

Apocalypse 129-130
En Sabah Nur (Arabic for "the morning light") is a powerful and immortal mutant, born in ancient Egypt and often worshipped as a god through the ages. He often keeps a team of four mutants to serve him as the Horsemen of Apocalypse. In modern times, he often clashed with the X-Men, but he was given a place on the Quiet Council of Krakoa. *First appearance: X-Factor #5 (June 1986)*

Asim 130
A boy who lives in ancient Egypt under the rule of Pharaoh Rama-Tut. He and his mother Khepri may help the heroes.

Attilan 122
The home city of the Inhumans, central to their society. It was originally founded on an "Island of the Gods" that bore the same name in the North Atlantic Ocean, but it has moved multiple times since. The entire island and the city upon it were transported to the Himalayas, and then later to the Blue Area of the Moon. From there it took off into space and came to rest on Hala, the capital planet of the Kree Empire. After that, it returned to Earth and hovered over New York City until its destruction during an invasion by Thanos and his forces. On Earth-56438, Attilan remains on the Moon, and Godking Kang has taken it over. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #47 (Feb. 1966)*

B

Baal 129
A warrior in ancient Egypt who became the leader of the Sandstormers. He greeted Nathaniel Richards when he arrived in that period and named him Rama-Tut. He also raised the infant who would become Apocalypse—after killing the rest of his tribe. *First appearance: Rise of Apocalypse #1 (August 1996)*

Baxter Building 76
A Manhattan skyscraper that has housed the Fantastic Four throughout the majority of their career. It has been destroyed and rebuilt a number of times. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #3 (March 1962)*

Black Bolt 122, **144***
The king of the Inhumans and the head of the Inhuman Royal Family, his voice is powerful enough to shatter mountains. On Earth-56438, he has decided to keep Attilan on the Moon and stay out of politics on Earth. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #45 (Dec. 1965)*

Black Widow 74, **146***
On the heroes' world, Natasha Romanova was a Russian spy that defected to the US to become a super hero and a long-standing member of the Avengers. On Earth-56438, she went over to Hydra instead and is now a valued member of the Supremacy. *First appearance: Tales of Suspense #52 (April 1964)*

Blue Area 119, 147
A part of the Moon—located in the Luther Crater—that has been altered to have the same atmospheric and gravitational conditions as the Earth. The Skrulls originally created it as a place to test the Kree, who later rebelled against them. The Watcher (Uatu) set up his citadel there, from which he monitored the Earth. The X-Men have a home there now called the Summer House. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #13 (April 1963)*

Bulldozer 44, **180**
Henry Camp, a masked super villain who wears a reinforced helmet and armor and rams into things. One of the original members of the Wrecking Crew. *First appearance: Defenders #17 (Nov. 1974)*

Bullseye 72, **150***
As an assassin gifted with uncanny accuracy, Bullseye's talents were nurtured by Hydra on Earth-56438. *First appearance: Daredevil #131 (March 1976)*

C

Captain America (Steve Rogers) 27, **151***
On the heroes' world, Steve Rogers becomes the first Captain America during World War II. After being blown into the North Atlantic on a mission against Baron Zemo, he wakes up decades later to become one of the first Avengers. On Earth-56438, Rogers awakened alone and—after seeing what had happened to the world in his absence—became a member of the resistance. *First appearance: Captain America Comics #1 (Dec. 1940)*

Captain Avalon 120, **182**
Brian Braddock, who for many years filled the role of Captain Britain, now wields the Sword of Might and protects Avalon. *First appearance: Excalibur #13 (Dec. 2020)*

Captain Britain 155
A super hero charged with protecting Great Britain and Otherworld. Brian Braddock served in this role for many years, but on the heroes' world, his sister Betsy Braddock has taken over the job. Brian has since become Captain Avalon. *First appearance: Captain Britain #1 (October 1976)*

Captain Britain Corps 155
A force composed of Captains Britain from various parts of the Multiverse. They work together to protect Otherworld and tackle overwhelming threats. *First appearance: Daredevils #6 (June 1983)*

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Castle Doom 141, 151
The fortified home of Doctor Doom, a refitted medieval castle perched atop a mountain that looks out over Doomstadt, the capital city of Latveria. First appearance: *Fantastic Four Annual #2 (1964)*

Chavez, America 113-114, **137***
On the heroes' world, America Chavez is a powerful super hero who can travel between universes at will and is often called upon to help with multiversal threats. On Earth-56438, she's an important member of the resistance, but her powers also make her a top target of the Supremacy as they try to find a way to flee their universe. *First appearance: Vengeance #1 (Sept. 2011)*

Chronifact 134
A powerful device that allows its user to absorb and manipulate chronal energy. It was invented by Sidney Fishburne at Gena-Sys labs. On Earth-56438, Godking Kang used the Chronifact to power a nearly impenetrable force-field. *First appearance: Killpower: The Early Years #1 (Sept. 1993)*

Convention Center 48, 58
A gigantic, glass-walled convention center built in the 1980s. It is located at West 34th Street and 11th Avenue, in the Hell's Kitchen section of Manhattan.

Cosmic Cube 80
A glowing, fist-sized cube that allows the person wielding it to rewrite reality according to their wishes. The one in Doctor Doom's vault is fake. He doesn't have a real one. Some on Earth-56438 conjecture that Hydra used one to take power there. *First appearance: Tales of Suspense #79 (July 1966)*

Crimson Surfer 116, **187**
When Kang the Devourer reached one universe he was about to devour, he took that Earth's version of the Red Skull and made him his herald, much in the way that Galactus transformed Norrin Radd into the Silver Surfer. The Crimson Surfer has since been scouting for new timelines for his master to consume—and for a good way to betray him.

Crossbones 73, **156***
Brock Rumlow is a top Hydra assassin in both worlds, but on Earth-56438, he's been overshadowed by all the top-level talent in the Supremacy, and he works even harder to distinguish himself. *First appearance: Captain America #359 (October 1989)*

Crystal 122, **188**
The sister of Medusa, and a member of the Inhuman Royal Family, Crystal is an Inhuman with elemental powers. On Earth-56438, she serves as the Inhuman ambassador to Hydra, a job she excels at but detests. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #45 (Dec. 1965)*

D

Damage Control, Inc. 94
A company that specializes in repairing damage and containing fallout caused by conflicts among super-powered beings, up to and including complete reconstruction of entire areas. The original owners were Iron Man (Tony Stark) and Kingpin (Wilson Fisk), but the company has since gone public. *First appearance: Marvel Age Annual #4 (June 1988)*

Demolisher 40, **191**
A super villain who swings around a wrecking ball on the end of a cable. Also the newest member of the Wrecking Crew. *First appearance: Moon Girl and Devil Dinosaur #34 (Oct. 2018)*

DeWitt Clinton Park 50
A public park that occupies two city blocks on the north side of Hell's Kitchen, right next to the Hudson River.

Doctor Doom 148, **161***
Victor von Doom is one of the top scientists and most powerful sorcerers in the world. He rules his homeland of Latveria after leading a revolution there. On Earth-56438, he is a member of the Supremacy, but he remains in Latveria whenever possible to avoid their internal politics. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #5 (July 1962)*

Doctor Octopus 74, **161***
Otto Octavius is a genius super villain with telepathic control over a set of four artificial tentacles that he invented. On Earth-56438, he is a proud member of the Supremacy who is constantly looking for ways to prove his superiority over the cretins he's forced to work with. *First appearance: Amazing Spider-Man #3 (July 1963)*

Doombots 151, **192**
Artificially intelligent robots designed by Doctor Doom to serve him and—when necessary—act in his place. They appear identical to their creator. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #5 (July 1962)*

Doomstadt 152
The capital and largest city of Latveria. Doctor Doom renamed it from Hassenstadt after he became the new ruler of the nation. *First appearance: Fantastic Four Annual #2 (July 1964)*

Dormammu 164, **164***
The ruler of the Dark Dimension, the flame-headed Dormammu is one of the most powerful sorcerers in the universe. He is also the father of Clea, who is married to Doctor Strange. On Earth-56438, he has made an alliance with the Supremacy that boils down to "Give me what I want, and I won't need to invade your dimension." *First appearance: Strange Tales #126 (Nov. 1964)*

E

Earth-56438 13
An alternate Earth where Hydra successfully undermined the United States government and became the most powerful political organization on the planet. It is home to the Supremacy and Godking Kang and is currently under the threat of the Crimson Surfer and Kang the Devourer.

Echo 72, **224**, (non-Phoenix version) **167***
On the heroes' world, Maya Lopez was taken in by the Kingpin and trained as an enforcer. She has since reformed and become a member of the Avengers and was empowered by the Phoenix force. On Earth-56438, she was taken in by Hydra instead and became a member of the Supremacy. *First appearance: Daredevil #9 (Dec. 1999)*

Egghead 112-114, **193***
On the heroes' world, Elihas Starr is a B-list genius super villain obsessed with destroying Ant-Man (Hank Pym). On Earth-56438, he works in Horizon Labs and leads the effort to get the interdimensional portals to the heroes' world working. *First Appearance: Tales to Astonish #38 (Dec. 1962)*

Elektra 73, **167***
On the heroes' world, Elektra Natchios gave up her life as an assassin and is now working as a new Daredevil alongside the original, whom she recently married. On Earth-56438, she never reformed and instead became a valued member of the Supremacy. *First appearance: Daredevil #168 (Jan. 1981)*

E.M.P. Grenade 86
A prototype of a specialized grenade that releases an electromagnetic pulse that can fry electronic circuitry and harm robotic characters.

Empire State University 63
An Ivy League research university located in midtown Manhattan that counts several super heroes among its students and alumni. Also home to the Howard & Maria Stark Center for Galactic Research. *First appearance: Amazing Spider-Man #31 (Dec. 1965)*

En Sabah Nur
See *Apocalypse*

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Exiles 155
A team of universe-hopping super heroes who tackle problems affecting the Multiverse. Members use the Tallus to move between universes. *First appearance: Exiles #1 (Aug. 2001)*

Eye of Ages 134
A device from the 30th century that contains records of much of human history. Nathaniel Richards installed it in his first time-traveling ship before he journeyed back to ancient Egypt and became known as Rama-Tut. Those who touch it see parts of that history and sometimes interpret them as visions of the future. *First appearance: Rise of Apocalypse #1 (Oct. 1996)*

F

Fantasti-Car 75
Probably the best-known transportation vehicle of the Fantastic Four. A vertical take-off-and-landing (VTOL) aircraft capable of splitting into four separate units, each with its own controls. It can also be set on automatic to keep hands-free during missions. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #3 (March 1962)*

Federal Emergency Aid and Response (F.E.A.R.) 47
A fake federal agency set up in the heroes' universe by secret agents from Hydra of Earth-56438. To do this, they infiltrated law enforcement in the Hell's Kitchen neighborhood of Manhattan after the wanton destruction wreaked there by the Wrecking Crew of Earth-56438. Agents are careful never to use the group's acronym in public.

Fenris Twins 81-82, **178**
Andrea and Andreas von Strucker are the twin children of Baron Wolfgang von Strucker. Arnim Zola genetically engineered the X-gene into them in the womb, making them artificial mutants. Their powers work as long as they are touching each other. They have been affiliated with Hydra for years, although on the heroes' world they recently became the Black Knights of the Hellfire Club. *First appearance: Uncanny X-Men #194 (March 1985)*

Fromage et Vino 95
A specialty bodega in the Hudson Yards neighborhood of Manhattan. Its name is a clever mishmash of two languages. "Fromage et" is French for "cheese and," and "Vino" is Italian or Spanish for "wine." The store supplies cheeses to Luq, which is next door.

Fury, Nick Jr. 17, **215***
The son of CIA agent Nia Jones, Fury was raised as Marcus Johnson and joined the US Army at the age of eighteen. He didn't know his father—Nick Fury Sr.—until much later, as the elder Fury had stayed away to protect Nia and their son from his enemies. The younger Fury joined S.H.I.E.L.D. and rose quickly through the ranks there until the organization was dissolved. *First Appearance: Battle Scars #1 (Jan. 2012)*

Fury Jr.'s Command Center 64
A library that Nick Fury Jr. commandeers as a headquarters during the crisis in Chapter 4: New York State of Mind. It's located at 108–19 71st Avenue in the Forest Hills neighborhood of Queens.

Fury, Nick Sr. 144–147, **220**
A long-lived soldier and spy. Led the Howling Commandos for the US Army during World War II. Became the first and longest-serving director of S.H.I.E.L.D. Later killed the Watcher (Uatu). As punishment, he was transformed into the Unseen, forced to watch Earth but powerless to act. As the Unseen, he formed a new team of Exiles (a multiversal super hero team) to stop the Time-Eater. A restored Uatu set Fury up in the Watcher's citadel in the Blue Area of the Moon to watch over Earth again, but Fury recently departed to take direct action throughout the Multiverse. *First Appearance: Sgt. Fury and His Howling Commandos #1 (May 1963)*

G

Galactus 107, 121, 145, 154–155
Galan, the sole survivor of the Sixth Cosmos, became Galactus at the dawn of the Seventh Cosmos. A gigantic armored figure, he roams the universe in his worldship, *Taa II*. His hunger is so great that it can be sated only by devouring planets. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #48 (March 1966)*

Ghost-Spider 154, **173***
The Gwen Stacy of Earth-65, who was bitten by a radioactive spider that on the heroes' world gave Spider-Man (Peter Parker) his powers. Although she is not from the heroes' world, she uses the Ticket to the Multiverse to attend Empire State University there. On Earth-56438, Gwen Stacy has no powers and is not part of the resistance, but she works to undermine Hydra every chance she gets. *First appearance: Edge of Spider-Verse #2 (September 2014)*

Giza 129
A city on the west bank of the Nile River in Egypt, across from Cairo. It served as the necropolis of the pharaohs in ancient times, and the Great Pyramids and the Sphinx are located there.

God Emperor Doom 153
The title that Doctor Doom gave himself when he ruled over Battleworld, a conglomerated planet he constructed as Earth-15513 from pieces of various destroyed universes at the end of the Seventh Cosmos. When the Multiverse was reborn into the Eighth Cosmos, most people forgot all about Doom's reign and the entirety of the Secret Wars that went with it. *First appearance: Secret Wars #2 (July 2015)*

Godking Kang 120, 134–136
A version of Nathaniel Richards from Earth-56438. Fearing the impending arrival of Kang the Devourer, he uses chronal energy from ancient Egypt and the power of the Inhumans on the Moon to prepare for the arrival of the Devourer.

Gorgon (Gorgon Petragon) 126, **195**
A member of the Inhuman Royal Family, Gorgon can cause the earth to tremble by stomping with his goat-like legs. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #44 (Nov. 1965)*

Gorgon (Tomi Shishido) 114, **196**
On the heroes' world, Tomi Shishido long worked with Hydra, but he later put his villainous past behind him to become one of the Great Captains of Krakoa. On Earth-56438, he never left Hydra, and he has a far more prominent role with the Supremacy. There he works in New York City as the representative of Hydra's branch in Japan. *First appearance: Wolverine #20 (Dec. 2004)*

Great Sphinx of Giza 129, 132–133
A gigantic statue in Giza, Egypt, of a lion with the head of a man. Rama-Tut concealed his time machine under it when he ruled the region in ancient times.

Green Goblin 72, 74, **176***
On the heroes' world, Norman Osborn became the original Green Goblin, but he recently had his sins expunged and is now known as the Gold Goblin, working with Spider-Man (Peter Parker) rather than against him. On Earth-56438, the Green Goblin remains evil and is a proud and conniving member of the Supremacy, always looking to rise among Hydra's ranks. *First appearance: Amazing Spider-Man #14 (July 1964)*

Growing Man 129, **197**
An android designed by Kang the Conqueror as a tool of war. When struck, it grows in size and strength. On Earth-56438, Rama-Tut uses prototypes of this android to serve him in ancient Egypt. *First appearance: Thor #140 (May 1967)*

H

Hawkeye (Clint Barton) 71–72, **179***
On the heroes' world, Clint Barton is a reformed criminal who became a long-standing member of the Avengers and recently led a new team of Thunderbolts officially sanctioned by New York

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City. On Earth-56438, he never put aside his evil ways and is a member of the Supremacy instead. *First appearance: Tales of Suspense #57 (Sept. 1964)*

Hela 164, **180***
The Norse goddess who rules over Hel, a region for the dishonorable dead, located in Niffleheim, one of the Ten Realms of Asgardian legend. On Earth-56438, the Supremacy has struck a bargain with her to give her whatever she wants for her help against Asgard. *First appearance: Journey Into Mystery #102 (March 1964)*

Hell's Kitchen 36–37, 48, 108
A neighborhood on Manhattan's west side, between 34th and 59th Streets. It overlaps with Hudson Yards to the south. This was once a rough part of town, but it has been gentrified over the years. Daredevil (Matt Murdock) notably calls it home.

H.E.R.B.I.E. 77–79, **199**
Humanoid Experimental Robot B-Type Integrated Electronics is an artificially intelligent robot designed by Mister Fantastic and Master Xar of the Xandarians to help the Fantastic Four find Galactus. Valeria Richards freed the original H.E.R.B.I.E., who left and eventually joined the A.I. Army, fighting for the rights of A.I.s, but a number of other H.E.R.B.I.E. units are deployed in the Baxter Building. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #209 (Aug. 1979)*

Hill, Maria 101, **216**
On the heroes' world, Maria Hill is the former director of S.H.I.E.L.D., currently working as an agent of the CIA. On Earth-56438, there was no S.H.I.E.L.D. for her to join, much less lead. After leaving the US military, she joined the resistance, where she leads many of their efforts. *First appearance: New Avengers #4 (April 2005)*

Hood 114, **201**
Parker Robbins stumbled into his powers by shooting a demon and stealing its hooded cloak. On the heroes' world, he recently lost his powers. On Earth-56438, however, he's not only kept his powers but parlayed them into a prominent position with the Supremacy. *First appearance: Hood #1 (July 2002)*

Horizon Labs 106, 112–116
A cutting-edge technology company founded by Max Modell that once employed Peter Parker (Spider-Man). Its headquarters was in the South Street Seaport area of Manhattan, downtown on the East River. On the heroes' Earth, it has since folded. It is still in operation on Earth-56438, but it is now a part of Alchemax Labs. *First appearance: Amazing Spider-Man #648 (Jan. 2011)*

Howard & Maria Stark Center for Galactic Research 65, 89, 156
A research institute founded by Tony Stark (Iron Man) to research galactic history to better understand Earth's place in an interstellar context. It is located on the campus of Empire State University. *First appearance: Marvel Multiverse Role-Playing Game: Playtest Rulebook (April 2022)*

Hudson Yards 95–97
A neighborhood on Manhattan's West Side, roughly between 30th and 41st Streets. It originally featured rail yards but has been substantially redeveloped over the years. Luq restaurant is located here.

Human Torch (Johnny Storm) 148, 153, **183***
Blazing fire-controller Johnny Storm is one of the founding members of the Fantastic Four. On Earth-56438, he opposed Mister Fantastic's involvement with the Illuminati—and went missing. The Supremacy is holding him in a secret part of the prison known as the Raft, allowing his sister, the Invisible Woman, to believe the Illuminati killed him. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #1 (Nov. 1961)*

Hydra 13, 27–29, 33, 70–76, 100
An organization bent on world domination that has its roots in prehistoric times. Modern Hydra is a fascist organization that rose from the ashes of the Axis Powers after World War II. Several super villains have led it in whole or part, including Baron Wolfgang von Strucker, the Red Skull (Johann Shmidt), Viper (Ophelia Sarkissian), Kraken, Gorgon (Tomi Shishido) and Baron Helmut Zemo. On Earth-56438, Hydra has achieved its goals and runs much of the world, including the US. *First appearance: Strange Tales #135 (Aug. 1965)*

Hydra Air Drone 75
An unstaffed, remote-controlled quadcopter the size of a large pizza box, equipped to spray Adhesive X at targets.

Hydra Attack Helicopter 75
A battle helicopter deployed by Hydra forces from Earth-56438, fitted with an energy cannon.

Hydra Jet Pack 75
A device worn like a backpack that grants its user the ability to fly. Used by Hydra forces from Earth-56438.

Hydra Light Armored Vehicle 75
An armored truck deployed by Hydra forces from Earth-56438, fitted with an energy rifle.

Hydra Tank 75
An armored tank deployed by Hydra forces from Earth-56438, fitted with an energy cannon.

I

Illuminati 102
The Illuminati was a group of some of the most powerful and influential super heroes in the world, who agreed to work together in secret to anticipate and prevent disasters. Captain America (Steve Rogers) tried to expose them and put an end to it. On Earth-56438, this transpired much the same way, except that the Supremacy worked against the Illuminati as well. *First appearance: New Avengers #7 (July 2005)*

Infinity Gauntlet 153
A golden metal glove designed to have the six Infinity Stones mounted on it, giving the user complete control over the universe. Thanos notably used it to wipe out half of the population in the universe. The one in Doctor Doom's vault is a non-working replica he crafted for studying. *First appearance: Silver Surfer #44 (Dec. 1990)*

Inhumans 125
A subspecies of humanity known as inhomo supremis, created by Kree experimentation millennia ago. They carry an Inhuman gene that can be activated by exposure to the Terrigen Mist, granting them super powers. They made their home in Attilan and were ruled by a royal family led by Black Bolt, but after recent events, the Royal Family is all that remains of Inhuman society. On Earth-56438, the Inhumans have remained a closed society living in Attilan on the Moon. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #45 (Dec. 1965)*

Inhuman Royal Family 122
The members of the House of Agon, the ruling family of the Inhumans. It includes Black Bolt, Crystal, Gorgon, Karnak, Lockjaw, Medusa and Triton. On Earth-56438, Triton is missing. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #45 (Dec. 1965)*

Inhuman Royal Guard 125, **204**
A force of Inhumans tasked with protecting the Royal Family. Most of them do not have powers, and they are noted for the silence with which they work. They are sometimes backed up by powerful members of the Royal Family. *First appearance: Inhumans #1 (Sept. 1998)*

Invisible Woman 148, 153, **187***
Susan Storm was a founding member of the Fantastic Four and eventually married team leader Mister Fantastic, becoming Sue Richards. On Earth-56438, she turned to Hydra for help after she

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learned her husband was a member of the Illuminati—which she thinks killed her brother, the Human Torch. Despite her many misgivings, she is working with the Supremacy still, although her sympathies lie with the resistance. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #1 (Nov. 1961)*

Ironheart 101, **205**
On the heroes' world, Riri Williams is a gifted inventor and rising super hero who lives in Chicago's South Side. On Earth-56438, she's just as smart, and she's part of the next generation of the resistance against Hydra. She also moved to New York City to be closer to the action. *First appearance: (as Riri) Invincible Iron Man #7 (May 2016); (as Ironheart) Invincible Iron Man #3 (March 2017)*

J

Jahf 154
A powerful and cocky robot who resembles a short, blue-skinned alien and is the first of a series of such creatures who guard the M'kraan Crystal in every universe in the Multiverse. Those who defeat him must then face Modt. *First appearance: X-Men #108 (Dec. 1977)*

Jameson, J. Jonah 101, **208**
Being a news editor and reporter is in Jameson's blood, and he's often used his position to rail against super-powered people of all stripes, heroes included. He was the mayor of New York City not long ago on the heroes' world, but on Earth-56438, Hydra shut down his newspaper (the *Daily Bugle*) for griping about the Supremacy. He now puts his skills to use writing passionate editorials for the resistance. *First appearance: Amazing Spider-Man #1 (March 1963)*

K

Kang the Conqueror 209
See *Richards, Nathaniel*

Kang the Devourer 11, 139, 159
A version of Kang from an unidentified universe who went to the dawn of time and stole the power of Galactus from him. This transformed him into a gigantic person who consumes not planets but entire timelines.

Karnak 122, 126, **210**
A member of the Inhuman Royal Family, Karnak could have undergone exposure to the Terrigen Mist to gain powers, but his parents balked at this after his older brother Triton was so changed he could breathe only water, not air. While he has no super powers, he has been trained to spot and exploit even the smallest weaknesses. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #45 (Dec. 1965)*

Khepri 130, 131
A woman who lives in ancient Egypt under the rule of Pharaoh Rama-Tut. She and her son Asim may help the heroes.

Killmonger 114, **193***
On the heroes' world, Erik Killmonger has long been a thorn in the side of the Black Panther (T'Challa), trying to usurp his power in Wakanda. On Earth-56438, he continues to do so, but with the explicit support of Hydra in exchange for his membership in the Supremacy. He resides in the Supremacy Headquarters, where Hydra bills him as their representative from Africa. *First appearance: Jungle Action #6 (Sept. 1973)*

L

Laera, Annachiara and Paolo 18, 19
Annachiara (an-na-KEY-ar-a) and Paolo (POW-loh) Laera (LAIR-a) are sister-brother Maggia assassins sent to rough up the owner of Nanni's. They grew up in Little Italy and don't really want to lean on their fellow locals, but they have their orders.

LaGuardia Airport 81
The smallest of the New York City area's three major airports. (The others are John F. Kennedy Airport, on the south side of Queens, and Newark Liberty in Newark, New Jersey.) It's been operating since 1939, and it sits on the north side of the East Elmhurst neighborhood. That's on the north side of Queens, just south of Ryker's Island. It was named in honor of longtime New York City mayor Fiorella La Guardia in 1947, just months before he passed away.

Latveria 151
A small, mountainous nation in eastern Europe. Doctor Doom was born here and long ago established himself as its ruler after leading a successful revolution. Its largest city is the capital city of Doomstadt. *First appearance: Fantastic Four Annual #2 (July 1964)*

Lincoln Tunnel 43
An underground car tunnel that runs under the Hudson River and connects midtown Manhattan to Weehawken, New Jersey, via three tubes that are each two lanes wide. It emerges in Manhattan in the Hudson Yards neighborhood.

Lockjaw 122, **211**
A gigantic dog with teleportation powers given to him by prenatal experiments, Lockjaw is a loyal member of the Inhuman Royal Family. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #45 (Dec. 1965)*

Logos 132, **212**
The man who served as the grand vizier to Rama-Tut in ancient Egypt. As such, he handled many of the matters of state for Rama-Tut, freeing the time traveler up for his larger plans. On Earth-56438, Logos was also secretly a mutant psychic. *First appearance: Rise of Apocalypse #1 (August 1996)*

Long Beach Boardwalk 82
A lighted, wooden boardwalk that stretches over 2 miles along the south shore of Long Beach, a city in Nassau County, New York, on the eastern edge of Queens. It was built in 1914, and it connects many shops, hotels, restaurants, amusement areas and other attractions.

Luciano & Matteo's 18, 32, 21
An Italian grocery store named after the owners, the two Ingellis brothers, Luciano (LOO-chee-ah-noh) and Matteo (ma-TAY-oh). It's in Little Italy, near Nanni's Restaurant.

Luq 95
A fancy new restaurant that recently opened in Hudson Yards, near the Convention Center. People argue about the pronunciation, but when the staff welcomes people to the place, it sounds like "luck."

M

M'kraan Crystal 154
A house-sized pink crystal that sits on a planet in the center of the universe and exists in all universes in the Multiverse. Even shards of it can be used to travel between universes and through time. It is guarded by Jahf and Modt, the first of two guardians in a chain that supposedly grows exponentially more powerful with each one that is defeated. *First appearance: X-Men #107 (Oct. 1977)*

Madame Masque 26, **213**
Whitney Frost is the daughter of Count Nefaria, the head of the Nefaria family, one of the most powerful factions in the Maggia. A powerful and daring criminal in her own right—and a frequent nemesis of Iron Man (Tony Stark)—she has teamed up with her counterpart from Earth-56438 to help the Hydra of that world work their way into the heroes' world. The version from Earth-56438 goes by her original name, Giuletta Nefaria, and oversees the operation from that end. *First appearance: (as Whitney Frost) Tales of Suspense #98 (Feb. 1968); (as Madame Masque) Iron Man #17 (Sept. 1969)*

Maggia 19, 31, 72
A longstanding crime syndicate that began in Italy and now has branches worldwide, including in New York City. The Maggia (MAH-jee-ah) consists of several crime families, notably the Manfredis and the Nefarias. *First appearance: Avengers #13 (Feb. 1965)*

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Magneto 134, 143, 164, 165, **199***
One of the most powerful mutants in the world, Magneto—who controls magnetism—founded the Brotherhood of Evil Mutants, but he later reformed his ways and helped found the nation of Krakoa. He recently died on the heroes' world, but on Earth-56438, he is Krakoa's liaison with the Supremacy. He despises Hydra but sees working with the Supremacy as a necessary evil. *First appearance: X-Men #1 (Sept. 1963)*

Manfredis 19
One of the major families of New York's Maggia criminal organization. Led by Silvermane (Silvio Manfredi), the Manfredis have taken a quieter approach in recent years to avoid attracting the attention of super heroes. *First appearance: Amazing Spider-Man #73 (June 1969)*

Marta's 18
An upscale clothing boutique featuring the latest in Italian fashions. It's located near Nanni's restaurant in Little Italy.

Maximus
Maximus is the younger brother of Black Bolt, and a member of the Inhuman Royal Family. While a super genius, he is also mentally unstable and has mounted a number of attempts to take the Inhuman throne from his brother. On Earth-56438, he was killed while trying to renege on a deal with the Supremacy to destroy the rest of the Inhuman Royal Family. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #47 (Feb. 1966)*

Medusa 122, **218**
Medusa is a member of the Inhuman Royal Family with prehensile, floor-length hair. She married Black Bolt and is the queen of the Inhumans. She is also the older sister of Crystal. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #36 (March 1965)*

Metro-General Hospital 42
A public hospital located at West 58th Street and 9th Avenue in Manhattan, on the north side of Hell's Kitchen. *First appearance: Night Nurse #1 (Nov. 1972)*

Midtown North Police Precinct 44
A New York City Police Department precinct located at 306 West 54th Street in Manhattan, within Hell's Kitchen, five blocks south of Central Park. Bulldozer and Piledriver attack it in Chapter 3: Friendly Neighborhood.

Mister Fantastic 79, **205***
Super genius Reed Richards leads the Fantastic Four and was also a member of the Illuminati. On Earth-56438, though, his wife—the Invisible Woman—turned to Hydra for help after discovering Richards' involvement with the secretive group. Separated from his wife, he now works with the resistance instead. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #1 (Nov. 1961)*

Mockingbird 101, **219***
On the heroes' world, Bobbi Morse is a brilliant biologist turned costumed crime-fighter and occasional government agent. On Earth-56438, she became an espionage agent for Hydra instead. Appalled at Hydra's bullying tactics, she abandoned her post and joined up with the resistance. *First appearance: (as Barbara "Bobbie" Morse) Astonishing Tales #6 (June 1971); (as Mockingbird) Marvel Team-Up #95 (July 1980)*

M.O.D.O.K. 86, **207***
A super villain with a gigantic head supported by a hovering chair known as the Doomsday Chair. As M.O.D.O.C. (Mental Organism Designed Only for Computation), George Tarleton overthrew the leadership of A.I.M. and took charge of the organization himself, after which he changed the last letter in his acronym to a K for Killing. *First appearance: Tales of Suspense #94 (Oct. 1967)*

Modt 154
A large and powerful robot who resembles an armored giant. He is the second in a series of such creatures who guard the M'kraan Crystal in every universe in the Multiverse. Those who defeat him must then face an even more powerful guardian. *First appearance: X-Men #108 (Dec. 1977)*

Molecule Man 153
With the ability to rearrange reality at the atomic level, Owen Reece is one of the most powerful people in the universe. He started out as a villain but has since reformed, and he helped the Fantastic Four re-create the Multiverse after the birth of the Eighth Cosmos. On Earth-56438, he is nowhere to be found. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #20 (Nov. 1963)*

N

Nanni's Restaurant 18
An Italian restaurant in New York City's Little Italy neighborhood. It happens to be on the same block as Prano's, a rival restaurant that houses the initial gateway from Earth-56438 to the heroes' world. The arson of this place and the subsequent muscling of its owner, Giovanni di Batista Ingellis (GEE-oh-vah-nee dee ba-TEES-ta in-JEL-lees) are what draw the heroes into the first adventure.

Nicolo's 21
A used bookstore in Little Italy, near Nanni's Restaurant. It features Italian-language books in addition to the standard English-language ones, plus it has a phenomenal selection of fumetti (Italian comic books).

Nighthawk 97, 101, **221**
Kyle Richmond has had a long career as a costumed hero with the Avengers and Defenders in the heroes' universe. On Earth-56438, he works behind the scenes to fight crime while avoiding arrest by Hydra and the Supremacy. As part of that, he works hand-in-glove with the resistance. *First appearance: Avengers #69 (Oct. 1969)*

O

O'Dwyer, Incident Commander Siobhan 47
The officer in charge of Federal Emergency Aid and Response (F.E.A.R.). She is actually from Earth-56438 and is working for that universe's Hydra. She reports to Baron Zemo of Earth-56438.

Otherworld 155
A pocket dimension that features several different realms, it serves as a nexus of all reality. The Captain Britain Corps is usually headquartered here. Saturnyne currently rules it. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #54 (Sept. 1966)*

P

Parker, May 217
On the heroes' world, May Parker helped her husband, Ben, raise their nephew Peter Parker, who became Spider-Man shortly before a burglar killed Ben. On Earth-56438, Hydra killed Peter's parents before he was born. May and Ben became members of the resistance, a choice that cost Ben his life and made May even more determined to bring Hydra down. *First appearance: Amazing Fantasy #15 (June 1962)*

Piledriver 44, **225**
Brian Calusky, a masked super villain with enlarged and toughened hands. One of the original members of the Wrecking Crew. *First appearance: Defenders #17 (Nov. 1974)*

Prano's Restaurant 24
An Italian restaurant in New York City's Little Italy neighborhood. This is where the first portal between Earth-56438 and the heroes' world is opened.

Prince's Bay Lighthouse 83
An active lighthouse atop an 85-foot bluff on the southern shore of Staten Island. It has been helping guide ships, on and off, since 1828. On a clear day atop the lighthouse, you can see the Manhattan skyline in one direction and Sandy Hook, New Jersey, in another.

R

Raft 65, 72
A maximum-security prison for super-powered detainees that sits

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northwest of Ryker's Island in the East River, as part of the Bronx. On the heroes' world, it's run by the federal government. On Earth-56438, it falls under the control of Hydra and is filled with all sorts of political prisoners—super-powered people who refused to serve with the Supremacy. *First appearance: Alias #26 (Nov. 2003)*

Rama-Tut 129-134
See *Richards, Nathaniel*

Rama-Tut's Airships 129
These are airships that the Rama-Tut of Earth-56438 uses to move his robotic servants around Giza. They come equipped with energy cannons.

Remembrancer 123
A device Doctor Doom made to embed his memories into another person's mind. Doom ordered his Doombots to use it to transfer his mind into that of his chosen heir upon Doom's death. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #278 (May 1985)*

Resistance (of Earth-56438) 101-102
An organization on Earth-56438 dedicated to overthrowing Hydra and ending their control over the US and then the rest of the world. It features local versions of several people who are well-known super heroes in the heroes' universe, including Captain America (Steve Rogers), Ironheart, Maria Hill, J. Jonah Jameson, Mockingbird, Nighthawk (Kyle Richmond), May Parker, Shang-Chi, Spider-Woman (Jessica Drew), Stick, Storm and the Thing.

Resistance Hideout 108
A secret meeting space on the upper floor of a brownstone in Hell's Kitchen of Earth-56438. The first floor of the building houses a permanently closed store called the Book Nook.

Retcon
Short for "retroactive continuity." This refers to the practice of coming up with a new interpretation of previously established events, usually by showing that things weren't actually as they seemed. This information shows the past in a new light. It can refer to coming up with new ways to explain apparently contradictory details in a story, but it can also refer to altering a timeline's past to establish a new version of it.

Richards, Franklin 153
The oldest child of Mister Fantastic and the Invisible Woman. He had incredible powers at one point but has since lost them. On Earth-56438, he and his sister Valeria live under their mother's protection, and she takes great pains to keep Hydra's hands off them. *First appearance: Fantastic Four Annual #6 (Nov. 1968)*

Richards, Nathaniel 13, **209, 227**
The 30th-century man (from Earth-6311) who develops a time machine and travels into the past to prove his superiority by attempting to conquer as much of time as he can. He starts out as Rama-Tut and later becomes the Scarlet Centurion, Kang the Conqueror and Immortus. Other versions of him have become the Young Avenger Iron Lad and the villainous Kid Immortus, among others. In the universe of Earth-56438, he becomes Godking Kang, and in an unidentified universe, he transforms himself into Kang the Devourer. *First appearance: (as Rama-Tut) Fantastic Four #19 (Oct. 1963); (as Kang) Avengers #8 (Sept. 1964); (as Scarlet Centurion) Avengers Annual #2 (Sept. 1968); (as Immortus) Avengers #10 (Nov. 1964); (as Nathaniel Richards) Fantastic Four #272 (Nov. 1984); (as Iron Lad) Young Avengers #1 (April 2005); (as Kid Immortus) FF #8 (Aug. 2013)*

Richards, Valeria 153
The second child of Mister Fantastic and the Invisible Woman, she is a budding genius in her own right. On Earth-56438, she and her brother Franklin live under the protection of their mother, who takes great pains to keep Hydra's hands off them. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #15 (March 1999)*

S

Sabretooth 91, 100, **228***
On the heroes' world, Victor Creed is a brutal, sadistic killer, the kind that gives mutants a bad name. He's one of the few to have been thrown into the Pit on Krakoa as punishment for killing humans. On Earth-56438, the Supremacy appreciates those kinds of skills, and he's one of the top members of that group, living the life of a major celebrity. *First appearance: Iron Fist #14 (Aug. 1977)*

Sandstormers 129-130
A group of ruthless raiders in ancient Egypt, led by Baal. *First appearance: Rise of Apocalypse #1 (August 1996)*

Saturnyne 155
Originally from Earth-9, the sorcerer Saturnyne is the Omniversal Majestrix and the current ruler of Otherworld. She prefers to stay out of petty things like universes being destroyed one at a time. *First appearance: Marvel Super-Heroes (UK) #380 (Dec. 1981)*

Shang-Chi 101, **230***
Much like on the heroes' world, Zheng Shang-Chi threw off the evil influence of his father, who trained him to be a living weapon, one of the greatest martial artists alive. Instead of becoming the leader of the Five Weapons Society, though, on Earth-56438 Shang-Chi became an undercover agent of the resistance. *First appearance: Special Marvel Edition #15 (Dec. 1973)*

Silk 74, **234***
On the heroes' world, Cindy Moon was the second person bitten by the radioactive spider that gave Spider-Man (Peter Parker) his powers, but she spent years in a bunker hiding from the multiversal super villain Morlun. On Earth-56438, she was the only one bitten, and the Supremacy drafted her in soon after she gained her powers. *First appearance: Amazing Spider-Man #1 (June 2014)*

Silver Surfer 156, **228***
Norrin Radd pledged his service to Galactus as his herald to keep him from devouring his home planet of Zenn-La. He later defied Galactus to help the Fantastic Four save Earth. On Earth-56438, he was killed trying to defend Galactus from Kang the Devourer, one of the Devourer's first acts coming into a new universe. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #48 (Dec. 1965)*

Spider-Woman 94, **229**
On the heroes' world, Hydra took in Jessica Drew when she was a sheltered young woman, but she left them and became a super hero after refusing to assassinate Nick Fury Sr. On Earth-56438, Drew didn't have the same chances and became a member of the Supremacy, but she secretly joined the resistance as a double agent working against Hydra. *First appearance: Marvel Spotlight #32 (Feb. 1977)*

Stick 102, **230**
The blind man known only as Stick became a top martial artist and dedicated his life to protecting the world from the ancient ninja society called the Hand, as part of which he trained both Daredevils (Matt Murdock and Elektra). He's dead on the heroes' world, but as part of the resistance on Earth-56438, he continues to train fighters—to take down Hydra and the Supremacy instead. *First appearance: Daredevil #176 (Nov. 1981)*

Storm 102, **241***
In the heroes' universe, Ororo Munroe is a powerful leader of the mutants, having spent many years with the X-Men and their affiliated teams, and as the Voice of Sol, she represents the solar system on the Galactic Council. On Earth-56438, Hydra's much harsher suppression of mutants has kept her working in the shadows instead as part of the resistance. *First appearance: Giant-Size X-Men #1 (May 1975)*

Supremacy 13
The primary organization of super-powered people on Earth-56438, under Hydra's control. These are almost all variants of super villains from the heroes' own universe. It's a loose-knit group, much like the Avengers in the heroes' world. Hydra can assemble ad hoc teams from it for particular missions when needed.

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Supremacy Headquarters 103-108
A skyscraper that contains the offices, training facilities and living quarters of the members of the Supremacy centered in the US of Earth-56438. This includes Abomination, Egghead, Gorgon (Tomi Shishido), the Hood, Killmonger, Sabretooth and Viper (Ophelia Sarkissian). It is located where Stark Tower stood in the heroes' world, in the Columbus Circle neighborhood, near the southwest corner of Central Park.

Symkaria 153
A small eastern European nation that neighbors Latveria. In recent times, Latveria invaded and annexed it, bringing it under Doctor Doom's rule. *First appearance: Amazing Spider-Man #265 (June 1985)*

T

Taa II *156-161*
Galactus' starship, which is the size of an entire planet. It resembles a mobius strip twisted to form the symbol for infinity. It carries the machinery that Galactus uses to process the energy of a planet and make it easier to digest. Kang the Devourer uses it in a similar manner to devour timelines. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #49 (April 1966)*

Tallus 155
A wrist-worn device that contains a shard of the M'kraan Crystal and permits the wearer to travel between universes. The Exiles used it often. *First appearance: Exiles #1 (Aug. 2001)*

Taskmaster 76, 79, **245***
Anthony Masters, a super villain mercenary who can copy the moves of anyone he sees. The more moves he copies, though, the poorer the rest of his memory gets. Once a S.H.I.E.L.D. agent, he now sells his services to the highest bidder, including training the soldiers of various criminal organizations. *First appearance: Avengers #195 (May 1980)*

Temple of Rama-Tut 128, 132
A temple in Giza that sits near the Great Pyramids and the Sphinx. Rama-Tut of Earth-56438 used it as his headquarters when he ruled in ancient Egypt.

Terrigen Mist 125
A vapor that arises when Terrigen Crystals get wet. Inhumans exposed to it gain super powers. Sometimes this can go terribly wrong, so few Inhumans undergo the process, known as Terrigenesis, and usually only after genetic screening to prevent troubles. *First appearance: Thor #146 (Nov. 1967)*

Thanos 164, **245***
An Eternal born on Titan (a moon of Saturn) who became obsessed with death from an early age. He used the Infinity Gauntlet to destroy half the universe, but it was later restored. He recently took over as the ruler of the Eternals and was killed, but he has come back from the grave several times before. On Earth-56438, he arranged a detente with the Supremacy, which led to rumors that Hydra has control of the Infinity Gauntlet. *First appearance: Iron Man #55 (Feb. 1973)*

Thing 102, **246***
The rock-skinned and muscle-bound Ben Grimm is a founding member of the Fantastic Four. On Earth-56438, he was disgusted to learn that his best friend, Mister Fantastic, was a member of the Illuminati, but he knew Hydra was worse, so he now works alongside him for the resistance. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #1 (Nov. 1961)*

Thunderball 42, **231**
Dr. Eliot Franklin, a masked super villain (and former physicist) who wields a wrecking ball at the end of a chain. One of the original members of the Wrecking Crew. *First appearance: Defenders #17 (Nov. 1974)*

Ticket to the Multiverse 154
A device that allows its user to travel the multiverse, bonded to the DNA of Ghost-Spider. Her counterpart from Earth-3109 (who was the Green Goblin of that world) created it for her to thank Ghost-Spider for her help. *First appearance: Spider-Gwen: Ghost-Spider #3 (Feb. 2019)*

Time Chair 126, 134
A floating chair that Kang the Conqueror uses to travel through time on his own. *First appearance: Avengers #8 (Sept. 1964)*

Time-Eater
Nathaniel Richards of Earth-18854 became a version of Kang the Conqueror who killed the Galactus of his universe and stole his power. He then repeated that crime in countless universes until he became the Time-Eater. Instead of consuming timelines like Kang the Devourer, though, he consumed entire realities and digested them slowly. When a team of Exiles assembled from universes threatened by the Time-Eater defeated him, those realities returned to existence. *First appearance: Exiles #1 (June 2018)*

Time Platform 147
A device capable of sending those standing on it through time, invented by Doctor Doom, who originally used it to travel into the past to better study the use of magic. When activated, the platform will carry those standing on it through time as a group. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #5 (July 1962)*

Time Ship 132
A ship that Nathaniel Richards uses to travel through time by passing through the timeless realm of Limbo. It is also space-worthy and usually features the Eye of Ages. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #19 (Oct. 1963)*

Titania 71, **249***
Mary MacPherran was given her powers by Doctor Doom, and they transformed her into a statuesque powerhouse who takes glee in fistfights. Her Earth-56438 version hasn't been tested in battle by powerful foes and fears such confrontations. *First appearance: Marvel Super Heroes Secret Wars #3 (July 1984)*

Triton
A member of the Inhuman Royal Family and the older brother of Karnak. When Triton gained his aquatic powers, he also switched from breathing air to breathing water. In the heroes' universe, he recently died. On Earth-56438, he also died, but at the hands of the Supremacy, while trying to defend Maximus from them. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #45 (Dec. 1965)*

U

Ultimate Nullifier 147, 155, 165
A handheld weapon that can destroy anyone it is used against. In most cases, it also destroys the user. It is the only weapon Galactus fears. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #50 (May 1966)*

Untermyer Gardens Conservancy 65, 83,
A historic, 43-acre public park in northwest Yonkers. It features several gardens and classical structures, including the Temple of Love and the Temple of the Sky. They originally belonged to attorney Samuel Untermyer as part of a 150-acre estate, but he donated them to Yonkers after his death. They have been publicly owned since 1946.

V

Viper 114, **233**
Orphaned as a girl, Ophelia Sarkissian was taken in by Hydra and trained to become one of their greatest agents. With her ruthlessness and skills, she eventually rose to lead the entire organization. On Earth-56438, she has a more public-facing role as one of the leaders of the Supremacy instead. *First appearance: (as Madame Hydra) Captain America #110 (Feb. 1969); (as Viper) Captain America #180 (Dec. 1974)*

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VTOL Jet 67, 75
A vertical take-off-and-landing aircraft that Nick Fury Jr. uses to get places quickly. When in flight, it can move as fast as a jet, but it can also hover, land and take off from landing pads like a helicopter.

W

Wall of Remembrance 65, 83
A monument installed on the wall of Maimonides Park, the stadium of the Brooklyn Cyclones, a minor-league baseball team on Coney Island, on the south edge of Brooklyn. It features portraits of the first responders who lost their lives trying to save others after the attack on the World Trade Center on September 11, 2001.

Watcher (Emnu) 156, 168
The Watcher who invented the Ultimate Nullifier and used it to stop an alien race from conquering the universe with Watcher technology. In the heroes' universe, he recently lost much of his powers, along with the rest of the Watchers except Uatu. In the universe of Earth-56438, the Watchers maintain their pledge of noninterference. *First appearance: Tales of Suspense #53 (May 1964)*

Watcher (Uatu) 125, 145, 168
The Watcher assigned to monitor Earth. Although pledged never to interfere with the fate of other races, he often bent or broke that promise. In the heroes' universe, he is the only Watcher to retain his powers and now watches for them all. In the universe of Earth-56438, the Watchers still have their powers, and he steadfastly holds to his pledge, much as it pains him. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #13 (April 1963)*

Watchers 147, 168
An ancient and powerful alien race—originally called the Luminous—who long monitored the rest of the universe, earning them their name as the Watchers. In the universe's early days, they shared their technology with a younger race that then used it to try to conquer the universe. After stopping the threat, the Watchers pledged never to interfere with the development of another alien race again. In the heroes' universe, all of them except Uatu recently lost their powers. In the universe of Earth-56438, the Watchers maintain their pledge of noninterference. *First appearance: Fantastic Four #13 (April 1963)*

Winter Soldier 72, **258***
On the heroes' world, James Barnes was Captain America's sidekick Bucky during World War II. After his apparent death, the Soviet Union recovered him and brainwashed him into one of their top assassins. It wasn't until decades later that Captain America (Steve Rogers) discovered him and rescued him. On Earth-56438, though, the Winter Soldier is still brainwashed and has become a valued member of the Supremacy. *First appearance: (as Bucky) Captain America Comics #1 (March 1941); (as Winter Soldier) Captain America #1 (Jan. 2005)*

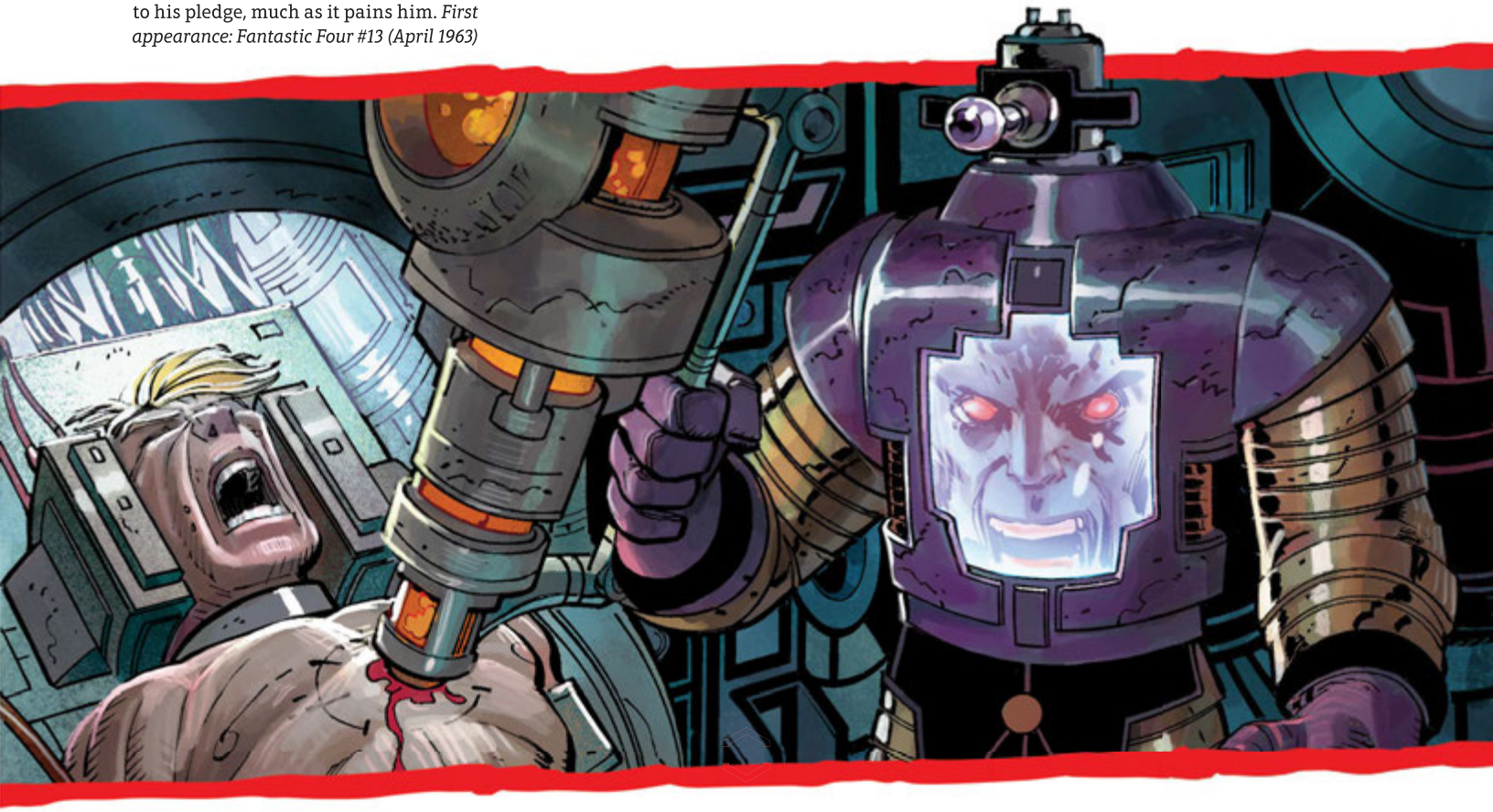
Wrecker 42, **215**
Dirk Garthwaite, a masked super villain who draws his power from an enchanted crowbar. Also the founder and leader of the Wrecking Crew. *First appearance: Thor #148 (Jan. 1968)*

Wrecking Crew 39, 44
A team of demolition-themed super villains founded by the Wrecker, who shared some of his power with his fellow inmates after they escaped from jail. *First appearance: Defenders #17 (Nov. 1974)*

Z

Zemo, Baron Helmut 39, 64, 134, **142***
A Hydra leader, both on the heroes' world and on Earth-56438. He is the son of Nazi scientist Baron Heinrich Zemo, who invented Adhesive X. Ironically, he fell into a boiling vat of the substance, which horribly disfigured him. On Earth-56438, he is considered Hydra's equivalent of Captain America. *First appearance: (as Phoenix) Captain America #168 (Dec. 1973); (as Baron Zemo) Captain America #276 (Dec. 1982)*

Zola, Arnim 76, **176**
A Nazi scientist who transferred his mind into a robot body that shows a face through a video screen embedded in its chest. He worked alongside Baron Heinrich Zemo, and he helped found Hydra after World War II. He later discovered and colonized Dimension Z, a pocket dimension in which time runs faster than in the heroes' world. *First appearance: Captain America #208 (April 1977)*



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